

Palm OS® Programmer's Companion

Volume I

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About This Document

Palm OS Programmer's Companion is part of the Palm OS® Software Development Kit. This introduction provides an overview of SDK documentation, discusses what materials are included in this document and what conventions are used.

Palm OS SDK Documentation

The following documents are part of the SDK:

Document	Description
Palm OS Programmer's API Reference	An API reference document that contains descriptions of all Palm OS function calls and important data structures.
Palm OS Programmer's Companion	A multi-volume guide to application programming for the Palm OS. This guide contains conceptual and "how-to" information that complements the Reference.
Constructor for Palm OS	A guide to using Constructor to create Palm OS resource files.
Palm OS Programming Development Tools Guide	A guide to writing and debugging Palm OS applications with the various tools available.

What This Volume Contains

This volume is designed for random access. That is, you can read any chapter in any order. You don't necessarily have to read some before others, though the first few chapters are designed for programmers who are new to the Palm OS. The first four chapters help you learn necessary tasks and possible features for your application.

Note that each chapter ends with a list of hypertext links into the relevant function descriptions in the Reference book.

Here is an overview of this volume:

- Chapter 1, "Programming Palm OS in a Nutshell." Provides new Palm OS programmers with a summary of what tasks and tools are involved in writing a Palm™ application and provides pointers to where to look for more information.
- Chapter 2, "Good Design Practices." Provides new Palm OS programmers with guidelines for creating a well-designed Palm application with a well-designed user interface.
- Chapter 3, "Application Startup and Stop." Describes how to use and respond to launch codes to start and stop an application and perform other actions. Describes how to implement the `PilotMain` function, the entry point for all applications.
- Chapter 4, "Event Loop." Describes the event manager, events, the event loop, and how to implement the event loop in your application. Discusses how your application and the system interact to handle events.
- Chapter 5, "User Interface." Describes the user interface elements that you can use in your application and how to use them. Also covers related topics such as drawing, dynamic UI, receiving user input, and the application launcher.
- Chapter 6, "Memory." Describes the memory architecture, memory use on the Palm devices, and the memory manager.
- Chapter 7, "Files and Databases." Describes the data storage system, the data manager, resource manager, and the file streaming API.
- Chapter 8, "Expansion." Describes how to work with expansion cards and add-on devices using the Palm OS Expansion and Virtual File System (VFS) Managers.
- Chapter 9, "Attentions and Alarms."Describes the Attention Manager, which applications use to bring important events to the user's attention, and the Alarm Manager, which allows applications to receive notification at some future point in time.
- Chapter 10, "Palm System Support." Describes features unique to the Palm hardware and OS such as the feature

manager, preferences, the sound manager, system boot and reset, the microkernal, time, and floating point arithmetic.

- Chapter 11, "Localized Applications." Discusses how to make your application localizable. Includes information on the text and international managers, as well as dealing with alternative character encodings, strings, numbers, and dates.
- Chapter 12, "Debugging Strategies." Describes programmatic approaches to debugging your application; that is, using the error manager and the Palm OS try and catch mechanism for debugging.
- Chapter 13, "Standard IO Applications." Describes how to create a command line application. On Palm OS, command line applications are typically used by developers for debugging purposes only.

Volume II of the Palm OS Programmer's Companion discusses communications.

Additional Resources

- Documentation

  Palm publishes its latest versions of this and other documents for Palm OS developers at

  http://www.palmos.com/dev/tech/docs/

- Training

  Palm and its partners host training classes for Palm OS developers. For topics and schedules, check

  http://www.palmos.com/dev/tech/support/classes/

- Knowledge Base

  The Knowledge Base is a fast, web-based database of technical information. Search for frequently asked questions (FAQs), sample code, white papers, and the development documentation at

  http://www.palmos.com/dev/tech/kb/

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Programming Palm OS in a Nutshell

This chapter is the place to start if you're new to Palm™ programming. It summarizes what's unique about writing applications for Palm OS® platform devices and tells you where to go for more in-depth information. It covers:

- Why Programming for Palm OS Is Different
- Palm OS Programming Concepts
- Programming Tools
- Where to Go From Here

Read this chapter for a high-level introduction to Palm programming. The rest of this book provides the details.

Why Programming for Palm OS Is Different

Like most programmers, you have probably written a desktop application—an application that is run on a desktop computer such as a PC or a Macintosh computer. Writing applications for handhelds, specifically Palm OS platform devices, is a bit different from writing desktop applications because the Palm OS platform device is designed differently than a desktop computer. Also, users simply interact with the device differently than they do desktop computers.

This section describes how these differences affect the design of a Palm OS application.

Screen Size

The Palm OS device's screen is only 160x160 pixels, so the amount of information you can display at one time is limited.

For this reason, you must design your user interface carefully with different priorities and goals than are used for large screens. Strive for a balance between providing enough information and overcrowding the screen. See the section "User Interface Guidelines" in the chapter "Good Design Practices" for more detailed guidelines on designing the user interface.

Note that screen sizes of future Palm OS devices may vary.

Quick Turnaround Expected

On a PC, users don't mind waiting a few seconds while an application loads because they plan to use the application for an extended amount of time.

By contrast, the average Palm user uses a Palm application 15 to 20 times per day for much briefer periods of time, usually just a few seconds. Speed is therefore a critical design objective for hand-held organizers and is not limited to execution speed of the code. The total time needed to navigate, select, and execute commands can have a big impact on overall efficiency. (Also consider that the Palm OS does not provide a wait cursor.)

To maximize performance, the user interface should minimize navigation between windows, opening of dialog boxes, and so on. The layout of application screens needs to be simple so that the user can pick up the product and use it effectively after a short time. It's especially helpful if the user interface of your application is consistent with other applications on the device so users work with familiar patterns.

The Palm OS development team has put together a set of design guidelines that were used as the basis for the applications resident on the device (MemoPad, Address Book, etc.). These guidelines are summarized in the chapter "Good Design Practices" in this book.

PC Connectivity

PC connectivity is an integral component of the Palm OS platform device. The device comes with a cradle that connects to a desktop PC and with software for the PC that provides "one-button" backup and synchronization of all data on the device with the user's PC.

Many Palm OS applications have a corresponding application on the desktop. To share data between the device's application and the desktop's application, you must write a **conduit**. A conduit is a plug-in to the HotSync® technology that runs when you press the HotSync button. A conduit synchronizes data between the application on the desktop and the application on the hand-held device. To write a conduit, you use the Conduit SDK, which provides its own documentation.

Input Methods

Users of a Palm Powered™ handheld device don't have a keyboard or mouse. Users enter data into the device using a pen. They can either write Graffiti® strokes or use the keyboard dialog provided on the device.

While Graffiti strokes and the keyboard dialog are useful ways of entering data, they are not as convenient as using the full-sized desktop computer with its keyboard and mouse. Therefore, you should not require users to enter a lot of data on the device itself.

Power

The Palm OS platform device runs on batteries and thus does not have the same processing power as a desktop PC. It is intended as a satellite viewer for corresponding desktop applications.

If your application needs to perform a computationally intensive task, you should implement that task in the desktop application instead of the device application.

Memory

The Palm OS device has limited heap space and storage space. Different versions of the device have between 512K and 8MB total of dynamic memory and storage available. The device does not have a disk drive or PCMCIA support.

Because of the limited space and power, optimization is critical. To make your application as fast and efficient as possible, optimize for heap space first, speed second, code size third.

File System

Because of the limited storage space, and to make synchronization with the desktop computer more efficient, Palm OS does not use a traditional file system. You store data in memory chunks called **records**, which are grouped into **databases**. A database is analogous to a file. The difference is that data is broken down into multiple records instead of being stored in one contiguous chunk. To save space, you edit a database in place in memory instead of creating it in RAM and then writing it out to storage.

Backward Compatibility

Different versions of the Palm OS platform device are available, and each runs a different version of the Palm OS. Users are not expected to upgrade their versions of the Palm OS as rapidly as they would an operating system on a desktop computer. Updates to the OS are designed in such a way that you can easily maintain backward compatibility with previous versions of the OS, and thus, your application is available to more users. See "Making Your Application Run on Different Devices" in the chapter "Good Design Practices" for details.

Palm OS Programming Concepts

Palm OS applications are generally single-threaded, event-driven programs. Only one program runs at a time. To successfully build a Palm OS application, you have to understand how the system itself is structured and how to structure your application.

- Each application has a `PilotMain` function that is equivalent to `main` in C programs. To launch an application, the system calls `PilotMain` and sends it a **launch code**. The launch code may specify that the application is to become active and display its user interface (called a normal launch), or it may specify that the application should simply perform a small task and exit without displaying its user interface.

  The sole purpose of the `PilotMain` function is to receive launch codes and respond to them. (See Chapter 3, "Application Startup and Stop.")

- Palm OS is an event-based operating system, so Palm OS applications contain an event loop; however, this event loop is only started in response to the normal launch. Your application may perform work outside the event loop in response to other launch codes. Chapter 4, "Event Loop," describes the main event loop.
- Most Palm OS applications contain a user interface made up of **forms**, which are analogous to windows in a desktop application. The user interface may contain both predefined UI elements (sometimes referred to as **UI objects**), and custom UI elements. (See Chapter 5, "User Interface.")
- All applications should use the memory and data management facilities provided by the system. (See Chapter 6, "Memory." and Chapter 7, "Files and Databases.")
- You implement an application's features by calling Palm OS functions. Palm OS consists of several managers, which are groups of functions that work together to implement a feature. As a rule, all functions that belong to one manager use the same prefix and work together to implement a certain aspect of functionality.

  Managers are available to, for example, generate sounds, send alarms, perform network communication, and beam information through an infrared port. A good way to find out the capabilities of the Palm OS is to scan the Table of Contents of this guide.

IMPORTANT: The ANSI C libraries are not part of the Palm development platform. In many cases, you can perform the same function using a Palm OS API call as you can with a call to a ANSI C function. For example, the Palm OS provides a string manager that performs many of the string functions you'd expect to be able to perform in an ANSI C program. If you do use a standard C function, the code for the function is linked into your application and results in a bigger executable.

Programming Tools

Several tools are available that help you build, test, and debug Palm OS applications. The most widely used tool is the CodeWarrior Interactive Development Environment (IDE). Documentation for the CodeWarrior IDE is provided with CodeWarrior. (See http://www.palmos.com/dev/tech/tools/ for information about other development tools.)

As with most applications, the user interface is generally stored in one or more resource files. You use the Palm OS Constructor to create these resources. To learn how, refer to the Constructor documentation.

To debug and test your application, there are several tools available:

- The CodeWarrior Debugger handles source-level debugging. You can use it with an application running on the Palm OS device, or you can use it in conjunction with one of the other debugging tools below.
- The Palm OS Emulator (POSE) tests your application on the desktop computer before downloading it onto the device.
- On the Macintosh, you can build a Simulator version of your application to test it. This is a standalone Mac OS application that runs your Palm OS application on a Macintosh computer.
- The Palm Debugger is an assembly-level tool. You can also use it to enter commands directly to the Palm device.

The book *Palm OS Programming Development Tools Guide* describes the Palm-provided debugging tools available on your development platform. For CodeWarrior Debugger documentation, refer to the CodeWarrior CD.

Where to Go From Here

This chapter provided you only with a general outline of the issues involved in writing a Palm OS application. To learn the specifics, refer to the following resources:

- This book

  The rest of this book provides details on how to implement common application features using the Palm OS SDK. If you're new to Palm OS programming, you need to read the next three chapters to learn the principles of Palm OS application and UI design, how to implement the main function, and how to implement the standard event loop. The remaining chapters you can read on an as-needed basis.

- Example applications

  The actual source code for the applications on the Palm OS device is included as examples on your SDK CD. The code can be a valuable aid when you develop your own program. The software development kit provides a royalty-free license that permits you to use any or all of the source code from the examples in your application.

- *Palm OS Programming Development Tools Guide*

  The *Palm OS Programming Development Tools Guide* provides more details on using the tools to debug programs. (You might also be interested in the "Debugging Strategies" chapter in this book, which describes programmatic debugging solutions.)

- *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*

  The reference book provides the details on all of the public data structures and API calls.

- Conduit Development Kits and documentation

  If you need to write a conduit for your application, see the documentation provided with the Conduit Development Kits.

2

Good Design Practices

This chapter helps you design an application that's fast, robust, and consistent with other applications on the device. The previous chapter described at a very high level the sorts of issues involved with writing a Palm OS® application. This chapter goes into much more detail about what is appropriate application design and user interface design. Its focus is how to:

- Avoid potential problems
- Make your application integrate well with others
- Achieve the best performance possible
- Localize with the minimum amount of work
- Maintain backward compatibility

The information was collected from engineers, testers, and other experts who designed, developed, and tested the four applications shipped with the first Palm OS device.

Paying attention to user interface guidelines and, if applicable, to localization guidelines early in your development cycle will save you time and trouble later. However, there's a lot to digest here. You may want to revisit this chapter from time to time to make sure you haven't forgotten anything.

This chapter discusses these topics:

- Designing Your Application
- User Interface Guidelines
- Localization Guidelines
- Making Your Application Run on Different Devices

NOTE: Be sure to read the "Avoiding Potential Pitfalls" and "Writing Robust Code" sections for information on the problems developers encounter most frequently.

Designing Your Application

This section provides Palm OS application design guidelines. It discusses these topics:

- Integrating Programs With the Palm OS Environment
- API Naming Conventions
- Achieving Optimum Performance
- Assigning a Database Type and Creator ID
- Working With Databases
- Writing Robust Code
- Avoiding Potential Pitfalls

Integrating Programs With the Palm OS Environment

When users work with a Palm OS application, they expect to be able to switch to other applications, have access to Graffiti® and the on-screen keyboard, access information with the global find, receive alarms, and so on. Your application will integrate well with others if you follow the guidelines in this section. Integrate with the system software as follows:

- Handle `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch`
- Handle or ignore other application launch codes as appropriate. For more information, see the next chapter, Chapter 3, "Application Startup and Stop."
- Handle system preferences properly. System preferences determine the display of
  - Date formats
  - Time formats
  - Number formats
  - First day of week (Sunday or Monday)

  Be sure your application uses the system preferences for numeric formats, date, time, and start day of week.

- Allow the system to post these messages:
  - alarms
  - low-battery warnings
  - system messages during synchronization
- Be sure your application does not obscure or change the Graffiti area, silk-screened buttons, and power button.
- Don't obscure Graffiti shift indicators.

In addition, follow these rules:

- Store state information in the application preferences database, not in the application record database. Call `PrefGetAppPreferences` and `PrefSetAppPreferences` to save and restore preferences. This is important if your application returns to the last displayed view by default.
- If your application uses the serial port, be sure to free the port when you no longer need it so that the HotSync® application can use it.
- Ensure that your application properly handles the global find. Generally, searches and sorts aren't case sensitive.
- If your application supports private records, be sure they are unavailable to the global find when they should be hidden.
- The application name is defined in two ways:

  The application name (required) is specified in the PalmRez panel of your CodeWarrior project and used by HotSync, the About box, the Memory display, and the database header.

  - The application icon name (optional) is a string resource in the application's resource file. It is used by the launcher screen and in the Button Assignment preferences panel (available in OS versions 2.0 and later). You assign the name using the Constructor Project Settings panel.

    Using the icon name is useful if you plan to localize your application.

    Note: If you use an application icon name, make it short!

- Together with the application name, each application displays a application icon in the launcher.

  Your applications needs to have two icons:

  – A large icon of type `tAIB`, with an ID of 1000. For compatibility with 2.0 devices, this icon should be 22 x 32 pixels; if your application only runs on older devices, you can make this icon 22 x 22 pixels.

  – A smaller icon, also of type `tAIB`, with an ID of 1001. This icon should be 15 x 9 pixels.

NOTE: The Constructor program supplied with Palm OS versions 3.5 and later allows you to create an Application Icon Family. You should not select the App Icon or Multi-bit Icon categories in this Constructor.

- Follow the guidelines listed in User Interface Guidelines and pay special attention to these points:
  – Ensure that the different user input modes (e.g., Graffiti and keyboard) are available for each field.
  – Ensure that menu items work with shortcuts as advertised.
  – Put limits on the length of fields and test them.
  – Ensure that any growable control, such as the launcher window or the menus, scrolls correctly.
- Ensure that your application properly handles system messages during and after synchronization.
- Ensure that deleted records are not displayed.
- Ensure that your application doesn't exceed the maximum number of categories: 15 categories and the obligatory category "Unfiled" for a total of 16.
- Ensure that your application uses a consistent default state when the user enters it:
  – Some applications have a fixed default; for example, the Date Book always displays the current day when launched.

  - Other applications return to the place the user exited last. In that case, remember to provide a default if that place is no longer available. Because of HotSync and Preferences, don't assume the application data is the same as it was when the user looked at it last.

- If your application uses sounds, be sure it uses the Warning and Confirmation sounds properly.

API Naming Conventions

The following conventions are used throughout the Palm OS API:

- Functions start with a capital letter.
- All functions belonging to a particular manager start with a two- or three-letter prefix, such as "Ctl" for control functions or "Ftr" for functions that are part of the feature manager.
- Events and other constants start with a lowercase letter.
- Structure elements start with a lowercase letter.
- Global variables start with a capital letter.
- Typedefs start with a capital letter and end with "Type" (for example, `DateFormatType`, found in `DateTime.h`).
- Macintosh ResEdit resource types usually start with a lowercase letter followed by three capital letters, for example tSTR or tTBL. (Customized Macintosh resources provided with your developer package are all uppercase, for example, MENU. Some resources, such as Talt, don't follow the conventions.)
- Members of an enumerated type start with a lowercase prefix followed by a name starting with a capital letter, as follows:

```
enum formObjects {
     frmFieldObj,
     frmControlObj,
     frmListObj,
     frmTableObj,
     frmBitmapObj,
     frmLineObj,
     frmFrameObj,
     frmRectangleObj,
     frmLabelObj,
```

```
    frmTitleObj,
    frmPopupObj,
    frmGraffitiStateObj,
    frmGadgetObj};
typedef enum formObjects FormObjectKind;
```

Achieving Optimum Performance

Because the Palm OS device has limited heap space and storage, optimization is critical. The Palm OS device currently has no wait cursor, so users will expect rapid response. Test for performance. Launching, switching, and finding should be fast.

To make your application as fast and efficient as possible, optimize for heap space first, speed second, code size third.

Follow these guidelines to optimize memory use:

- Allocate handles for your memory to avoid heap fragmentation.
- Sort on demand; don't keep different sort lists around. This makes your program simpler and requires less storage.
- Dynamic memory is a potential bottleneck. Don't put large structures on the stack.
- Arrange subroutines within the application to avoid 32K jumps.
- To have your application run well within the constraints of the limited dynamic heap, follow these guidelines:
  - Allocate memory chunks instead of using global variables where possible.
  - Switch from one UI form to another instead of stacking up dialog boxes.
  - Edit database records in place; don't make extra copies on the dynamic heap.
- Avoid placing large amounts of data on the stack. Heap corruption is hard to debug. Global variables are preferable to local variables (however, chunks are preferable to global variables). Your application only has from 2K or 4K of stack space depending on the system software version.

Assigning a Database Type and Creator ID

Each Palm OS application is uniquely identified by a four-byte creator ID. Assigning this same creator ID to all of the databases related to an application associates those databases with the application. The OS takes advantage of this; for instance, the launcher's Info panel uses the creator ID to calculate the total memory used by each application.

Each database on the Palm device has a type as well as a creator ID. The database type allows applications and the OS to distinguish among multiple databases with the same creator ID. For applications, set the database type to `sysFileTApplication` (`'appl'`). For each database associated with an application, set the database type to any other value (as long as it isn't composed entirely of lowercase letters, since those are reserved by Palm). Certain predefined types—such as `'appl'` (application) or `'libr'` (library)—have special meaning to the Palm OS. For instance, the launcher looks at the database type to determine which databases are applications.

Types and creator IDs are case-sensitive, and are composed of four ASCII characters in the range 32-126 (decimal). Types and creator IDs consisting of all lowercase letters are reserved for use by Palm Inc., so any type or creator ID that you choose must contain at least one uppercase letter, digit, or symbol[1].

To protect your application from conflicting with others, you need to register your creator ID with Palm, which maintains a database of registered IDs. To choose and register a creator ID, see this web page:

http://www.palmos.com/dev/creatorid/

Note that you don't need to register database types as you do creator IDs. Each creator ID in effect defines a new space of types, so there is no connection between two databases with type 'Data' but with different creator IDs.

1. Palm has also reserved `'pqa '`.

IMPORTANT: Applications with identical creator IDs cannot coexist on the same device; during installation the new application will replace the existing application that possesses the same creator ID. Further, the new application could well corrupt any databases that were associated with the preexisting application. For this reason, all applications should have their own unique creator ID.

Finally, creator IDs aren't used only to identify databases. They are also used, among other things, when getting or setting application preferences, to register for notifications, and to identify features.

Working With Databases

Working properly with databases makes your application run faster and synchronize without problems. Follow these suggestions:

- Database names can be up to 31 characters in length, and on the handheld can be composed of any valid ASCII characters. Conduits—in particular, the backup conduit—impose additional limitations, however. The following characters are replaced with an underscore ("_") when the database is transferred to the desktop by the backup conduit:

  ```
  * + , . / : ; < = > ? [ ] | \ ^ "
  ```

  As well, the backup conduit stores databases in case-insensitive format, so you should avoid filenames that depend on case for distinction.

  By convention, filename extensions are not used on the handheld. Instead, database types are used to identify databases as members of a certain type or class. Note that when the backup conduit transfers a file to the desktop, it automatically appends a `.pdb` or `.prc` extension, as appropriate, to the database filename. This extension is removed when the file is transferred back to the handheld.

- When the user deletes a record, call `DmDeleteRecord` to remove all data from the record, not `DmRemoveRecord` to remove the record itself. That way, the desktop application

can retrieve the information that the record is deleted the next time there is a HotSync.

Note: If your application doesn't have an associated conduit, call `DmRemoveRecord` to completely remove the record.

- Keep data in database records compact. To avoid performance problems, Palm OS databases are not compressed, but all data are tightly packed. This pays off for storage and during HotSync.
- All records in a database should be of the same type and format. This is not a requirement, but is highly recommended to avoid processing overhead.
- Be sure your application modifies the flags in the database header appropriately when the user deletes or otherwise modifies information. This flag modification is only required if you're synchronizing with the Palm PIM applications.
- Don't display deleted records.
- Call `DmSetDatabaseInfo` when creating a database to assign a version number to your application. Databases default to version 0 if the version isn't explicitly set.
- Call `DmDatabaseInfo` to check the database version at application start-up.

Writing Robust Code

To make your programs more robust and to increase their compatibility with the next generation of Palm OS products, it is strongly recommended that you follow the guidelines and practices outlined in this section.

- Check assumptions

  You can write defensive code by adding frequent calls to the `ErrNonFatalDisplayIf` function, which enables your debug builds to check assumptions. Many bugs are caught in this way, and these "extra" calls don't weigh down your shipping application. You can keep more important checks in the release builds by using the `ErrFatalDisplayIf` function.

- Avoid continual polling

  To conserve the battery, avoid continual polling. If your application is in a wait loop, poll at short intervals (for example, every tenth of a second) instead. The event loop of the Hardball example application included with your Palm OS SDK illustrates how to do this.

- Avoid reading and writing to `NULL` (or low memory)

  When calling functions that allocate memory (`MemSet`, `MemMove` and similar functions) make sure that the pointers they return are non-`NULL`. (If you can do better validation than that, so much the better.) Also check that pointers your code obtains from structures or other function calls are not `NULL`. Consider adding to your debug build a `#define` that overrides `MemMove` (and similar functions) with a version that validates the arguments passed to it.

- Use dynamic heap space frugally

  It is important not to use the extra dynamic heap space available on Palm units running 2.0 and higher unless it is truly necessary to do so. Wasteful use of heap space may limit your application to running only on the latest devices—which prevents it from running on the very large number of units already in the marketplace.

  Note that some system services, such as the IrDA stack or the Find window, can require additional memory while your application is running; for example, if the unit starts to receive a beam or other external input, the system may need to allocate additional heap space for the incoming data. Don't use all available dynamic memory just because it's there; instead, consider using the storage heap for working with large amounts of temporary data.

- Check result codes when allocating memory

  Because future devices may have larger or smaller amounts of available memory, it is always a good idea to check result codes carefully when allocating memory. It's also good practice to use the storage heap (and possibly file streams) to work with large objects.

- Avoid allocating zero-length objects

  It's not valid to allocate a zero-byte buffer, or to resize a buffer to zero bytes. Palm OS 2.0 and previous releases allowed this practice, but future revisions of the OS may not permit zero-length objects.

- Avoid making assumptions about the screen

  The location of the screen buffer, its size, and the number of pixels per bit aren't set in stone—they might well change. Don't hack around the windowing and drawing functions. If you are going to hack the hardware to circumvent the APIs, save the state and return the system to that saved state when you quit.

- Don't access globals or hardware directly

  Global variables and their locations can change; to avoid mishaps, use the documented API functions and disable your application if it is run on anything but a tested version of the OS. Future devices might run on a different processor than the current one.

  Similarly, don't hardcode references to cards. Although current Palm OS hardware provides only a single card slot, this may not always be the case. Thus, when calling functions that manipulate cards, such as database manager and file streaming functions, pass a variable that references the target card, rather than passing a hardcoded reference to card 0.

- Built-in applications can change

  The format and size of the preferences (and data) for the built-in applications is subject to change. Write your code defensively, and consider disabling your application if it is run on an untested version of the OS.

Avoiding Potential Pitfalls

Certain problems are encountered by application developers again and again. To avoid them, ask yourself these questions:

- Do you have a Creator ID for your application?

- Each application (not just each company) has to have a Creator ID. Note that the Creator ID is only needed for the application (database of type `'appl'`) not for all other databases. To ensure that your Creator ID is unique, register it using this web page:

  http://www.palmos.com/dev/creatorid/

- Did you use C library calls in your application? If you did, change them to corresponding Palm OS calls.

User Interface Guidelines

The Palm OS device is designed for rapid entry and quick retrieval of information. To maximize performance, the UI should minimize navigation between windows, opening of dialog boxes, and so on. The layout of application screens needs to be simple so that the user can pick up the product and use it effectively after a short time. It's especially helpful if the UI of your application is consistent with other applications on the device so users work with familiar patterns.

This section helps you design a user interface that's intuitive, easy to use, and consistent with other applications on the device. You learn about these issues:

- Understanding the Palm OS UI Design Philosophy
- Creating a Palm OS User Interface
- Palm OS Resource Selection: List or Table?

NOTE: Guidelines for implementing specific user-interface objects, such as information on the size of buttons or the font for labels, is provided in "Palm OS Resources" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*. Also see the chapter "User Interface" in this book.

Understanding the Palm OS UI Design Philosophy

This section considers some issues that underlie the design of a user interface for the Palm OS device. It discusses these topics:

- Creating Fast Applications
- Matching Use Frequency and Accessibility
- Creating Easy-to-Use Applications

Creating Fast Applications

On a PC, users don't mind waiting a few seconds while an application loads because they plan to use the application for a certain amount of time.

The Palm OS paradigm, in contrast, resembles that of a watch: People want instant access to information. Speed is therefore a critical design objective for hand-held organizers and is not limited to execution speed of the code. The total time needed to navigate, select, and execute commands can have a big impact on overall efficiency.

The user should be able to keep up with someone on the telephone when setting up appointments, looking up phone numbers, and so on. Priorities include the ability to:

- Execute key commands quickly
- Navigate to key screens quickly
- Find key data quickly (for example, phone numbers)

Matching Use Frequency and Accessibility

PC user interfaces are typically designed to display commands as if they were used equally. In reality, some commands are used very frequently while most are used only rarely. Similarly, some settings are more likely to be used than others. For example, a 3 p.m.- 4 p.m. meeting occurs much more frequently than a 3:25 to 4:15 meeting.

More frequently used commands and settings should be easier to find and faster to execute.

- Frequently executed software commands should be accessible by one tap.

- Infrequently used commands may require more user action.

Frequency	Example	Accessibility
Several times per hour.	Checking today's schedule or to-do items.	One tap.
Several times per day.	One hour meeting starting at the top of the hour.	One tap, write in place.
Several times per week.	Setting a weekly meeting (repeating event).	Several taps, second dialog box.

To make your application easily accessible, follow these guidelines:

- Minimize the number of taps to execute a function or change a setting.
- Provide command buttons for commonly executed multistep operations. Command buttons streamline execution.
- Minimize the need to change screens.
- Minimize the number of dialogs users have to open and close.
- Avoid dialogs within dialogs unless it's an infrequently used feature.

Choose the appropriate UI object when making a speed versus screen layout decision:

- Buttons on the screen provide instant access but take up valuable screen space.
- Push buttons are faster than popup lists and should be used if they fit on the screen reasonably.
- Popup lists are faster than manual input or increment/decrement buttons
- Popup lists can be cumbersome if there are too many items on the list or if the list needs to scroll.

Creating Easy-to-Use Applications

Users must be able to pick up a Palm device and, with no training or instruction, navigate between applications (without getting stuck) and execute basic commands within five minutes. Advanced commands should be easily accessible but should not be in the way.

The design must therefore fit the following criteria:

- Indicate clearly where in an application the user is. The PIM applications and modal dialog boxes have black title bars that usually indicate the application name and view.
- Make it obvious to the user how to get to different views. The command buttons provide the best example of achieving this.
- Use buttons for important commands.
- Accomplishing common tasks should be fast and easy. Minimizing steps helps not only speed but ease of use.

Ease of use amounts to a series of trade-offs. Striking the best balance for the most people is the biggest challenge of UI design. For example:

- Consistency reduces the time needed to learn an application by limiting the number of things that people need to keep in their heads at once. The user should not have to memorize an entire set of rules to use the device easily, for example, the up arrow key should not do different things on different screens.
- Choose the number of buttons on the screen diligently:
  - The fewer buttons on the screen, the less time it takes to learn how to use the product.
  - However, keeping a few frequently used buttons on screen helps reduce the time spent learning basic functionality.
- Advanced features should not be in the way for beginners, but should not require multiple-step searching.
- If possible, make your application consistent with the Palm OS device's native applications; users are used to interacting with them and will easily get used to your application if you follow these rules.

Creating a Palm OS User Interface

The small screen and pen-based user interaction require a different UI paradigm than a desktop computer. Here are some guidelines for making your application's interface consistent with other applications, including the PIM applications.

- Provide an application icon for the Launcher. To launch an application, users navigate to the launcher screen and tap on an icon. Choose a short icon name and an easy to recognize icon.

  Specify the Application Icon Name and Application Icon using the Project Settings panel in Constructor.

- Provide a **base screen** that offers an overview of all available information. This screen is typically a list view. Not all applications need a base screen.
- Allow users to view most record information by pressing the navigation keys. Each event, to-do item, address, memo page, and so on is called a record.
- Organize records into user-defined **categories** if that makes sense. Categories usually result in more efficient screen use. Users can switch between categories using a popup menu or can display all records at once.
- Detailed information and advanced navigation require the use of a stylus. See Data Entry Guidelines for different data entry modes.
- Don't require double taps.
- Don't gray out menu commands or other UI elements; instead, remove an element when it's not available.
- If you can, allow finger navigation. For finger navigation, buttons need to be big enough for the system to recognize which button has been pushed. This is done by the Palm OS system software.
- Consider overloading the buttons. If you do overload, release the buttons at every possible opportunity. This is useful only for certain applications, such as games.

This section provides information on a variety of UI design issues:

- Navigation Guidelines
- Preferences Guidelines
- Data Entry Guidelines
- Command Execution Guidelines
- Guidelines for Screen Layout
- Guidelines for Dialog Box Layout

Navigation Guidelines

Users can move through applications by the following methods:

- **Switching applications**. Users press the physical buttons representing the PIM applications or access a launcher to switch applications.

  On Palm OS 2.0 or later devices, users can assign each button to the application of their choice using a Preferences panel.

  When switching to an application, the user is either presented with a standard first screen or returned to the last place in that application.

- **Switching views**. Each PIM application has two or more views (or modes) typically
  - a list view (or view mode)
  - an edit view (or edit mode)

  The user taps on records or uses command buttons to toggle between these views.

  Edit mode gives users access to the Details button for settings that affect the entire record. They can also access specific menu commands for records. In many applications, tapping on a record switches the application to edit mode and displays an input cursor.

- **Switching categories of records**. A popup menu in the top right corner lets users switch between categories. The popup menu is found in the list view of applications that support categories.
- **Switching records in applications**. Depending on the application, the user can scroll through lists of records, then tap on a record or a Details button for further information.
- **Graffiti navigation.** Support Graffiti navigation:
  - Left-right-forward-backward movement as part of a field's behavior.
  - Getting to next and previous screen using the down/up and up/down keystrokes.
- **Cycling through categories**. Holding the button on the hard case cycles through all categories.

- **Scrolling**. Records too long to display in one screen are scrollable. On-screen scroll buttons allow users to move up or down one line at a time. The physical arrow buttons allow users to move up and down one page at a time.

  Scrollbars were introduced in OS 2.0. Scrollbars are optional. Developers have to consider the trade-off between taking up 7 pixels of horizontal space (the width of the scroll bar) vs. providing convenient scrolling for long lists of records.

Preferences Guidelines

Palm OS 2.0 and later has improved preferences facilities. They are available through launch codes, discussed in the chapter "Application Launch Codes" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

The system now offers application-specific panels, sticky panels, and quick switch, as follows:

- **Application-specific panels**. Applications can add application-specific preferences panels to follow the system panels when the user cycles though the preferences. To do so, use the common code provided in the `Formats` example application to make the pull-down menu available. If the application uses the common code, a Done button inserts itself if the panel was called from the application, not sequentially following another panel.
- **Sticky panels**. When users bring up a preference panel from the launcher, exit the panel, then bring it up again, the system returns to the last panel used.
- **Quick switch**. Applications can now use the launch codes `sysAppLaunchCmdPanelCalledFromApp` and `sysAppLaunchCmdReturnFromPanel`, which allow an application to let users change preferences without first selecting the launcher, then selecting the application again.

Data Entry Guidelines

Users can enter data by the following methods:

- **Graffiti.** Graffiti characters are written in the text area on the digitizer and appear on the screen at the cursor location. The

user specifies the cursor location by tapping directly on the screen with the stylus.

Some controls accept input from Graffiti: For example, in the time selector dialog, you can write the time into the Graffiti area and it appears as start time or end time. The "next field" stroke switches between start and end time. The "Return" stroke dismisses the dialog.

For 2.0 and later applications, users expect that your application includes the Graffiti Reference option. You can include this option by calling SysGraffitiReferenceDialog.

- **On-screen keyboard**. In place of using Graffiti, the user can tap an on-screen keyboard with the stylus. Any text is entered into a temporary window. When the user dismisses the keyboard, the system inserts that text at the cursor location.
- **Controls**. Buttons, check boxes, and popup lists provide a quick way to enter settings and select options.
- **HotSync**. The user can type data on the PC and download it to the Palm OS device.
- **Auto-creation**. Many applications, such as the DateBook or the Memo Pad provide an auto-create feature. If the user starts to write in a list view with no record selected, a new record is created with no additional interaction.

To provide a consistent interface, follow these guidelines when designing the data entry interface for your application:

- Let users perform basic data entry in place.
- Have the cursor ready and visible if there's only one field for text entry (saves one tap).
- Provide a Details dialog for more elaborate data entry.
- Use the following format in the Details dialog:

  ```
  Item (right-justified): Value(left-justified)
  ```

  for example:

  ```
        Set Date: 4-1-96
  Auto-off after: 2 minutes
  ```

- Don't nest dialog boxes too deeply.
- Provide only one interface per function, that is, allow users to interact with an application through either a button, menu, or popup list. Don't provide both a button and a menu for the same actions.

NOTE: All developers are urged to include the rules listed below in their test plan. Applications that don't follow these rules may cause problems for other applications on the device.

- Whenever a field for user input is available, make sure that:
  - System keyboard is available via shortcut
  - System keyboard is available via menu
  - Graffiti input is possible (regular strokes and shortcuts)
  - Cut, copy, paste, and undo are possible
- Be sure to handle the clipboard correctly. If you use it, allow users to copy and paste between applications; if you don't, make sure it's intact when you exit.

Command Execution Guidelines

Users can execute commands by the following methods:

- **Command buttons**. Users execute common commands by tapping on command buttons at the bottom of the screen.
- **Menus**. Commands not represented by command buttons can be accessed via a simple menu system. The user taps on a menu hard icon in the digitizer area to invoke a menu bar. Beginning in Palm OS 3.5, the user may also invoke a menu bar by tapping the form's title. Provide menu shortcuts if possible.

NOTE: If you provide shortcuts, make sure that each shortcut is unique among all commands available at that time.

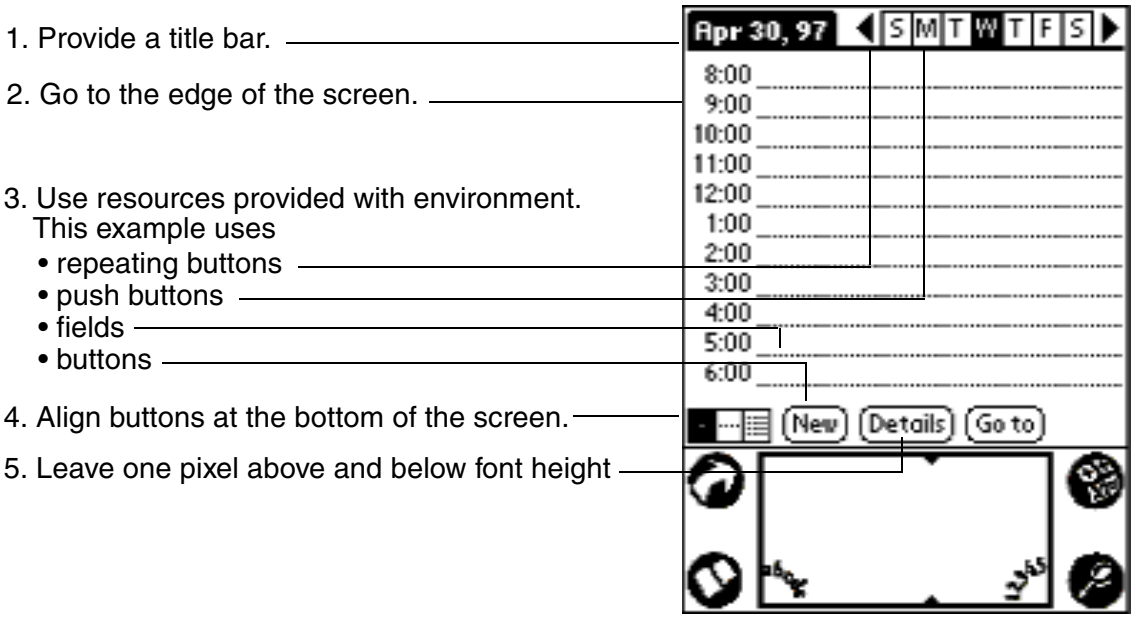
- **Graffiti menu command shortcuts**. Users can write a special Graffiti stroke and a command keystroke to execute a menu command. This is analogous to keyboard shortcuts on a personal computer. For example, writing the command

stroke symbol (a bottom-left to top-right line) and "C" allows the user to copy the selected text.

- **Buttons on command toolbar.** Beginning in Palm OS 3.5, entering the Graffiti command stroke symbol displays a command toolbar containing buttons for the commands that are possible in the current user context. For example, if text is selected in a field, the toolbar may display buttons for cut, copy, paste, and undo. Users may either complete the menu command shortcut as described above, or they may tap one of the buttons on the command toolbar.

Guidelines for Screen Layout

The illustration below provides some interface guidelines. Each guideline is numbered and explained in more detail below.

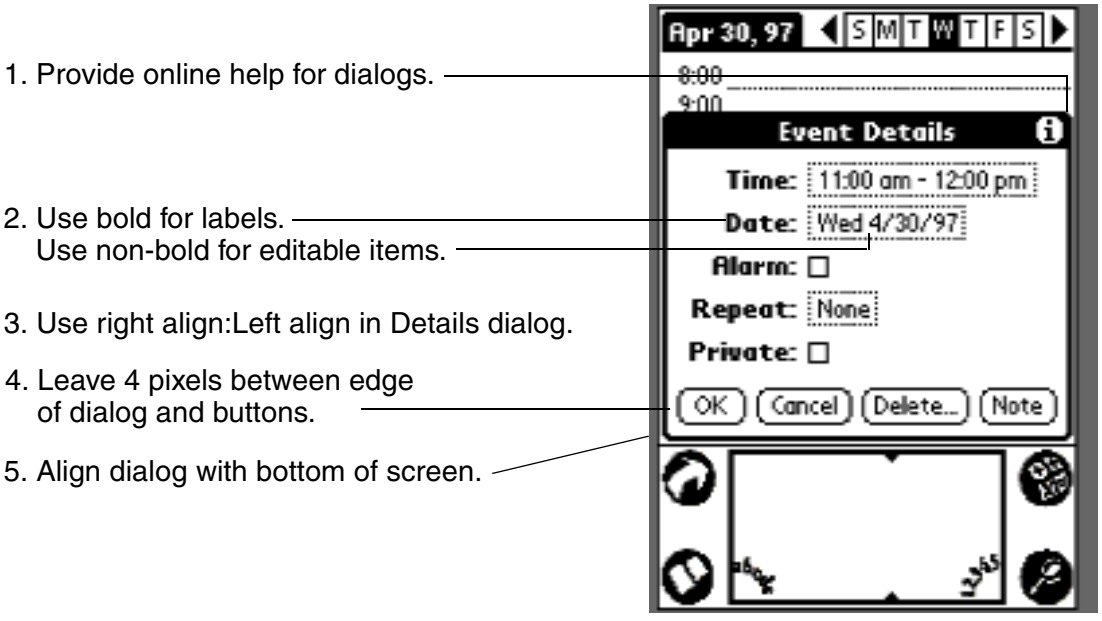


1. In the **title bar** for each screen, provide both the application name and the name of the screen, if possible. Otherwise, provide the most relevant information.
2. Always go to the edge of the screen; that is, don't use borders. This practice maximizes screen real estate available to the application. The non-active area of the LCD and the case provide a natural margin.

3. Use the **resources** provided with the development environment and use the recommended values for width, height, and so on, provided in "Palm OS Resources" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.
4. Align buttons with the bottom edge of the screen.
5. For text surrounded by borders, leave one pixel above and below the font height.
6. For controls that can be displayed in groups, have at least two pixels to the left and right of the text label. The exception is command buttons, which require wider margins to accommodate the rounded border.
7. Don't change or obscure the **Graffiti status indicator** area.
8. Don't change or obscure the **silk-screened icons**.

Guidelines for Dialog Box Layout

The illustration below provides some guidelines for dialog box interfaces. Each guideline is numbered and explained in more detail below under the same number.



1. Provide online help for dialogs. If you associate a Help ID with a form in Constructor, the system will add the "i" icon and handle presentation of the dialog.
2. Use bold face for labels, nonbold for editable items.
3. In the details dialog, right-align the label and left align the editable field.
4. When using buttons in dialogs, leave a space of four pixels between the edge of the dialog and the buttons. Leave four pixels between adjacent buttons.
5. Align dialogs with the bottom of the screen. Leave the screen title bar visible if possible.

Palm OS Resource Selection: List or Table?

Many developers find it difficult to decide whether to choose a list or a table for certain components of their application.

Use tables when you need quality text handling (including editing in place). Be careful if you work with non-text items in some of the columns, the selection region may be smaller than you need.

Use lists when users select from a predefined list (e.g. categories). Remember that you are responsible for scroll button handling and that editing can be non-trivial.

Localization Guidelines

If you're planning to localize the Palm OS software that you're developing, start by looking at the localized versions of the four PIM applications on the device. Then plan your application's interface, keeping in mind localization issues listed below. Also see the chapter "Localized Applications", which describes guidelines for writing code in a localized application.

- If you use the English language version of the software as a guide when designing the layout of the screen, try to allow:
  - extra space for strings
  - larger dialogs than the English version requires
- Abbreviations may be the best way to accommodate the particularly scarce screen real estate on the Palm OS device.

- Don't put language-dependent strings in code. If you have to display text directly on the screen, remember that a one-line warning or message in one language may need more than one line in another language.
- Don't depend on the physical characteristics of a string, such as the number of characters, the fact that it contains a particular substring, or any other attribute that might disappear in translation.
- Consider using string templates. For example, the MemoPad application uses the template: Memo # of %. The application can replace # and % to change the text. Use as many parameters as possible to give localizers greater flexibility. Avoid building sentences by concatenating substrings together, as this often causes translation problems.
- Remember that user interface elements such as lists, fields, and tips scroll if you need more space.

Making Your Application Run on Different Devices

There are many different devices that run Palm OS, and each may have a different version of the OS installed on it (see Table 2.1). Users are not expected to upgrade the Palm OS as frequently as they would an OS on a desktop computer. This fact makes backward compatibility more crucial for Palm applications.

Table 2.1 Some Palm OS platform devices

Name	Palm OS Version
Pilot 1000[a]	1.0
Pilot 5000[a]	1.0
PalmPilot[a]	2.0
PalmPilot Professional[a]	2.0
Palm III™	3.0
IBM Workpad	2.0 or 3.0
Symbol SPT 1500	3.0

Table 2.1 Some Palm OS platform devices *(continued)*

Name	Palm OS Version
Qualcomm pdQ	3.0
Palm IIIe™	3.1
Palm IIIx™	3.1
Palm V™	3.1
Palm VII™	3.2
Palm IIIc™	3.5

a. No longer available.

This section describes how to make sure your application runs on as many devices as possible by discussing:

- Running New Applications on an Older Device
- Compiling Older Applications With The Latest SDK

Running New Applications on an Older Device

Releases of the Palm OS are binary compatible with each other. If you write a brand new application today, it can run on all versions of the operating system provided the application doesn't use any new features. In other words, if you write your application using only features available in Palm OS 1.0, then your application runs on all devices. If you use 2.0 features, your application won't run on the earliest Palm OS platform devices, but it will run on all others, and so on.

How can you tell which features are available in each version of the operating system? There are a couple of way to do so:

- The *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* has a "Compatibility Guide" appendix. This guide lists the feature and functions introduced in each operating system version greater than 1.0.
- The header file `SysTraps.h` (or `CoreTraps.h` on Palm OS 3.5 and higher) lists all of the system traps available. Traps are listed in the order in which they were introduced to the system, and comments in the file clearly mark where each operating system version begins.

Programmatically, you can use the feature manager to determine which features are available on the system the application is running on. Note that you can't always rely on the operating system version number to guarantee that a feature exists. For example, Palm OS version 3.2 introduces wireless support, but not all Palm OS devices have that capability. Thus, checking that the system version is 3.2 does not guarantee that wireless support exists. Consult the "Compatibility Guide" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* to learn how to check for the existence of each specific feature.

Compiling Older Applications With The Latest SDK

As a rule, all Palm OS applications developed with an earlier version of the Palm OS platform SDK should run error-free on the latest release.

If you want to compile your older application under the latest release, you need to look out for functions with a changed API. For any of these functions, the old function still exists with an extension noting the release that supports it, such as V10 or V20.

You can choose one of two options:

- Change the function name to keep using the old API. Your application will then run error free on the newer devices.
- Update your application to use the new API. The application will then run error free and have access to some new functionality; however, it will no longer run on older devices that use prior releases of the OS.

NOTE: If you want to compile an existing application with the Palm OS 3.5 SDK, note that some header file names have changed, and the names used for basic types have changed. For example, parameters previously declared as `Word` are now `UInt16` or `Int16`. To compile existing applications, you'll need to make these changes in your code or include the header file `PalmOSCompatibility.h`. See the "Compatibility Guide" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for further details.

3

Application Startup and Stop

On desktop computers, an application starts up when a user launches it and stops when the user chooses the Exit or Quit command. These things occur a little bit differently on the Palm OS® handheld. A Palm OS application does launch when the user requests it, but it may also launch in response to some other user action, such as a request for the global find facility. Palm OS applications don't have an Exit command; instead they exit when a user requests another application.

This chapter describes how an application launches, how an application stops, and the code you must write to perform these tasks properly. It also covers notifications, which is another way for the system to launch your code when certain events occur. Notifications are available in later releases of the Palm OS. This chapter covers:

- Launch Codes and Launching an Application
- Responding to Launch Codes
- Launching Applications Programmatically
- Creating Your Own Launch Codes
- Stopping an Application
- Notifications
- Helper Notifications
- Launch Code Summary
- Notification Summary
- Launch and Notification Function Summary

This chapter does not cover the main application event loop. The event loop is covered in Chapter 4, "Event Loop."

Launch Codes and Launching an Application

An application launches when it receives a **launch code**. Launch codes are a means of communication between the Palm OS and the application (or between two applications).

For example, an application typically launches when a user presses one of the buttons on the device or selects an application icon from the application launcher screen. When this happens, the system generates the launch code `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch`, which tells the application to perform a full launch and display its user interface.

Other launch codes specify that the application should perform some action but not necessarily become the current application (the application the user sees). A good example of this is the launch code used by the global find facility. The global find facility allows users to search all databases for a certain record, such as a name. In this case, it would be very wasteful to do a full launch—including the user interface—of each application only to access the application's databases in search of that item. Using a launch code avoids this overhead.

Each launch code may be accompanied by two types of information:

- A parameter block, a pointer to a structure that contains several parameters. These parameters contain information necessary to handle the associated launch code.
- Launch flags indicate how the application should behave. For example, a flag could be used to specify whether the application should display UI or not. (See "Launch Flags" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.)

A complete list of all launch codes is provided at the end of this chapter in the section "Launch Code Summary." That section contains links into where each launch code is described in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

Responding to Launch Codes

Your application should respond to launch codes in a function named `PilotMain`. `PilotMain` is the entry point for all applications.

When an application receives a launch code, it must first check whether it can handle this particular code. For example, only applications that have text data should respond to a launch code requesting a string search. If an application can't handle a launch code, it exits without failure. Otherwise, it performs the action immediately and returns.

Listing 3.1 shows parts of `PilotMain` from the Datebook application as an example. To see the complete example, go to the examples folder in the Palm OS SDK and look at the file `Datebook.c`.

Listing 3.1 PilotMain in Datebook.c

```
UInt32 PilotMain (UInt16 cmd, void *cmdPBP,
UInt16 launchFlags)
{
   return DBPilotMain(cmd, cmdPBP, launchFlags);
}

static UInt32 DBPilotMain (UInt16 cmd, void *cmdPBP,
UInt16 launchFlags)
{
   UInt16 error;
   Boolean launched;

   // This app makes use of PalmOS 2.0 features.It will crash
   // if run on an earlier version of PalmOS. Detect and warn
   // if this happens, then exit.
   error = RomVersionCompatible (version20, launchFlags);
   if (error)
      return error;

   // Launch code sent by the launcher or the datebook
   // button.
   if (cmd == sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch) {
      error = StartApplication ();
      if (error) return (error);

      FrmGotoForm (DayView);
      EventLoop ();
      StopApplication ();
   }


   // Launch code sent by text search.
```

```
   else if (cmd == sysAppLaunchCmdFind) {
      Search ((FindParamsPtr)cmdPBP);
   }


   // This launch code might be sent to the app when it's
   // already running if the user hits the "Go To" button in
   // the Find Results dialog box.
   else if (cmd == sysAppLaunchCmdGoTo) {
      launched = launchFlags & sysAppLaunchFlagNewGlobals;
      if (launched) {
         error = StartApplication ();
         if (error) return (error);

         GoToItem ((GoToParamsPtr) cmdPBP, launched);

         EventLoop ();
         StopApplication ();
         else
         GoToItem ((GoToParamsPtr) cmdPBP, launched);
   }

   // Launch code sent by sync application to notify the
   // datebook application that its database has been synced.
   // ...
   // Launch code sent by Alarm Manager to notify the
   // datebook application that an alarm has triggered.
   // ...
   // Launch code sent by Alarm Manager to notify the
   // datebook application that is should display its alarm
   // dialog.
   // ...
   // Launch code sent when the system time is changed.
   // ...
   // Launch code sent after the system is reset. We use this
   // time to create our default database if this is a hard
   // reset
   // ...
   // Launch code sent by the DesktopLink server when it
   // creates a new database.  We will initialize the new
   // database.
   return (0);
}
```

Responding to Normal Launch

When an application receives the launch code `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch`, it begins with a startup routine, then goes into an event loop, and finally exits with a stop routine. (The event loop is described in Chapter 4, "Event Loop." The stop routine is shown in the section "Stopping an Application" at the end of this chapter.)

During the startup routine, your application should perform these actions:

1. Get system-wide preferences (for example for numeric or date and time formats) and use them to initialize global variables that will be referenced throughout the application.
2. Find the application database by creator type. If none exists, create it and initialize it.
3. Get application-specific preferences and initialize related global variables.
4. Initialize any other global variables.

As you saw in Listing 3.1, the Datebook application example responds to `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch` by calling a function named `StartApplication`. Listing 3.2 shows the `StartApplication` function.

Listing 3.2 StartApplication from Datebook.c

```
static UInt16 StartApplication (void)
{
   UInt16 error = 0;
   Err err = 0;
   UInt16 mode;
   DateTimeType dateTime;
   DatebookPreferenceType prefs;
   SystemPreferencesType sysPrefs;
   UInt16 prefsSize;

   // Step 1: Get system-wide preferences.
   PrefGetPreferences (&sysPrefs);
   // Determime if secret records should be
   // displayed.
   HideSecretRecords = sysPrefs.hideSecretRecords;
```

```
if (HideSecretRecords)
   mode = dmModeReadWrite;
else
   mode = dmModeReadWrite | dmModeShowSecret;

// Get the time formats from the system preferences.
TimeFormat = sysPrefs.timeFormat;

// Get the date formats from the system preferences.
LongDateFormat = sysPrefs.longDateFormat;
ShortDateFormat = sysPrefs.dateFormat;

// Get the starting day of the week from the system
// preferences.
StartDayOfWeek = sysPrefs.weekStartDay;


// Get today's date.
TimSecondsToDateTime (TimGetSeconds(), &dateTime);
Date.year = dateTime.year - firstYear;
Date.month = dateTime.month;
Date.day = dateTime.day;


// Step 2. Find the application's data file.  If it
// doesn't exist, create it.
ApptDB = DmOpenDatabaseByTypeCreator(datebookDBType,
   sysFileCDatebook, mode);
if (! ApptDB) {
   error = DmCreateDatabase (0, datebookDBName,
      sysFileCDatebook, datebookDBType, false);
   if (error) return error;

   ApptDB =
      DmOpenDatabaseByTypeCreator(datebookDBType,
      sysFileCDatebook, mode);
   if (! ApptDB) return (1);

   error = ApptAppInfoInit (ApptDB);
   if (error) return error;
}


// Step 3. Get application-specific preferences.
// Read the preferences/saved-state information. There is
// only one version of the DateBook preferences so don't
// worry about multiple versions.
prefsSize = sizeof (DatebookPreferenceType);
```

```
   if (PrefGetAppPreferences (sysFileCDatebook,
         datebookPrefID, &prefs, &prefsSize, true)
         != noPreferenceFound) {
      DayStartHour = prefs.dayStartHour;
      DayEndHour = prefs.dayEndHour;
      AlarmPreset = prefs.alarmPreset;
      NoteFont = prefs.noteFont;
      SaveBackup = prefs.saveBackup;
      ShowTimeBars = prefs.showTimeBars;
      CompressDayView = prefs.compressDayView;
      ShowTimedAppts = prefs.showTimedAppts;
      ShowUntimedAppts = prefs.showUntimedAppts;
      ShowDailyRepeatingAppts =
         prefs.showDailyRepeatingAppts;
   }

   // Step 4. Initialize any other global variables.
   TopVisibleAppt = 0;
   CurrentRecord = noRecordSelected;


   // Load the far call jump table.
   FarCalls.apptGetAppointments = ApptGetAppointments;
   FarCalls.apptGetRecord = ApptGetRecord;
   FarCalls.apptFindFirst = ApptFindFirst;
   FarCalls.apptNextRepeat = ApptNextRepeat;
   FarCalls.apptNewRecord = ApptNewRecord;
   FarCalls.moveEvent = MoveEvent;

   return (error);
}
```

Responding to Other Launch Codes

If an application receives a launch code other than `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch`, it decides if it should respond to that launch code. If it responds to the launch code, it does so by implementing a launch code handler, which is invoked from its `PilotMain` function.

In most cases, when you respond to other launch codes, you are not able to access global variables. Global variables are generally only allocated after an application receives `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch` (see Listing 3.2) or `sysAppLaunchCmdGoto`; so if the application hasn't received

either of these launch codes, its global variables are usually not allocated and not accessible. In addition, if the application has multiple code segments, you cannot access code outside of segment 0 (the first segment) if the application has no access to global variables.

There is one other case where an application may have access to its global variables (and to code segments other than 0). This is when an application is launched with the code `sysAppLaunchCmdURLParams`. If this launch code results from a `palm` URL, then globals are available. If the launch code results from a `palmcall` URL, then globals are not available. The URL is passed to your application in the launch parameter block.

NOTE: Static local variables are stored with the global variables on the system's dynamic heap. They are not accessible if global variables are not accessible.

Checking launch codes is generally a good way to determine if your application has access to global variables. However, it actually depends on the setting of the launch flags that are sent with the launch code. In particular, if the `sysAppLaunchFlagNewGlobals` flag is set, then your application's global variables have been allocated on this launch. This flag is set by the system and isn't (and shouldn't be) set by the sender of a launch code.

```
Boolean appHasGlobals = launchFlags & sysAppLaunchFlagNewGlobals;
```

There's one case where this flag won't be set and your application will still have access to global variables. This is when your application is already running as the current application. In this case, its global variables have already been allocated through a previous launch.

If your application receives a launch code other than `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch` or `sysAppLaunchCmdGoTo`, you can find out if it is the current application by checking the launch flags that are sent with the launch code. If the application is the currently running application, the `sysAppLaunchFlagSubCall` flag is set. This flag is set by the system and isn't (and shouldn't be) set by the sender of a launch code.

```
Boolean appIsActive = launchFlags & sysAppLaunchFlagSubCall;
```

Launching Applications Programmatically

Applications can send launch codes to each other, so your application might be launched from another application or it might be launched from the system. An application can use a launch code to request that another application perform an action or modify its data. For example, a data collection application could instruct an email application to queue up a particular message to be sent.

TIP: In Palm OS 4.0 and higher, there are other ways for applications to communicate. See the section "When to Use the Helper API" to help you decide which method to use.

Sending a launch code to another application is like calling a specific subroutine in that application: the application responding to the launch code is responsible for determining what to do given the launch code constant passed on the stack as a parameter.

To send a launch code to another application, use the system manager function `SysAppLaunch`. Use this routine when you want to make use of another application's functionality and eventually return control of the system to your application. Usually, applications use it only for sending launch codes to other user-interface applications.

For example, you would use this function to request that the built in Address Book application search its databases for a specified phone number and return the results of the search to your application. When calling `SysAppLaunch` do not set launch flags yourself—the `SysAppLaunch` function sets launch flags appropriately for you.

An alternative, simpler method of sending launch codes is the `SysBroadcastActionCode` call. This routine automatically finds all other user-interface applications and calls `SysAppLaunch` to send the launch code to each of them.

When an application is called using `SysAppLaunch`, the system considers that application to be the current application even though

the application has not switched from the user's perspective. Thus, if your application is called from another application, it can still use the function SysCurAppDatabase to get the card number and database ID of its own database.

If you want to actually close your application and open another application, use SysUIAppSwitch instead of SysAppLaunch. This routine notifies the system which application to launch next and feeds an application-quit event into the event queue. If and when the current application responds to the quit event and returns, the system launches the new application.

When you allocate a parameter block to pass to SysUIAppSwitch, you must call MemPtrSetOwner to grant ownership of the parameter block chunk to the OS (your application is originally set as the owner). If the parameter block structure contains references by pointer or handle to any other chunks, you also must set the owner of those chunks by calling MemPtrSetOwner or MemHandleSetOwner. If you don't change the ownership of the parameter block, it will get freed before the application you're launching has a chance to use it.

In Palm OS 3.0 and higher, you can also use the Application Launcher to launch any application. For more information, see the section "Application Launcher" in the "User Interface" chapter.

WARNING! Do not use the SysUIAppSwitch or SysAppLaunch functions to open the Application Launcher application.

Creating Your Own Launch Codes

The Palm OS contains predefined launch codes, which are listed in Table 3.1 at the end of this chapter. In addition, developers can create their own launch codes to implement specific functionality. Both the sending and the receiving application must know about and handle any developer-defined launch codes.

The launch code parameter is a 16-bit word value. All launch codes with values 0–32767 are reserved for use by the system and for future enhancements. Launch codes 32768–65535 are available for private use by applications.

Stopping an Application

An application shuts itself down when it receives the event `appStopEvent`. Note that this is an event, not a launch code. The application must detect this event and terminate. (You'll learn more about events in the next chapter.)

When an application stops, it is given an opportunity to perform cleanup activities including closing databases and saving state information.

In the stop routine, an application should first flush all active records, then close the application's database, and finally save those aspects of the current state needed for startup. Listing 3.3 is an example of a `StopApplication` routine from `Datebook.c`.

Listing 3.3 StopApplication from Datebook.c

```
static void StopApplication (void)
{
   DatebookPreferenceType prefs;

   // Write the preferences / saved-state information.
   prefs.noteFont = NoteFont;
   prefs.dayStartHour = DayStartHour;
   prefs.dayEndHour = DayEndHour;
   prefs.alarmPreset = AlarmPreset;
   prefs.saveBackup = SaveBackup;
   prefs.showTimeBars = ShowTimeBars;
   prefs.compressDayView = CompressDayView;
   prefs.showTimedAppts = ShowTimedAppts;
   prefs.showUntimedAppts = ShowUntimedAppts;
   prefs.showDailyRepeatingAppts = ShowDailyRepeatingAppts;

   // Write the state information.
   PrefSetAppPreferences (sysFileCDatebook, datebookPrefID,
      datebookVersionNum, &prefs, sizeof
      (DatebookPreferenceType), true);

   // Send a frmSave event to all the open forms.
   FrmSaveAllForms ();

   // Close all the open forms.
   FrmCloseAllForms ();

   // Close the application's data file.
   DmCloseDatabase (ApptDB);
}
```

Notifications

On systems where the Notification Feature Set is present, your application can receive **notifications** and launch when certain system-level events or application-level events occur. Notifications are similar to application launch codes, but differ from them in two important ways:

- Notifications can be sent to any code resource, such as a shared library or a system extension (for example, a hack installed with the HackMaster program). Launch codes can only be sent to applications. Any code resource that is registered to receive a notification is called a **notification client**.
- Notifications are only sent to applications or code resources that have specifically registered to receive them, making them more efficient than launch codes. Many launch codes are sent to all installed applications to give each application a chance to respond.

The Palm OS system and the built-in applications send notifications when certain events occur. See the "Notification Summary" in this chapter for a complete list.

It's also possible for your application to create and broadcast its own notifications. However, doing so is rare. It's more likely that you'll want to register to receive the predefined notifications or that you'll broadcast the predefined `sysNotifyHelperEvent` described in the "Helper Notifications" section.

Three general types of event flow are possible using the notification manager:

- Single consumer

  Each client is notified that the event has occurred and handles it in its own way without modifying any information in the parameter block.

- Collaborative

  The notification's parameter block contains a `handled` flag. Clients can set this flag to communicate to other clients that the event has been handled, while still allowing them to receive the notification. An example of this is the

`sysNotifyAntennaRaisedEvent` for Palm VII™ series devices. A client might decide to handle the antenna key down event and in this case, sets `handled` to `true` to inform other clients that the event has been handled.

- Collective

  Each client can add information to the notification's parameter block, allowing the data to be accumulated for all clients. This style of notification could be used, for example, to build a menu dynamically by letting each client add its own menu text. The `sysNotifyMenuCmdBarOpenEvent` is similar to this style of notification.

Registering for a Notification

To receive notification that an event has occurred, you must register for it using the `SysNotifyRegister` function. Once you register for a notification, you remain registered until the system is reset or until you explicitly unregister for this notification using `SysNotifyUnregister`.

To register an application for the HotSync® notification, you'd use a function call similar to the one in Listing 3.4.

Listing 3.4 Registering an application for a notification

```
SysNotifyRegister(myCardNo, appDBID, sysNotifySyncStartEvent,
   NULL, sysNotifyNormalPriority, myDataP);
```

If you are writing a shared library instead of an application and you want to be notified about the HotSync event, your call to `SysNotifyRegister` looks slightly different. See Listing 3.5.

Listing 3.5 Registering a shared library for a notification

```
SysNotifyRegister(myCardNo, shlibDBID,
   sysNotifySyncStartEvent, SyncNotifyHandler,
   sysNotifyNormalPriority, myDataP);
```

The parameters you pass to the `SysNotifyRegister` function specify the following:

- The first two parameters are the card number and database ID for the `prc` file. Be sure you're not passing the local ID of the record database that your application accesses. You use the record database's local ID more frequently than you do the application's local ID, so this is a common mistake to make.
- `sysNotifySyncStartEvent` specifies that you want to be informed when a HotSync operation is about to start. There is also a `sysNotifySyncFinishEvent` that specifies that a HotSync operation has ended.
- The next parameter specifies how the notification should be received. This is where Listing 3.4 and Listing 3.5 differ.

  Applications use `NULL` for this parameter to specify that they should be notified through the application launch code `sysAppLaunchCmdNotify`. As with all other launch codes, the system passes this to the application's `PilotMain` function.

  The shared library has no `PilotMain` function and therefore no way to receive a launch code, so it passes a pointer to a callback function. Only use a callback function if your code doesn't have a `PilotMain`.

  Note that it's always necessary to pass the card number and database ID of your `prc` file even if you specify a callback function.

- `sysNotifyNormalPriority` means that you don't want your code to receive any special consideration when receiving the notification. Notifications are broadcast synchronously in priority order. The lower the number you specify here, the earlier you receive the notification in the list.

  In virtually all cases, you should use `sysNotifyNormalPriority`. If you absolutely must ensure that your code is notified in a certain order (either before most notifications or after most notifications), be sure to leave some space between priority values so that your code won't collide with the system's handling of notifications or with another application's handling of notifications. Never

use the extreme maximum or minimum allowed value. In general, Palm™ recommends using a value whose least significant bits are 0 (such as 32, 64, 96, and so on).

- `myDataP` is a pointer to any data you need to access in your notification handler function. As with most launch codes, `sysAppLaunchCmdNotify` does not provide access to global variables, so you should use this pointer to pass yourself any needed data.

After you've made the calls shown in Listing 3.4 and Listing 3.5 and the system is about to begin a HotSync operation, it broadcasts the `sysNotifySyncStartEvent` notification to both clients.

The application is notified through the `sysAppLaunchCmdNotify` launch code. This launch code's parameter block is a `SysNotifyParamType` structure containing the notification name, the broadcaster, and a pointer to your specific data (`myDataP` in the example above). Some notifications contain extra information in a `notifyDetailsP` field in this structure. The HotSync notifications do not use the `notifyDetailsP` field.

The shared library is notified by a call to its `SyncNotifyHandler` function. This function is passed the same `SysNotifyParamType` structure that is passed through the launch code mechanism.

IMPORTANT: Because the callback pointer is used to directly call the function, the pointer must remain valid from the time `SysNotifyRegister` is called to the time the notification is broadcast. If the function is in a shared library, you must keep the library open. If the function is in a separately loaded code resource, the resource must remain locked while registered for the notification. When you close a library or unlock a resource, you must first unregister for any notifications. If you don't, the system will crash when the notification is broadcast.

Writing a Notification Handler

The application's response to `sysAppLaunchCmdNotify` and the shared library's callback function are called **notification handlers**. A notification handler may perform any processing necessary,

including displaying a user interface or broadcasting other notifications.

When displaying a user interface, consider the possibility that you may be blocking other applications from receiving the notification. For this reason, it's generally not a good idea to display a modal form or do anything else that requires waiting for the user to respond. Also, many of the notifications are broadcast during `SysHandleEvent`, which means your application event loop may not have progressed to the point where it is possible for you to display a user interface, or that you may overflow the stack.

If you need to perform some lengthy process in a notification handler, one way to ensure that you aren't blocking other events is to send yourself a deferred notification. For example, Listing 3.6 shows a notification handler for the `sysNotifyTimeChangeEvent` notification that performs no work other than setting up a deferred notification (`myDeferredNotifyEvent`) and scheduling it for broadcast. When the application receives the `myDeferredNotifyEvent`, it calls the `MyNotifyHandler` function, which is where the application really handles the time change event.

Listing 3.6 Deferring notification within a handler

```
case sysAppLaunchCmdNotify :
   if (cmdPBP->notify->notifyType == sysNotifyTimeChangeEvent) {
      SysNotifyParamType notifyParm;
      MyGlobalsToAccess myData;

      /* initialize myData here */

      /* Create the notification block. */
      notifyParam.notifyType = myDeferredNotifyEvent;
      notifyParam.broadcaster = myCreatorID;
      notifyParam.notifyDetailsP= NULL;
      notifyParam.handled = false;

      /* Register for my notification */
      SysNotifyRegister(myCardNo, appDBID, myDeferredNotifyEvent, NULL,
         sysNotifyNormalPriority, &myData);

      /* Broadcast the notification */
```

```
      SysNotifyBroadcastDeferred(&notifyParam, NULL);

   } else if (cmdPBP->notify->notifyType == myDeferredNotifyEvent)
      MyNotifyHandler(cmdPBP->notify);
break;
```

The SysNotifyBroadcastDeferred function broadcasts the specified notification to all interested parties; however, it waits to do so until the current event has completed processing. Thus, by using a separate deferred notification, you can be sure that all other clients have had a chance to respond to the first notification.

There are several functions that broadcast notifications. Notification handlers should use `SysNotifyBroadcastDeferred` to avoid the possibility of overflowing the notification stack.

A special case of dealing with lengthy computations in a notification handler occurs when the system is being put to sleep. See "Sleep and Wake Notifications" below.

Sleep and Wake Notifications

Several notifications are broadcast at various stages when the system goes to sleep and when the system wakes up. These are:

- sysNotifySleepRequestEvent
- sysNotifySleepNotifyEvent
- sysNotifyEarlyWakeupEvent
- sysNotifyLateWakeupEvent

These notifications are **not** guaranteed to be broadcast. For example, if the system goes to sleep because the user removes the batteries, sleep notifications are not sent. Thus, these notifications are unsuitable for applications where external hardware must be shut off to conserve power before the system goes to sleep.

If you want to know when the system is going to sleep because you have a small amount of cleanup that should occur beforehand, then register for `sysNotifySleepNotifyEvent`.

It is recommended that you not perform any sort of prolonged activity, such as displaying an alert panel that requests confirmation, in response to a sleep notification. If you do, the alert

might be displayed long enough to trigger another auto-off event, which could be detrimental to other handlers of the sleep notify event.

In a few instances, you might need to prevent the system from going to sleep. For example, your code might be in the middle of performing some lengthy computation or in the middle of attempting a network connection. If so, register for the `sysNotifySleepRequestEvent` instead. This notification informs all clients that the system might go to sleep. If necessary, your handler can delay the sleep request by doing the following:

```
((SleepEventParamType *)
  (notify->notifyDetailsP))->deferSleep++;
```

The system checks the `deferSleep` value when each notification handler returns. If it is nonzero, it cancels the sleep event.

After you defer sleep, your code is free to finish what it was doing. When it is finished, you must allow the system to continue with the sleep event. To do so, create a `keyDownEvent` with the `resumeSleepChr` and the command key bit set (to signal that the character is virtual) and add it to the event queue. When the system receives this event, it will again broadcast the `sysNotifySleepRequestEvent` to all clients. If `deferSleep` is 0 after all clients return, then the system knows it is safe to go to sleep, and it broadcasts the `sysNotifySleepNotifyEvent` to all of its clients.

Notice that you may potentially receive the `sysNotifySleepRequestEvent` many times before the system actually goes to sleep, but you receive the `sysNotifySleepNotifyEvent` exactly once.

During a wake-up event, the other two notifications listed above are broadcast. The `sysNotifyEarlyWakeupEvent` is broadcast very early on in the wakeup process, generally before the screen has turned on. At this stage, it is not guaranteed that the system will fully wake up. It may simply handle an alarm or a battery charger event and go back to sleep. Most applications that need notification of a wakeup event will probably want to register for `sysNotifyLateWakeupEvent` instead. At this stage, the screen has been turned on and the system is guaranteed to fully wake up.

When the device receives the `sysNotifyLateWakeupEvent` notification, it may be locked and waiting for the user to enter the password. If this is the case, you must wait for the user to unlock the device before you display a user interface. Therefore, if you intend to display a user interface when the device wakes up, you should make sure the device is not locked. If the device is locked, you should register for `sysNotifyDeviceUnlocked` notification and display your user interface when it is received. See Listing 3.7.

Listing 3.7 Responding to Late Wakeup Notification

```
case sysNotifyLateWakeupEvent:
   if ((Boolean)
         PrefGetPreference(prefDeviceLocked)) {
      SysNotifyRegister(myCardNo, myDbID,
         sysNotifyDeviceUnlocked, NULL,
         sysNotifyNormalPriority, NULL);
   } else {
      HandleDeviceWakeup();
   }
case sysNotifyDeviceUnlocked:
   HandleDeviceWakeup();
```

Helper Notifications

If the 4.0 New Feature Set is present, the helper notification, `sysNotifyHelperEvent`, is defined. This notification is a way for one application to request a service from another application. On Palm OS 4.0, the Dial application is the only application that performs a service through `sysNotifyHelperEvent`. Specifically, the Dial application dials a phone in response to this notification. The Address Book uses the Dial application to dial the phone number that the user has selected. You can use the Dial application in a similar way by broadcasting the `sysNotifyHelperEvent` from your application. You may also choose to write a provider of services.

In this section, the application that responds to the `sysNotifyHelperEvent` notification is called the **helper**, and the application that broadcasts the notification is called the **broadcaster**.

A helper registers for the `sysNotifyHelperEvent` notification. In the notification handler, the helper responds to action requests pertaining to the **service** that it provides.

Actions are requests to provide information about the service or to perform the service. The details structure for `sysNotifyHelperEvent` (a `HelperNotifyEventType` structure) defines three possible actions:

- `kHelperNotifyActionCodeEnumerate` is a request for the helper to list the services that it can perform.
- `kHelperNotifyActionCodeValidate` is a request for the helper to make sure that it can perform the service.
- `kHelperNotifyActionCodeExecute` is a request to actually perform the service.

The possible **services** are defined in `HelperServiceClass.h` and described in the chapter "Helper API" on page 665 of the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*. These services are to dial a number, email a message, send an SMS message, or send a fax. If you want to define your own service, you must register a unique creator ID for that service. Alternatively, you can use the creator ID of your application.

This section discusses the helper APIs, which include the `sysNotifyHelperEvent` notification and the data structures that it passes as the `notifyDetailsP` portion of the `SysNotifyParamType` structure. It covers:

- When to Use the Helper API
- Requesting a Helper Service
- Implementing a Helper

When to Use the Helper API

If the 4.0 New Feature Set is present, there are several means by which one application can communicate with another application on the same device. Specifically, an application can send a launch code to another application (see "Launching Applications Programmatically" in this chapter), can use the Exchange Manager and Local Exchange Library to send data to another application (see the "Object Exchange" chapter), or can use the helper API to request

that a service be performed. It can be difficult to determine which is the best method to use for your particular situation.

The helper API is best used in these circumstances:

- The 4.0 New Feature Set is present.
- You do not know anything about the receiving application.

  The helper API provides a means of communication where the sending and receiving application do not need to know anything about each other. This contrasts with the launch code mechanism, in which the sending application must know the card number and local ID of the receiving database as well as which launch code to send.
- You want to communicate with any type of program.

  Because the helper API uses a notification, the helper can be a shared library or another separately loaded code resource. Launch codes can only be received by applications. Because the Exchange Manager works through launch codes, it also only works with applications.

Requesting a Helper Service

Listing 3.8 shows how an application should request the dial service. In general, you should do the following to request a service:

- Broadcast a `sysNotifyHelperEvent` with a `kHelperNotifyActionCodeValidate` action each time you want to advertise that the service is available.

  For example, when the Address Book initializes the List view form, it checks to see if the dial service is available by broadcasting the notification with the action code `kHelperNotifyActionCodeValidate`. The Dial application makes sure the Telephony Library is open. If so, it sets `handled` to `true` in the `SysNotifyParamType` structure. If not, it sets `handled` to `false`. If `handled` is `false` after the notification is broadcast, the Address Book does not display the Dial menu item.
- Broadcast a `sysNotifyHelperEvent` with a `kHelperNotifyActionCodeExecute` action when you want the service performed. See Listing 3.8.

- If you want to obtain a list of all possible services, broadcast a `sysNotifyHelperEvent` with a `kHelperNotifyActionCodeEnumerate` action. You might do so when your application is launched, upon system reset, or any time the user performs a task where you might want to provide a service.

Listing 3.8 Requesting a helper service

```
Boolean PrvDialListDialSelected(FormType* frmP) {
   SysNotifyParamType param;
   HelperNotifyEventType details;
   HelperNotifyExecuteType execute;

   param.notifyType = sysNotifyHelperEvent;
   param.broadcaster = sysFileCAddress;
   param.notifyDetailsP = &details;
   param.handled = false;

   details.version = kHelperNotifyCurrentVersion;
   details.actionCode = kHelperNotifyActionCodeExecute;
   details.data.executeP = &execute;

   execute.serviceClassID = kHelperServiceClassIDVoiceDial;
   execute.helperAppID = 0;
   execute.dataP = FldGetTextPtr(ToolsGetFrmObjectPtr(frmP,
      DialListNumberField));
   execute.displayedName = gDisplayName;
   execute.detailsP = 0;
   execute.err = errNone;

   SysNotifyBroadcast(&param);

   // Check error code
   if (!param.handled)
   // Not handled so exit the list - Unexpected error
      return true;
   else
      return (execute.err == errNone);
}
```

When you broadcast the `sysNotifyHelperEvent`, it's important to note the following:

- Always use `SysNotifyBroadcast`, which broadcasts the notification synchronously.

- The notification's `notifyDetailsP` parameter points to a `HelperNotifyEventType`. This structure allows the broadcaster to communicate with the helper.
- The helper may allocate memory and add it to the `HelperNotifyEventType` structure. In particular, if the action code is `kHelperNotifyActionCodeEnumerate`, the helper allocates at least one structure of type `HelperNotifyEnumerateListType` and adds it to the `data` field in the `HelperNotifyEventType` structure. The broadcaster must free this memory, even though the helper allocated it.
- The broadcaster uses the `helperAppID` field to communicate directly with a particular provider of the requested service. For example, suppose two applications provide a dial service. The broadcaster might discover these two applications through the enumerate action and then allow the user to specify which application should dial the phone number. When broadcasting the enumerate action, no helper ID is specified, so all helpers respond. After the user has set the preferred helper, the broadcaster sets the `helperAppID` field for the validate and execute actions to that helper's creator ID. A helper must check the `helperAppID` field and only respond to the notification if its creator ID matches the value in that field or if that field is 0.
- The `dataP` field contains the data required to perform the service. For the dial service, `dataP` contains the phone number to dial. If any extra information is required or desired, then it is provided in the `detailsP` field. If you're requesting the email or SMS service, you use `detailsP` to provide the message to be sent. See the chapter "Helper API" on page 665 of the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for more information.
- The `handled` field of `SysNotifyParamType` and the `err` field of the `HelperNotifyEventType` structure are used to return the result. Always set `handled` to `false` and `err` to `errNone` before broadcasting and check their values after the broadcast is complete. The helper uses `handled` to indicate if it attempted to handle the service. If `handled` is `true`, it uses `err` to indicate the success or failure of performing that service.

Implementing a Helper

To implement a helper, do the following:

- Register to receive the `sysNotifyHelperEvent`. It is best to register for this notification in response to the `sysAppLaunchCmdSyncNotify` and `sysAppLaunchCmdSystemReset` launch codes. This registers your helper when it is first installed and re-registers it upon each system reset.
- In the notification handler, handle the three possible actions: enumerate, execute, and validate. Note that even though the enumerate action is optional and not currently used by Address Book, a helper must respond to this action in its handler because another third party application might send the enumerate action.

Listing 3.9 and Listing 3.10 show how the Dial application responds to the enumerate and validate actions. Note that the enumerate action requires the helper to allocate memory and add that memory to the `HelperNotifyEventType` structure pointed to by `notifyDetailsP` in the `SysNotifyParamType` parameter block. In this case, the `notifyDetailsP->dataP` field is a linked list of `HelperNotifyEnumerateListType` structures. Each helper must allocate one of these structure per service and add it to the end of the list. The broadcaster is responsible for freeing all of these structures after the notification broadcast is complete.

Listing 3.9 Enumerating services provided

```
Boolean PrvAppEnumerate
(HelperNotifyEventType *helperNotifyEventP)
{
   HelperNotifyEnumerateListType* newNodeP;
   MemHandle handle;
   MemPtr stringP;

   newNodeP = MemPtrNew
      (sizeof(HelperNotifyEnumerateListType));

   // Get name to display in user interface.
   handle = DmGetResource(strRsc, HelperAppNameString);
   stringP = MemHandleLock(handle);
   StrCopy(newNodeP->helperAppName, stringP);
   MemHandleUnlock(handle);
```

```
   DmReleaseResource(handle);

   // Get name of service to display in UI.
   handle = DmGetResource(strRsc, HelperActionNameString);
   stringP = MemHandleLock(handle);
   StrCopy(newNodeP->actionName, stringP);
   MemHandleUnlock(handle);
   DmReleaseResource(handle);

   newNodeP->serviceClassID = kHelperServiceClassIDVoiceDial;
   newNodeP->helperAppID = kDialCreator;
   newNodeP->nextP = 0;

   // Add the new node.
   if (helperNotifyEventP->data.enumerateP == 0) {
      helperNotifyEventP->data.enumerateP = newNodeP;
   else {
      HelperNotifyEnumerateListType* nodeP;
      nodeP = helperNotifyEventP->data.enumerateP;
      //Look for the end of the list.
      while ( nodeP->nextP != 0 )
         nodeP = nodeP->nextP;
      nodeP->nextP = newNodeP;
   }

   return true;
}
```

Listing 3.10 show how the Dial application responds to the validate action.

Listing 3.10 Responding to validate action

```
Boolean PrvAppValidate (SysNotifyParamType *sysNotifyParamP)
{
   HelperNotifyEventType* helperNotifyEvent;

   helperNotifyEvent = sysNotifyParamP->notifyDetailsP;
   // Check version
   if (helperNotifyEvent->version < 1)
      return false;

   // Check service
   if (helperNotifyEvent-> data.validateP->serviceClassID
         != kHelperServiceClassIDVoiceDial)
      return false;
```

```
   // check appId (either null or me)
   if ((helperNotifyEvent->data.validateP->helperAppID != 0)
      && (helperNotifyEvent->data.validateP->helperAppID !=
         kDialCreator))
      return false;

   // Check Telephony library presence
   if (!PrvAppCheckTelephony())
      return false;

   sysNotifyParamP->handled = true;
   return true;
}
```

When writing a helper, it is also important to note the following:

- Always check the `helperAppID` field and only respond if it is 0 or if it matches your creator ID. For the validate and execute actions, a broadcaster may use `helperAppID` to only communicate with the desired helper.
- If you handle the action, set `handled` to `true`. If the handling of the service was unsuccessful, set the `err` field in `notifyDetailsP`.
- Always check the `handled` field before performing the service. If any helper can perform the service, you must make sure that the service has not already been performed before you perform it. If `handled` is `true`, the service has already been performed.
- Remember that, as with all notifications, your notification handler does not have access to global variables. If there is data you need to access, pass it in the `userDataP` parameter to `SysNotifyRegister`. If you want to have the notification handler return before the service is fully complete, make a copy of any data in the parameter block that you will need to complete the service.

Launch Code Summary

Table 3.1 lists all Palm OS standard launch codes. These launch codes are declared in the header `SystemMgr.h`. All the parameters for a launch code are passed in a single parameter block, and the results are returned in the same parameter block.

Table 3.1 Palm OS Launch Codes

Code	Request
`scptLaunchCmdExecuteCmd`	Execute the specified Network login script plugin command.
`scptLaunchCmdListCmds`	Provide information about the commands that your Network script plugin executes.
`sysAppLaunchCmdAddRecord`	Add a record to a database.
`sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered`	Schedule next alarm or perform quick actions such as sounding alarm tones.
`sysAppLaunchCmdAttention`	Perform the action requested by the attention manager.
`sysAppLaunchCmdCardLaunch`	Launch the application. This launch code signifies that the application is being launched from an expansion card.
`sysAppLaunchCmdCountryChange`	Respond to country change.
`sysAppLaunchCmdDisplayAlarm`	Display specified alarm dialog or perform time-consuming alarm-related actions.
`sysAppLaunchCmdExgAskUser`	Let application override display of dialog asking user if they want to receive incoming data via the Exchange Manager.
`sysAppLaunchCmdExgGetData`	Notify application that it should send data using the Exchange Manager.

Table 3.1 Palm OS Launch Codes *(continued)*

Code	Request
sysAppLaunchCmdExgPreview	Notify application that it should display a preview using the Exchange Manager.
sysAppLaunchCmdExgReceiveData	Notify application that it should receive incoming data using the Exchange Manager.
sysAppLaunchCmdFind	Find a text string.
sysAppLaunchCmdGoto	Go to a particular record, display it, and optionally select the specified text.
sysAppLaunchCmdGoToURL	Launch an application and open a URL.
sysAppLaunchCmdInitDatabase	Initialize database.
sysAppLaunchCmdLookup	Look up data. In contrast to sysAppLaunchCmdFind, a level of indirection is implied. For example, look up a phone number associated with a name.
sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch	Launch normally.
sysAppLaunchCmdNotify	Broadcast a notification.
sysAppLaunchCmdOpenDB	Launch application and open a database.
sysAppLaunchCmdPanelCalledFromApp	Tell preferences panel that it was invoked from an application, not the Preferences application.
sysAppLaunchCmdReturnFromPanel	Tell an application that it's restarting after preferences panel had been called.
sysAppLaunchCmdSaveData	Save data. Often sent before find operations.

Table 3.1 Palm OS Launch Codes *(continued)*

Code	Request
sysAppLaunchCmdSyncNotify	Notify applications that a HotSync has been completed.
sysAppLaunchCmdSystemLock	Sent to the Security application to request that the system be locked down.
sysAppLaunchCmdSystemReset	Respond to system reset. No UI is allowed during this launch code.
sysAppLaunchCmdTimeChange	Respond to system time change.
sysAppLaunchCmdURLParams	Launch an application with parameters from the Web Clipping Application Viewer.

Notification Summary

Table 3.2 lists all Palm OS standard notifications. These notifications are declared in the header `NotifyMgr.h`. All the parameters for a notification are passed in a `SysNotifyParamType` structure and the results are returned in that same structure.

Table 3.2 Notification Constants

Constant	Description
cncNotifyProfileEvent	The connection profile used by the Connection Panel has changed.
sysExternalConnectorAttachEvent	A device has been attached to an external connector.
sysExternalConnectorDetachEvent	A device has been detached from an external connector.
sysNotifyAntennaRaisedEvent	The antenna has been raised on a Palm VII series device.

Table 3.2 Notification Constants *(continued)*

Constant	Description
sysNotifyCardInsertedEvent	An expansion card has been inserted into the expansion slot.
sysNotifyCardRemovedEvent	An expansion card has been removed from the expansion slot.
sysNotifyDBDeletedEvent	A database has been deleted.
sysNotifyDeleteProtectedEvent	The Launcher has attempted to delete a protected database.
sysNotifyDeviceUnlocked	The user has unlocked the device.
sysNotifyDisplayChangeEvent	The color table or bit depth has changed.
sysNotifyEarlyWakeupEvent	The system is starting to wake up.
sysNotifyForgotPasswordEvent	The user has tapped the Lost Password button in the Security application.
sysNotifyGotUsersAttention	The Attention Manager has informed the user of an event.
sysNotifyHelperEvent	An application has requested that a particular service be performed.
sysNotifyIrDASniffEvent	Not used.
sysNotifyLateWakeupEvent	The system has finished waking up.
sysNotifyLocaleChangedEvent	The system locale has changed.
sysNotifyMenuCmdBarOpenEvent	The system is about to display the menu command toolbar.
sysNotifyNetLibIFMediaEvent	The system has been connected to or disconnected from the network.
sysNotifyPhoneEvent	Reserved for future use.
sysNotifyPOSEMountEvent	System use only.
sysNotifyResetFinishedEvent	The system has finished a reset.

Table 3.2 Notification Constants *(continued)*

Constant	Description
sysNotifyRetryEnqueueKey	The Attention Manager has failed to post a virtual character to the key queue.
sysNotifySleepNotifyEvent	The system is about to go to sleep.
sysNotifySleepRequestEvent	The system has decided to go to sleep.
sysNotifySyncFinishEvent	A HotSync operation has just completed.
sysNotifySyncStartEvent	A HotSync operation is about to begin.
sysNotifyTimeChangeEvent	The system time has just changed.
sysNotifyVolumeMountedEvent	A file system has been mounted.
sysNotifyVolumeUnmountedEvent	A file system has been unmounted.

Launch and Notification Function Summary

Launching Applications

SysAppLaunch
SysUIAppSwitch
SysBroadcastActionCode

Notification Manager Functions

SysNotifyRegister
SysNotifyUnregister
SysNotifyBroadcast
SysNotifyBroadcastDeferred
SysNotifyBroadcastFromInterrupt

4

Event Loop

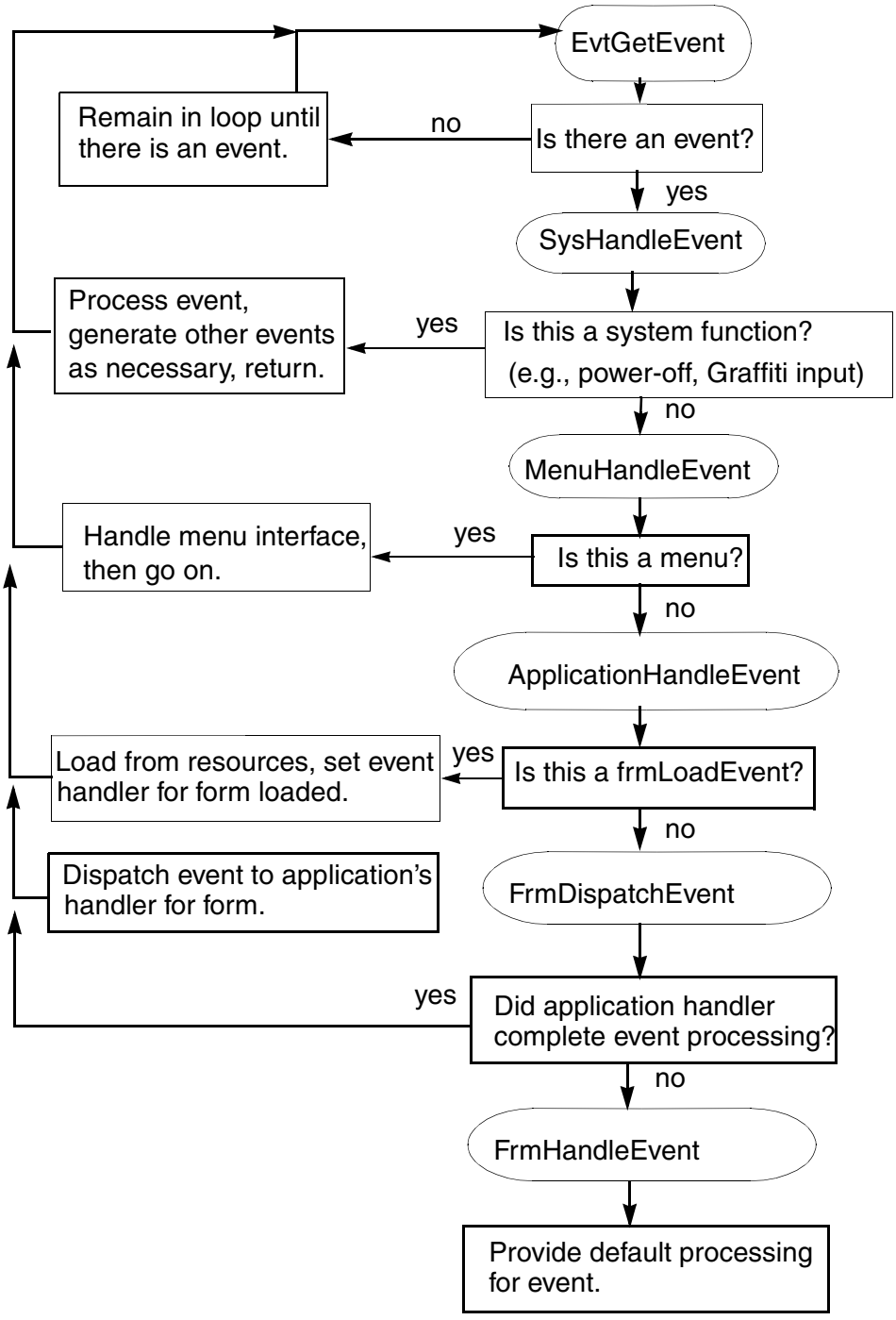
This chapter discusses the event manager, the main interface between the Palm OS® system software and the application. It discusses in some detail what an application does in response to user input, providing code fragments as examples where needed. The topics covered are:

- The Application Event Loop
- Low-Level Event Management

This chapter's focus is on how to write your applications main event loop. For more detailed information on events, consult the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*. Details for each event are given in Chapter 3, "Palm OS Events." In addition to the reference material, consult the chapter "User Interface" in this book. It provides the event flow for each user interface element.

Figure 4.1 illustrates control flow in a typical application.

Figure 4.1 Control Flow in a Typical Application



The Application Event Loop

As described in the previous chapter, "Application Startup and Stop," an application performs a full startup when it receives the launch code `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch`. It begins with a startup routine, then goes into an event loop, and finally exits with a stop routine.

In the event loop, the application fetches events from the queue and dispatches them, taking advantage of the default system functionality as appropriate.

While in the loop, the application continuously checks for events on the event queue. If there are events on the queue, the application has to process them as determined in the event loop. As a rule, the events are passed on to the system, which knows how to handle them. For example, the system knows how to respond to pen taps on forms or menus.

The application typically remains in the event loop until the system tells it to shut itself down by sending an `appStopEvent` (not a launch code) through the event queue. The application must detect this event and terminate.

Listing 4.1 Top-Level Event Loop Example from Datebook.c

```
static void EventLoop (void)
{
   UInt16 error;
   EventType event;
   do
      {
      EvtGetEvent (&event, evtWaitForever);

      PreprocessEvent (&event);

      if (! SysHandleEvent (&event))

         if (! MenuHandleEvent (NULL, &event, &error))

            if (! ApplicationHandleEvent (&event))
               FrmDispatchEvent (&event);
```

```
      #if  EMULATION_LEVEL != EMULATION_NONE
         ECApptDBValidate (ApptDB);
      #endif
      }
   while (event.eType != appStopEvent);
}
```

In the event loop, the application iterates through these steps (see Figure 4.1 and Listing 4.1)

1. Fetch an event from the event queue.
2. Call `PreprocessEvent` to allow the datebook event handler to see the command keys before any other event handler gets them. Some of the datebook views display UI that disappears automatically; this UI needs to be dismissed before the system event handler or the menu event handler display any UI objects.

   Note that not all applications need a `PreprocessEvent` function. It may be appropriate to call `SysHandleEvent` right away.
3. Call `SysHandleEvent` to give the system an opportunity to handle the event.

   The system handles events like power on/power off, Graffiti® input, tapping silk-screened icons, or pressing buttons. During the call to `SysHandleEvent`, the user may also be informed about low-battery warnings or may find and search another application.

   Note that in the process of handling an event, `SysHandleEvent` may generate new events and put them on the queue. For example, the system handles Graffiti input by translating the pen events to key events. Those, in turn, are put on the event queue and are eventually handled by the application.

   `SysHandleEvent` returns `true` if the event was completely handled, that is, no further processing of the event is required. The application can then pick up the next event from the queue.

4. If SysHandleEvent did not completely handle the event, the application calls MenuHandleEvent. MenuHandleEvent handles two types of events:
   - If the user has tapped in the area that invokes a menu, MenuHandleEvent brings up the menu.
   - If the user has tapped inside a menu to invoke a menu command, MenuHandleEvent removes the menu from the screen and puts the events that result from the command onto the event queue.

   MenuHandleEvent returns TRUE if the event was completely handled.
5. If MenuHandleEvent did not completely handle the event, the application calls ApplicationHandleEvent, a function your application has to provide itself. ApplicationHandleEvent handles only the frmLoadEvent for that event; it loads and activates application form resources and sets the event handler for the active form.
6. If ApplicationHandleEvent did not completely handle the event, the application calls FrmDispatchEvent. FrmDispatchEvent first sends the event to the application's event handler for the active form. This is the event handler routine that was established in ApplicationHandleEvent. Thus the application's code is given the first opportunity to process events that pertain to the current form. The application's event handler may completely handle the event and return true to calls from FrmDispatchEvent. In that case, FrmDispatchEvent returns to the application's event loop. Otherwise, FrmDispatchEvent calls FrmHandleEvent to provide the system's default processing for the event.

   For example, in the process of handling an event, an application frequently has to first close the current form and then open another one, as follows:
   - The application calls FrmGotoForm to bring up another form. FrmGotoForm queues a frmCloseEvent for the currently active form, then queues frmLoadEvent and frmOpenEvent for the new form.

- When the application gets the `frmCloseEvent`, it closes and erases the currently active form.
- When the application gets the `frmLoadEvent`, it loads and then activates the new form. Normally, the form remains active until it's closed. (Note that this wouldn't work if you preload all forms, but preloading is really discouraged. Applications don't need to be concerned with the overhead of loading forms; loading is so fast that applications can do it when they need it.) The application's event handler for the new form is also established.
- When the application gets the `frmOpenEvent`, it performs any required initialization of the form, then draws the form on the display.

After `FrmGotoForm` has been called, any further events that come through the main event loop and to `FrmDispatchEvent` are dispatched to the event handler for the form that's currently active. For each dialog box or form, the event handler knows how it should respond to events, for example, it may open, close, highlight, or perform other actions in response to the event. `FrmHandleEvent` invokes this default UI functionality.

After the system has done all it can to handle the event for the specified form, the application finally calls the active form's own event handling function. For example, in the datebook application, it may call `DayViewHandleEvent` or `WeekViewHandleEvent`.

Notice how the event flow allows your application to rely on system functionality as much as it wants. If your application wants to know whether a button is pressed, it has only to wait for `ctlSelectEvent`. All the details of the event queue are handled by the system.

Some events are actually requests for the application to do something, for example, `frmOpenEvent`. Typically, all the application does is draw its own interface, using the functions provided by the system, and then waits for events it can handle to arrive from the queue.

Only the active form should process events.

Low-Level Event Management

You can perform low-level event management using System Event Manager functions. The system event manager:

- manages the low-level pen and key event queues.
- translates taps on silk-screened icons into key events.
- sends pen strokes in the Graffiti area to the Graffiti recognizer.
- puts the system into low-power doze mode when there is no user activity.

Most applications have no need to call the system event manager directly because most of the functionality they need comes from the higher-level event manager or is automatically handled by the system.

Applications that do use the system event manager directly might do so to enqueue key events into the key queue or to retrieve each of the pen points that comprise a pen stroke from the pen queue.

This section provides information about the system event manager by discussing these topics:

- Event Translation: Pen Strokes to Key Events
- Pen Queue Management
- Auto-Off Control
- System Event Manager Summary

Event Translation: Pen Strokes to Key Events

One of the higher-level functions provided by the system event manager is conversion of pen strokes on the digitizer to key events. For example, the system event manager sends any stroke in the Graffiti area of the digitizer automatically to the Graffiti recognizer for conversion to a key event. Taps on silk-screened icons, such as the application launcher, Menu button, and Find button, are also intercepted by the system event manager and converted into the appropriate key events.

When the system converts a pen stroke to a key event, it:

- Retrieves all pen points that comprise the stroke from the pen queue
- Converts the stroke into the matching key event
- Enqueues that key event into the key queue

Eventually, the system returns the key event to the application as a normal result of calling `EvtGetEvent`.

Most applications rely on the following default behavior of the system event manager:

- All strokes in the predefined Graffiti area of the digitizer are converted to key events
- All taps on the silk-screened icons are convert to key events
- All other strokes are passed on to the application for processing

Pen Queue Management

The pen queue is a preallocated area of system memory used for capturing the most recent pen strokes on the digitizer. It is a circular queue with a first-in, first-out method of storing and retrieving pen points. Points are usually enqueued by a low-level interrupt routine and dequeued by the system event manager or application.

Table 4.1 summarizes pen management.

Table 4.1 Pen Queue Management

The user...	The system...
Brings the pen down on the digitizer.	Stores a pen-down sequence in the pen queue and starts the stroke capture.
Draws a character.	Stores additional points in the pen queue periodically.
Lifts the pen.	Stores a pen-up sequence in the pen queue and turns off stroke capture.

The system event manager provides an API for initializing and flushing the pen queue and for queuing and dequeuing points. Some state information is stored in the queue itself: to dequeue a stroke, the caller must first make a call to dequeue the stroke information (`EvtDequeuePenStrokeInfo`) before the points for the stroke can be dequeued. Once the last point is dequeued, another `EvtDequeuePenStrokeInfo` call must be made to get the next stroke.

Applications usually don't need to call `EvtDequeuePenStrokeInfo` because the event manager calls this function automatically when it detects a complete pen stroke in the pen queue. After calling `EvtDequeuePenStrokeInfo`, the system event manager stores the stroke bounds into the event record and returns the pen-up event to the application. The application is then free to dequeue the stroke points from the pen queue, or to ignore them altogether. If the points for that stroke are not dequeued by the time `EvtGetEvent` is called again, the system event manager automatically flushes them.

Key Queue Management

The key queue is an area of system memory preallocated for capturing key events. Key events come from one of two occurrences:

- As a direct result of the user pressing one of the buttons on the case
- As a side effect of the user drawing a Graffiti stroke on the digitizer, which is converted in software to a key event

Table 4.2 summarizes key management.

Table 4.2 Key Queue Management

User action	System response
Hardware button press.	Interrupt routine enqueues the appropriate key event into the key queue, temporarily disables further hardware button interrupts, and sets up a timer task to run every 10 ms.
Hold down key for extended time period.	Timer task to supports auto-repeat of the key (timer task is also used to debounce the hardware).

Table 4.2 Key Queue Management *(continued)*

User action	System response
Release key for certain amount of time.	Timer task reenables the hardware button interrupts.
Pen stroke in Graffiti area of digitizer.	System manager calls the Graffiti recognizer, which then removes the stroke from the pen queue, converts the stroke into one or more key events, and finally enqueues these key events into the key queue.
Pen stroke on silk-screened icons.	System event manager converts the stroke into the appropriate key event and enqueues it into the key queue.

The system event manager provides an API for initializing and flushing the key queue and for enqueuing and dequeuing key events. Usually, applications have no need to dequeue key events; the event manager does this automatically if it detects a key in the queue and returns a `keyDownEvent` to the application through the `EvtGetEvent` call.

Auto-Off Control

Because the system event manager manages hardware events like pen taps and hardware button presses, it's responsible for resetting the auto-off timer on the device. Whenever the system detects a hardware event, it automatically resets the auto-off timer to 0. If an application needs to reset the auto-off timer manually, it can do so through the system event manager call `EvtResetAutoOffTimer`.

System Event Manager Summary

System Event Manager Functions	
Main Event Queue Management	
EvtGetEvent	EvtEventAvail
EvtSysEventAvail	EvtAddEventToQueue
EvtAddUniqueEventToQueue	EvtCopyEvent

System Event Manager Functions	
Pen Queue Management	
EvtPenQueueSize	EvtDequeuePenPoint
EvtDequeuePenStrokeInfo	EvtFlushNextPenStroke
EvtFlushPenQueue	EvtGetPen
EvtGetPenBtnList	
Key Queue Management	
EvtKeyQueueSize	EvtEnqueueKey
EvtFlushKeyQueue	EvtKeyQueueEmpty
Handling pen strokes and key strokes	
EvtEnableGraffiti	EvtProcessSoftKeyStroke
Handling power on and off events	
EvtResetAutoOffTimer	EvtWakeup

5

User Interface

This chapter describes the user interface (UI) elements that you can use in your application. To create a user interface element, you create a resource that defines what that element looks like and where it is displayed. You interact with the element programmatically as a UI object. A Palm OS UI object is a C structure that is linked with one or more items on the screen. Note that Palm UI objects are just structures, not the more elaborate objects found in some systems. This is useful because in general a C structure is more compact than these other objects.

This chapter introduces each of the user interface objects. It also describes Palm system managers that aid in working with the user interface. The chapter covers:

- Palm OS Resource Summary
- Drawing on the Palm OS Device
- Forms, Windows, and Dialogs
- Controls
- Fields
- Menus
- Tables
- Lists
- Categories
- Bitmaps
- Labels
- Scroll Bars
- Custom UI Objects
- Dynamic UI
- Color and Grayscale Support
- Insertion Point

- Text
- Receiving User Input
- Application Launcher

For guidelines on creating a user interface, see the chapter "Good Design Practices" earlier in this book.

Palm OS Resource Summary

The Palm OS development environment provides a set of resource templates that application developers use to implement the buttons, dialogs, and other UI elements. Table 5.1 maps user interface elements to resources. The ResEdit name is included for developers using that tool. It is not relevant for Palm OS Constructor users.

All resources are discussed in detail in the chapter "Palm OS Resources" on page 35 of the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*. Specific design recommendations for some of the elements are provided in the chapter "Good Design Practices" in "User Interface Guidelines."

Table 5.1 UI resource summary

UI Element and Functionality	Example	Resource(s)
Command button— Execute command.		Button (tBTN)
Push button (also called radio button)— Select a value		Push button (tPBN)
Hot text entry— Invoke dialog that changes text of the button.		Selector trigger (tSLT)
Increment arrow— Increment/decrement values, or scroll.		Button (tBTN) or repeating button (tREP)
Check box— Toggle on or off.		Checkbox (tCBX)

Table 5.1 UI resource summary *(continued)*

UI Element and Functionality	Example	Resource(s)
Popup list— Choose a setting from a list.		Popup trigger (tPUT) Popup list (tPUL) List (tLST)
Menu— Execute commands not found on screen as buttons and so on.		Menu Bar (MBAR) Menu (MENU)
Text field— Display text (single or multiple lines).	Staff meeting	Field (tFLD)
Scroll bar— Use together with fields or tables.		Scroll bar (tSCL)

Drawing on the Palm OS Device

The first Palm OS platform devices have an LCD screen of 160x160 pixels. The built-in LCD controller maps a portion of system memory to the LCD. This controller can support 2 bits/pixel grayscale; however, the Palm OS software only supported 1 bit/pixel monochrome graphics until version 3.0. Two bits/pixel support was added in Palm OS 3.0 and 4 bits/pixel in Palm OS 3.3. Palm OS 3.5 introduces support for both grayscale and color displays, with system palettes of either 1, 2, 4, or 8 bits/pixel. Palm OS 4.0 introduces support for 16 bits/pixel color.(See "Color and Grayscale Support" for more information.) Hardware may still limit the actual displayable depths.

Usually, the form manager handles all necessary drawing and redrawing to the screen when it receives certain events. (In Palm OS, a **form** is analogous to a window in a desktop application, and a **window** is an abstract drawing region.) You don't have to explicitly call drawing routines. However, if you're performing animation or if you have any custom user interface objects (known as gadgets), you might need to use the drawing functions provided by the window manager.

The window manager defines a window object and provides functions for drawing to windows. A window is a drawing region that is either onscreen or offscreen. The window's data structure contains a bitmap that contains the actual data displayed in the window. Windows add clipping regions over the top of bitmaps.

The Draw State

The window manager also defines a draw state: pen color, pattern, graphics state, and so on. The draw state is handled differently depending on the operating system version.

On pre-3.5 versions of Palm OS, the system maintains several individual global variables that each track an element of the draw state. If you want to change some aspect of the draw state, you use a `WinSet`... function (such as `WinSetUnderlineMode`). Each `WinSet`... function returns the old value. It's your responsibility to save the old value returned by the function and to restore the variable's value when you are finished by calling the function again. Using such routines can be inconvenient because it means using application stack space to track system state. Further, if a caller forgets to restore the value, the entire look and feel of the device may be altered.

Palm OS 3.5 introduces two improvements to make tracking changes to the draw state easier. First, it groups the drawing-related global variables and treats them as a single unit. This draw state is the Palm OS implementation of a **pen**. It contains the current transfer (or draw) mode, pattern mode and pattern data for `WinFill`... routines, and foreground and background colors. It also contains text-related drawing information: the font ID, the font pointer, the underline mode, and the text color. (Palm OS does not currently support other common pen-like concepts such as line

width, pen shape, or corner join.) Only one draw state exists in the system.

Second, Palm OS 3.5 can track changes to the draw state by storing states on a stack. Your application no longer needs to use its own stack for pieces of the draw state. Instead, use `WinPushDrawState` to push a copy of the current draw state on the top of the stack. Then use the existing `WinSet...` functions to make your changes. When you've finished your drawing and want to restore the draw state, call `WinPopDrawState`.

The new drawing state stack allows for additional debugging help. If an application exits without popping sufficiently or it pops too much, this is detected and flagged on debug ROMs. When switching applications, the system pops to a default state on application exit, guaranteeing a consistent draw state when a new application is launched.

Drawing Functions

The window manager can draw rectangles, lines, characters, bitmaps, and (starting in version 3.5) pixels. The window manager supports five flavors of most calls:

Table 5.2 Window manager drawing operations

Mode	Operation
Draw	Render object outline only, using current foreground color and pattern. For a bitmap, draws the bitmap.
Fill	Render object internals only, using current foreground color and pattern.
Erase	Erase object outline and internals to window background color.
Invert	Swap foreground and background colors within region defined by object.
Paint	Supported only in version 3.5 and higher. Render object using all of the current draw state: transfer mode, foreground and background colors, pattern, font, text color, and underline mode.

The drawing functions always draw to the current draw window. This window may be either an onscreen window or an offscreen window. Use `WinSetDrawWindow` to set the draw window before calling these functions.

Forms, Windows, and Dialogs

A form is the GUI area for each view of your application. For example the Address Book offers an Address List view, Address Edit view, and so on. Each application has to have one form, and most applications have more than one. To actually create the view, you have to add other UI elements to the form; either by dragging them onto the form from the catalog or by providing their ID as the value of some of the form's fields.

Figure 5.1 shows an example of a form. Typical forms are as large as the screen, as shown here. Other forms are modal dialogs, which are shorter than the screen but just as wide.

Figure 5.1 Form



A window defines a drawing region. This region may be on the display or in a memory buffer (an off-screen window). Off-screen windows are useful for saving and restoring regions of the display that are obscured by other UI objects. All forms are windows, but not all windows are forms.

The window object is the portion of the form object that determines how the form's window looks and behaves. A window object contains viewing coordinates of the window and clipping bounds.

When a form is opened, a `frmOpenEvent` is triggered and the form's ID is stored. A `winExitEvent` is triggered whenever a form is closed, and a `winEnterEvent` is triggered whenever a form is drawn.

The following two sections describe special types of forms:

- Alert Dialogs
- Progress Dialogs

Alert Dialogs

If you want to display an alert dialog (see Figure 5.2) or prompt the user for a response to a question, use the alert manager. The alert manager defines the following functions:

- `FrmAlert`
- `FrmCustomAlert`

Figure 5.2 Alert dialog



Given a resource ID that defines an alert, the alert manager creates and displays a modal dialog box. When the user taps one of the buttons in the dialog, the alert manager disposes of the dialog box and returns to the caller the item number of the button the user tapped.

There are four types of system-defined alerts:

- Question
- Warning
- Notification
- Error

The alert type determines which icon is drawn in the alert window and which sound plays when the alert is displayed.

When the alert manager is invoked, it's passed an alert resource (see the chapter "Palm OS Resources" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*) that contains the following information:

- The rectangle that specifies the size and position of the alert window
- The alert type (question, warning, notification, or error)
- The null-terminated text string; that is, the message the alert displays
- The text labels for one or more buttons

Progress Dialogs

If your application performs a lengthy process, such as data transfer during a communications session, consider displaying a progress dialog to inform the user of the status of the process. The progress manager provides the mechanism to display progress dialogs.

You display a progress dialog by calling `PrgStartDialog`. Then, as your process progresses, you call `PrgUpdateDialog` to update the dialog with new information for the user. In your event loop you call `PrgHandleEvent` to handle the progress dialog update events queued by `PrgUpdateDialog`. The `PrgHandleEvent` function makes a callback to a `textCallback` function that you supply to get the latest progress information.

Note that whatever operation you are doing that is the lengthy process, you do the work inside your normal event loop, not in the callback function. That is, you call `EvtGetEvent` and do work when you get a `nilEvent`. Each time you get a `nilEvent`, do a chunk of work, but be sure to continue to call `EvtGetEvent` frequently (like every half second), so that pen taps and other events get noticed quickly enough.

The dialog can display a few lines of text that are automatically centered and formatted. You can also specify an icon that identifies the operation in progress. The dialog has one optional button that can be a cancel or an OK button. The type of the button is automatically controlled by the progress manager and depends on

the current progress state (no error, error, or user canceled operation).

Progress textCallback Function

When you want to update the progress dialog with new information, you call the function `PrgUpdateDialog`. To get the current progress information to display in the progress dialog, `PrgHandleEvent` makes a callback to a function, `textCallback`, that you supplied in your call to `PrgStartDialog`.

The system passes the `textCallback` function one parameter, a pointer to a `PrgCallbackData` structure. To learn what type of information is passed in this structure, see the chapter "Progress Manager" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

Your `textCallback` function should return a Boolean. Return `true` if the progress dialog should be updated using the values you specified in the `PrgCallbackData` structure. If you specify `false`, the dialog is still updated, but with default status messages. (Returning `false` is not recommended.)

In the `textCallback` function, you should set the value of the `textP` buffer to the string you want to display in the progress dialog when it is updated. You can use the value in the `stage` field to look up a message in a string resource. You also might want to append the text in the `message` field to your base string. Typically, the `message` field would contain more dynamic information that depends on a user selection, such as a phone number, device name, or network identifier, etc.

For example, the `PrgUpdateDialog` function might have been called with a `stage` of 1 and a `messageP` parameter value of a phone number string, "555-1212". Based on the stage, you might find the string "Dialing" in a string resource, and append the phone number, to form the final text "Dialing 555-1212" that you place in the text buffer `textP`.

Keeping the static strings corresponding to various stages in a resource makes it easier to localize your application. More dynamic information can be passed in via the `messageP` parameter to `PrgUpdateDialog`.

NOTE: The `textCallback` function is called only if the parameters passed to `PrgUpdateDialog` have changed from the last time it was called. If `PrgUpdateDialog` is called twice with exactly the same parameters, the `textCallback` function is called only once.

Controls

Control objects allow for user interaction when you add them to the forms in your application. Events in control objects are handled by `CtlHandleEvent`. There are several types of control objects, which are all described in this section.

NOTE: Palm OS 3.5 and higher support graphical controls for all control types other than check box. Graphical controls behave the same as their non-graphical counterparts, but they display a bitmap instead of a text label. On releases prior to Palm OS 3.5, you can create a graphical control by setting the text label to the empty string and placing the control on top of a bitmap.

Buttons

Buttons (see Figure 5.3) display a text label in a box. The default style for a button is a text string centered within a rounded rectangle. Buttons have rounded corners unless a rectangular frame is specified. A button without a frame inverts a rectangular region when pressed.

When the user taps a button with the pen, the button highlights until the user releases the pen or drags it outside the bounds of the button.

Table 5.3 shows the system events generated when the user interacts with the button and `CtlHandleEvent`'s response to the events.

Figure 5.3 Buttons



Table 5.3 Event flow for buttons

User Action	System Response	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen goes down on a button.	penDownEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlEnterEvent to the event queue.
	ctlEnterEvent with button's ID number.	Inverts the button's display.
Pen is lifted from button.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlSelectEvent to the event queue.
Pen is lifted outside button.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlExitEvent to the event queue.

Popup Trigger

A popup trigger (see Figure 5.4) displays a text label and a graphic element (always on the left) that signifies the control initiates a popup list. If the text label changes, the width of the control expands or contracts to the width of the new label plus the graphic element.

Table 5.4 shows the system events generated when the user interacts with the popup trigger and CtlHandleEvent's response to the events. Because popup triggers are used to display list objects, also see the section "Lists" in this chapter.

Figure 5.4 Popup trigger



Table 5.4 Event flow for popup triggers

User Action	System Response	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen goes down on the popup trigger.	penDownEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlEnterEvent to the event queue.
	ctlEnterEvent with popup trigger's ID number.	Inverts the trigger's display.
Pen is lifted from button.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlSelectEvent to the event queue.
	ctlSelectEvent with popup trigger's ID number.	Adds a winEnterEvent for the list object's window to the event queue. Control passes to FrmHandleEvent, which displays the list. Control then passes to LstHandleEvent.
Pen is lifted outside button.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlExitEvent to the event queue.

Selector Trigger

A selector trigger (see Figure 5.5) displays a text label surrounded by a gray rectangular frame. If the text label changes, the width of the control expands or contracts to the width of the new label.

Table 5.5 shows the system events generated when the user interacts with the selector trigger and CtlHandleEvent's response to the events.

Figure 5.5 Selector trigger



Table 5.5 Event flow for selector triggers

User Action	System Response	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen goes down on a selector trigger.	penDownEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlEnterEvent to the event queue.
	ctlEnterEvent with selector trigger's ID number.	Inverts the button's display.
Pen is lifted from the selector trigger.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlSelectEvent to the event queue.
	ctlSelectEvent with selector trigger's ID number.	Adds a frmOpenEvent followed by a winExitEvent to the event queue. Control is passed to the form object.

Repeating Button

A repeat control looks like a button. In contrast to buttons, however, users can repeatedly select repeat controls if they don't lift the pen when the control has been selected. The object is selected repeatedly until the pen is lifted.

Table 5.6 shows the system events generated when the user interacts with the selector trigger and CtlHandleEvent's response to the events.

Table 5.6 Event flow for repeating buttons

User Action	System Response	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen goes down on a repeating button.	penDownEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlEnterEvent to the event queue.
	ctlEnterEvent with button's ID number.	Adds the ctlRepeatEvent to the event queue.

Table 5.6 Event flow for repeating buttons *(continued)*

User Action	System Response	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen remains on repeating button.	`ctlRepeatEvent`	Tracks the pen for a period of time, then sends another `ctlRepeatEvent` if the pen is still within the bounds of the control.
Pen is dragged off the repeating button.		No `ctlRepeatEvent` occurs.
Pen is dragged back onto the button.	`ctlRepeatEvent`	See above.
Pen is lifted from button.	`penUpEvent` with the x and y coordinates stored in `EventType`.	Adds the `ctlExitEvent` to the event queue.

Push Buttons

Push buttons (see Figure 5.6) look like buttons, but the frame always has square corners. Touching a push button with the pen inverts the bounds. If the pen is released within the bounds, the button remains inverted.

Table 5.7 shows the system events generated when the user interacts with the push button and `CtlHandleEvent`'s response to the events.

Figure 5.6 Push buttons



Table 5.7 Event flow for push buttons

User Action	System Response	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen goes down on a push button.	penDownEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlEnterEvent to the event queue.
	ctlEnterEvent with push button's ID number.	If push button is grouped and highlighted, no change. If push button is ungrouped and highlighted, it becomes unhighlighted.
Pen is lifted from push button.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlSelectEvent to the event queue.

Check Boxes

Check boxes (see Figure 5.7) display a setting, either on (checked) or off (unchecked). Touching a check box with the pen toggles the setting. The check box appears as a square, which contains a check mark if the check box's setting is on. A check box can have a text label attached to it; selecting the label also toggles the check box.

Push buttons and check boxes can be arranged into exclusive groups; one and only one control in a group can be on at a time.

Table 5.8 shows the system events generated when the user interacts with the check box and CtlHandleEvent's response to the events.

Figure 5.7 Check boxes

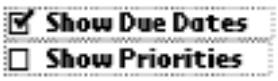


Table 5.8 Event flow for check boxes

User Action	Event Generated	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen goes down on check box.	penDownEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlEnterEvent to the event queue.
	ctlEnterEvent with check box's ID number.	Tracks the pen until the user lifts it.
Pen is lifted from check box.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	• If the check box is unchecked, a check appears. • If the check box is already checked and is grouped, there is no change in appearance. • If the check box is already checked and is ungrouped, the check disappears. Adds the ctlSelectEvent to the event queue.
Pen is lifted outside box.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlExitEvent to the event queue.

Sliders and Feedback Sliders

Starting in Palm OS 3.5, slider controls (see Figure 5.8) are supported. Sliders represent a value that falls within a particular range. For example, a slider might represent a value that can be between 0 and 10.

Figure 5.8 Slider



There are four attributes that are unique to slider controls:

- The minimum value the slider can represent

- The maximum value the slider can represent
- The current value
- The page jump value, or the amount by which the value is increased or decreased when the user clicks to the left or right of the slider thumb

Palm OS supports two types of sliders: regular slider and feedback slider. Sliders and feedback sliders look alike but behave differently. Specifically, a regular slider control does not send events while the user is dragging its thumb. A feedback slider control sends an event each time the thumb moves one pixel, whether the pen has been lifted or not.

Table 5.9 shows the system events generated when the user interfaces with a slider and how `CtlHandleEvent` responds to the events.

Table 5.9 Event flow for sliders

User Action	System Response	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen tap on slider's background.	`penDownEvent` with the x and y coordinates stored in `EventType`.	Adds the `ctlEnterEvent` to the event queue.
	`ctlEnterEvent` with slider's ID number.	Adds or subtracts the slider's page jump value from its current value, and adds a `ctlSelectEvent` with the new value to the event queue.
Pen goes down on the slider's thumb.	`penDownEvent` with the x and y coordinates stored in `EventType`.	Adds the `ctlEnterEvent` to the event queue.
	`ctlEnterEvent` with slider's ID number.	Tracks the pen.
Pen drags slider's thumb to the left or right.		Continues tracking the pen.

Table 5.9 Event flow for sliders *(continued)*

User Action	System Response	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen is lifted from slider.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlSelectEvent with the slider's ID number and new value if the coordinates are within the bounds of the slider. Adds the ctlExitEvent if the coordinates are outside of the slider's bounds.

Table 5.10 shows the system events generated when the user interacts with a feedback slider and CtlHandleEvent's response to the events.

Table 5.10 Event flow for feedback sliders

User Action	System Response	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen tap on slider's background.	penDownEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlEnterEvent to the event queue.
	ctlEnterEvent with slider's ID number.	Adds or subtracts the slider's page jump value from its current value and then sends a ctlRepeatEvent with the slider's new value.
	ctlRepeatEvent	Adds or subtracts the slider's page jump value from its current value repeatedly until the thumb reaches the pen position or the slider's minimum or maximum. Then sends a ctlSelectEvent with slider's ID number and new value.

Table 5.10 Event flow for feedback sliders *(continued)*

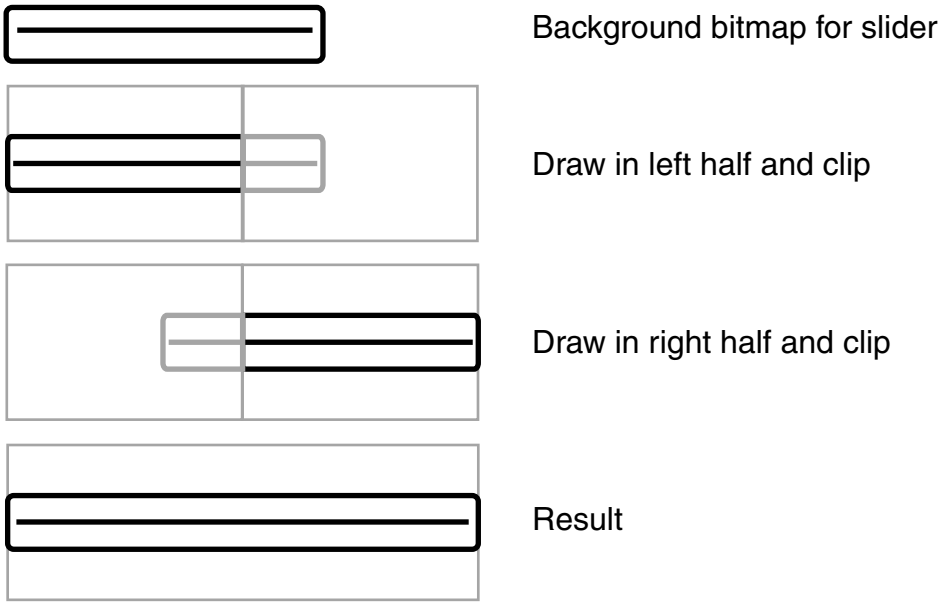
User Action	System Response	CtlHandleEvent Response
Pen goes down on the slider's thumb.	penDownEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlEnterEvent to the event queue.
	ctlEnterEvent with slider's ID number.	Tracks the pen and updates the display.
Pen drags slider's thumb to the left or right.	ctlRepeatEvent with slider's ID number and new value.	Tracks the pen. Each time pen moves to the left or right, sends another ctlRepeatEvent if the pen is still within the bounds of the control.
Pen is dragged off the slider vertically.		ctlRepeatEvent with the slider's ID number and old value.
Pen is dragged back onto the slider.		ctlRepeatEvent with the slider's ID number and new value.
Pen is lifted from slider.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the ctlExitEvent to the event queue.

Sliders are drawn using two bitmaps: one for the slider background, and the other for the thumb. You may use the default bitmaps to draw sliders, or you may specify your own bitmaps when you create the slider.

The background bitmap you provide can be smaller than the slider's bounding rectangle. This allows you to provide one bitmap for sliders of several different sizes. If the background bitmap isn't as tall as the slider's bounding rectangle, it's vertically centered in the rectangle. If the bitmap isn't as wide as the slider's bounding rectangle, the bitmap is drawn twice. First, it's drawn left-justified in the left half of the bounding rectangle and clipped to exactly half of the rectangle's width. Then, it's drawn right-justified in the right

half of the bounding rectangle and clipped to exactly half of the rectangle's width. (See Figure 5.9.) Note that this means that the bitmap you provide must be at least half the width of the bounding rectangle.

Figure 5.9 Drawing a slider background



Fields

A field object displays one or more lines of text. Figure 5.10 is an underlined, left-justified field containing data.

Figure 5.10 Field



The field object supports these features:

- Proportional fonts (only one font per field)
- Drag-selection
- Scrolling for multiline fields
- Cut, copy, and paste

- Left and right text justification
- Tab stops
- Editable/noneditable attribute
- Expandable field height (the height of the field expands as more text is entered)
- Underlined text (each line of the field is underlined)
- Maximum character limit (the field stops accepting characters when the maximum is reached)
- Special keys (Graffiti strokes) to support cut, copy, and paste
- Insertion point positioning with pen (the insertion point is positioned by touching the pen between characters)
- Scroll bars

The field object does **not** support overstrike input mode; horizontal scrolling; numeric formatting; or special keys for page up, page down, left word, right word, home, end, left margin, right margin, and backspace. On Palm OS Versions earlier than 3.5, the field object also does not support word selection. Starting in version 3.5, double-tapping a word selects that word, and triple-tapping selects the entire line.

NOTE: Field objects can handle line feeds—\0A—but not carriage returns—\0D. PalmRez translates any carriage returns it finds in any Palm OS resources into line feeds, but doesn't touch static data.

Events in field objects are handled by `FldHandleEvent`. Table 5.11 provides an overview of how `FldHandleEvent` deals with the different events

Table 5.11 Event flow for fields

User Action	Event Generated	FldHandleEvent Response
Pen goes down on a field.	penDownEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the fldEnterEvent to the event queue.
	fldEnterEvent with the field's ID number.	Sets the insertion point position to the position of the pen and tracks the pen until it is released. Drag-selection and drag-scrolling are supported. Starting in Palm OS release 3.5, double-tapping in a field selects the word at that location, and triple-tapping selects the line.
Pen is lifted.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates.	Nothing happens; a field remains selected until another field is selected or the form that contains the field is closed.
Enters characters into selected field.	keyDownEvent with character value in EventType.	Character added to field's text string.
Presses up arrow key	keyDownEvent	Moves insertion point up a line.
Presses down arrow	keyDownEvent	Moves insertion point down a line; the insertion point doesn't move beyond the last line that contains text.
Presses left arrow	keyDownEvent	Moves insertion point one character position to the left. When the left margin is reached, move to the end of the previous line.

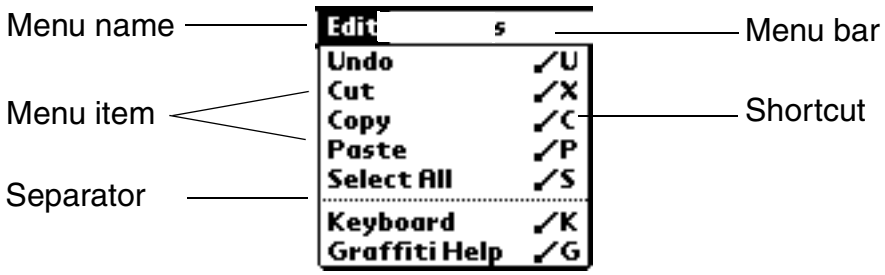
Table 5.11 Event flow for fields *(continued)*

User Action	Event Generated	FldHandleEvent Response
Presses right arrow	keyDownEvent	Moves insertion point one character position to the right. When the right margin is reached, move to the start of the next line.
Cut command	keyDownEvent	Cuts the current selection to the text clipboard.
Copy command	keyDownEvent	Copies the current selection to the text clipboard.
Paste command	keyDownEvent	Inserts clipboard text into the field at insertion point.

Menus

A menu bar is displayed whenever the user taps a menu icon. Starting in Palm OS 3.5, the menu bar is also displayed when the user taps in a form's titlebar. The menu bar, a horizontal list of menu titles, appears at the top of the screen in its own window, above all application windows. Pressing a menu title highlights the title and "pulls down" the menu below the title (see Figure 5.11).

Figure 5.11 Menu



User actions have the following effect on a menu:

When...	Then...
User drags the pen through the menu.	Command under the pen is highlighted.
Pen is released over a menu item.	That item is selected and the menu bar and menu disappear.
Pen is released outside both the menu bar and the menu.	Both menu and menu bar disappear and no selection is made.
Pen is released in a menu title.	Menu bar and Menu remain displayed until a selection is made from the menu.
Pen is tapped outside menu and menu bar.	Both menu and menu bar are dismissed.
User selects a separator with the pen.	Menu is dismissed but no event is posted.

A menu has the following features:

- Item separators, which are lines to group menu items.
- Keyboard shortcuts; the shortcut labels are right justified in menu items.
- A menu remembers its last selection; the next time a menu is displayed the prior selection appears highlighted.
- The bits behind the menu bar and the menus are saved and restored by the menu routines.
- When the menu is visible, the insertion point is turned off.

Menu events are handled by `MenuHandleEvent`. Table 5.12 describes how user actions get translated into events and what `MenuHandleEvent` does in response.

Table 5.12 Event flow for menus

User Action	Event Generated	MenuHandleEvent Response
Pen enters menu bar.	winEnterEvent identifying menu's window.	Tracks the pen.
User selects a menu item.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates.	Adds a menuEvent with the item's ID to the event queue.

Dynamic Menus

In releases of Palm OS prior to release 3.5, the menu was loaded from a menu resource (created with Constructor or some other tool) and could not be modified in code. Starting in Palm OS 3.5, you can add, hide, or unhide menu items while the menu resource is being loaded.

A menuOpenEvent is sent when the menu resource is loaded. (Note that this event is new in version 3.5. Previous releases do not use it.) In response to this event, you can call MenuAddItem to add a menu item to one of the pull-down menus, MenuHideItem to hide a menu item, or MenuShowItem to display a menu item.

You might receive menuOpenEvent several times during an application session. The menu resource is loaded each time the menu is made the active menu. A menu becomes active the first time the user either requests that the menu be displayed or enters the command keystroke on the current form. That menu remains active as long as the form with which it is associated is active. A menu loses its active status under these conditions:

- When FrmSetMenu is called to change the active menu on the form.
- When a new form, even a modal form or alert panel, becomes active.

Suppose a user selects your application's About item from the Options menu then clicks the OK button to return to the main form. When the About dialog is displayed, it becomes the active form, which causes the main form's menu state to be erased. This menu state is not restored when the main form becomes active again. The

next time the user requests the menu, the menu resource is reloaded, and a new `menuOpenEvent` is queued.

You should only make changes to a menu the first time it is loaded after a form becomes active. You should not add, hide, or show items based on user context. Such practice is discouraged in the Palm OS user interface guidelines.

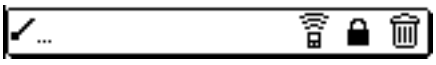
Menu Shortcuts

As an alternative to selecting a menu command through the user interface, users can instead enter a menu shortcut. This support is present in all versions of the Palm OS, but it has been extended in Palm OS 3.5.

On all versions of Palm OS, the user can enter a Graffiti command keystroke followed by another Graffiti character. If the next character matches one of the shortcut characters for an item on the active menu, a `menuEvent` with that menu item is generated. To support this behavior, you simply specify a shortcut character when you create a menu item resource. The default behavior of Palm OS handles this shortcut appropriately.

Starting in Palm OS 3.5, entering the Graffiti command character displays the command toolbar (see Figure 5.12). This toolbar is the width of the screen. (Previous versions of Palm OS simply display the string "Command:" in the lower-left portion of the screen.) The command toolbar displays a status message on the left and buttons on the right. After entering the command character, the user has the choice of entering a Graffiti character or of tapping one of the buttons on the command toolbar. Both of these actions cause the status message to be briefly displayed and (in most cases) a `menuEvent` to be added to the event queue.

Figure 5.12 Command Toolbar



The buttons displayed on the toolbar depend on the user context. If the focus is in an editable field, the field manager displays buttons

for cut, copy, and paste on the command toolbar. If there is an action to undo, the field manager also displays a button for undo.

The active application may also add its own buttons to the toolbar. To do so, respond to the `menuCmdBarOpenEvent` and use `MenuCmdBarAddButton` to add the button. Listing 5.1 shows some code from the Memo application that adds to the command toolbar a button that displays the security dialog and then prevents the field manager from adding other buttons.

Listing 5.1 Responding to menuCmdBarOpenEvent

```
else if (event->eType == menuCmdBarOpenEvent) {

   MenuCmdBarAddButton(menuCmdBarOnLeft,
      BarSecureBitmap, menuCmdBarResultMenuItem,
      ListOptionsSecurityCmd, 0);

   // Tell the field package to not add buttons
   // automatically; we've done it all ourselves.
   event->data.menuCmdBarOpen.preventFieldButtons =
      true;

   // Don't set handled to true; this event must
   // fall through to the system.
}
```

The system contains bitmaps that represent such commands as beaming and deleting records. If your application performs any of these actions, it should use the system bitmap. Table 5.13 shows the system bitmaps and the commands they represent. If you use any of these, you should use them in the order shown, from right to left. That is, `BarDeleteBitmap` should always be the rightmost of these bitmaps, and `BarInfoBitmap` should always be the leftmost.

Table 5.13 System command toolbar bitmaps

Bitmap	Command
`BarDeleteBitmap`	Delete record.
`BarPasteBitmap`	Paste clipboard contents at insertion point.
`BarCopyBitmap`	Copy selection.

Table 5.13 System command toolbar bitmaps *(continued)*

Bitmap	Command
`BarCutBitmap`	Cut selection.
`BarUndoBitmap`	Undo previous action.
`BarSecureBitmap`	Show Security dialog.
`BarBeamBitmap`	Beam current record.
`BarInfoBitmap`	Show Info dialog (Launcher).

You should limit the buttons displayed on the command toolbar to 4 or 5. There are two reasons to limit the number of buttons. You must leave room for the status message to be displayed before the action is performed. Also, consider that the toolbar is displayed only briefly. Users must be able to instantly understand the meaning of each of the buttons on the toolbar. If there are too many buttons, it reduces the chance that users can find what they need.

Note that the field manager already potentially displays 4 buttons by itself. If you want to suppress this behavior and display your own buttons when a field has focus, set the `preventFieldButtons` flag of the `menuCmdBarOpenEvent` to `true` as is shown in Listing 5.1.

Tables

Tables support multi-column displays. Examples are:

- the List view of the ToDo application
- the Day view in the Datebook

The table object is used to organize several types of UI objects. The number of rows and the number of columns must be specified for each table object. A UI object can be placed inside a cell of a table. Tables often consist of rows or columns of the same object. For example, a table might have one column of labels and another column of fields. Tables can only be scrolled vertically. Tables can't include bitmaps.

A problem may arise if non-text elements are used in the table. For example, assume you have a table with two columns. In the first column is an icon that displays information, the second column is a text column. The table only allows users to select elements in the first column that are as high as one row of text. If the icon is larger, only a narrow strip at the top of the column can be selected.

Table Event

The table object generates the event `tblSelectEvent`. This event contains:

- The table's ID number
- The row of the selected table
- The column of the selected table

When `tblSelectEvent` is sent to a table, the table generates an event to handle any possible events within the item's UI object.

Lists

The list object appears as a vertical list of choices in a box. The current selection of the list is inverted.

Figure 5.13 List



A list is meant for static data. Users can choose from a predetermined number of items. Examples include:

- the time list in the time edit window of the datebook
- the Category popup list (see "Categories" in this chapter)

If there are more choices than can be displayed, the system draws small arrows (scroll indicators) in the right margin next to the first and last visible choice. When the pen comes down and up on a

scroll indicator, the list is scrolled. When the user scrolls down, the last visible item becomes the first visible item if there are enough items to fill the list. If not, the list is scrolled so that the last item of the list appears at the bottom of the list. The reverse is true for scrolling up. Scrolling doesn't change the current selection.

Bringing the pen down on a list item unhighlights the current selection and highlights the item under the pen. Dragging the pen through the list highlights the item under the pen. Dragging the pen above or below the list causes the list to scroll if it contains more choices than are visible.

When the pen is released over an item, that item becomes the current selection. When the pen is dragged outside the list, the item that was highlighted before the `penDownEvent` is highlighted again if it's visible. If it's not, no item is highlighted.

An application can use a list in two ways:

- Initialize a structure with all data for all entries in the list and let the list manage its own data.
- Provide list drawing functions but don't keep any data in memory. The list picks up the data as it's drawing.

  Not keeping data in memory avoids unacceptable memory overhead if the list is large and the contents of the list depends on choices made by the user. An example would be a time conversion application that provides a list of clock times for a number of cities based on a city the user selects. Note that only lists can pick up the display information on the fly like this; tables cannot.

Formatting can be an issue for lists: While it's possible to imitate a multi-column display, lists really consist of rows of text.

The `LstHandleEvent` function handles list events. Table 5.14 provides an overview of how `LstHandleEvent` deals with the different events.

Table 5.14 Event flow for lists

User Action	System Response	LstHandleEvent Response
Pen goes down on popup trigger button.	winEnterEvent identifying list's window.	Adds the lstEnterEvent to the event queue.
	lstEnterEvent with list's ID number and selected item.	Tracks the pen.
Pen goes down on a list box.	penDownEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Highlights the selection underneath the pen.
Pen is lifted from the list box.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds the lstSelectEvent to the event queue.
	lstSelectEvent with list's ID number and number of selected item.	Stores the new selection. If the list is associated with a popup trigger, adds a popSelectEvent to the event queue. with the popup trigger ID, the popup list ID, and the item number selected in EventType. Control passes to FrmHandleEvent.
Pen is lifted outside the list box.	penUpEvent with the x and y coordinates stored in EventType.	Adds winExitEvent to event queue.

Categories

Categories allow you to group records logically into manageable lists. In the user interface, categories typically appear in a popup list in a form's titlebar and in dialogs that allow you to edit a single database record.

You create a category popup list the same way you create any other popup list: create the list resource, create the popup trigger control resource with a width of 0, and set the trigger's list ID to be the ID of

the list. You manage the category popup list using the category API described in the chapter "Categories" on page 121 of the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

For the most part, you can handle a category popup list using only these calls:

- Call `CategoryInitialize` when you create a new database as described in "Initializing Categories in a Database" below).
- Call `CategorySetTriggerLabel` to set the category popup trigger's label when the form is opened (as described in "Initializing the Category Popup Trigger").
- Call `CategorySelect` when the user selects the category popup trigger (as described in "Managing a Category Popup List").

You typically don't need to use the other functions declared in `Category.h` unless you want more control over what happens when the user selects the category trigger.

This section focuses on the user interface aspects of categories. For information on how categories are stored and how to manage categories in a database, read Chapter 7, "Files and Databases."

Initializing Categories in a Database

Before you can use the category API calls, you must set up the database appropriately. The category functions expect to find information at a certain location. If the information is not there, the functions will fail.

Category information is stored in the `AppInfoType` structure within the database's application info block. As described in the chapter titled "Files and Databases" in this book, the application info block may contain any information that your database needs. If you want to use the category API, the first field in the application info block must be an `AppInfoType` structure.

The `AppInfoType` structure maps category names to category indexes and category unique IDs. Category names are displayed in the user interface. Category indexes are used to associate a database record with a category. That is, the database record's attribute word contains the index of the category to which the record belongs.

Category unique IDs are used when synchronizing the database with the desktop computer.

To initialize the `AppInfoType` structure, you call `CategoryInitialize`, passing a string list resource containing category names. This function creates as many category indexes and unique IDs as are necessary. You only need to make this call when the database is first created or when you newly assign the application info block to the database.

The string list resource is an `appInfoStringsRsc ('tAIS')` resource. It contains predefined categories that new users see when they start the application for the first time. Note that the call to `CategoryInitialize` is the only place where you use an `appInfoStringsRsc`. Follow these guidelines when creating the resource:

- Place any categories that you don't want the user to be able to change at the beginning of the list. For example, it's common to have at least one uneditable category named Unfiled, so it should be the first item in the list.
- The string list must have 16 entries. Typically, you don't want to predefine 16 categories. You might define one or two and leave the remaining entries blank. The unused slots should have 0 length.
- Keep in mind that there is a limit of 16 categories. That includes both the predefined categories and the categories your users will create.
- Each category name has a maximum length defined by the `dmCategoryLength` constant (currently, 16 bytes).
- Don't include strings for "All" or "Edit Categories." While these two items often appear in category lists, they are not categories, and they are treated differently by the category functions.

Listing 5.2 shows an example function that creates and initializes a database with an application info block. Notice that because the application info block is stored with the database, you allocate memory for it using `DmNewHandle`, not with `MemHandleNew`.

Listing 5.2 Creating a database with an app info block

```
typedef struct {
   AppInfoType appInfo;
   UInt16 myCustomAppInfo;
} MyAppInfoType;

Err CreateAndOpenDatabase(DmOpenRef *dbPP, UInt16 mode)
{
   Err error = errNone;
   DmOpenRef dbP;
   UInt16 cardNo;
   MemHandle h;
   LocalID dbID;
   LocalID appInfoID;
   MyAppInfoType *appInfoP;

   // Create the database.
   error = DmCreateDatabase (0, MyDBName, MyDBCreator, MyDBType,
      false);
   if (error) return error;

   // Open the database.
   dbP = DmOpenDatabaseByTypeCreator(MyDBType, MyDBCreator,
      mode);
   if (!dbP) return (dmErrCantOpen);

   // Get database local ID and card number. We need these to
   // initialize app info block.
   if (DmOpenDatabaseInfo(dbP, &dbID, NULL, NULL, &cardNo, NULL))
      return dmErrInvalidParam;

   // Allocate app info in storage heap.
   h = DmNewHandle(dbP, sizeof(MyAppInfoType));
   if (!h) return dmErrMemError;

   // Associate app info with database.
   appInfoID = MemHandleToLocalID (h);
   DmSetDatabaseInfo(cardNo, dbID, NULL, NULL, NULL, NULL, NULL,
      NULL, NULL, &appInfoID, NULL, NULL, NULL);

   // Initialize app info block to 0.
   appInfoP = MemHandleLock(h);
   DmSet(appInfoP, 0, sizeof(MyAppInfoType), 0);

   // Initialize the categories.
   CategoryInitialize ((AppInfoPtr) appInfoP,
```

```
      MyLocalizedAppInfoStr);

   // Unlock the app info block.
   MemPtrUnlock(appInfoP);

   // Set the output parameter and return.
   *dbPP = dbP;
   return error;
}
```

Initializing the Category Popup Trigger

When a form is opened, you need to set the text that the category popup trigger should display. To do this, use `CategoryGetName` to look up the name in the `AppInfoType` structure and then use `CategorySetTriggerLabel` to set the popup trigger.

For the main form of the application, it's common to store the index of the previously selected category in a preference and restore it when the application starts up again.

Forms that display information from a single record should show that record's category in the popup list. Each database record stores the index of its category in its attribute word. You can retrieve the record attribute using `DmRecordInfo` and then AND it with the mask `dmRecAttrCategoryMask` to obtain the category index.

Listing 5.3 shows how to set the trigger label to match the category for a particular database record.

Listing 5.3 Setting the category trigger label

```
UInt16 attr, category;
Char categoryName [dmCategoryLength];
ControlType *ctl;

// If current category is All, we need to look
// up category.
if (CurrentCategory == dmAllCategories) {
   DmRecordInfo (AddrDB, CurrentRecord, &attr,
      NULL, NULL);
   category = attr & dmRecAttrCategoryMask;
} else
   category = CurrentCategory;
```

```
CategoryGetName (AddrDB, category,
   categoryName);
ctl = FrmGetObjectPtr(frm,
   FrmGetObjectIndex(frm, objectID));
CategorySetTriggerLabel (ctl, categoryName);
```

Managing a Category Popup List

When the user taps the category popup trigger, call `CategorySelect`. That is, call `CategorySelect` in response to a `ctlSelectEvent` when the ID stored in the event matches the ID of the category's trigger. The `CategorySelect` function displays the popup list, manages the user selection, displays the Edit Categories modal dialog as necessary, and sets the popup trigger label to the item the user selected.

Calling CategorySelect

The following is a typical call to `CategorySelect`:

```
categoryEdited = CategorySelect (AddrDB, frm,
  ListCategoryTrigger, ListCategoryList, true,
  &category, CategoryName, 1,
  categoryDefaultEditCategoryString);
```

This example uses the following as parameters:

- `AddrDB` is the database with the categories to be displayed.
- `frm`, `ListCategoryTrigger`, and `ListCategoryList` identify the form, popup trigger resource, and list resource.
- `true` indicates that the list should contain an "All" item. The "All" item should appear only in forms that display multiple records. It should not appear in forms that display a single record because selecting it would have no meaning.
- `category` and `CategoryName` are pointers to the index and name of the currently selected category. When you call this function, these two parameters should specify the category currently displayed in the popup trigger. Unfiled is the default.
- The number 1 is the number of uneditable categories. `CategorySelect` needs this information when the user

chooses the Edit Categories list item. Categories that the user cannot edit should not appear in the Edit Categories dialog.

Because uneditable categories are assumed to be at the beginning of the category list, passing 1 for this parameter means that `CategorySelect` does not allow the user to edit the category at index 0.

- `categoryDefaultEditCategoryString` is a constant that means include an Edit Categories item in the list and use the default string for its name ("Edit Categories" on US English ROMs).

  To use a different name (for example, if you don't have enough room for the default name), pass the ID of a string resource containing the desired name.

  In some cases, you might not want to include the Edit Categories item. If so, pass the constant `categoryHideEditCategory`.

NOTE: The `categoryDefaultEditCategoryString` and `categoryHideEditCategory` constants are only defined if 3.5 New Feature Set is present. See the `CategorySelect` function description in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for further compatibility information.

Interpreting the Return Value

The `CategorySelect` return value is somewhat tricky: `CategorySelect` returns `true` if the user edited the category list, `false` otherwise. That is, if the user chose the Edit Categories item and added, deleted, or changed category names, the function returns `true`. If the user never selects Edit Categories, the function returns `false`. In most cases, a user simply selects a different category from the existing list without editing categories. In such cases, `CategorySelect` returns `false`.

This means you should not rely solely on the return value to see if you need to take action. Instead, you should store the value that you passed for the category index and compare it to the index that `CategorySelect` passes back. For example:

```
Int16 category;
Boolean categoryEdited;

category = CurrentCategory;

categoryEdited = CategorySelect (AddrDB, frm,
  ListCategoryTrigger, ListCategoryList, true,
  &category, CategoryName, 1,
  categoryDefaultEditCategoryString);

if ( categoryEdited ||
    (category != CurrentCategory)) {
  /* user changed category selection or
    edited category list. Do something. */
}
```

If the user has selected a different category, you probably want to do one of two things:

- Update the display so that only records in that category are displayed. See the function `ListViewUpdateRecords` in the Address Book example application for sample code.
- Change the current record's category from the previous category to the newly selected category. See the function `EditViewSelectCategory` in the Address Book example application for sample code.

Note that the `CategorySelect` function handles the results of the Edit Categories dialog for you. It adds, deletes, and renames items in the database's `AppInfoType` structure. If the user deletes a category that contains records, it moves those records to the Unfiled category. If the user changes the name of an existing category to the name of another existing category, it prompts the user and, if confirmed, moves the records from the old category to the new category. Therefore, you never have to worry about managing the category list after a call to `CategorySelect`.

The Default Application Category

You can store an application's category in a `'taic'` resource (symbolically named `defaultCategoryRscType`) with the ID 1000 in the `.prc` file. Starting in Palm OS 3.5, the Launcher

application installs your application into the specified category. In Constructor, you can specify the `'taic'` resource by providing a value for the Default App Category field in the main window.

Most applications should **not** specify a `'taic'` resource. By default, Launcher installs applications in the Unfiled category, and each user chooses where to file the application.

Only specify a `'taic'` resource in these instances:

- Your application is intended for consumers and clearly belongs to one of the Launcher predefined categories (see Table 5.15).

  Always specify the Launcher predefined categories in US English in ASCII characters. Launcher provides the appropriate translations for localized ROMs.

- Your application is intended for a vertical market or you've created a suite of custom applications that work together to provide a complete custom solution.

  In this case, you might define a `'taic'` resource with a custom category name. Launcher creates the category if it doesn't already exist in the Launcher database. When you're not identifying one of Launcher's predefined categories, you may identify the category in any language.

Table 5.15 Launcher predefined categories

Default Launcher Category	Description
Games	Any game.
Main	Applications that would be used on a daily basis, such as Date Book or Address Book.
System	Applications that control how the system behaves, such as the Preferences, HotSync, and Security.
Utilities	Applications that help the user with system management.
Unfiled	The default category.

Do not treat the default application category as something analogous to the Microsoft Windows Start menu category. On a Palm OS device, the user is limited to 16 categories including Unfiled. Obviously, that limit would be quickly reached if each application defines its own category. Only assign a default category where it is a clear benefit to your users.

Bitmaps

A bitmap is a graphic displayed by Palm OS. There are several ways to create a bitmap resource in Constructor:

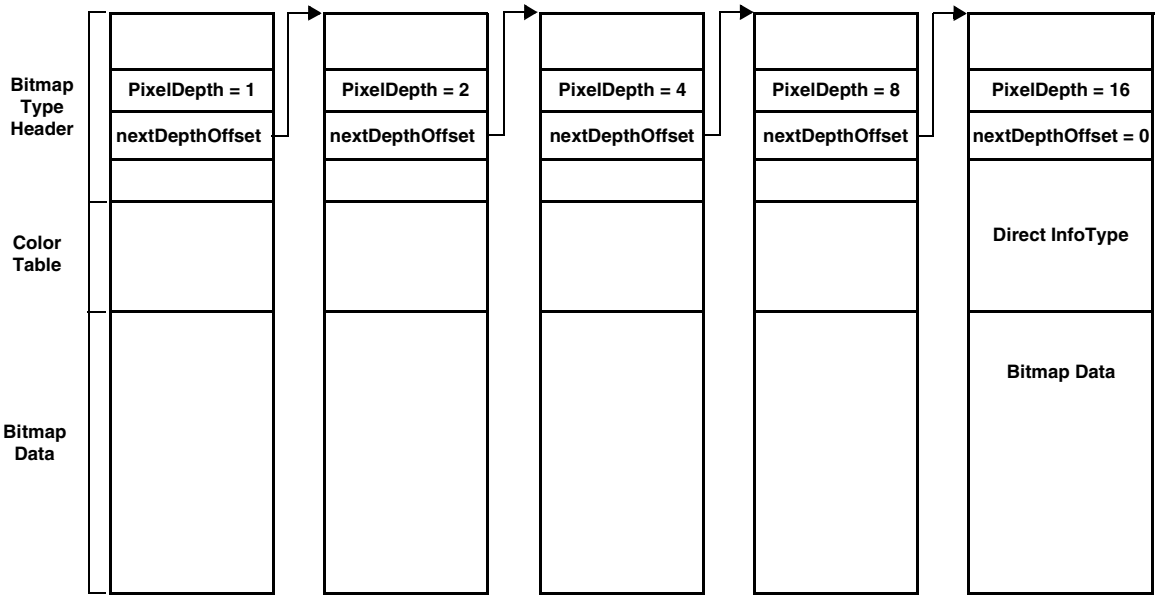
- If you simply want to display a bitmap at a fixed location on a form, drag a Form Bitmap object to the form. Assign a resource ID in the Bitmap ID field, and you can then create a bitmap resource. The bitmap resource is a `'Tbmp'` resource, and the Form Bitmap object that contains it is a `'tFBM'` resource.
- If you want to create a bitmap for some other purpose (for example, to use in animation or to display a gadget), create either a Bitmap resource or a Bitmap Family resource in the main project window. In this case, Constructor creates a `'tbmf'` resource, and the PalmRez post linker converts it and its associated PICTs to a `'Tbmp'` resource. (Constructor creates PICT format images on both the Macintosh and Microsoft Windows operating systems.)

A `'Tbmp'` resource defines either a single bitmap or a bitmap family. A **bitmap family** is a group of bitmaps, each containing the same drawing but at a different pixel depth (see Figure 5.14). When requested to draw a bitmap family, the operating system chooses the version of the bitmap with the pixel depth equal to the display. If such a bitmap doesn't exist, the bitmap with the pixel depth closest to but less than the display depth is chosen. If there are no bitmaps less than the display depth, then the bitmap with the pixel depth closest to the display depth is used.

Programmatically, a bitmap or bitmap family is represented by a `BitmapType` structure. This structure is simply a header. It is followed by the bitmap data in the same memory block. Bitmaps in Palm OS 3.0 and higher are also allowed to have their own color

tables. When a bitmap has its own color table, it is stored between the bitmap header and the bitmap data.

Figure 5.14 Bitmap family



Versions of Bitmap Support

There are three different bitmap encodings:

- Version 0 encoding is supported by all Palm OS releases.
- Version 1 encoding is supported on Palm OS 3.0 and higher. PalmRez creates version 1 bitmaps unless you've explicitly specified a transparency index or a compression type when creating the bitmap in Constructor.
- Version 2 encoding is supported on Palm OS 3.5 and higher. This encoding supports transparency indices and RLE compression.

  With a version 2 bitmap, you can specify one index value as a transparent color at creation time. The transparency index is an alternative to masking. The system does not draw bits that have the transparency index value.

When a bitmap with a transparency index is rendered at a depth other than the one at which it was created, the transparent color is first translated to the corresponding depth color, and the resulting color is named transparent. This may result in a group of colors becoming transparent.

Drawing a Bitmap

If you use a Form Bitmap object, your bitmap is drawn when the form is drawn. No extra coding is required on your part.

If you're not using a Form Bitmap object, to draw the bitmap you obtain it from the resource database and then call either `WinDrawBitmap` or `WinPaintBitmap`. (The form manager code uses `WinDrawBitmap` to draw Form Bitmap objects.) If passed a bitmap family, these two functions draw the bitmap that has the depth equal to the current draw window depth or the closest depth that is less than the current draw window depth if available, or the closest depth greater than the current draw depth if not.

```
MemHandle resH =
  DmGetResource (bitmapRsc, rscID);
BitmapType *bitmap = MemHandleLock (resH);
WinPaintBitmap(bitmap, 0, 0);
```

If you want to modify a bitmap, starting in Palm OS 3.5 you can create the bitmap programmatically with `BmpCreate`, create an offscreen window wrapper around the bitmap using `WinCreateBitmapWindow`, set the active window to the new bitmap window, and use the window drawing functions to draw to the bitmap:

```
BitmapType *bmpP;
WinHandle win;
Err error;

bmpP = BmpCreate(10, 10, 8, NULL, &error);
if (bmpP) {
  win = WinCreateBitmapWindow(bmpP, &error);
  if (win) {
    WinSetDrawWindow(win);
```

```
        WinDrawLines(win, ...);
        /* etc */
    }
}
```

`BmpCreate` always creates a version 2 bitmap, even if you don't specify a transparency or compression.

To learn how to modify a bitmap in releases prior to Palm OS 3.5, download the Signatures example application from the Knowledge Base on the Palm OS Developer website.

Color Tables and Bitmaps

As mentioned previously, bitmaps can have their own color tables attached to them. A bitmap might have a custom color table if it requires a palette that differs from the default system palettes. If a bitmap has its own color table, the system must create a conversion table to convert the color table of the current draw window before it can draw the bitmap. This conversion is a drain on performance, so using custom color tables with bitmaps is not recommended if performance is critical.

As an alternative, if your bitmap needs a custom palette, use the `WinPalette` function to change the system palette that is currently in use, then draw your bitmap. After the bitmap is no longer visible, use `WinPalette` again to set the system palette back to its previous state.

Labels

You can create a label in a form by creating a label resource.

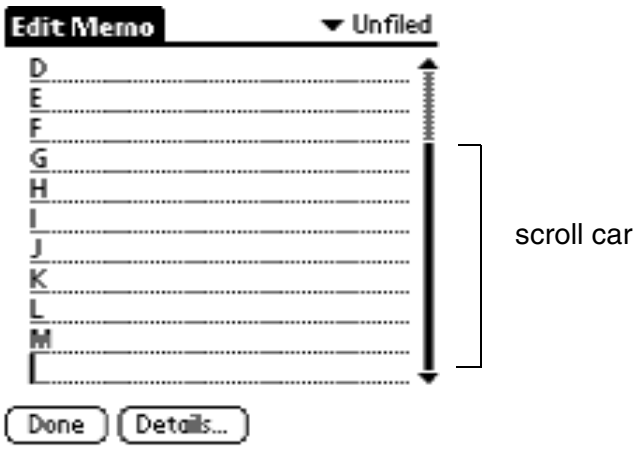
The label resource displays noneditable text or labels on a form (dialog box or full-screen). It's used, for example, to have text appear to the left of a checkbox instead of the right.

You don't interact with a label as a programmatic entity; however, you can use Form and Control API to create new labels or to change labels dynamically. See the "Summary of User Interface API" at the end of this chapter.

Scroll Bars

Palm OS 2.0 and later provides vertical scroll bar support. As a result, you can attach scroll bars to fields, tables, or lists, and the system sends the appropriate events when the end user interacts with the scroll bar (see Figure 5.15).

Figure 5.15 Scroll bar



Here's what you have to do to include a scroll bar in your user interface:

1. **Create a scroll bar (tSCL) UI resource.**

   Provide the ID and the bounds for the scroll bar rectangle. The height has to match the object you want to attach it to. The width should be 7.

2. **Provide a minimum and maximum value as well as a page size.**

   - Minimum is usually 0.
   - Maximum is usually 0 and set programmatically.
   - The page size determines how many lines the scroll bar moves when the text scrolls.

3. **Make the scroll bar part of the form.**

   When you compile your application, the system creates the appropriate scroll bar UI object. (See the chapter "Scroll Bars" in the

Palm OS Programmer's API Reference for more information on the scroll bar UI object.)

There are two ways in which the scroll bar and the user interface object that it's attached to need to interact:

- When the user adds or removes text, the scroll bar needs to know about the change in size.

  To get this functionality, set the `hasScrollbar` attribute of the field, table, or list. (For tables, you must set this programmatically with the function `TblHasScrollBar`.)

  If `hasScrollbar` is set for a field, you'll receive a `fldChangedEvent` whenever the field's size changes. Your application should handle these events by computing new values for the scroll bar's minimum, maximum, and current position and then use `SclSetScrollBar` to update it.

  If `hasScrollbar` is set for a table, you should keep track of when the table's size changes. Whenever it does, you should compute new values for the scroll bar's minimum, maximum, and current position and then use `SclSetScrollBar` to update it.

  Lists are intended for static data, so you typically don't have to worry about the size of a list changing.

  You should also call `SclSetScrollBar` when the form is initialized to set the current position of the scroll bar.

- When the user moves the scroll bar, the text needs to move accordingly. This can either happen dynamically (as the user moves the scroll bar) or statically (after the user has released the scroll bar).

  The system sends the following scroll bar events:

  – `sclEnterEvent` is sent when a `penDownEvent` occurs within the bounds of the scroll bar.

  – `sclRepeatEvent` is sent when the user drags the scroll bar.

– sclExitEvent is sent when the user lifts the pen. This event is sent regardless of previous sclRepeatEvents.

Applications that want to support immediate-mode scrolling (that is, scrolling happens as the user drags the pen) need to watch for occurrences of sclRepeatEvent. In response to this event, call the scrolling function associated with the UI object (FldScrollField, LstScrollList, or your own scrolling function in the case of tables).

Applications that don't support immediate-mode scrolling should ignore occurrences of sclRepeatEvent and wait only for the sclExitEvent.

Custom UI Objects

A gadget resource lets you implement a custom UI object. The gadget resource contains basic information about the custom gadget, which is useful to the gadget writer for drawing and processing user input.

You interact with gadgets programmatically using the Form API. See the "Summary of User Interface API" at the end of this chapter.

A gadget is best thought of as simply a reserved rectangle at a set location on the form. You must provide all drawing and event handling code. There is no default behavior for a gadget.

Starting in Palm OS 3.5, you can create an extended gadget. An extended gadget is simply a gadget with a callback routine (FormGadgetHandler) that provides drawing and event handling code for the gadget. Use FrmSetGadgetHandler to set the callback function. (A pointer to the gadget is passed to the callback, so you can use the same function for multiple gadgets.) When the form receives certain requests to draw itself, delete itself, or to hide or show a gadget object, the form manager calls the gadget handler function you provide. When the form receives events intended for the gadget, it passes those to the gadget handler function as well.

In versions prior to 3.5, gadgets do not have a callback function. Instead, you must write code to draw the gadget and respond to pen down events in the form's event handler. Listing 5.4 shows the event handler for the main form in the Rock Music sample

application. This code makes calls to draw the gadget in response to a `frmOpenEvent` or `frmUpdateEvent`, and if there is a `penDownEvent` within the bounds of the gadget, it calls a function to handle that event as well. Listing 5.5 shows how a gadget handler function might be written for Rock Music.

Listing 5.4 Pre-Palm OS 3.5 gadget example

```
Boolean MainViewHandleEvent(EventPtr event)
{
   Boolean handled = false;
   Word objIndex;
   FormPtr frm;
   RectangleType r;

   switch (event->eType) {
      case frmOpenEvent:
         MainViewInit();
         frm = FrmGetActiveForm ();
         FrmDrawForm (frm);
         DrawGadget();
         handled = true;
         break;

      case frmUpdateEvent:
         frm = FrmGetActiveForm ();
         FrmDrawForm (frm);
         DrawGadget();
         handled = true;
         break;

      case penDownEvent:
         frm = FrmGetActiveForm ();
         objIndex = FrmGetObjectIndex (frm,
            RockMusicMainInputGadget);
         FrmGetObjectBounds (frm, objIndex, &r);
         if (RctPtInRectangle (event->screenX,
            event->screenY, &r)) {
            GadgetTapped ();
            handled=true;
         }
         break;
      ...
   }
```

Listing 5.5 Palm OS 3.5 gadget example

```
Boolean GadgetHandler (struct FormGadgetType *gadgetP,
UInt16 cmd, void *paramP)
{
   Boolean handled = false;

   switch (cmd) {
      case formGadgetDrawCmd:
      //Sent to active gadgets any time form is
      //drawn or redrawn.
         DrawGadget();
         gadgetP->attr.visible = true;
         handled = true;
         break;

      case formGadgetHandleEventCmd:
      //Sent when form receives a gadget event.
      //paramP points to EventType structure.
         if (paramP->eType == frmGadgetEnterEvent) {
         // penDown in gadget's bounds.
            GadgetTapped ();
            handled = true;
         }
         if (paramP->eType == frmGadgetMiscEvent) {
            //This event is sent by your application
            //when it needs to send info to the gadget
         }
         break;
      case formGadgetDeleteCmd:
         //Perform any cleanup prior to deletion.
         break;
      case formGadgetEraseCmd:
      //FrmHideObject takes care of this if you
      //return false.
         handled = false;
         break;
   }
   return handled;
}
```

Dynamic UI

Palm OS 3.0 and later provides functions that can be used to create forms and form elements at runtime. Most applications will never

need to change any user interface elements at runtime—the built-in applications don't do so, and the Palm user interface guidelines discourage it. The preferred method of having UI objects appear as needed is to create the objects in Constructor and set their usable attributes to false. Then use `FrmShowObject` and `FrmHideObject` to make the object appear and disappear as needed.

Some applications, such as forms packages, must create their displays at runtime—it is for applications such as these that the Dynamic UI API is provided. If you're not absolutely sure that you need to change your UI dynamically, don't do it—unexpected changes to an application's interface are likely to confuse or frustrate the end user.

Dynamic user interface objects are subject to the following limitations:

- You cannot create tables or Graffiti Shift indicators.
- You cannot create buttons (or repeating buttons) having frames or non-bold frames.

You can use the `FrmNewForm` function to create new forms dynamically. Palm's UI guidelines encourage you to keep popup dialogs at the bottom of the screen, using the entire screen width. This isn't enforced by the routine, but is strongly encouraged in order to maintain a look and feel that is consistent with the built-in applications.

The `FrmNewLabel`, `FrmNewBitmap`, `FrmNewGadget`, `LstNewList`, `FldNewField` and `CtlNewControl` functions can be used to create new objects on forms.

It is fine to add new items to an active form, but doing so is very likely to move the form structure in memory; therefore, any pointers to the form or to controls on the form might change. Make sure to update any variables or pointers that you are using so that they refer to the form's new memory location, which is returned when you create the object.

The `FrmRemoveObject` function removes an object from a form. This function doesn't free memory referenced by the object (if any) but it does shrink the form chunk. For best efficiency when removing items from forms, remove items in order of decreasing index values, beginning with the item having the highest index

value. When removing items from a form, you need to be mindful of the same concerns as when adding items: the form pointer and pointers to controls on the form may change as a result of any call that moves the form structure in memory.

When creating forms dynamically, or just to make your application more robust, use the FrmValidatePtr function to ensure that your form pointer is valid and the form it points to is valid. This routine can catch lots of bugs for you—use it!

Dynamic User Interface Functions

The following API can be used to create forms dynamically:

- CtlNewControl
- CtlValidatePointer
- FldNewField
- FrmNewBitmap
- FrmNewForm
- FrmNewGadget
- FrmNewLabel
- FrmRemoveObject
- FrmValidatePtr
- LstNewList
- WinValidateHandle
- FrmNewGsi (available only if 3.5 New Feature Set is present)

Color and Grayscale Support

Starting in Palm OS version 3.5, the operating system supports system palettes of 1, 2, 4, or 8 bits-per-pixel, as follows:

- 1-bit: white (0) and black (1)
- 2-bit: white (0), light gray (1), dark gray (2), and black (3)
- 4-bit: 16 shades of gray, from white (0) to black (0xF)
- 8-bit: 216 color "Web-safe" palette, which includes all combinations of red, green, and blue at these levels: 0x00, 0x33, 0x66, 0x99, 0xCC, and 0xFF. Also, it includes all 16 gray

shades at these levels: 0x00, 0x11, 0x22, ... 0xFF. Finally, it includes these extra named HTML colors: 0xC0C0C0 (silver), 0x808080 (gray), 0x800000 (maroon), 0x800080 (purple), 0x008000 (green), and 0x008080 (teal). The remaining 24 entries (indexes 0xE7 through 0xFE) are unspecified and filled with black. These entries may be defined by an application.

Generalized support for color tables in all bit depths is included, with performance degrading if the color tables are not standard.

Starting in Palm OS version 4.0, the operating system supports 16-bit color. However, support is not provided to allow the UI layer of the OS to utilize 16-bit color mode. Buttons, controls, and other gadgets continue to be displayed with a color bit depth of no more than 8-bits.

Indexed Versus Direct Color Display

Displays that support 1, 2, 4, or 8 bits per pixel rely on a color lookup table in the display hardware in order to map pixel values into colors. The only colors that can be displayed on the screen at any given time are those that are found in the display's color lookup table.

Direct color displays on the other hand, do not rely on a color lookup table because the value stored into each pixel location specifies the amount of red, green, and blue components directly. For example, a 16-bit direct color display could have 5 bits of each pixel assigned as the red component, 6 bits as the green component, and 5 bits as the blue component. With this type of display, the application is no longer limited to drawing with a color that is in the color lookup table.

The color indexed mode for setting the foreground, background, and text colors used previous to Palm OS release 4.0 continues to work even with direct color displays because the system uses a translation table for mapping color index values into direct colors.

When the screen is a direct color display, the color lookup table for the screen is present only for compatibility with the indexed mode color calls. The lookup table has no effect on the display hardware, since the hardware derives the color from the red, green, and blue bits stored in each pixel location of the frame buffer.

Color Table

The system color table is stored in a `'tclt'` resource (symbolically named `colorTableRsc`). The color table is a count of the number of entries, followed by an array of `RGBColorType` colors. An `RGBColorType` struct holds 8 bits each of red, green, and blue plus an "extra" byte to hold an index value.

A color's index is used in different ways by different software layers. When querying for a color or doing color fitting, the index holds the index of the closest match to the RGB value in the reference color table. When setting a color in a color table, the index can specify which slot the color should occupy. In some routines, the index is ignored.

Generally, the drawing routines and the operating system use indexed colors rather than RGB. Indexed colors are used for performance reasons; it allows the RGB-to-index translation to be skipped for most drawing operations.

Care should be taken not to confuse a full color table (which includes the count) with an array of RGB color values. Some routines operate on entire color tables, others operate on lists of color entries.

Color Translation Table

When rendering requires a translation from one depth to another, a color translation table is used. For example, suppose you are trying to display an 8-bit color bitmap image on a 2-bit display. Palm OS must translate the color bitmap to a grayscale bitmap in order to display it. To do so, it creates the translation table by stepping through each element of the source color table (the 8-bit bitmap) and finding the best fit for the RGB value in the destination color table (which has exactly 4 values). This table is generated once and is reused for all drawing operations until it is no longer valid.

Palm OS uses one of two algorithms to build the translation table:

- Luminosity fitting if the destination color table is grayscale.
- Shortest distance in the RGB space if the destination color table is color.

Although shortest distance RGB fitting does not always produce the best perceptual match, it is fast, and it works well for the available palettes on Palm OS.

Color Table Management

If you want to change the color table used by the current draw window, you can do so with the `WinPalette` function. If the current draw window is onscreen, the palette for the display hardware is also changed. For more information see the `WinPalette` function description in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

If your application needs to know which RGB color corresponds to which index color in the current palette, it can do so with the function calls `WinRGBToIndex` and `WinIndexToRGB`. When calling `WinRGBToIndex`, an exact match may not be available. That is, you may be calling `WinRGBToIndex` with an RGB value that is not in the palette and thus does not have an index. If there is no exact RGB match, the best-fit algorithm currently in place is used to determine the index value. For `WinIndexToRGB`, the RGB value returned is always the exact match. (An error is displayed on debug ROMs if the index is out of range.)

UI Color List

The system builds a UI color list in addition to the system color table. The UI color list contains the colors used by the various user interface elements. Each UI color is represented by a symbolic color constant. See Table 5.16 for a list of colors used.

Each bit depth has its own list of UI colors, allowing for a different color scheme in monochrome, grayscale, and color modes. This is important because even with a default monochrome look and feel, highlighted field text is black-on-yellow in color and white-on-black in other modes.

To obtain the color list, the system first tries to load it from the synchronized preferences database using the value `sysResIDPrefUIColorTableBase` plus the current screen depth. The use of a preference allows for the possibility that individual users could customize the look using a third party "personality" or "themes" editor. If the preference is not defined, it

loads the default color table from the system color table resource plus the current screen depth.

Using a list allows easy variation of the colors of UI elements to either personalize the overall color scheme of a given Palm device or to adjust it within an application. Defining these as color classes ensures that the user interface elements are consistent with each other.

Table 5.16 UI objects and colors

UI Object	Symbolic Colors Used
Forms	`UIFormFrame`, `UIFormFill`
Modal dialogs	`UIDialogFrame`, `UIDialogFill`
Alert dialogs	`UIAlertFrame`, `UIAlertFill`
Buttons (push button, repeating button, check boxes, and selector triggers)	`UIObjectFrame`, `UIObjectFill`, `UIObjectForeground`, `UIObjectSelectedFill`, `UIObjectSelectedForeground`
Fields	`UIFieldBackground`, `UIFieldText`, `UIFieldTextLines`, `UIFieldTextHighlightBackground`, `UIFieldTextHighlightForeground`
Menus	`UIMenuFrame`, `UIMenuFill`, `UIMenuForeground`, `UIMenuSelectedFill`, `UIMenuSelectedForeground`
Tables	Uses `UIFieldBackground` for the background, other colors controlled by the object in the table cell.
Lists and popup triggers	`UIObjectFrame`, `UIObjectFill`, `UIObjectForeground`, `UIObjectSelectedFill`, `UIObjectSelectedForeground`

Table 5.16 UI objects and colors *(continued)*

UI Object	Symbolic Colors Used
Labels	Labels on a control and noneditable fields use `UIObjectForeground`, and text written to a form using `WinDrawChars` or `WinPaintChars` use the current text setting in the draw state.
Scroll bars	`UIObjectFill`, `UIObjectForeground`, `UIObjectSelectedFill`, `UIObjectSelectedForeground`
Insertion point	`UIFieldCaret`
Front-end processor (currently only used on Japanese systems)	`UIFieldFepRawText`, `UIFieldFepRawBackground`, `UIFieldFepConvertedText`, `UIFieldFepConvertedBackground`, `UIFieldFepUnderline`

Should your application need to change the colors used by the UI color list, it can do so with `UIColorSetTableEntry`. If you need to retrieve a color used, it can do so with `UIColorGetTableEntryIndex` or `UIColorGetTableEntryRGB`.

If you change the UI color list, your changes are in effect only while your application is active. The UI color list is reset as soon as control switches to another application. When control switches back to your application, you'll have to call `UIColorSetTableEntry` again.

Direct Color Functions

The direct color function calls are more generic than their indexed forms and can be used with both indexed (1, 2, 4, or 8 bit) or direct 16-bit color displays. The system automatically looks up the color index value of the closest color if necessary.

The direct color functions are: WinSetForeColorRGB, WinSetBackColorRGB, WinSetTextColorRGB, and WinGetPixelRGB

Because these calls are only available on systems with the direct color enhancements present, applications should generally stick to using the indexed form of these calls: WinSetForeColor, WinSetBackColor, WinSetTextColor, and WinGetPixel unless they need finer control over the choice and dynamic range of colors.

Pixel Reading and Writing

The Palm OS 3.5 API call for reading a pixel value, WinGetPixel, is designed to return a color index value. When this call is performed on a direct color display, it must first get the actual pixel value (a 16 or 24 bit direct color value). The system then looks up the closest color from the system's virtual 8-bit color lookup table, and returns the index of the closest color from that table. This mode of operation ensures compatibility for applications that take the return value from `WinGetPixel` and use it as an indexed color to WinSetForeColor, WinSetBackColor, and WinSetTextColor.

Applications that need to copy pixels exactly from one location to another on direct color displays should use WinGetPixelRGB instead of WinGetPixel. If you use WinGetPixel on a direct color display, it can result in a loss of color because of the closest-match color table lookup operation that WinGetPixel performs.

WinGetPixelRGB returns the pixel as an RGBColorType with a full 8 bits each of red, green, and blue, assuring no loss of color resolution. This call is more generic than the WinGetPixel call and can be used with both indexed (1, 2, 4, or 8 bit) or direct color modes. The system automatically looks up the RGB components of indexed color pixels as necessary.

The pixel setting API calls (WinPaintPixel, WinDrawPixel, and so on) all rely on using the current foreground and background colors and do not require new forms for the direct color mode. An application can simply pass in the return RGBColorType from WinGetPixelRGB to WinSetForeColorRGB and then call WinDrawPixel in order to copy a direct color pixel.

Direct Color Bitmaps

In Palm OS release 4.0 the Window manager supports16 bits per pixel direct color bitmaps, as well as the previously supported 1, 2, 4, and 8 bit indexed color bitmaps. A direct color bitmap is indicated by the new `directColor` bit in the `BitmapFlagsType` bit-field of the `BitmapType` data structure. In addition to this flag, a direct color bitmap must also include the `BitmapDirectInfoType` fields: `redBits`, `greenBits`, `blueBits`, `reserved`, and `transparentColor`.

The `redBits`, `greenBits`, and `blueBits` fields indicate the number of bits in each pixel for each color component. The current implementation only supports 16 bits per pixel, with 5 bits of red, 6 bits of green, and 5 bits of blue:

```
R R R R  R G G G  G G G B  B B B B
MSB                           LSB
```

The `transparentColor` field contains the red, green, and blue components of the transparent color of the bitmap. For direct color bitmaps, this field is used instead of the `transparentIndex` field to designate the transparent color value of the bitmap, because the `transparentIndex` field is only 8 bits wide and can only represent an indexed color. The `transparentColor` field, like the `transparentIndex` field, is ignored unless the `hasTransparency` bit is set in the bitmap's flags field.

With Palm OS 4.0, a 16-bit direct color bitmap can always be rendered, regardless of the actual screen depth. The 16-bit color functions automatically perform the necessary bit depth conversion to render the bitmap into whatever depth the destination is in.

Bitmap resources can be built to contain multiple depth images in the same bitmap resource, one image for each possible depth. A potential incompatibility could arise if an application includes only a direct color version of a bitmap. Therefore, applications need to either check that version 4.0 of Palm OS is present before drawing a direct color bitmap, or they must always include a 1, 2, 4, or 8 bit per pixel image of the bitmap in the bitmap resource along with the direct color version.

Special Drawing Modes

The special drawing modes of `winErase`, `winMask`, `winInvert`, and `winOverlay` introduce a complication when it comes to direct color models. These drawing modes were originally designed for use with monochrome bitmaps where black is designated by 1 bits and white is designated by 0 bits. With these color assignments, these various modes can be described as:

- `WinErase` becomes an AND operation (black pixels in the source leave the destination alone whereas white pixels in the source make the destination white).
- `WinMask` becomes an AND NOT operation (black pixels in the source make the destination white whereas white pixels leave the destination alone)
- `WinInvert` becomes an XOR operation (black pixels in the source invert the destination whereas white pixels leave the destination alone)
- `WinOverlay` becomes an OR operation (black pixels in the source make the destination black, white pixels in the source leave the destination alone)

In a direct color bitmap, black is designated by all 0s and white is designated by all 1s. Because of this, if all the drawing modes were implemented as logical operations in the same way as they are for indexed color modes, the desired effect would not be achieved.

The assumption made by direct color functions is that the desired effect is more important to the caller than the actual logical operation that is performed. Thus, the various drawing modes, when drawing to a direct color bitmap, become:

- `WinErase` becomes an OR operation (black pixels in the source leave the destination alone whereas white pixels in the source make the destination white).
- `WinMask` becomes an OR NOT operation (black pixels in the source make the destination white whereas white pixels leave the destination alone)
- `WinInvert` becomes an XOR NOT operation (black pixels in the source invert the destination whereas white pixels leave the destination alone)

- `WinOverlay` becomes an AND operation (black pixels in the source make the destination black, white pixels in the source leave the destination alone)

As long as the source and destination bitmaps contain only black and white colors, the new interpretations of the drawing modes in direct color modes produce the same effects as they would have with an indexed color mode.

With non-black and white pixels however, an application may get unexpected results from these drawing modes if they assume that the direct color function calls perform the same logical operation in direct color mode as they do in indexed color mode.

Insertion Point

The insertion point is a blinking indicator that shows where text is inserted when users write Graffiti characters or paste clipboard text.

In general, an application doesn't need to be concerned with the insertion point; the Palm OS UI manages the insertion point.

Text

This section describes how to work with text in the user interface—whether it's text the user has entered or text that your application has created to display on the screen.

NOTE: If you application is going to be localized, you must take special care when working with text. See the chapter "Localized Applications" for more information.

Working With Text As Strings

The string manager provides a set of string manipulation functions. The string manager API is closely modeled after the standard C string-manipulation functions like `strcpy`, `strcat`, etc.

Applications should use the functions built into the string manager instead of the standard C functions because doing so makes the application smaller:

- When your application uses the string manager functions, the actual code that implements the function is not linked into your application but is already part of the operating system.
- When you use the standard C functions, the code for each function you use is linked into your application and results in a bigger executable.

In addition, many standard C functions don't work on the Palm OS device at all because the OS doesn't provide all basic system functions (such as `malloc`) and doesn't support the subroutine calls used by most standard C functions.

NOTE: If your application is going to be localized, be careful when using string functions. Where possible, use the functions described in the chapter "Localized Applications" instead.

Using the StrVPrintF Function

Like the C `vsprintf` function, the `StrVPrintF` function is designed to be called by your own function that takes a variable number of arguments and passes them to `StrVPrintF` for formatting. This section gives a brief overview of how to use `StrVPrintF`. For more details, refer to `vsprintf` and the use of the `stdarg.h` macros in a standard C reference book.

When you call `StrVPrintF`, you must use the special macros from `stdarg.h` to access the optional arguments (those specified after the fixed arguments) passed to your function. This is necessary, because when you declare your function that takes an optional number of arguments, you declare it using an ellipsis at the end of the argument list:

```
MyPrintF(CharPtr s, CharPtr formatStr, ...);
```

The ellipsis indicates that zero or more optional arguments may be passed to the function following the `formatStr` argument. Since these optional arguments don't have names, the `stdarg.h` macros must be used to access them before they can be passed to `StrVPrintF`.

To use these macros in your function, first declare an `args` variable as type `va_list`:

```
va_list args;
```

Next, initialize the `args` variable to point to the optional argument list by using `va_start`:

```
va_start(args, formatStr);
```

Note that the second argument to the `va_start` macro is the last required argument to your function (last before the optional arguments begin). Now you can pass the `args` variable as the last parameter to the `StrVPrintF` function:

```
StrVPrintF(text, formatStr, args);
```

When you are finished, invoke the macro `va_end` before returning from your function:

```
va_end(args);
```

Note that the `StrPrintF` and `StrVPrintF` functions implement only a subset of the conversion specifications allowed by the ANSI C function `vsprintf`. See the `StrVPrintF` function reference for details.

Fonts in Palm OS 3.0 and Later

Palm OS 3.0 and later provides a new font (`largeBoldFont`), two new font manipulation routines (`FontSelect` and `FntDefineFont`), and support for the use of custom fonts.

To use the large, bold font, pass the `largeBoldFont` selector to the `FntSetFont` function. Under Palm OS 3.0 and later, if you try to draw with a font that isn't installed, the system uses the standard font by default. Previous versions of Palm OS can crash if told to use a nonexistent font.

The `FontSelect` function displays a dialog box in which the user can specify the use of one of the three primary fonts `stdFont`, `boldFont`, or `largeBoldFont`. For more information, see the description of `FontSelect` in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

The FntDefineFont function makes a custom font available to your application. For more information, see the description of FntDefineFont in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

Currently, Palm has not made available any tools or specifications to convert desktop fonts for use on Palm OS 3.0 or later. If you have an urgent need for such support, send email to devsupp@palm.com for updated information.

Receiving User Input

The five ways that a user interacts with an application are:

- by entering Graffiti
- by pressing a hardware button on the device
- by tapping the pen on a control in a form or dialog
- by tapping on an onscreen keyboard in the keyboard dialog.
- by tapping in the menu bar or in a particular menu.

For the first three types of input, the Palm OS provides a dedicated manager: The Graffiti Manager, The Key Manager, and The Pen Manager, respectively. Most applications do not need to access these managers directly; instead, applications receive events from these managers and respond to the events. There are cases, however, where you might need to interact with one of these managers. The following pages describe each of these managers and when you might need to use them. To learn how to obtain user input from a UI object, refer to the section in this chapter that covers that object.

The keyboard dialog allows users to input characters into a text field by tapping an onscreen keyboard. When the keyboard dialog is closed, the amended text is automatically displayed in the original field. As with the three managers just mentioned, you will probably not need to access the keyboard dialog directly. The user can open the keyboard from any text field. In certain limited circumstances, however, you may wish to display the keyboard dialog programmatically. For more information, see "The Keyboard Dialog" on page 144.

The Menu Manager handles taps that display a menu and those that select an item from a menu. For details, see "Menus" on page 101.

The Graffiti Manager

The Graffiti manager provides an API to the Palm OS Graffiti recognizer. The recognizer converts pen strokes into key events, which are then fed to an application through the event manager.

Most applications never need to call the Graffiti manager directly because it's automatically called by the event manager whenever it detects pen strokes in the Graffiti area of the digitizer.

Special-purpose applications, such as a Graffiti tutorial, may want to call the Graffiti manager directly to recognize strokes in other areas of the screen or to customize the Graffiti behavior.

Using GrfProcessStroke

`GrfProcessStroke` is a high-level Graffiti manager call used by the event manager for converting pen strokes into key events. The call

- Removes pen points from the pen queue
- Recognizes the stroke
- Puts one or more key events into the key queue

`GrfProcessStroke` automatically handles Graffiti ShortCuts and calls the user interface as appropriate to display shift indicators in the current window.

An application can call `GrfProcessStroke` when it receives a `penUpEvent` from the event manager if it wants to recognize strokes entered into its application area (in addition to the Graffiti area).

Using Other High-Level Graffiti Manager Calls

Other high-level calls provided by the Graffiti manager include routines for

- Getting and setting the current Graffiti shift state (caps lock on/off, temporary shift state, etc.)
- Notifying Graffiti when the user selects a different field. Graffiti needs to be notified when a field change occurs so that it can cancel out of any partially entered shortcut and clear its temporary shift state if it's showing a potentially accented character.

Special-Purpose Graffiti Manager Calls

The remainder of Graffiti manager API routines are for special-purpose use. They are basically all the entry points into the Graffiti recognizer engine and are usually called only by `GrfProcessStroke`. These special-purpose uses include calls to add pen points to the Graffiti recognizer's stroke buffer, to convert the stroke buffer into a Graffiti glyph ID, and to map a glyph into a string of one or more key strokes.

Accessing Graffiti ShortCuts

Other routines provide access to the Graffiti ShortCuts database. This is a separate database owned and maintained by the Graffiti manager that contains all of the shortcuts. This database is opened by the Graffiti manager when it initializes and stays open even after applications quit.

The only way to modify this database is through the Graffiti manager API. It provides calls for getting a list of all shortcuts, and for adding, editing, and removing shortcuts. The ShortCuts screen of the Preferences application provides a user-interface for modifying this database.

Note on Auto Shifting

The Palm OS 2.0 and later automatically uses an upper-case letter under the following conditions:

- Period and space or Return.
- Other sentence terminator (such as ? or !) and space

This functionality requires no changes by the developer, but should be welcome to the end user.

Note that the auto-shifting rules are language-specific, since capitalization differs depending on the region. These rules depend on the version of the ROM, the market into which the device is being sold, and so on.

Note on Graffiti Help

In Palm OS 2.0 and later, applications can pop up Graffiti help by calling `SysGraffitiReferenceDialog` or by putting a virtual character—`graffitiReferenceChr` from `Chars.h`—on the queue.

Graffiti help is also available through the system Edit menu. As a result, any application that includes the system Edit menu allows users to access Graffiti Help that way.

The Key Manager

The key manager manages the hardware buttons on the Palm OS device. It converts hardware button presses into key events and implements auto-repeat of the buttons. Most applications never need to call the key manager directly except to change the key repeat rate or to poll the current state of the keys.

The event manager is the main interface to the keys; it returns a `keyDownEvent` to an application whenever a button is pressed. Normally, applications are notified of key presses through the event manager. Whenever a hardware button is pressed, the application receives an event through the event manager with the appropriate key code stored in the event record. The state of the hardware buttons can also be queried by applications at any time through the `KeyCurrentState` function call.

The `KeyRates` call changes the auto-repeat rate of the hardware buttons. This might be useful to game applications that want to use the hardware buttons for control. The current key repeat rates are stored in the key manager globals and should be restored before the application exits.

The Pen Manager

The pen manager manages the digitizer hardware and converts input from the digitizer into pen coordinates. The Palm OS platform device has a built-in digitizer overlaid onto the LCD screen and extending about an inch below the screen. This digitizer is capable of sampling accurately to within 0.35 mm (.0138 in) with up to 50 accurate points/second. When the device is in doze mode, an interrupt is generated when the pen is first brought down on the screen. After a pen down is detected, the system software polls the pen location periodically (every 20 ms) until the pen is again raised.

Most applications never need to call the pen manager directly because any pen activity is automatically returned to the application in the form of events.

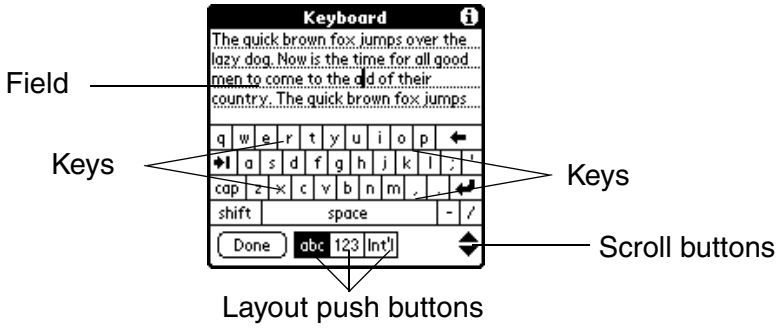
Pen coordinates are stored in the pen queue as raw, uncalibrated coordinates. When the system event manager routine for removing pen coordinates from the pen queue is called, it converts the pen coordinate into screen coordinates before returning.

The Preferences application provides a user interface for calibrating the digitizer. It uses the pen manager API to set up the calibration which is then saved into the Preferences database. The pen manager assumes that the digitizer is linear in both the x and y directions; the calibration is therefore a simple matter of adding an offset and scaling the x and y coordinates appropriately.

The Keyboard Dialog

The keyboard dialog is an onscreen keyboard on which the user taps to input information into a text field. When the insertion point is in a text field, the user can open the onscreen keyboard by tapping on the silk-screen letters ("abc" or "123") in the lower corners of the Graffiti area. The keyboard dialog appears:

Figure 5.16 The Keyboard Dialog



The keyboard dialog's text field contains the full text of the original field, with the insertion point in the same position as in the original field. Users can start inserting and deleting characters immediately, or they can scroll up or down and then insert and delete. When one of the software keys is tapped, the corresponding character is inserted in the text field of the keyboard dialog.

As the user taps, the keyboard dialog code captures pen events, maps them to characters, and posts `keyDownEvents`. The text field

in the keyboard dialog handles each `keyDownEvent`, displaying the character onscreen and inserting it into the memory chunk associated with the field. Since the keyboard dialog has its own event loop, you cannot handle the key events yourself. If you need to capture the key events, you should consider creating a custom version of the onscreen keyboard dialog, as outlined in "Creating a Custom Keyboard Layout" on page 146.

The keyboard code edits the text string of the original field in-place. Each field has a text handle that points to the memory chunk containing the text string for the field. When the keyboard dialog is opened, the association between the text handle and the original field is removed. The text handle is then assigned to the text field of the keyboard dialog and edited according to user input. When the keyboard dialog is closed, the text handle is reassigned to the original field.

For details on how `FldHandleEvent` manipulates the memory chunk that holds a field's text string, see Chapter 9, "Fields," in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*. Read about the `FldGetTextHandle` and `FldSetText` functions.

Opening the Keyboard Dialog Programmatically

In most applications, the keyboard dialog appears only when explicitly opened by the user. There are occasions, however, when you may wish to force the user to input characters via the onscreen keyboard. For example, the service activation application shipped with all Palm VIIs displays the keyboard dialog automatically. Palm made this choice because the activation application must be usable by completely new Palm users, who may not know how to write Graffiti or open the keyboard dialog themselves. Other reasons for imposing the keyboard dialog include accurate input of passwords or account numbers.

To display the keyboard dialog programmatically, use one of the following functions:

- `SysKeyboardDialog`
- `SysKeyboardDialogV10`

Normally, use `SysKeyboardDialog` only. `SysKeyboardDialogV10` is for compatibility with Palm OS 1.0.

See `keyboard.h` for the function prototypes and the `KeyboardType` they use. Note that the rest of the functions listed in `keyboard.h` are for system use only and do not form part of the Palm OS API.

Keyboard Layouts

The keyboard dialog has three views, one for each of the pre-defined layouts: the English alphabet, numerals and punctuation, and Latin characters with diacritic marks. The default is the English alphabet. To display a particular layout, call the `sysKeyboardDialog` function and pass it one of the following constants, which are defined in an enumeration named `KeyboardType`:

Table 5.17 Constants Defined in KeyboardType

Constant	Character Set
`kbdAlpha`	The English language character set.
`kbdNumbersAndPunc`	A set containing numbers and some advanced punctuation.
`kbdAccent`	The International character set, made up of Latin characters with diacritic marks.
`kbdDefault`	The value of `kbdDefault` is the same as `kdbAlpha` and cannot be changed.

Creating a Custom Keyboard Layout

You cannot add an extra keyboard layout or modify an existing one. You can, however, create your own keyboard dialog module that implements the functionality outlined below.

First, your application should intercept the `keyDownEvent` generated when the user taps the "abc" or "123" silk-screen letters in the Graffiti area. Create a custom keyboard dialog loader routine to handle it. Your keyboard code should then do the following:

- Get the text handle of the original field and save it in a variable. Use `FldGetTextHandle`.

- Remove the association between the text handle and the original field. Use `FldSetTextHandle` or `FldSetText`, passing NULL as the second argument.
- Assign the text handle to the text field of the keyboard dialog.
- Define a Keyboard event handler that:
  - captures pen events in your onscreen keyboard region, which may be a bitmap of a keyboard or may consist of individual push buttons,
  - maps pen events to characters,
  - creates `keyDownEvents` and posts them to the event queue so that the dialog's text field can automatically handle them and insert them in its text chunk.
- When the dialog is closed, remove the association between the text handle and keyboard's field, and then re-assign the text handle to the original text field.

Finally, if you wish more than one layout, your custom keyboard dialog must contain a button to open each layout.

Application Launcher

The Application Launcher (accessed via the silk-screen "Applications" button) presents a window or menu from which the user can open other applications present on the Palm device. Applications installed on the Palm device (resource databases of type `'appl'`) appear in the Application Launcher automatically.

NOTE: Versions of Palm OS prior to 3.0 implemented the Launcher as a popup. The `SysAppLauncherDialog` function, which provides the API to the old popup launcher, is still present in Palm OS 3.0 for compatibility purposes, but it has not been updated and, in most cases, should not be used.

The Launcher application can beam applications to other Palm devices. Only the application itself is beamed; associated storage databases and preferences are not transmitted. To suppress the beaming of your application by the Launcher, you can set the

dmHdrAttrCopyPrevention bit in your database header. (For a runtime code example, see the "Dr McCoy" sample application. Note that you can also use compile-time code to suppress beaming.)

Normally, the Launcher represents installed applications graphically as icons that appear in the Launcher window. The Launcher application also provides a list mode that allows the user to see more applications at once than are normally visible in its default viewing mode. You can use the Constructor tool to provide a small icon for the list mode—you'll need to create a tAIB resource having 1001 as the value of its ID.

The Launcher displays a version string from each application's tver resource, ID 1000. This short string (usually 3 to 6 characters) is displayed in the "Info" dialog.

Situations in which you need to open the Application Launcher programmatically are rare, but the system does provide an API for doing so. To activate the Launcher from within your application, enqueue a keyDownEvent that contains a launchChr, as shown in Listing 5.6.

WARNING! Do not use the SysUIAppSwitch or SysAppLaunch functions to open the Application Launcher application.

Listing 5.6 Opening the Launcher

```
EventType newEvent;
newEvent.eType = keyDownEvent;
newEvent.data.keyDown.chr = launchChr;
newEvent.data.keyDown.modifiers = commandKeyMask;
EvtAddEventToQueue (&newEvent);
```

For information on launching other applications programmatically, see "Launching Applications Programmatically" in the chapter "Application Startup and Stop."

Summary of User Interface API

Progress Manager Functions

PrgHandleEvent
PrgStartDialog
PrgStopDialog
PrgUpdateDialog
PrgUserCancel

Form Functions

Initialization

FrmInitForm

Event Handling

FrmSetEventHandler
FrmDispatchEvent
FrmHandleEvent

Displaying a Form

FrmGotoForm
FrmPopupForm
FrmDrawForm
FrmNewForm
FrmSetActiveForm

Displaying a Modal Dialog

FrmCustomAlert
FrmHelp
FrmCustomResponseAlert
FrmSaveActiveState
FrmAlert
FrmRestoreActiveState
FrmDoDialog
FrmNewGsi

Updating the Display

FrmUpdateForm
FrmReturnToForm
FrmShowObject
FrmHideObject
FrmRemoveObject
FrmUpdateScrollers

Form Attributes

FrmVisible
FrmSaveAllForms

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FrmGetActiveForm
FrmGetActiveFormID
FrmGetFirstForm
FrmGetFormId
FrmGetFormPtr
FrmGetWindowHandle
FrmValidatePtr

Accessing Objects Within a Form

FrmGetFocus
FrmSetFocus
FrmGetObjectId
FrmGetObjectIndex
FrmGetObjectType
FrmGetObjectPosition
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Title and Menu

FrmCopyTitle
FrmGetTitle
FrmPointInTitle
FrmSetTitle
FrmSetMenu

Labels

FrmCopyLabel
FrmSetCategoryLabel
FrmGetLabel
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Controls

FrmGetControlValue
FrmSetControlValue
FrmGetControlGroupSelection
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Gadgets

FrmGetGadgetData
FrmSetGadgetData
FrmNewGadget
FrmSetGadgetHandler

Bitmaps

FrmNewBitmap

Coordinates and Boundaries

FrmGetObjectBounds
FrmSetObjectBounds
FrmSetObjectPosition
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Removing a Form From the Display

FrmCloseAllForms
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FrmDeleteForm

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WinCreateWindow

Making a Window Active

WinSetActiveWindow
WinSetDrawWindow

Accessing a Window Programmatically

WinGetActiveWindow
WinGetDrawWindow
WinGetDisplayWindow
WinGetFirstWindow
WinValidateHandle

Offscreen Windows

WinRestoreBits
WinSaveBits
WinCreateOffscreenWindow
WinCreateBitmapWindow

Displaying Characters

WinDrawChar
WinDrawChars
WinInvertChars
WinDrawInvertedChars
WinDrawTruncChars
WinEraseChars
WinPaintChar
WinPaintChars

Bitmaps

WinDrawBitmap
WinGetBitmap
WinPaintBitmap

Window Functions

Lines

WinDrawLine
WinFillLine
WinEraseLine
WinPaintLines
WinDrawGrayLine
WinInvertLine
WinPaintLine

Rectangles

WinDrawRectangle
WinInvertRectangle
WinFillRectangle
WinEraseRectangle
WinDrawGrayRectangleFrame
WinPaintRectangle
WinCopyRectangle
WinDrawRectangleFrame
WinInvertRectangleFrame
WinScrollRectangle
WinEraseRectangleFrame
WinPaintRectangleFrame

Pixels

WinDrawPixel
WinErasePixel
WinGetPixel
WinInvertPixel
WinPaintPixel
WinPaintPixels

Clipping Rectangle

WinGetClip
WinResetClip
WinSetClip
WinClipRectangle

Setting the Drawing State

WinPopDrawState
WinModal
WinSetPattern
WinGetPatternType
WinSetBackColor
WinSetPatternType
WinPushDrawState
WinGetPattern
WinSetUnderlineMode
WinSetDrawMode
WinSetForeColor
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WinDisplayToWindowPt
WinGetDisplayExtent
WinSetBounds
WinGetFramesRectangle
WinWindowToDisplayPt
WinGetWindowExtent
WinGetBounds
WinGetWindowFrameRect

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Working with the Screen

WinScreenMode
WinScreenLock
WinScreenUnlock

Removing a Window From the Display

WinEraseWindow

Releasing a Window's Memory

WinDeleteWindow

Working with Colors

WinIndexToRGB
WinPalette
WinRGBToIndex

WinGetPixelRGB
WinSetForeColorRGB
WinSetBackColor
WinSetBackColorRGB
WinSetForeColor
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WinSetTextColor

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CtlDrawControl
CtlSetUsable
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CtlGetValue
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Label

CtlSetLabel
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CtlHideControl	CtlEraseControl
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CtlHandleEvent	
Setting up controls	
CtlGetSliderValues	CtlSetSliderValues
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CtlHitControl	CtlValidatePointer

Field Functions	
Obtaining User Input	
FldGetTextPtr	FldGetTextHandle
FldSetDirty	FldDirty
FldGetSelection	
Updating the Display	
FldDrawField	FldMakeFullyVisible
FldSetSelection	FldSetBounds
FldRecalculateField	
Displaying Text	
FldSetTextPtr	
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FldSetText	FldSetTextHandle
FldInsert	FldDelete
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FldCut
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FldScrollField
FldScrollable
FldSetScrollPosition
FldGetScrollPosition
FldGetVisibleLines
FldGetScrollValues
FldGetNumberOfBlankLines

Field Attributes

FldGetAttributes
FldSetFont
FldGetFont
FldSetMaxChars
FldGetMaxChars
FldSetMaxVisibleLines
FldSetAttributes
FldGetBounds

Text Attributes

FldCalcFieldHeight
FldGetTextHeight
FldGetTextAllocatedSize
FldGetTextLength
FldSetTextAllocatedSize
FldWordWrap

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FldGetInsPtPosition
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Releasing Memory

FldCompactText
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FldHandleEvent
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MenuCmdBarDisplay
MenuCmdBarGetButtonData
MenuHideItem
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TblSetLoadDataProcedure

Updating the Display

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TblGrabFocus
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TblUnhighlightSelection
TblRemoveRow
TblMarkRowInvalid
TblMarkTableInvalid
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Retrieving Data

TblGetItemPtr
TblGetRowData
TblFindRowData
TblGetItemInt
TblGetSelection
TblGetCurrentField
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Displaying Data

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TblSetItemStyle
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TblSetRowData

Retrieving a Row

TblFindRowID
TblGetRowID

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Table Information

TblEditing
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TblGetItemBounds
TblGetLastUsableRow
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LstPopupList
LstSetDrawFunction
LstNewList

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LstMakeItemVisible
LstSetListChoices
LstSetSelection
LstScrollList
LstSetHeight
LstSetTopItem
LstSetPosition

List Data and Attributes

LstGetNumberOfItems
LstGetSelection
LstGetSelectionText
LstGetTopItem
LstGetVisibleItems

Removing a List From the Display

LstEraseList

Event Handling

LstHandleEvent

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CategoryCreateList
CategoryEdit
CategoryFind
CategoryFreeList
CategoryGetName
CategoryGetNext
CategoryInitialize
CategorySelect
CategorySetName
CategorySetTriggerLabel
CategorySelect
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Bitmap Functions	
BmpBitsSize	BmpGetBits
BmpColortableSize	BmpGetColortable
BmpCompress	BmpSize
BmpCreate	ColorTableEntries
BmpDelete	

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SclSetScrollBar	SclGetScrollBar
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StrNCompare
StrCaselessCompare
StrNCaselessCompare

Changing Strings

StrPrintF
StrVPrintF
StrCat
StrNCat
StrCopy
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Searching Strings

StrStr
StrChr

Converting

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Localized Numbers

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StrLocalizeNumber

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Changing the Font

FontSelect
FntSetFont

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FntGetFontPtr

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FntWordWrap
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Font Functions

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FntCharsWidth
FntLineWidth
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Character Width

FntAverageCharWidth
FntCharWidth

Height

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FntLineHeight
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GrfSetState
GrfFindBranch

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GrfGetPoint
GrfAddPoint
GrfFilterPoints
GrfFlushPoints
GrfGetGlyphMapping
GrfMatch
GrfMatchGlyph

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GrfDeleteMacro	GrfGetMacro
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KeyCurrentState	KeyRates
KeySetMask	

Pen Manager Functions	
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SysKeyboardDialog
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6

Memory

This chapter helps you understand memory use on Palm OS®.

- Introduction to Palm OS Memory Use provides information about Palm OS hardware relevant to memory management.
- Memory Architecture discusses in detail how memory is structured on Palm OS. It also examines the structure of the basic building blocks of Palm OS memory: heaps, chunks, and records.
- The Memory Manager discusses how to use the Palm OS memory manager in your applications. The memory manager maintains the location and size of each memory chunk in nonvolatile storage, volatile storage, and ROM. It provides functions for allocating chunks, disposing of chunks, resizing chunks, locking and unlocking chunks, and compacting the heap when it becomes fragmented.

Introduction to Palm OS Memory Use

The Palm OS system software supports applications on low-cost, low-power, handheld devices. Given these constraints, Palm OS is efficient in its use of both memory and processing resources. This section presents two aspects of Palm OS devices that contribute to this efficiency: Hardware Architecture and PC Connectivity.

Hardware Architecture

The first implementation of Palm OS provides nearly instantaneous response to user input while running on a 16 MHz Motorola® 68000 type processor with a minimum of 128K of nonvolatile storage memory and 512 KB of ROM. Subsequent Palm OS devices provide additional RAM and ROM in varying amounts.

The ROM and RAM for each Palm OS device resides on a memory module known as a **card**. Each memory card can contain ROM,

RAM, or both. There is no RAM or ROM storage on the motherboard of the device.

Though all previous and current Palm OS devices hold one card in a user-accessible hardware slot, it is unwise to assume that any Palm OS device has a memory module that can be removed physically. A "card" is simply a logical construct used by the operating system—Palm OS devices can have one card, multiple cards, or no cards. For example, the Simulator provided by the Palm OS SDK on Macintosh can simulate a device that has two cards.

The ROM and RAM on each card is divided into one or more heaps of 64K (in the current implementation) or less. All the RAM-based heaps on a memory card are treated as the RAM store, and all the ROM-based heaps are treated as the ROM store. The heaps for a store do not have to be adjacent to each other in address space—they can be scattered throughout the memory space on the card—but they must all reside on the same card.

The main suite of applications provided with each Palm OS device is built into ROM. This design permits the user to replace the operating system and the entire applications suite simply by installing a single replacement module. Additional or replacement applications and system extensions can be loaded into RAM, but doing so is not always practical in this RAM-constrained environment.

PC Connectivity

PC connectivity is an integral component of the Palm OS device. The device comes with a cradle that connects to a desktop PC and with software for the PC that provides "one-button" backup and synchronization of all data on the device with the user's PC.

Because all user data can be backed up on the PC, replacement of the nonvolatile storage area of the Palm OS device becomes a simple matter of installing the new module in place of the old one and resynchronizing with the PC. The format of the user's data in storage RAM can change with a new version of the ROM; the connectivity software on the PC is responsible for translating the data into the correct format when downloading it onto a device with a new ROM.

Memory Architecture

IMPORTANT: This section describes the current (3.X) implementation of Palm OS memory architecture. This implementation may change as the Palm OS evolves. Do not rely on implementation-specific information described here; instead, always use the API provided to manipulate memory.

The Palm OS system software is designed around a 32-bit architecture. The system uses 32-bit addresses, and its basic data types are 8, 16, and 32 bits long.

The 32-bit addresses available to software provide a total of 4 GB of address space for storing code and data. This address space affords a large growth potential for future revisions of both the hardware and software without affecting the execution model. Although a large memory space is available, Palm OS was designed to work efficiently with small amounts of RAM. For example, the first commercial Palm OS device has less than 1 MB of memory, or .025% of this address space.

The Motorola 68328 processor's 32-bit registers and 32 internal address lines support a 32-bit execution model as well, although the external data bus is only 16 bits wide. This design reduces cost without impacting the software model. The processor's bus controller automatically breaks down 32-bit reads and writes into multiple 16-bit reads and writes externally.

Each memory card in the Palm OS device has 256 MB of address space reserved for it. Memory card 0 starts at address $1000000, memory card 1 starts at address $2000000, and so on.

The Palm OS divides the total available RAM store into two logical areas: **dynamic** RAM and **storage** RAM. Dynamic RAM is used as working space for temporary allocations, and is analogous to the RAM installed in a typical desktop system. The remainder of the available RAM on the card is designated as storage RAM and is analogous to disk storage on a typical desktop system.

Because power is always applied to the memory system, both areas of RAM preserve their contents when the device is turned "off" (i.e., is in low-power sleep mode.) See "Palm OS Power Modes" in the

chapter "Palm System Support" in this book. All of storage memory is preserved even when the device is reset explicitly. As part of the boot sequence, the system software reinitializes the dynamic area, and leaves the storage area intact.

The entire dynamic area of RAM is used to implement a single heap that provides memory for dynamic allocations. From this **dynamic heap**, the system provides memory for dynamic data such as global variables, system dynamic allocations (TCP/IP, IrDA, and so on, as applicable), application stacks, temporary memory allocations, and application dynamic allocations (such as those performed when the application calls the `MemHandleNew` function).

The entire amount of RAM reserved for the dynamic heap is always dedicated to this use, regardless of whether it is actually used for allocations. The size of the dynamic area of RAM on a particular device varies according to the OS version running, the amount of physical RAM available, and the requirements of pre-installed software such as the TCP/IP stack or IrDA stack. Table 6.1 provides more information about the dynamic heap space that currently available combinations of OS and hardware provide.

Table 6.1 Dynamic Heap Space

RAM Usage	OS 3.5 ≤ 4 MB TCP/IP & IrDA	OS 3.5 ≤ 2 MB TCP/IP & IrDA	OS 3.0 > 3.3 > 1 MB TCP/IP & IrDA (Palm III™)	OS 2.0 1 MB TCP/IP only (Professional)	OS 2.0/1.0 512 KB no TCP/IP or IrDA (Personal)
Total dynamic area	256 KB	128 KB	96 KB	64 KB	32 KB
System Globals (screen buffer, UI globals, database references, etc.)	40 KB (OS)	40 KB (OS)	~2.5 KB	~2.5 KB	~2.5 KB
TCP/IP stack	32 KB	32 KB	32 KB	32 KB	0 KB
System dynamic allocation (IrDA, "Find" window, temporary allocations)	variable	variable	variable amount	~15 KB (no IrDA in this OS)	~15 KB

Table 6.1 Dynamic Heap Space *(continued)*

RAM Usage	OS 3.5 ≤ 4 MB TCP/IP & IrDA	OS 3.5 ≤ 2 MB TCP/IP & IrDA	OS 3.0 > 3.3 > 1 MB TCP/IP & IrDA (Palm III™)	OS 2.0 1 MB TCP/IP only (Professional)	OS 2.0/1.0 512 KB no TCP/IP or IrDA (Personal)
Application stack (call stack and local vars)	N/A (see note)	N/A (see note)	4 KB (default)	2.5 KB	2.5 KB
Remaining dynamic space (dynamic allocations, application global variables, and static variables)	184 KB	56 KB	≤ 36 KB	≤ 12 KB	≤ 12 KB

The remaining portion of RAM not dedicated to the dynamic heap is configured as one or more **storage heaps** used to hold nonvolatile user data such as appointments, to do lists, memos, address lists, and so on. An application accesses a storage heap by calling the database manager or resource manager, according to whether it needs to manipulate user data or resources.

NOTE: Starting with Palm OS 3.5, the dynamic heap is sized based on the amount of memory available to the system.

The size and number of storage heaps available on a particular device varies according to the OS version that is running; the amount of physical RAM that is available; and the storage requirements of end-user application software such as the Address List, Date Book, or third-party applications.

Versions 1.0 and 2.0 of Palm OS subdivide storage RAM into multiple storage heaps of 64 KB each. Palm OS 3.X configures all storage RAM on a card as a single storage heap. Under all versions of Palm OS, system overhead limits the maximum usable data storage available in a single chunk to slightly less than 64 KB.

In the Palm OS environment, all data are stored in memory manager chunks. A **chunk** is an area of contiguous memory between 1 byte and slightly less than 64 KB in size that has been allocated by the Palm OS memory manager. (Because system overhead requirements may vary, an exact figure for the maximum amount of usable data storage for all chunks cannot be specified.) Currently, all Palm OS implementations limit the maximum size of any chunk to slightly less than 64 KB; however, the API does not have this constraint, and it may be relaxed in the future.

Each chunk resides in a heap. Some heaps are ROM-based and contain only nonmovable chunks; some are RAM-based and may contain movable or nonmovable chunks. A RAM-based heap may be a dynamic heap or a storage heap. The Palm OS memory manager allocates memory in the dynamic heap (for dynamic allocations, stacks, global variables, and so on). The Palm OS data manager allocates memory in one or more storage heaps (for nonvolatile user data).

Every memory chunk used to hold storage data (as opposed to memory chunks that store dynamic data) is a **record** in a database implemented by the Palm OS data manager. In the Palm OS environment, a **database** is simply a list of memory chunks and associated database header information. Normally, the items in a database share some logical association; for example, a database may hold a collection of all address book entries, all datebook entries, and so on.

A database is analogous to a file in a desktop system. Just as a traditional file system can create, delete, open, and close files, Palm OS applications can create, delete, open, and close databases as necessary. There is no restriction on where the records for a particular database reside as long as they are all on the same memory card. The records from one database can be interspersed with the records from one or more other databases in memory.

Storing data by database fits nicely with the Palm OS memory manager design. Each record in a database is in fact a memory manager chunk. The data manager can use memory manager calls to allocate, delete, and resize database records. All heaps except for the dynamic heap are nonvolatile, so database records can be stored in any heap except the dynamic heap. Because records can be stored

anywhere on the memory card, databases can be distributed over multiple discontiguous areas of physical RAM, but all records belonging to a particular database must reside on the same card.

To understand how database records are manipulated, it helps to know something about the way the memory manager allocates and tracks memory chunks, as the next section describes.

Heap Overview

IMPORTANT: This section describes the current (3.X) implementation of Palm OS memory architecture. This implementation may change as the Palm OS evolves. Do not rely on implementation-specific information described here; instead, always use the API provided to manipulate memory.

Recall that a **heap** is a contiguous area of memory used to contain and manage one or more smaller chunks of memory. When applications work with memory (allocate, resize, lock, etc.) they usually work with chunks of memory. An application can specify whether to allocate a new chunk of memory in the storage heap or the dynamic heap. The memory manager manages each heap independently and rearranges chunks as necessary to defragment heaps and merge free space.

Heaps in the Palm OS environment are referenced through heap IDs. A **heap ID** is a unique 16-bit value that the memory manager uses to identify a heap within the Palm OS address space. Heap IDs start at 0 and increment sequentially by units of 1. Values are assigned beginning with the RAM heaps on card 0, continuing with the ROM heaps on card 0, and then continuing through RAM and ROM heaps on subsequent cards. The sequence of heap IDs is continuous; that is, no values in the sequence are skipped.

The first heap (heap 0) on card 0 is the dynamic heap. This heap is reinitialized every time the Palm OS device is reset. When an application quits, the system frees any chunks allocated by that application in the dynamic heap. All other heaps are nonvolatile storage heaps that retain their contents through soft reset cycles.

When a Palm OS device is presented with multiple dynamic heaps, the first heap (heap 0) on card 0 is the active dynamic heap. All other potential dynamic heaps are ignored. For example, it is possible that a future Palm OS device supporting multiple cards might be presented with two cards, each having its own dynamic heap; if so, only the dynamic heap residing on card 0 would be active—the system would not treat any heaps on other cards as dynamic heaps, nor would heap IDs be assigned to these heaps. Subsequent storage heaps would be assigned IDs in sequential order, as always beginning with RAM heaps, followed by ROM heaps.

NOTE: In Palm OS 3.5, the dynamic heap is sized based on the amount of memory available to the system.

Overview of Memory Chunk Structure

Memory chunks can be movable or nonmovable. Applications need to store data in movable chunks whenever feasible, thereby enabling the memory manager to move chunks as necessary to create contiguous free space in memory for allocation requests.

When the memory manager allocates a nonmovable chunk it returns a pointer to that chunk. The pointer is simply that chunk's address in memory. Because the chunk cannot move, its pointer remains valid for the chunk's lifetime; thus, the pointer can be passed "as is" to the caller that requested the allocation.

When the memory manager allocates a moveable chunk, it generates a pointer to that chunk, just as it did for the nonmovable chunk, but it does not return the pointer to the caller. Instead, it stores the pointer to the chunk, called the **master chunk pointer**, in a **master pointer table** that is used to track all of the moveable chunks in the heap, and returns a reference to the master chunk pointer. This reference to the master chunk pointer is known as a **handle**. It is this handle that the memory manager returns to the caller that requested the allocation of a moveable chunk.

Using handles imposes a slight performance penalty over direct pointer access but permits the memory manager to move chunks around in the heap without invalidating any chunk references that an application might have stored away. As long as an application

uses handles to reference data, only the master pointer to a chunk needs to be updated by the memory manager when it moves a chunk during defragmentation.

An application typically locks a chunk handle for a short time while it has to read or manipulate the contents of the chunk. The process of locking a chunk tells the memory manager to mark that data chunk as immobile. When an application no longer needs the data chunk, it should unlock the handle immediately to keep heap fragmentation to a minimum.

Note that any handle is good only until the system is reset. When the system resets, it reinitializes all dynamic memory areas and relaunches applications. Therefore, you must not store a handle in a database record or a resource.

Each chunk on a memory card is actually located by means of a card–relative reference called a **local ID**. A local ID is a reference to a data chunk that the system computes from the base address of the card. The local ID of a nonmovable chunk is simply the offset of the chunk from the base address of the card. The local ID of a movable chunk is the offset of the master pointer to the chunk from the base address of the card, but with the low-order bit set. Since chunks are always aligned on word boundaries, only local IDs of movable chunks have the low-order bit set. Once the base address of the card is determined at runtime, a local ID can be converted quickly to a pointer or handle.

For example, when an application needs the handle to a particular data record, it calls the data manager to retrieve the record by index from the appropriate database. The data manager fetches the local ID of the record out of the database header and uses it to compute the handle to the record. The handle to the record is never actually stored in the database itself.

Although currently available Palm OS devices do not provide hardware support for multiple cards, the use of local IDs provides support in software for future devices that may allow the user to remove or insert memory cards. If the user moves a memory card to a slot having a different base address, the handle to a memory chunk on that card is likely to change, but the local ID associated with that chunk does not change.

The Memory Manager

The Palm OS memory manager is responsible for maintaining the location and size of every memory chunk in nonvolatile storage, volatile storage, and ROM. It provides an API for allocating new chunks, disposing of chunks, resizing chunks, locking and unlocking chunks, and compacting heaps when they become fragmented. Because of the limited RAM and processor resources of the Palm OS device, the memory manager is efficient in its use of processing power and memory.

This section provides background information on the organization of memory in Palm OS and provides an overview of the memory manager API, discussing these topics:

- Memory Manager Structures
- Using the Memory Manager

Memory Manager Structures

This section discusses the different structures the memory manager uses:

- Heap Structures
- Chunk Structures
- Local ID Structures

Heap Structures

IMPORTANT: Expect the heap structure to change in the future. Use the API to work with heaps.

A heap consists of the heap header, master pointer table, and the heap chunks.

- **Heap header**. The heap header is located at the beginning of the heap. It holds the size of the heap and contains flags for the heap that provide certain information to the memory manager; for example, whether the heap is ROM-based.

- **Master pointer table**. Following the heap header is a master pointer table. It is used to store 32-bit pointers to movable chunks in the heap.
  - When the memory manager moves a chunk to compact the heap, the pointer for that chunk in the master pointer table is updated to the chunk's new location. The handles an application uses to track movable chunks reference the address of the master pointer to the chunk, not the chunk itself. In this way, handles remain valid even after a chunk is moved. The OS compacts the heap automatically when available contiguous space is not sufficient to fulfill an allocation request.
  - If the master pointer table becomes full, another is allocated and its offset is stored in the `nextMstrPtrTable` field of the previous master pointer table. Any number of master pointer tables can be linked in this way. Because additional master pointer chunks are nonmovable, they are allocated at the end of the heap, according to the guidelines described in the "Heap chunks" section following immediately.
- **Heap chunks**. Following the master pointer table are the actual chunks in the heap.
  - Movable chunks are generally allocated at the beginning of the heap, and nonmovable chunks at the end of the heap.
  - Nonmovable chunks do not need an entry in the master pointer table since they are never relocated by the memory manager.
  - Applications can easily walk the heap by hopping from chunk to chunk because each chunk header contains the size of the chunk. All free and nonmovable chunks can be found in this manner by checking the flags in each chunk header.

  Because heaps can be ROM-based, there is no information in the header that must be changed when using a heap. Also, ROM-based heaps contain only nonmovable chunks and have a master pointer table with 0 entries.

Chunk Structures

IMPORTANT: Expect the chunk structure to change in the future. Use the API to work with chunks.

Each chunk begins with an 8-byte header followed by that chunk's data. The chunk header consists of a `Flags:size` adjustment byte, 3 bytes of size information, a `lock:owner` byte, and 3 bytes of `hOffset` information.

- **`Flags:sizeAdj` byte.**This byte contains flags in the high nibble and a size adjustment in the low nibble.
  - The flags nibble has 1 bit currently defined, which is set for free chunks.
  - The size adjustment nibble can be used to calculate the requested size of the chunk, given the actual size. The requested size is computed by taking the size as stored in the chunk header and subtracting the size of the header and the size adjustment field. The actual size of a chunk is always a multiple of two so that chunks always start on a word boundary.
- **`size` field (3 bytes)**. This three-byte value describes the size of the chunk, which is **larger** than the size requested by the application and includes the size of the chunk header itself. The maximum data size for a chunk is slightly less than 64 KB.
- **`Lock:owner` byte**. Following the size information is a byte that holds the lock count in the high nibble and the owner ID in the low nibble.
  - The lock count is incremented every time a chunk is locked and decremented every time a chunk is unlocked. A movable chunk can be locked a maximum of 14 times before being unlocked. Nonmovable chunks always have 15 in the lock field.
  - The owner ID determines the owner of a memory chunk and is set by the memory manager when allocating a new chunk. Owner ID information is useful for debugging and for garbage collection when an application terminates abnormally.

- **`hOffset` field (3 bytes)**. The last three bytes in the chunk header is the distance from the master pointer for the chunk to the chunk's header, divided by two. Note that this offset could be a negative value if the master pointer table is at a higher address than the chunk itself. For nonmovable chunks that do not need an entry in the master pointer table, this field is 0.

Local ID Structures

IMPORTANT: Expect the local ID structure to change in the future. Use the API to work with chunks.

Chunks that contain database records or other database information are tracked by the data manager through local IDs. A local ID is card relative and is always valid no matter what memory slot the card resides in. A local ID can be easily converted to a pointer or the handle to a chunk once the base address of the card is known.

The upper 31 bits of a local ID contain the offset of the chunk or master pointer to the chunk from the beginning of the card. The low-order bit is set for local IDs of handles and clear for local IDs of pointers.

The `MemLocalIDToGlobal` function converts a local ID and card number (either 0 or 1) to a pointer or handle. It looks at the card number and adds the appropriate card base address to convert the local ID to a pointer or handle for that card.

Using the Memory Manager

Use the memory manager API to allocate memory in the dynamic heap (for dynamic allocations, stacks, global variables, and so on) and use the data manager API to allocate memory in one or more storage heaps (for user data). The data manager calls the memory manager as appropriate to perform low-level allocations. (See The Data Manager for more information.)

Overview of the Memory Manager API

To allocate a movable chunk, call `MemHandleNew` and pass the desired chunk size. Before you can read or write data to this chunk,

you must call MemHandleLock to lock it and get a pointer to it. Every time you lock a chunk, its lock count is incremented. You can lock a chunk a maximum of 14 times before an error is returned. (Recall that unmovable chunks hold the value 15 in the lock field.) MemHandleUnlock reverses the effect of MemHandleLock—it decrements the value of the lock field by 1. When the lock count is reduced to 0, the chunk is free to be moved by the memory manager.

When an application allocates memory in the dynamic heap, the memory manager uses an owner ID to associate that chunk with the application. The system further distinguishes chunks belonging to the currently active allocation by setting a special bit in the owner ID information. When the application quits, all chunks in the dynamic heap having this bit set are freed automatically.

If the system needs to allocate a chunk that is not disposed of when an application quits, it changes the chunk's owner ID to 0 by calling the system functions MemHandleSetOwner or MemPtrSetOwner. These functions are not generally used by applications, except in special circumstances. For example, when the current application is passing a parameter block to a new application that it is launching with SysUIAppSwitch, the owner of the block must be set to the system; otherwise, when the current application exits, the system deletes the block when it frees all memory allocated by the current application.

To determine the size of a movable chunk, pass its handle to MemHandleSize. To resize it, call MemHandleResize. You generally cannot increase the size of a chunk if it's locked unless there happens to be free space in the heap immediately following the chunk. If the chunk is unlocked, the memory manager is allowed to move it to another area of the heap to increase its size.When you no longer need the chunk, call MemHandleFree, which releases the chunk even if it is locked.

If you have a pointer to a locked, movable chunk, you can recover the handle by calling MemPtrRecoverHandle. In fact, all of the MemPtr*Xxx* calls, including MemPtrSize, also work on pointers to locked, movable chunks.

To allocate a nonmovable chunk, call MemPtrNew and pass the desired size of the chunk. This call returns a pointer to the chunk, which can be used directly to read or write to it.

NOTE: You cannot allocate a zero-size chunk.

To determine the size of a nonmovable chunk, call `MemPtrSize`. To resize it, call `MemPtrResize`. You generally can't increase the size of a nonmovable chunk unless there is free space in the heap immediately following the chunk. When you no longer need the chunk, call `MemPtrFree`, which releases the chunk even if it's locked.

Use the memory manager utility routines `MemMove` and `MemSet` to move memory from one place to another or to fill memory with a specific value.

In most situations, the proper way to free memory is by calling one of the `MemPtrFree` or `MemHandleFree` functions.

NOTE: For important cautions and practical advice regarding the proper use of memory on Palm OS devices, be sure to read "Writing Robust Code" in the chapter "Good Design Practices" in this book.

Storage Heap Sizes and Memory Management Schemes

In Palm OS version 1.0, individual storage heaps were limited to a maximum size of 64 KB each and the memory manager moved objects automatically among multiple storage heaps to prevent any of them from becoming too full. This strategy tended to decrease the availability of contiguous space for large objects. The version 2.0 memory manager abandoned this approach, increasing the availability of contiguous heap space; however, it still limited the maximum size of individual heaps to 64 KB each. Palm OS version 3.X removes the 64 KB maximum size restriction on individual heaps and creates just two heaps: one 96K dynamic heap and one storage heap that is the size of all remaining RAM on the card.

NOTE: Starting with Palm OS 3.5, the dynamic heap is sized based on the amount of memory available to the system. The size which will be used is as follows:

Device RAM size	Heap size
< 2 mb of ram	64 k
>= 2 mb	128 k
>= 4 mb	256 k

Optimizing Memory Manager Performance

Because Palm OS applications must perform well in a RAM-constrained environment, proper code segmentation is critical to achieving optimum performance.

If your application segments are too large, your application may not perform well (or to run at all) when large contiguous blocks of memory are not available. Conversely, if your application segments are too small, performance may be hindered by the overhead required to find and load resources too frequently.

Unfortunately, it impossible to specify a single size for memory chunks that will perform optimally for all applications.You will need to experiment with segmenting your code in different ways while measuring your application's performance in order to discover the size and arrangement of resource chunks that will optimize your particular application's responsiveness and overall performance. The Metrowerks CodeWarrior Debugger, Palm OS Debugger, and the Simulator provide tools for examining the internal structure of heaps, viewing the amount of free space available, manipulating blocks, and so on.

Summary of Memory Management

Memory Manager Functions

Allocating and Freeing Memory

MemHandleNew
MemHandleLock
MemLocalIDToLockedPtr
MemHandleFree
MemPtrNew
MemHandleUnlock
MemPtrUnlock
MemPtrFree

Resizing Chunks

MemHandleResize
MemPtrResize
MemHeapFreeBytes
MemHandleSize
MemPtrSize
MemHeapSize

Working With Memory

MemMove
MemCmp
MemSet
MemHeapCompact

Converting Pointers

MemPtrRecoverHandle
MemLocalIDKind
MemPtrToLocalID
MemHandleToLocalID
MemLocalIDToGlobal
MemLocalIDToPtr

Chunk Information

MemHandleCardNo
MemHandleHeapID
MemPtrCardNo
MemPtrSetOwner
MemHandleDataStorage
MemHandleSetOwner
MemPtrDataStorage

Heap Information

MemPtrHeapID
MemHeapDynamic
MemHeapFlags
MemHeapID
MemHeapCheck

Memory Manager Functions	
Card Information	
MemCardInfo	MemNumCards
MemNumHeaps	MemNumRAMHeaps
MemStoreInfo	
Debugging	
MemDebugMode	MemHeapScramble
MemSetDebugMode	

7

Files and Databases

This chapter describes how to work with databases using Palm OS® managers.

- The Data Manager manages user data, which is stored in databases for convenient access.
- The Resource Manager can be used by applications to conveniently retrieve and save chunks of data. It's similar to the data manager, but has the added capability of tagging each chunk with a unique resource type and ID. These tagged data chunks, called resources, are stored in resource databases. Resources are typically used to store the application's user interface elements, such as images, fonts, or dialog layouts.
- File Streaming Application Program Interface can be used by applications to handle large blocks of data.

The Data Manager

A traditional file system first reads all or a portion of a file into a memory buffer from disk, using and/or updating the information in the memory buffer, and then writes the updated memory buffer back to disk. Because Palm OS devices have limited amounts of dynamic RAM and use nonvolatile RAM instead of disk storage, a traditional file system is not optimal for storing and retrieving Palm OS user data.

Palm OS accesses and updates all information in place. This works well because it reduces dynamic memory requirements and eliminates the overhead of transferring the data to and from another memory buffer involved in a file system.

As a further enhancement, data in the Palm OS device is broken down into multiple, finite-size **records** that can be left scattered throughout the memory space; thus, adding, deleting, or resizing a record does not require moving other records around in memory.

Each record in a database is in fact a memory manager chunk. The data manager uses memory manager functions to allocate, delete, and resize database records.

This section explains how to use the database manager by discussing these topics:

- Records and Databases
- Structure of a Database Header
- Using the Data Manager

Records and Databases

Databases organize related records; every record belongs to one and only one database. A database may be a collection of all address book entries, all datebook entries, and so on. A Palm OS application can create, delete, open, and close databases as necessary, just as a traditional file system can create, delete, open, and close a traditional file. There is no restriction on where the records for a particular database reside as long as they all reside on the same memory card. The records from one database can be interspersed with the records from one or more other databases in memory.

Storing data by database fits nicely with the Palm OS memory manager design. All heaps except for the dynamic heap(s) are nonvolatile, so database records can be stored in any heap except the dynamic heap(s) (see "Heap Overview" in the "Memory" chapter). Because records can be stored anywhere on the memory card, databases can be distributed over multiple discontiguous areas of physical RAM.

Accessing Data With Local IDs

A database maintains a list of all records that belong to it by storing the local ID of each record in the database header. Because local IDs are used, the memory card can be placed into any memory slot of a Palm OS device. An application finds a particular record in a database by index. When an application requests a particular record, the data manager fetches the local ID of the record from the database header by index, converts the local ID to a handle using the card number that contains the database header, and returns the handle to the record.

Structure of a Database Header

A database header consists of some basic database information and a list of records in the database. Each record entry in the header has the local ID of the record, 8 attribute bits, and a 3-byte unique ID for the record.

This section provides information about database headers, discussing these topics:

- Database Header Fields
- Structure of a Record Entry in a Database Header

IMPORTANT: Expect the database header structure to change in the future. Use the API to work with database structures.

Database Header Fields

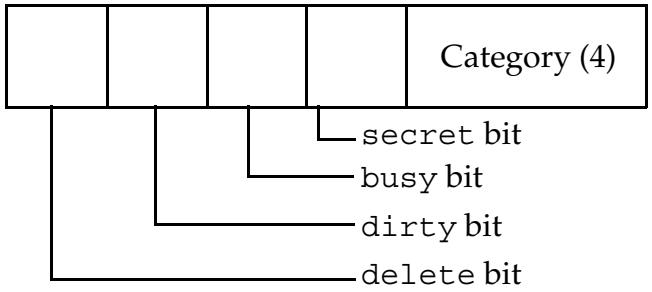
The database header has the following fields:

- The `name` field holds the name of the database.
- The `attributes` field has flags for the database.
- The `version` field holds an application-specific version number for that database.
- The `modificationNumber` is incremented every time a record in the database is deleted, added, or modified. Thus applications can quickly determine if a shared database has been modified by another process.
- The `appInfoID` is an optional field that an application can use to store application-specific information about the database. For example, it might be used to store user display preferences for a particular database.
- The `sortInfoID` is another optional field an application can use for storing the local ID of a sort table for the database.
- The `type` and `creator` fields are each 4 bytes and hold the database type and creator. The system uses these fields to distinguish application databases from data databases and to associate data databases with the appropriate application.

- The `numRecords` field holds the number of record entries stored in the database header itself. If all the record entries cannot fit in the header, then `nextRecordList` has the local ID of a `recordList` that contains the next set of records.

  Each record entry stored in a record list has three fields and is 8 bytes in length. Each entry has the local ID of the record which takes up 4 bytes: 1 byte of attributes and a 3-byte unique ID for the record. The `attribute` field, shown in Figure 7.1, is 8 bits long and contains 4 flags and a 4-bit category number. The category number is used to place records into user-defined categories like "business" or "personal."

Figure 7.1 Record Attributes



Structure of a Record Entry in a Database Header

Each record entry has the local ID of the record, 8 attribute bits, and a 3-byte unique ID for the record.

- Local IDs make the database slot-independent. Since all records for a database reside on the same memory card as the header, the handle of any record in the database can be quickly calculated. When an application requests a specific record from a database, the data manager returns a handle to the record that it determines from the stored local ID.

  A special situation occurs with ROM-based databases. Because ROM-based heaps use nonmovable chunks exclusively, the local IDs to records in a ROM-based database are local IDs of pointers, not handles. So, when an application opens a ROM-based database, the data manager

allocates and initializes a fake handle for each record and returns the appropriate fake handle when the application requests a record. Because of this, applications can use handles to access both RAM- and ROM-based database records.

- The unique ID must be unique for each record within a database. It remains the same for a particular record no matter how many times the record is modified. It is used during synchronization with the desktop to track records on the Palm OS device with the same records on the desktop system.

When the user deletes or archives a record on Palm OS:

- The `delete` bit is set in the `attributes` flags, but its entry in the database header remains until the next synchronization with the PC.
- The `dirty` bit is set whenever a record is updated.
- The `busy` bit is set when an application currently has a record locked for reading or writing.
- The `secret` bit is set for records that should not be displayed before the user password has been entered on the device.

When a user "deletes" a record on the Palm OS device, the record's data chunk is freed, the local ID stored in the record entry is set to 0, and the `delete` bit is set in the attributes. When the user archives a record, the deleted bit is also set but the chunk is not freed and the local ID is preserved. This way, the next time the user synchronizes with the desktop system, the desktop can quickly determine which records to delete (since their record entries are still around on the Palm OS device). In the case of archived records, the desktop can save the record data on the PC before it permanently removes the record entry and data from the Palm OS device. For deleted records, the PC just has to delete the same record from the PC before permanently removing the record entry from the Palm OS device.

Using the Data Manager

Using the data manager is similar to using a traditional file manager, except that the data is broken down into multiple records instead of being stored in one contiguous chunk. To create or delete a database, call `DmCreateDatabase` and `DmDeleteDatabase`.

Each memory card is akin to a disk drive and can contain multiple databases. To open a database for reading or writing, you must first get the database ID, which is simply the local ID of the database header. Calling DmFindDatabase searches a particular memory card for a database by name and returns the local ID of the database header. Alternatively, calling DmGetDatabase returns the database ID for each database on a card by index.

After determining the database ID, you can open the database for read-only or read/write access. When you open a database, the system locks down the database header and returns a reference to a database access structure, which tracks information about the open database and caches certain information for optimum performance. The database access structure is a relatively small structure (less than 100 bytes) allocated in the dynamic heap that is disposed of when the database is closed.

Call DmDatabaseInfo, DmSetDatabaseInfo, and DmDatabaseSize to query or set information about a database, such as its name, size, creation and modification dates, attributes, type, and creator.

Call DmGetRecord, DmQueryRecord, and DmReleaseRecord when viewing or updating a database.

- DmGetRecord takes a record index as a parameter, marks the record busy, and returns a handle to the record. If a record is already busy when DmGetRecord is called, an error is returned.
- DmQueryRecord is faster if the application only needs to view the record; it doesn't check or set the busy bit, so it's not necessary to call DmReleaseRecord when finished viewing the record.
- DmReleaseRecord clears the busy bit, and updates the modification number of the database and marks the record dirty if the dirty parameter is true.

To resize a record to grow or shrink its contents, call DmResizeRecord. This routine automatically reallocates the record in another heap of the same card if the current heap does not have enough space for it. Note that if the data manager needs to move the record into another heap to resize it, the handle to the

record changes. DmResizeRecord returns the new handle to the record.

To add a new record to a database, call DmNewRecord. This routine can insert the new record at any index position, append it to the end, or replace an existing record by index. It returns a handle to the new record.

There are three methods for removing a record: DmRemoveRecord, DmDeleteRecord, and DmArchiveRecord.

- DmRemoveRecord removes the record's entry from the database header and disposes of the record data.
- DmDeleteRecord also disposes of the record data, but instead of removing the record's entry from the database header, it sets the deleted bit in the record entry attributes field and clears the local chunk ID.
- DmArchiveRecord does not dispose of the record's data; it just sets the deleted bit in the record entry.

Both DmDeleteRecord and DmArchiveRecord are useful for synchronizing information with a desktop PC. Since the unique ID of the deleted or archived record is still kept in the database header, the desktop PC can perform the necessary operations on its own copy of the database before permanently removing the record from the Palm OS database.

Call DmRecordInfo and DmSetRecordInfo to retrieve or set the record information stored in the database header, such as the attributes, unique ID, and local ID of the record. Typically, these routines are used to set or retrieve the category of a record that is stored in the lower four bits of the record's attribute field.

To move records from one index to another or from one database to another, call DmMoveRecord, DmAttachRecord, and DmDetachRecord. DmDetachRecord removes a record entry from the database header and returns the record handle. Given the handle of a new record, DmAttachRecord inserts or appends that new record to a database or replaces an existing record with the new record. DmMoveRecord is an optimized way to move a record from one index to another in the same database.

The Resource Manager

Applications can use the resource manager much like the data manager to retrieve and save chunks of data conveniently. The resource manager has the added capability of tagging each chunk of data with a unique resource type and resource ID. These tagged data chunks, called **resources**, are stored in resource databases. Resource databases are almost identical in structure to normal databases except for a slight amount of increased storage overhead per resource record (two extra bytes). In fact, the resource manager is nothing more than a subset of routines in the data manager that are broken out here for conceptual reasons only.

Resources are typically used to store the user interface elements of an application, such as images, fonts, dialog layouts, and so forth. Part of building an application involves creating these resources and merging them with the actual executable code. In the Palm OS environment, an application is, in fact, simply a resource database with the executable code stored as one or more code resources and the graphics elements and other miscellaneous data stored in the same database as other resource types.

Applications may also find the resource manager useful for storing and retrieving application preferences, saved window positions, state information, and so forth. These preferences settings can be stored in a separate resource database.

This section explains how to work with the resource manager and discusses these topics:

- Structure of a Resource Database Header
- Using the Resource Manager
- Resource Manager Functions

Structure of a Resource Database Header

A resource database header consists of some general database information followed by a list of resources in the database. The first portion of the header is identical in structure to a normal database header. Resource database headers are distinguished from normal database headers by the `dmHdrAttrResDB` bit in the `attributes` field.

IMPORTANT: Expect the resource database header structure to change in the future. Use the API to work with resource database structures.

- The `name` field holds the name of the resource database.
- The `attributes` field has flags for the database and always has the `dmHdrAttrResDB` bit set.
- The `modificationNumber` is incremented every time a resource in the database is deleted, added, or modified. Thus, applications can quickly determine if a shared resource database has been modified by another process.
- The `appInfoID` and `sortInfoID` fields are not normally needed for a resource database but are included to match the structure of a regular database. An application may optionally use these fields for its own purposes.
- The `type` and `creator` fields hold 4-byte signatures of the database `type` and `creator` as defined by the application that created the database.
- The `numResources` field holds the number of resource info entries that are stored in the header itself. In most cases, this is the total number of resources. If all the resource info entries cannot fit in the header, however, then `nextResourceList` has the `chunkID` of a `resourceList` that contains the next set of resource info entries.

Each 10-byte resource info entry in the header has the resource type, the resource ID, and the local ID of the memory manager chunk that contains the resource data.

Using the Resource Manager

You can create, delete, open, and close resource databases with the routines used to create normal record-based databases (see Using the Data Manager). This includes all database-level (not record-level) routines in the data manager such as `DmCreateDatabase`, `DmDeleteDatabase`, `DmDatabaseInfo`, and so on.

When you create a new database using `DmCreateDatabase`, the type of database created (record or resource) depends on the value

of the resDB parameter. If set, a resource database is created and the dmHdrAttrResDB bit is set in the attributes field of the database header. Given a database header ID, an application can determine which type of database it is by calling DmDatabaseInfo and examining the dmHdrAttrResDB bit in the returned attributes field.

Once a resource database has been opened, an application can read and manipulate its resources by using the resource-based access routines of the resource manager. Generally, applications use the DmGetResource and DmReleaseResource routines.

DmGetResource returns a handle to a resource, given the type and ID. This routine searches all open resource databases for a resource of the given type and ID, and returns a handle to it. The search starts with the most recently opened database. To search only the most recently opened resource database for a resource instead of all open resource databases, call DmGet1Resource.

DmReleaseResource should be called as soon as an application finishes reading or writing the resource data. To resize a resource, call DmResizeResource, which accepts a handle to a resource and reallocates the resource in another heap of the same card if necessary. It returns the handle of the resource, which might have been changed if the resource had to be moved to another heap to be resized.

The remaining resource manager routines are usually not required for most applications. These include functions to get and set resource attributes, move resources from one database to another, get resources by index, and create new resources. Most of these functions reference resources by index to optimize performance. When referencing a resource by index, the DmOpenRef of the open resource database that the resource belongs to must also be specified. Call DmSearchResource to find a resource by type and ID or by pointer by searching in all open resource databases.

To get the DmOpenRef of the topmost open resource database, call DmNextOpenResDatabase and pass nil as the current DmOpenRef. To find out the DmOpenRef of each successive database, call DmNextOpenResDatabase repeatedly with each successive DmOpenRef.

Given the access pointer of a specific open resource database, DmFindResource can be used to return the index of a resource, given its type and ID. DmFindResourceType can be used to get the index of every resource of a given type. To get a resource handle by index, call DmGetResourceIndex.

To determine how many resources are in a given database, call DmNumResources. To get and set attributes of a resource including its type and ID, call DmResourceInfo and DmSetResourceInfo. To attach an existing data chunk to a resource database as a new resource, call DmAttachResource. To detach a resource from a database, call DmDetachResource.

To create a new resource, call DmNewResource and pass the desired size, type, and ID of the new resource. To delete a resource, call DmRemoveResource. Removing a resource disposes of its data chunk and removes its entry from the database header.

File Streaming Application Program Interface

The file streaming functions in Palm OS 3.0 and later let you work with large blocks of data. File streams can be arbitrarily large—they are not subject to the 64 KB maximum size limit imposed by the memory manager on allocated objects. File streams can be used for permanent data storage; in Palm OS 3.0, their underlying implementation is a Palm OS database. You can read, write, seek to a specified offset, truncate, and do everything else you'd expect to do with a desktop-style file.

Other than backup/restore, Palm OS does not provide direct Hot Sync support for file streams, and none is planned at this time.

The use of double-buffering imposes a performance penalty on file streams that may make them unsuitable for certain applications. Record-intensive applications tend to obtain better performance from the Data Manager.

Using the File Streaming API

The File Streaming API is derived from the C programming language's <stdio.h> interface. Any C book that explains the <stdio.h> interface should serve as a suitable introduction to the

concepts underlying the Palm OS File Streaming API. This section provides only a brief overview of the most commonly used file streaming functions.

The FileOpen function opens a file, and the FileRead function reads it. The semantics of FileRead and FileWrite are just like their <stdio.h> equivalents, the fread and fwrite functions. The other <stdio.h> routines have obvious analogs in the File Streaming API as well.

For example,

```
theStream =
FileOpen(cardId,"KillerAppDataFile",
            'KILR', 'KILD', fileModeReadOnly,
             &err);
```

As on a desktop, the filename is the unique item. The creator ID and file type are for informational purposes and your code may require that an opened file have the correct type and creator.

Normally, the FileOpen function returns an error when it attempts to open or replace an existing stream having a type and creator that do not match those specified. To suppress this error, pass the fileModeAnyTypeCreator selector as a flag in the openMode parameter to the FileOpen function.

To read data, use the FileRead function as in the following example:

```
FileRead(theStream, &buf, objSize, numObjs,
         &err);
```

To free the memory used to store stream data as the data is read, you can use the FileControl function to switch the stream to destructive read mode. This mode is useful for manipulating temporary data; for example, destructive read mode would be ideal for adding the objects in a large data stream to a database when sufficient memory for duplicating the entire file stream is not available. You can switch a stream to destructive read mode by passing the fileOpDestructiveReadMode selector as the value of the op parameter to the FileControl function.

The FileDmRead function can read data directly into a Database Manager chunk for immediate addition to a Palm OS database.

Summary of Files and Databases

Data Manager Functions

Creating Databases

DmCreateDatabase
DmCreateDatabaseFromImage

Opening and Closing Databases

DmOpenDatabase
DmCloseDatabase
DmDatabaseProtect
DmOpenDatabaseByTypeCreator

Creating Records

DmNewHandle
DmNewRecord

Accessing Records

DmGetRecord
DmQueryRecord
DmFindRecordByID
DmSearchRecord

Adding Records

DmAttachRecord

Unlocking Records

DmReleaseRecord

Changing Records

DmMoveRecord
DmResizeRecord
DmSet
DmStrCopy
DmWrite
DmWriteCheck

Deleting Records

DmArchiveRecord
DmDeleteDatabase
DmDeleteRecord
DmDetachRecord
DmRemoveRecord
DmRemoveSecretRecords

Sorting

DmInsertionSort
DmFindSortPositionV10
DmFindSortPosition
DmQuickSort

Data Manager Functions

Categories

DmMoveCategory
DmDeleteCategory
DmQueryNextInCategory
DmNumRecordsInCategory
DmPositionInCategory
DmSeekRecordInCategory

Locating Databases

DmFindDatabase
DmGetDatabase
DmNextOpenDatabase
DmGetNextDatabaseByTypeCreator

Database Information

DmDatabaseInfo
DmRecordInfo
DmOpenDatabaseInfo
DmNumDatabases
DmSetDatabaseInfo
DmSetRecordInfo
DmDatabaseSize
DmNumRecords

Application Information

DmGetAppInfoID

Error Handling

DmGetLastErr

Resource Manager Functions

DmOpenDBNoOverlay
DmNewResource
DmReleaseResource
DmDetachResource
DmSearchResource
DmFindResourceType
DmGetResource
DmNumResources
DmResourceInfo
DmAttachResource
DmRemoveResource
DmGetResourceIndex
DmFindResource
DmGet1Resource
DmNextOpenResDatabase
DmResizeResource
DmSetResourceInfo

File Streaming Function Summary	
Opening and Closing	
FileOpen	FileClose
FileSeek	
Reading Files	
FileRead	FileDmRead
FileRewind	FileControl
Writing to Files	
FileWrite	FileTruncate
File Information	
FileEOF	FileTell
Deleting Files	
FileDelete	FileFlush
Error Handling	
FileError	FileGetLastError
FileClearerr	

8

Expansion

This chapter describes how to work with expansion cards and add-on devices using the Palm OS® Expansion and Virtual File System (VFS) Managers.

- Expansion Support introduces basic terminology and discusses the hardware and file systems supported by the Expansion and VFS Managers.
- Architectural Overview illustrates the Palm OS expansion architecture and discusses the differences between primary and secondary storage.
- Standard Directories lists directories that are treated specially by the Palm OS and describes their use.
- Applications on Cards covers the various implications of running Palm OS applications from an expansion card.
- Card Insertion and Removal covers, in detail, the sequence of events that occur when an expansion card is inserted into or removed from an expansion slot.
- Checking for Expansion Cards shows you how to verify that the device supports expansion, how to check each of the device's slots for expansion cards, and how to determine the capabilities of a card in a given slot.
- Volume Operations discusses the various ways in which you can work with volumes on an expansion card.
- File Operations discusses the various ways in which you can work with files on an expansion card.
- Directory Operations discusses the various ways in which you can work with directories on an expansion card.
- Custom Calls briefly discusses how you can go beyond the functions provided by the Expansion and VFS Managers and interact with specialized I/O devices.
- Debugging briefly introduces the process of debugging an application that relies on the presence of an expansion card.

Expansion Support

Beginning with Palm OS 4.0[1], a set of optional system extensions provide a standard mechanism by which Palm OS applications can take advantage of the expansion capabilities of various Palm Powered™ handhelds. This capability not only augments the memory and I/O of the handheld, but facilitates data interchange with other Palm Powered handhelds and with devices that aren't running the Palm OS. These other devices include digital cameras, digital audio players, desktop or laptop computers, and the like.

Primary vs. Secondary Storage

All Palm Powered handhelds contain **primary storage**—directly addressable memory that is used for both long-term and temporary storage. This includes storage RAM, used to hold nonvolatile user data and applications; and dynamic RAM, which is used as working space for temporary allocations.

On most handhelds, primary storage is contained entirely within the device itself. The Palm OS memory architecture doesn't limit devices to this, however; devices can be designed to accept additional storage RAM. The products developed by Handspring™ work this way; memory modules plugged into the Springboard slot are fully-addressable and appear to a Palm OS application as additional storage RAM.

Secondary storage, by contrast, is designed primarily to be add-on nonvolatile storage. Although not limited to any particular implementation, most secondary storage media:

- can be inserted and removed from the expansion slot at will
- are based upon a third-party standard, such as Secure Digital (SD) memory cards, MultiMedia (MMC) cards, CompactFlash, Sony's Memory Stick™, and others
- present a serial interface, accessing data one bit, byte, or block at a time

1. The Sony CLIÉ™ handheld running Palm OS 3.5 runs a binary-compatible version of these extensions.

Applications access primary storage either directly, in the case of most dynamic RAM, or through the Database and Resource Managers. To access secondary storage, however, applications use the Expansion and VFS Managers. These have been designed to support as broad a range of serial expansion architectures as possible.

Expansion Slot

The expansion slots found on many Palm Powered handhelds vary depending on the manufacturer. While some may accept SD and MMC cards, others may accept Memory Stick or CompactFlash. Note that there is no restriction on the number of expansion slots that a given handheld can have.

Depending on the expansion technology used, there can be a wide variety of expansion cards usable with a given handheld:

- Storage cards provide secondary storage and can either be used to hold additional applications and data, or can be used for a specific purpose, for instance as a backup mechanism.
- ROM cards hold dedicated applications and data.
- I/O cards extend the handheld's I/O capabilities. A modem, for instance, could provide wired access, while a Bluetooth™ transceiver could add wireless capability.
- "Combo" cards provide both additional storage or ROM along with some I/O capability.

Universal Connector

Certain newer Palm Powered handhelds may be equipped with a universal connector that connects the handheld to a HotSync® cradle. This connector can be used to connect the handheld to snap-on I/O devices as well. A special slot driver dedicated to this connector allows handheld-to-accessory communication using the serial portion of the connector. This "plug and play" slot driver presents the peripheral as a card in a slot, even to the extent of providing the card insertion notification when the peripheral is attached.

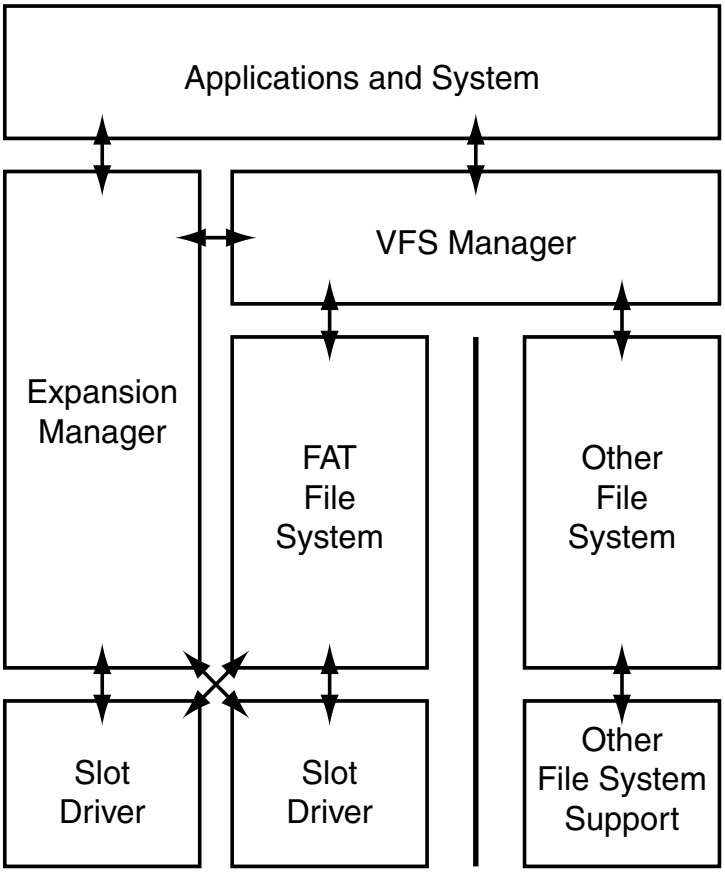
Because the universal connector's slot driver makes a snap-on peripheral appear to be a card in a slot, such peripherals can be

treated as expansion cards, at least from an application developer's perspective. For the remainder of this chapter, wherever an I/O card could be used, the phrase "expansion card" can be taken to mean both "expansion card" and "plug and play peripheral."

Architectural Overview

Figure 8.1 illustrates the Palm OS expansion architecture. It is designed to be flexible enough to support multiple file systems and diverse physical expansion mechanisms while still presenting a consistent set of APIs to applications and to other parts of the Palm OS. The following sections describe the major components of the Palm OS expansion architecture. Working from the bottom up, those components are: slot drivers, file systems, the VFS Manager, and the Expansion Manager.

Figure 8.1 Palm OS expansion architecture



Slot Drivers

A slot driver is a standard Palm OS shared library of type `sysFileTSlotDriver('libs')`. It is a special library that encapsulates direct access to the hardware and provides a standard set of services to the Expansion Manager and, optionally, to file system libraries. Adding support for a new type of hardware expansion is usually simply a matter of writing a slot driver for it. As illustrated in Figure 8.1, applications don't normally interact directly with slot drivers.

Each expansion slot has a slot driver associated with it. Slots are identified by a unique **slot reference number**, which is assigned by the Expansion Manager. Expansion cards themselves are not numbered individually; applications typically reference the slot into which a card is inserted. Note, however, that a slot may or may not have a card in it at any given time, and that a card can be inserted and removed while an application is running.

NOTE: "Card number" is a Palm OS Memory Manager term, and is not to be confused with "slot reference number."

The current implementation only supports one volume per slot.

File Systems

The Palm OS expansion architecture defines a common interface for all file system implementations on the Palm OS. This interface consists of a complete set of APIs for interacting with the file system, including the ability to open, close, read, write, and delete both files and directories on named volumes.

File system implementations are packaged as shared libraries of type `sysFileTFileSystem('libf')`. They are modular plug-ins that add support for a particular type of file system, such as VFAT, HFS, or NFS. The Palm OS expansion architecture allows multiple file system libraries to be installed at any given time. Typically, an implementation of the VFAT file system is present.

VFAT is the industry standard for flash memory cards of all types. It enables easy transfer of data and or applications to desktops and other devices. The VFAT file system library included with Palm OS

4.0 natively supports VFAT file systems on secondary storage media. It is able to recognize and mount FAT and VFAT file systems, and offers to reformat unrecognizable or corrupted media.

Because the VFAT file system requires long filenames to be stored in Unicode/UCS2 format, the standard VFAT file system library supports conversion between UCS2 and Shift-JIS (the standard Palm OS multi-byte character encoding), and the Palm/Latin encoding.

VFS Manager

The VFS (Virtual File System) Manager provides a unified API that gives applications access to many different file systems on many different media types. It abstracts the underlying file systems so that applications can be written without regard to the actual file system in use. The VFS Manager includes APIs for manipulating files, directories, and volumes.

NOTE: Although the great majority of the functions in the VFS Manager can be used by any application, some are intended only for use by slot drivers and file systems. Others are not intended for use by third-party applications but are designed primarily for system use.

The VFS Manager, the Data Manager, and File Streaming APIs

With the addition of the VFS Manager to the Palm OS, there are now three distinct ways applications can store and retrieve Palm OS user data:

- The Data Manager manages user data in the storage heap. It was specifically designed to make the most of the limited dynamic RAM and the nonvolatile RAM used instead of disk storage on most handhelds. Use the Data Manager to store and retrieve Palm OS user data when storage on the handheld is all that is needed, or when efficient access to data is paramount.
- The File Streaming API is a layer on top of the Data Manager that provides file functionality with all data being read from or written to a database in the storage heap. Most

applications have no need for the File Streaming APIs; they are primarily used by applications that need to work with large blocks of data.

- The VFS and Expansion Managers were designed specifically to support many types of expansion memory as secondary storage. The VFS Manager APIs present a consistent interface to many different types of file systems on many types of external media. Applications that use the VFS APIs can support the widest variety of file systems. Use the VFS Manager when your application needs to read and write data stored on external media.

Palm OS applications should use the appropriate APIs for each given situation. The Data Manager, being an efficient manager of storage in the storage heap, should be used whenever access to external media is not absolutely needed. Use the VFS API when interoperability and file system access is needed. Note, however, that the VFS Manager adds the extra overhead of buffering all reads and writes in memory when accessing data, so only applications that specifically need this functionality should use the VFS Manager.

For more information on the Data and Resource Managers, as well as on the File Streaming APIs, see Chapter 7, "Files and Databases." For details of the APIs presented by the VFS Manager, see Chapter 54, "Virtual File System Manager," in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

Expansion Manager

The Expansion Manager is a software layer that manages slot drivers on Palm OS handhelds. Supported expansion card types include, but are not limited to, Memory Stick and SD cards. The Expansion Manager does not support these expansion cards directly; rather, it provides an architecture and higher level set of APIs that, with the help of low level slot drivers and file system libraries, support these types of media.

The Expansion Manager:

- broadcasts notification of card insertion and removal
- plays sounds to signify card insertion and removal
- mounts and unmounts card-resident volumes

NOTE: Some of the other functions provided by the Expansion Manager are for use by slot drivers and file systems and are not generally used by their-party applications.

For details of the APIs presented by the VFS Manager, see Chapter 30, "Expansion Manager," in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

Standard Directories

The user experience presented by the Palm OS is simpler and more intuitive than that of a typical desktop computer. Part of this simplicity arises from the fact that the Palm OS doesn't present a file system to the user. Users don't have to understand the complexities of a typical file system; applications are readily available with one or two taps of a button or icon, and data associated with those applications is accessible only through each application. Maintaining this simplicity of user operation while supporting a file system on an expansion card is made possible through a standard set of directories on the expansion card.

The following table lists the standard directory layout for all "standards compliant" Palm OS secondary storage. All Palm OS relevant data should be in the `/PALM` directory (or in a subdirectory of the `/PALM` directory), effectively partitioning off a private name space.

Directory	Description
/	Root of the secondary storage.
`/PALM`	Most data written by Palm™ applications lives in a subdirectory of this directory. `start.prc` lives directly in `/PALM`. This optional file is automatically run when the secondary storage volume is mounted. Other applications may also reside in this directory.

Directory	Description
/PALM/Backup	Reserved by the Palm OS for backup purposes.
/PALM/Programs	Catch-all for other applications and data.
/PALM/Launcher	Home of Launcher-visible applications.

The Palm OS Launcher has been enhanced to be expansion card aware. When an expansion card containing a file system is inserted, all applications listed in the card's /PALM/Launcher directory are automatically added to a new Launcher category. This new category takes the name of the expansion card volume. Note that the name displayed in the Launcher for a given application is the name in the application's tAIN (application icon name) resource or, if this resource is empty, the database name, which may or may not match the name of the file.

NOTE: Whenever possible give the same name to the .prc file and to the database. If the .prc filename differs from the database name, and users copy your application from the card to the handheld and then to another card, the filename may change. This is because the database name is used when an application is copied from the handheld to the card.

When a writable volume is mounted, the Launcher automatically creates the /PALM and /PALM/Launcher directories if they don't already exist. If they do, and if there are applications present in the /PALM/Launcher directory, the Launcher automatically switches to the card's list of applications unless it runs start.prc.

In addition to these standard directories, the VFS Manager supports the concept of a **default directory**; a directory in which data of a particular type is typically stored. See "Determining the Default Directory for a Particular File Type" on page 231 for more information.

Applications on Cards

Palm OS applications located in the `/PALM/Launcher` directory of an expansion card volume appear in a separate Launcher category when the card is inserted into the handheld's expansion slot. If you tap the icon for one of these applications, it is copied to main memory and then launched.

Applications launched from a card ("card-launched" applications) are first sent a `sysAppLaunchCmdCardLaunch` launch code, along with a parameter block that includes the reference number of the volume on which the application resides and the complete path to the application. When processing this launch code, the application shouldn't interact with the user or access globals. Unless the application sets the `sysAppLaunchStartFlagNoUISwitch` bit in the `start` flags (which are part of the parameter block), the application is then sent a `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch` launch code. This is when the application should, if it needs to, interact with user. Applications may want to save some state when `sysAppLaunchCmdCardLaunch` is received, then act upon that state information when `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch` is received.

When the user switches to a new application, the card-launched application is removed from main memory. Note, however, that any databases created by the card-launched application remain.

There are certain implications to this "copy and run" process.

- There must be sufficient memory for the application. If the handheld doesn't have enough memory to receive the application, it isn't copied from the expansion card and it isn't launched.
- The copying process takes time. For large applications, this can cause a noticeable delay before the application is actually launched.
- If some version of the application on the card is already present in main memory, the Launcher puts up a dialog that requires the user to choose whether or not to overwrite the in-memory version.

- Card-launched applications have a limited lifetime: applications reside in main memory only while they are running. When the user switches to a different application, the card-launched application that was just running is removed from main memory. If the card-launched application is then re-launched, it is once again copied into the handheld's memory.
- "Legacy" applications—those that are unaware that they are being launched from a card—only work with databases in main memory. Associated databases aren't copied to main memory along with the application unless the database is bundled with the application. Databases created by card-launched applications are not removed along with the application, however, so this data is available to the application when it is subsequently run. Applications that are written to take advantage of the VFS Manager can read and write data on the expansion card, so this limitation generally only applies to legacy applications.

  Bundled databases, although copied to main memory along with their associated application, are meant for static data that doesn't change, such as a game level database. Bundled databases are not copied back to the card; they are simply deleted from memory when the user chooses another application. To bundle a database with an application, give it the same creator ID as the owning application, set the `dmHdrAttrBundle` bit, and place it in the `/PALM/Launcher` directory along with the application.
- Unless a card-launched application is running, it doesn't receive notifications or launch codes since it isn't present on the handheld. In particular, these applications don't receive notifications and aren't informed when an alarm is triggered.

Card Insertion and Removal

The Expansion Manager supports the insertion and removal of expansion media at any time. The handheld continues to run as before, though an application switch may occur upon card insertion. The handheld need not be reset or otherwise explicitly informed that a card has been inserted or removed.

WARNING! Due to the way certain expansion cards are constructed, if the user removes an expansion card while it is being written to, in certain rare circumstances it is possible for the card to become damaged to the point where either it can no longer be used or it must be reformatted. To the greatest extent possible, applications should only write to the card at well-defined points, and the application should warn the user—perhaps with a "Please Wait" or progress dialog—at that time not to remove the expansion card. The card can be removed while an application is reading from it without fear of damage.

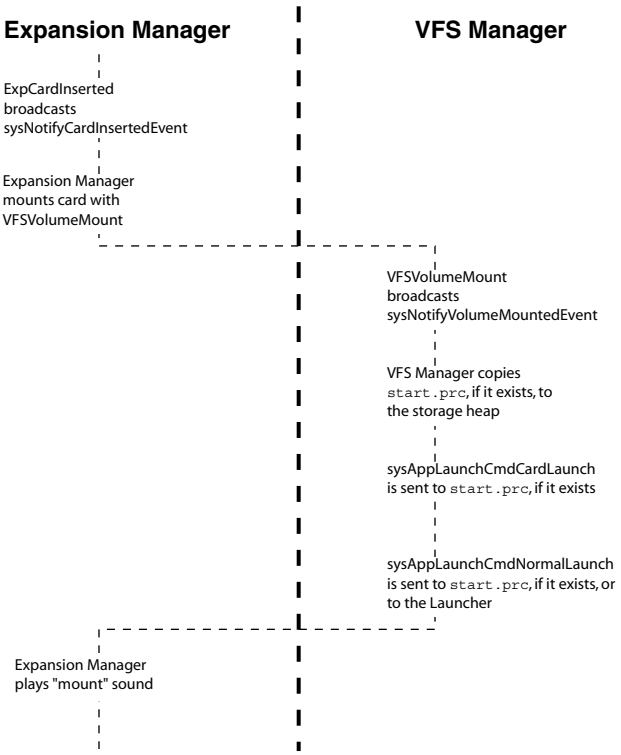
The Palm OS uses a series of notifications to indicate that a card has been inserted or removed, or that a volume has been mounted or unmounted. The following table lists these notifications, and the priority for which they have been registered by the Expansion and VFS Managers. Note that the priorities may change in a future release, so applications shouldn't depend on these precise values. Applications that register for these using normal priority get the correct behavior.

Table 8.1 Expansion card notifications

Notification	Registered by	Priority
sysNotifyCardInsertedEvent	Exp. Manager	20
sysNotifyCardRemovedEvent	Exp. Manager	-20
sysNotifyVolumeMountedEvent	Exp. Manager	-20
sysNotifyVolumeMountedEvent	VFS Manager	10
sysNotifyVolumeUnmountedEvent	Exp. Manager	-20

The following diagram shows the sequence of events that occur when an expansion card is inserted into a Palm Powered handheld's expansion slot. For clarity, it assumes that no errors occur. If the card doesn't contain a mountable volume, and if the card cannot be formatted and then mounted, this sequence is aborted and the card remains unmounted, although the card insertion notification is still broadcast.

Figure 8.2 Sequence of events upon card insertion



The Expansion Manager registers for `sysNotifyCardInsertedEvent` with a priority of 20, ensuring that it is notified after other handlers that may have registered with normal priority. To override the Expansion Manager's default handler, register your handler to receive `sysNotifyCardInsertedEvent` with normal priority, and have it set the appropriate bits in the `handled` member of the `SysNotifyParamType` structure:

- `expHandledVolume` indicates that any volumes associated with the card have been dealt with, and prevents the Expansion Manager from mounting or unmounting the card's volumes.
- `expHandledSound` indicates that your application has handled the playing of an appropriate sound, and prevents the Expansion Manager from playing a sound when the card is inserted or removed.

Note that the number of the slot into which the card was inserted is passed to your handler using the `notifyDetailsP` member—which is a `UInt16`, cast to a `void *`—of the `SysNotifyParamType` structure.

Although most applications only register for volume mount and unmount notifications, if you need to receive notifications when the user removes a card from a slot managed by the Expansion Manager, have your application register to receive `sysNotifyCardRemovedEvent`. Unlike with `sysNotifyCardInsertedEvent`, the Expansion Manager registers for `sysNotifyCardRemovedEvent` with a priority of -20, ensuring that it receives the notification before other handlers that are registered for it with normal priority. This notification, too, passes the number of the slot from which the card was removed to your handler using the `notifyDetailsP` member—which is a `UInt16`, cast to a `void *`—of the `SysNotifyParamType` structure.

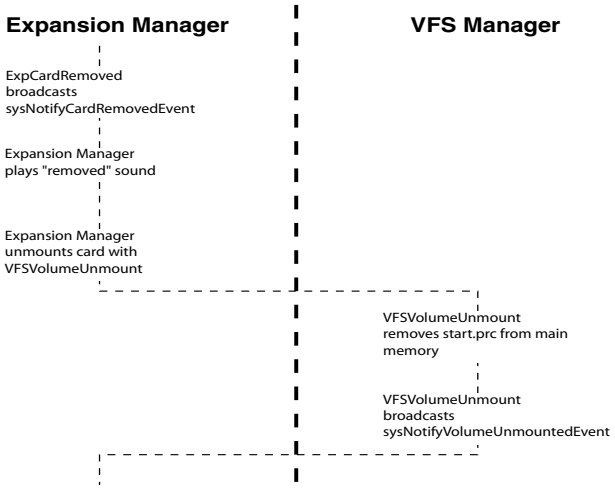
The VFS Manager registers for `sysNotifyVolumeMountedEvent` with a priority of 10. To override the VFS Manager's default handler, register your handler to receive `sysNotifyVolumeMountedEvent` with normal priority, and have it set the appropriate bits in the `handled` member of the `SysNotifyParamType` structure:

- `vfsHandledUIAppSwitch` indicates that your application has handled `SysUIAppSwitch` to `start.prc`. This bit prevents the VFS Manager from performing its own `SysUIAppSwitch` to `start.prc` (although `start.prc` is still loaded and a `SysAppLaunch` is performed), and also prevents the launcher from switching to itself.
- `vfsHandledStartPrc` indicates that your handler has dealt with the automatic running of `start.prc`. The VFS Manager won't load it and won't call either `SysAppLaunch` or `SysUIAppSwitch`.

Note that if your application handles the running of `start.prc`, you need to keep security in mind. If the handheld is locked when an expansion card is inserted, the VFS Manager's own handler defers the execution of `start.prc` until the user unlocks the handheld.

Card removal follows a similar sequence, although there is no equivalent to `start.prc` that is automatically run. This sequence is illustrated in the following diagram.

Figure 8.3 Sequence of events upon card removal



Upon card removal, the Expansion Manager broadcasts a notification to all applications that have registered to receive card removal notifications and unmounts any mounted volumes on the card. This causes the VFS Manager to issue a card unmounted notification. Each application must register for the card unmounted notification and provide the necessary error handling code if card removal at any time will cause a problem for the application.

Note that the card insertion and removal notifications are intended primarily for system use, although they can be registered for by applications that need them. Applications that deal only with file systems and the VFS Manager should confine themselves to the volume mounted and unmounted notifications.

Start.prc

Upon receipt of a `sysNotifyVolumeMountedEvent` that hasn't already been handled (as indicated by the state of the `vfsHandledStartPrc` bit, as described in the previous section),

the VFS Manager copies `/Palm/start.prc`—and its overlay, if there is one—to the storage heap and launches it. This process enables "application cards"—single-function cards that execute automatically upon card insertion. It also allows for combo cards that automatically load any necessary drivers and applications to support card I/O.

To launch `start.prc`, the VFS Manager first sends it a special launch code, `sysAppLaunchCmdCardLaunch`. If the application only needs to do a bit of work and return, it should do it here and then set the `sysAppLaunchStartFlagNoUISwitch` bit in the start flags, which are part of the `sysAppLaunchCmdCardLaunch` parameter block. Note that the application doesn't have access to globals and it shouldn't interact with the user here. If the `sysAppLaunchStartFlagNoUISwitch` bit is not set, as it isn't if the application ignores the `sysAppLaunchCmdCardLaunch` launch code, the VFS Manager then sends it a `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch` launch code to run the application normally. This ensures backwards compatibility with applications that do not understand the `sysAppLaunchCmdCardLaunch` launch code. This is where the application can interact with the user; an application may want to save state when it receives `sysAppLaunchCmdCardLaunch`, and then act upon that state when it receives `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch`.

To avoid running out of stack space, the VFS Manager sets the "new stack" bit when launching `start.prc`. The `start.prc` application remains in system memory until the volume from which it was copied is removed. `start.prc` is deleted before `VFSVolumeUnmount` broadcasts `sysNotifyVolumeUnmountedEvent` but after the Expansion Manager broadcasts `sysNotifyCardRemovedEvent`. By registering for `sysNotifyCardRemovedEvent`, `start.prc` can react to the volume being removed before it is deleted.

NOTE: If an expansion card is inserted while the handheld is locked, `start.prc` is not executed until the user unlocks the handheld.

Checking for Expansion Cards

Before looking for an expansion card, your program should first make sure that the handheld supports expansion by verifying the presence of the Expansion and VFS Managers. It can then query for mounted volumes. Finally, your program may want to ascertain the capabilities of the card; whether it has memory, whether it does I/O, and so on. The following sections describe each of these steps.

Verifying Handheld Compatibility

There are many different Palm OS handhelds, and in the future there will be many more. Some will have expansion slots to support secondary storage, and some will not. Hardware to support secondary storage is optional, and may or may not be present on a given handheld. Since the Expansion and VFS Managers are of no use on a handheld that has no physical expansion capability, they are optional system extensions that are not present on every Palm Powered handheld.

Due to the great variability both in handheld configuration and in the modules which can be plugged into or snapped onto the handheld, applications shouldn't attempt to detect the manufacturer or model of a specific handheld when determining if it supports secondary storage. Instead, check for the presence and capabilities of the underlying operating system.

The VFS Manager and the Expansion Manager are individual system extensions that are both optional. They both make use of other parts of the operating system that were introduced in Palm OS 4.0. Thus, in order to be fully capable of running an application that relies on the Expansion and VFS Managers, the following all have to be true for a given handheld:

- The handheld must be running Palm OS 4.0[2].
- The Expansion Manager must be present.
- The VFS Manager must be present.

2. The Sony CLIÉ™ handheld running Palm OS 3.5 uses a version of the Expansion and VFS Managers. Sony's version of these managers is binary compatible with those included with Palm OS 4.0.

Appendix B, "Compatibility Guide," details how to verify the presence of each:

- 4.0 New Feature Set begins by illustrating how to verify that the handheld is running Palm OS 4.0.
- Expansion Manager Feature Set shows how to check for the presence of the Expansion Manager.
- VFS Manager Feature Set shows how to check for the presence of the VFS Manager.

Although your program could check for the presence of all of the above, it can take advantage of the fact that the VFS Manager relies on the Expansion Manager and won't be present without it. Thus, if the VFS Manager is present, you can safely assume that the Expansion Manager is present as well.

Checking for Mounted Volumes

Many applications rely on the handheld's expansion capabilities for additional storage. Applications that don't care about the physical characteristics of the secondary storage module, and that don't need to know the slot into which the module is inserted, can rely on the fact that the Palm OS automatically mounts any recognized volumes inserted into or snapped onto the handheld. Thus, many applications can simply enumerate the mounted volumes and select one as appropriate. The following code illustrates how to do this:

Listing 8.1 Enumerating mounted volumes

```
UInt16 volRefNum;
UInt32 volIterator = vfsIteratorStart;

while (volIterator != vfsIteratorStop) {
   err = VFSVolumeEnumerate(&volRefNum, &volIterator);
   if (err == errNone) {
      // Do something with the volRefNum
   } else {
      // handle error... possibly by
      // breaking out of the loop
   }
}
```

The volume reference number obtained from VFSVolumeEnumerate can then be used with many of the volume, directory, and file operations that are described later in this chapter.

Occasionally an application needs to know more than that there is secondary storage available for use. Those applications likely need to take a few extra steps, beginning with checking each of the handheld's slots.

Enumerating Slots

Before you can determine which expansion modules are attached to a Palm OS handheld, you must first determine how those modules could be attached. Expansion cards and some I/O devices could be plugged into physical slots, and snap-on modules could be connected through the handheld's universal connector. Irrespective of how they're physically connected, the Expansion Manager presents these to the developer as slots. Enumerating these slots is made simple due to the presence of the ExpSlotEnumerate function. The use of this function is illustrated here:

Listing 8.2 Iterating through a handheld's expansion slots

```
UInt16 slotRefNum;
UInt32 slotIterator = expIteratorStart;

while (slotIterator != expIteratorStop) {
   // Get the slotRefNum for the next slot
   err = ExpSlotEnumerate(&slotRefNum, &slotIterator);
   if(err == errNone) {
      // perform slot-specific processing here
   } else {
      // handle error... possibly by
      // breaking out of the loop
}
```

The slot reference number returned by `ExpSlotEnumerate` uniquely identifies a given slot. This can be supplied to various Expansion Manager functions to obtain information about the slot, such as whether there is a card or other expansion module present in the slot.

Checking a Slot for the Presence of a Card

Use the ExpCardPresent function to determine if a card is present in a given slot. Given the slot reference number, this function returns errNone if there is a card in the slot, or an error if either there is no card in the slot or there is a problem with the specified slot.

Determining a Card's Capabilities

Just knowing that an expansion card is inserted into a slot or connected to the handheld isn't enough; your application needs to know something about the card to ensure that the operations it needs to perform are compatible with the card. For instance, if your application needs to write data to the card, its important to know if writing is permitted.

The capabilities available to your application depend not only on the card but on the slot driver as well. Handheld manufacturers will provide one or more slot drivers that define standard interfaces to certain classes of expansion hardware. Card and device manufacturers may also choose to provide card-specific slot drivers, or they may require that applications use the slot custom control function and a registered creator code to access and control certain cards.

The slot driver is responsible for querying expansion cards for a standard set of capabilities. When a slot driver is present for a given expansion card, you can use the ExpCardInfo function to determine the following:

- the name of the expansion card's manufacturer
- the name of the expansion card
- the "device class," or type of expansion card. Values returned here might include "Ethernet" or "Backup"
- a unique identifier for the device, such as a serial number
- whether the card supports both reading and writing, or whether it is read-only
- whether the card supports a simple serial interface

Note that the existence of the ExpCardInfo function does not imply that all expansion cards support these capabilities. It only means that the slot driver is able to assess a card and report its findings up to the Expansion Manager.

Volume Operations

If an expansion card supports a file system, the VFS Manager allows you to perform a number of standard volume operations. To determine which volumes are currently mounted and available, use `VFSVolumeEnumerate`. This function, the use of which is illustrated in "Checking for Mounted Volumes" on page 214, returns a volume reference number that you then to supply to the remainder of the volume operations.

When the user inserts a card containing a mountable volume into a slot (note that the current implementation only supports one volume per slot), the VFS Manager attempts to mount the volume automatically. You should rarely, if ever, have to mount volumes directly. You can attempt to mount a volume using a different file system, however, perhaps after installing a new file system driver on the handheld. To explicitly mount or unmount a volume, use `VFSVolumeMount` and `VFSVolumeUnmount`. When mounting a volume, you can either specify an explicit file system with which to mount the volume, or you can request that the VFS Manager try to determine the appropriate file system. If the VFS Manager cannot mount the volume using any of the available file systems, it attempts to format the volume using a file system deemed appropriate for the slot, and then mount it. See the description of `VFSVolumeMount` in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for the precise arguments you must supply when explicitly mounting a volume.

Use `VFSVolumeFormat` to format a volume. This function can be used to change the file system on the expansion card; you can explicitly indicate a file system to use when formatting it. Once the card has been formatted, the VFS Manager automatically mounts it; a new volume reference number is returned from `VFSVolumeFormat`.

The `VFSVolumeGetLabel` and `VFSVolumeSetLabel` functions get and set the volume label, respectively. Since the file system is responsible for verifying the validity of strings, you can try to set the volume label to any desired value. If the file system doesn't natively support the name given, the VFS Manager creates the `/VOLUME.NAM` file used to support long volume names (see "Naming

Volumes" on page 219 for more information) or you get an error back if the file system doesn't support the supplied string.

Additional information about the volume can be obtained through the use of `VFSVolumeSize` and `VFSVolumeInfo`. As the name implies, `VFSVolumeSize` returns size information about the volume. In particular, it returns both the total amount of space on the volume, in bytes, and the amount of that volume's space that is currently in use, again in bytes. `VFSVolumeInfo` returns various pieces of information about the volume, including:

- whether the volume is hidden
- whether the volume is read-only
- whether the volume is supported by a slot driver, or is being simulated by the Palm OS Emulator
- the type and creator of the underlying file system
- the slot with which the volume is associated, and the reference number of the slot driver controlling the slot
- the type of media on which this volume is located, such as SD, CompactFlash, or Memory Stick

All of the above information is returned encapsulated within a `VolumeInfoType` structure. Whether the volume is hidden or read-only is further encoded into a single field within this structure; see Volume Attributes in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for the bits that make up this field.

Hidden Volumes

Included among the volume attributes is a "hidden" bit, `vfsVolumeAttrHidden`, that indicates whether the volume on the card is to be visible or hidden. Hidden volumes are typically not meant to be directly available to the user; the Launcher and the CardInfo application both ignore all hidden volumes.

To make a volume hidden, simply create an empty file named `HIDDEN.VOL` in the `/PALM` directory. The `VFSVolumeInfo` function looks for this file and, if found, returns the `vfsVolumeAttrHidden` bit along with the volume's other attributes.

Matching Volumes to Slots

Many applications don't need to know the specifics of an expansion card as provided by the ExpCardInfo function. Often, the information provided by the VFSVolumeInfo function is enough. Some applications need to know more about a particular volume, however. The name of the manufacturer or the type of card, for instance, may be important.

The VolumeInfoType structure returned from VFSVolumeInfo contains a slotRefNum field that can be passed to ExpCardInfo. This allows you to obtain specific information about the card on which a particular volume is located.

Although slot drivers currently only support one volume per slot, obtaining volume information that corresponds to a given slot reference number isn't quite so simple, since there isn't a function that returns the volume reference number given a slot reference number. You can, however, iterate through the mounted volumes and check each volume's slot reference number. This is the technique that the CardInfo application uses.

Naming Volumes

Different file system libraries support volume names of different maximum lengths and have different restrictions on character sets. The file system library is responsible for verifying whether or not a given volume name is valid, and returns an error if it is not. From a Palm OS developer's standpoint, volume names can be up to 255 characters long, and can include any printable character.

The file system library is responsible for translating the volume name into a format that is acceptable to the underlying file system. For example, in a file system where the 8.3 naming convention is used for filenames, to translate a long volume name the first eleven valid, non-space characters are used. Valid characters in this instance are A-Z, 0-9, $, %, ', -, _, @, ~, ', !, (,), ^, #, and &.

When the underlying file system doesn't support a long volume name, VFSVolumeSetLabel creates the file /VOLUME.NAM in an effort to preserve the long volume name. This file contains the following, in order:

Field	Description
`Char cookie[4]`	4 byte cookie that identifies this file. The value of this cookie is `vfsVolumeNameFileCookie`.
`UInt16 cacheLen`	Big-endian length, in bytes, of the cached file-system-level volume label.
`Char cacheLabel[cacheLen]`	Unicode UCS-2 format string containing the volume label as it is stored in the file system layer. This is compared with the file system volume label to see if the user has changed the volume label on a device that doesn't support the `/VOLUME.NAM` file. In this event, the file system volume label is used; the contents of `/VOLUME.NAM` are ignored.
`UInt16 length`	Big-endian length, in bytes, of the long volume label.
`Char label[length]`	Unicode UCS-2 format string containing the long volume label.

File Operations

All of the familiar operations you'd use to operate on files in a desktop application are supported by the VFS Manager; these are listed in "Common Operations," below. In addition, the VFS Manager includes a set of functions that simplify the way you work with files that represent Palm databases (`.pdb`) or Palm resource databases (`.prc`). These are covered in "Working with Palm Databases" on page 223.

Common Operations

The VFS Manager provides all of the standard file operations that should be familiar from desktop and larger computer systems. Because these functions work largely as you would expect, their use isn't detailed here. See the descriptions of each individual function in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for the arguments, return values, and side effects of each.

Note that some of these functions can be applied to both files and directories, while others work only with files.

Table 8.2 Common file operations

Function	Description
VFSFileOpen	Open a file, given a volume reference number and a file path.
VFSFileClose	Close an open file.
VFSFileRead	Read data from a file into the dynamic heap or any writable memory.
VFSFileReadData	Read data from a file into a chunk of memory in the storage heap.
VFSFileWrite	Write data to an open file.
VFSFileSeek	Set the position within an open file from which to read or write.
VFSFileTell	Get the current position of the file pointer within an open file.
VFSFileEOF	Get the end-of-file status for an open file.
VFSFileCreate	Create a file, given a volume reference number and a file path.
VFSFileDelete	Delete a closed file.
VFSFileRename	Rename a closed file.
VFSFileSize	Obtain the size of an open file.

Table 8.2 Common file operations *(continued)*

Function	Description
VFSFileResize	Change the size of an open file.
VFSFileGetAttributes	Obtain the attributes of an open file, including hidden, read-only, system, and archive bits. See "File and Directory Attributes" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for the bits that make up the attributes field.
VFSFileSetAttributes	Set the attributes of an open file, including hidden, read-only, system, and archive bits.
VFSFileGetDate	Get the created, modified, and last accessed dates for an open file.
VFSFileSetDate	Set the created, modified, and last accessed dates for an open file.

Once a file has been opened, it is identified by a unique reference number: a FileRef. Functions that work with open files take a file reference. Others, such as VFSFileOpen, require a volume reference and a path that identifies the file within the volume. Note that all paths are volume relative, **and absolute within that volume**: the VFS Manager has no concept of a "current working directory," so relative path names are not supported. The directory separator character is the forward slash: "/". The root directory for the specified volume is specified by a path of "/".

Naming Files

Different file systems support filenames and paths of different maximum lengths. The file system library is responsible for verifying whether or not a given path is valid and returns an error if it is not valid. From an application developer's standpoint, filenames can be up to 255 characters long and can include any

normal character including spaces and lower case characters in any character set. They can also include the following special characters:

```
$ % ' - _ @ ~ '! ( ) ^ # & + , ; = [ ]
```

The file system library is responsible for translating each filename and path into a format that is acceptable to the underlying file system. For example, when the 8.3 naming convention is used to translate a long filename, the following guidelines are used:

- The name is created from the first six valid, non-space characters which appear before the last period. The only valid characters are A-Z, 0-9, $, %, ‘, -, _, @, ~, ‘, !, (,), ^, #, and &.
- The extension is the first three valid characters after the last period.
- The end of the six byte name has “~1” appended to it for the first occurrence of the shortened filename. Each subsequent occurrence uses the next unique number, so the second occurrence would have “~2” appended, and so on.

The standard VFAT file system library provided with all Palm Powered devices that support expansion uses the above rules to create FAT-compliant names from long filenames.

Working with Palm Databases

Expansion cards are often used to hold Palm applications and data in `.prc` and `.pdb` format. Due to the way that secondary storage media are connected to the Palm Powered handheld, applications cannot be run directly from the expansion card, nor can databases be manipulated using the Data Manager without first transferring them to main memory. Applications written to use the VFS Manager, however, can operate directly on files located on an expansion card.

NOTE: Whenever possible give the same name to the `.prc` file and to the database. If the `.prc` filename differs from the database name, and the user copies your application from the card to the handheld and then to another card, the filename may change. This is because the database name is used when an application is copied from the handheld to the card.

Stand-Alone Applications

To allow the user to run an application that is self-contained—that isn't accompanied by a separate database—you need only do one of two things:

- If the application is to be run whenever the card is inserted into the expansion slot, simply name the application `start.prc` and place it in the `/PALM` directory. The operating system takes care of transferring the application to main memory and starting it automatically.
- If the application is to be run on-demand, place it in the `/PALM/Launcher` directory. All applications located in this directory appear in the launcher when the user selects the category bearing the name of the expansion card.

Both of these mechanisms allow applications that were written without any knowledge of the VFS or Expansion Manager APIs to be run from a card. Because they are transferred to main memory prior to being run, such applications need not know that they are being run from an expansion card. Databases created by these applications are placed in the storage heap, as usual. When the card containing the application is removed, the application disappears from main memory unless it is running, in which case it remains until such time as the application is no longer running. Any databases it created remain. When the card is re-inserted and the application re-run, it is once again copied into main memory and is able to access those databases.

Applications with Static Data

Many applications are accompanied by one or more associated Palm databases when installed. These applications, at least to a limited degree, need to be cognizant of the fact that they reside on an expansion card.

If there is no specific requirement for the application's data to be stored in Palm database format, you may want to use the VFS Manager's many file I/O operations to read and write the data on the card. Because of the large data storage capabilities of the expansion media relative to the handheld's memory, this latter solution is the one preferred by applications where large capacity data storage is a key feature.

Bundled Databases

When an application is launched from a card using the launcher, any bundled databases present in the `/PALM/Launcher` directory are also imported. Bundled databases have the same creator as the "owning" application and have the `dmHdrAttrBundle` bit set. Note that bundled databases are intended only for read-only data, such as a game-level database. Bundled databases are removed from main memory along with the application when the user switches to another application and are not copied back to the expansion card.

Transferring Palm Databases to and from Expansion Cards

The `VFSExportDatabaseToFile` function converts a database from its internal format on the handheld to its equivalent `.prc` or `.pdb` file format and transfers it to an expansion card. The `VFSImportDatabaseFromFile` function does the reverse; it transfers the `.prc` or `.pdb` file to main memory and converts it to the internal format used by the Palm OS. Use these functions when moving Palm databases between main memory and an expansion card. These two functions rely upon Exchange Manager routines to convert and transfer the data; see Chapter 1, "Object Exchange" in *Palm OS Programmer's Companion*, vol. II, *Communications* for more information on using the Exchange Manager to send and receive data.

The `VFSExportDatabaseToFile` and `VFSImportDatabaseFromFile` routines are atomic and, depending on the size of the database and the mechanism by which it is being transferred, can take some time. Use `VFSExportDatabaseToFileCustom` and `VFSImportDatabaseFromFileCustom` if you want to display a progress dialog or allow the user to cancel the operation. These routines make repeated calls to a callback function that you specify; within this callback function you can update a progress indicator. The return value from your callback determines whether the database transfer should proceed; return `errNone` if it should continue, or return any other value to abort the process. See the documentation for `VFSExportProcPtr` and `VFSImportProcPtr` in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for the format of each callback function.

The following code excerpt illustrates the use of `VFSImportDatabaseFromFileCustom` with a progress tracker.

Listing 8.3 Using VFSImportDatabaseFromFileCustom

```
typedef struct {
   ProgressType *progressP;
   const Char   *nameP;
} CBDataType, *CBDataPtr;

static Boolean ProgressTextCB(PrgCallbackDataPtr cbP) {
   const Char *nameP = ((CBDataPtr) cbP->userDataP)->nameP;

   // Set up the progress text to be displayed
   StrPrintF(cbP->textP, "Importing %s.", nameP);
   cbP->textChanged = true;

   return true;  // So what we specify here is used to update the dialog
}

static Err CopyProgressCB(UInt32 size, UInt32 offset, void *userDataP) {
   CBDataPtr CBDataP = (CBDataPtr) userDataP;

   if (offset == 0) {  // If we're just starting, we need to set up the dialog
      CBDataP->progressP = PrgStartDialog("Importing Database", ProgressTextCB,
         CBDataP);

      if (!CBDataP->progressP)
         return memErrNotEnoughSpace;
   } else {
      EventType event;
      Boolean   handled;

      do {
         EvtGetEvent(&event, 0);  // Check for events

         handled = PrgHandleEvent(CBDataP->progressP, &event);

         if (!handled) {  // Did the user tap the "Cancel" button?
            if( PrgUserCancel(CBDataP->progressP) )
               return exgErrUserCancel;
         }
      } while(event.eType != sysEventNilEvent);
   }

   return errNone;
}
```

```
static Err ImportFile(UInt16 volRefNum, Char *pathP, Char *nameP,
   UInt16 *cardNoP, LocalID *dbIDP)
{
   CBDataType userData;
   Char       fullPathP[256];
   Err        err;

   userData.progressP = NULL;
   userData.nameP = nameP;

   StrPrintF(fullPathP, "%s/%s", pathP, nameP); // rebuild full path to the
file
   err = VFSImportDatabaseFromFileCustom(volRefNum, fullPathP, cardNoP, dbIDP,
      CopyProgressCB, &userData);

   if (userData.progressP) // If the progress dialog was displayed, remove it.
      PrgStopDialog(userData.progressP, (err == exgErrUserCancel) );

   return err;
}
```

Exploring Palm Databases on Expansion Cards

The VFS Manager includes functions specifically designed for exploring the contents of a Palm database located on an expansion card. This access is read-only, however. You can extract individual records and resources from a database, and you can determine information such as the last modification date of a database on an expansion card. But there aren't parallel functions to write records and resources to a database or to update database-specific information for a database that is located on an expansion card. To do this you need to import the database into main memory, make the necessary changes, and then export it back to the expansion card.

To obtain a single record from a database located on an expansion card without first importing the database into main memory, use VFSFileDBGetRecord. This function is analogous to DmGetRecord but works with files on an external card rather than with databases in main memory. It transfers the specified record to the storage heap after allocating a handle of the appropriate size. Note that you'll need to free this memory, using MemHandleFree, when the record is no longer needed.

The VFSFileDBGetResource function operates in a similar fashion, but instead of loading a particular database record it loads a specified resource from a resource database located on an expansion card. This resource is put onto the storage heap. Again, free this memory once the resource is no longer needed.

To obtain more general information about a database on an external card, use VFSFileDBInfo. In addition to the information you could obtain about any file on an external card using the VFSFileGetAttributes and VFSFileGetDate functions, VFSFileDBInfo returns:

- the database name
- the version of the database
- the number of times the database was modified
- the application info block handle
- the sort info block handle
- the database's type
- the database's creator
- the number of records in the database

NOTE: The functions described in this section incur a lot of overhead in order to parse the database file format. Frequent use of these functions is not recommended. Also, if you request either the application info block handle or the sort info block handle, you must free the handle when it is no longer needed.

Directory Operations

All of the familiar operations you'd use to operate on directories are supported by the VFS Manager; these are listed in "Common Operations", below. One common operation—determining the files that are contained within a given directory—is covered in some detail in "Enumerating the Files in a Directory" on page 230. To improve data interchange with devices that aren't running the Palm OS, expansion card manufacturers have specified default directories for certain file types. "Determining the Default Directory for a

Particular File Type" on page 231 discusses how you can both determine and set the default directory for a given file type.

Directory Paths

All paths are volume relative, **and absolute within that volume**: the VFS Manager has no concept of a "current working directory," so relative path names are not supported. The directory separator character is the forward slash: "/". The root directory for the specified volume is specified by a path of "/".

Common Operations

The VFS Manager provides all of the standard directory operations that should be familiar from desktop and larger computer systems. Because these functions work largely as you would expect, their use isn't detailed here. See the descriptions of each individual function in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for the arguments, return values, and side effects of each.

Note that most of these functions can be applied to files as well as directories.

Table 8.3 Common directory operations

Function	Description
VFSDirCreate	Create a new directory.
VFSFileDelete	Delete a directory, given a path.
VFSFileRename	Rename a directory.
VFSFileOpen	Open the file or directory.
VFSFileClose	Close the file or directory.
VFSFileGetAttributes	Obtain the attributes of an open directory, including hidden, read-only, system, and archive bits. See "File and Directory Attributes" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for the bits that make up the attributes field.

Table 8.3 Common directory operations

Function	Description
VFSFileSetAttributes	Set the attributes of an open directory, including hidden, read-only, system, and archive bits.
VFSFileGetDate	Get the created, modified, and last accessed dates for an open file.
VFSFileSetDate	Set the created, modified, and last accessed dates for an open file.

Enumerating the Files in a Directory

Enumerating the files within a directory is made simple due to the presence of the VFSDirEntryEnumerate function. The use of this function is illustrated below. Note that `volRefNum` and `dirPathStr` must be declared and initialized prior to the following code.

Listing 8.4 Enumerating a directory's contents

```
// Open the directory and iterate through the files in it.
// volRefNum must have already been defined.
err = VFSFileOpen(volRefNum, "/", vfsModeRead, &dirRef);
if(err == errNone) {
   // Iterate through all the files in the open directory
   UInt32 fileIterator;
   FileInfoType fileInfo;
   FileRef dirRef;
   Char *fileName = MemPtrNew(256);   // should check for err

   fileInfo.nameP = fileName;    // point to local buffer
   fileInfo.nameBufLen = sizeof(fileName);
   fileIterator = expIteratorStart;
   while (fileIterator != expIteratorStop) {
      // Get the next file
      err = VFSDirEntryEnumerate(dirRef, &fileIterator,
            &fileInfo);
      if(err == errNone) {
         // Process the file here.
      }
```

```
   } else {
      // handle directory open error here
   }
   MemPtrFree(fileName);
}
```

Each time through the while loop, `VFSDirEntryEnumerate` sets the `FileInfoType` structure as appropriate for the file currently being enumerated. Note that if you want the file name it isn't enough to simply allocate space for the `FileInfoType` structure; you must also allocate a buffer for the filename, set the appropriate pointer to it in the `FileInfoType` structure, and specify your buffer's length. Since the only other information encapsulated within `FileInfoType` is the file's attributes, most applications will want to also know the file's name.

Determining the Default Directory for a Particular File Type

As explained in "Standard Directories" on page 204, the expansion capabilities of Palm OS 4.0 include a mechanism to map MIME types or file extensions to specific directory names. This mechanism is specific to the slot driver: where an image might be stored in the "/Images" directory on a Memory Stick, on an MMC card it may be stored in the "/DCIM" directory. The VFS Manager includes a function that enables you to get the default directory on a particular volume for a given file extension or MIME type, along with functions that allow you to register and un-register your own default directories.

The `VFSGetDefaultDirectory` function takes a volume reference and a string containing the file extension or MIME type and returns a string containing the full path to the corresponding default directory. When specifying the file type, either supply a MIME media type/subtype pair, such as "image/jpeg", "text/plain", or "audio/basic"; or a file extension, such as "`.jpeg`". As with most other Palm OS functions, you'll need to pre-allocate a buffer to contain the returned path. Supply a pointer to this buffer along with the buffer's length. The length is updated upon return to indicate the actual length of the path, which won't exceed the originally-specified buffer length.

The default directory registered for a given file type is intended to be the "root" default directory. If a given default directory has one or more subdirectories, applications should also search those subdirectories for files of the appropriate type.

`VFSGetDefaultDirectory` allows you to determine the directory associated with a particular file suffix. However, there's no way to get the entire list of file suffixes that are mapped to default directories. For this reason, CardInfo keeps its own list of possible file suffixes. It iterates through this list, calling `VFSGetDefaultDirectory` for each file suffix to get the full path to the corresponding default directory. It then looks into each default directory for files that match the expected suffix or suffixes for that directory.

Registering New Default Directories

In addition to the default directories that the underlying slot driver is already aware of, you can create your own mappings between files of a given type and a specific directory on a particular kind of external storage card. Most applications don't need this functionality; it is generally used by a slot driver to register those files and media types that are supported by that slot driver. However, `VFSRegisterDefaultDirectory` and its opposite, `VFSUnregisterDefaultDirectory`, are available to those applications that need them. Such applications should generally register the desired file types for `expMediaType_Any`. This is a wildcard which works for all media types; it can be overridden by a registration that specifies a real media type.

If a default directory has already been registered for a given file/media type combination, applications should use the pre-existing registration instead of establishing a new one. Existing registrations should generally not be removed.

Default Directories Registered at Initialization

The VFS Manager registers the following under the `expMediaType_Any` media type, which `VFSGetDefaultDirectory` reverts to when there is no default registered by the slot driver for a given media type.

Table 8.4 Default registrations

File Type	Path
.prc	/PALM/Launcher/
.pdb	/PALM/Launcher/
.pqa	/PALM/Launcher/
application/vnd.palm	/PALM/Launcher/
.jpg	/DCIM/
.jpeg	/DCIM/
image/jpeg	/DCIM/
.gif	/DCIM/
image/gif	/DCIM/
.qt	/DCIM/
.mov	/DCIM/
video/quicktime	/DCIM/
.avi	/DCIM/
video/x-msvideo	/DCIM/
.mpg	/DCIM/
.mpeg	/DCIM/
video/mpeg	/DCIM/
.mp3	/AUDIO/
.wav	/AUDIO/
audio/x-wav	/AUDIO/

The SD slot driver provided by Palm, Inc. registers the following, since it has an appropriate specification for these file types:

Table 8.5 Directories registered by the SD slot driver

File Type	Path
.jpg	/DCIM/
.jpeg	/DCIM/
image/jpeg	/DCIM/
.qt	/DCIM/
.mov	/DCIM/
video/quicktime	/DCIM/
.avi	/DCIM/
video/x-msvideo	/DCIM/

Although the directories registered by Palm's SD slot driver all happen to be duplicates of the default registrations made by the VFS Manager, they are also registered under the SD media type since the SD specification explicitly includes them.

Slot drivers written by other Palm Powered handheld manufacturers that support different media types, such as Memory Stick, will register default directories appropriate to their media's specifications. In some cases these registrations will override the `expMediaType_Any` media type registration, or in some cases augment the `expMediaType_Any` registrations with file types not previously registered.

These registrations are intended to aid applications developers, but you aren't required to follow them. Although you can choose to ignore these registrations, by following them you'll improve interoperability between applications and other devices. For example, a digital camera which conforms to the media specifications will put its pictures into the registered directory (or a subdirectory of it) appropriate for the image format and media type. By looking up the registered directory for that format, an image viewer application on the handheld can easily find the images without having to search the entire card. These registrations also help prevent different developers from hard-coding different paths

for specific file types. Thus, if a user has two different image viewer applications, both will look in the same location and find the same set of images.

Registering these file types at initialization allows you to use HotSync to transfer files of these types to an expansion card. During the HotSync process, files of the registered types are placed directly in the specified directories on the card.

Custom Calls

Recognizing that some file systems may implement functionality not covered by the APIs included in the VFS and Expansion Managers, the VFS Manager includes a single function that exists solely to give developers access to the underlying file system. This function, `VFSCustomControl`, takes a registered creator code and a selector that together identify the operation that is to be performed. `VFSCustomControl` can either request that a specific file system perform the specified operation, or it can iterate through all of the currently-registered file systems in an effort to locate one that responds to the desired operation.

Parameters are passed to the file system's custom function through a single `VFSCustomControl` parameter. This parameter, `valueP`, is declared as a `void *` so you can pass a pointer to a structure of any type. A second parameter, `valueLenP`, allows you to specify the length of `valueP`. Note that these values are simply passed to the file system and are in reality dependent upon the underlying file system. See the description of `VFSCustomControl` in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for more information.

Because `VFSCustomControl` is designed to allow access to non-standard functionality provided by a particular file system, see the documentation provided with that file system for a list of any custom functions that it provides.

Custom I/O

While the Expansion and VFS Managers provide higher-level OS support for secondary storage applications, they don't attempt to present anything more than a raw interface to custom I/O

applications. Since it isn't really possible to envision all uses of an expansion mechanism, the Expansion and VFS Managers simply try to get out of the way of custom hardware.

The Expansion Manager provides insertion and removal notification and can load and unload drivers. Everything else is the responsibility of the application developer. Palm has defined a common expansion slot driver API which is extensible by licensees. This API is designed to support all of the needs of the Expansion Manager, the VFS Manager, and the file system libraries. Applications that need to communicate with an I/O device, however, may need to go beyond the provided APIs. Such applications should wherever possible use the slot custom call, which provides direct access to the expansion slot driver. See the developer documentation provided to licensees for more information on slot drivers and the slot custom call. For documentation on functions made available by a particular I/O device, along with how you access those functions, contact the I/O device manufacturer.

Debugging

The Palm OS Emulator has been extended to support the expansion capabilities of the VFS Manager. It can be configured to present a directory on the host file system as a volume to the virtual file system. You can populate this directory on your host system and then simulate a volume mount. Changes made to the emulated expansion card's contents can be verified simply by examining the directory on the host.

For more information on configuring and operating the Palm OS Emulator, see the *Palm OS Programming Development Tools Guide*.

Summary of Expansion and VFS Managers

Expansion Manager Functions

ExpCardGetSerialPort
ExpCardInfo
ExpCardPresent
ExpSlotDriverInstall
ExpSlotDriverRemove
ExpSlotEnumerate
ExpSlotLibFind

VFS Manager Functions

Working with Files

VFSFileClose
VFSFileCreate
VFSFileDelete
VFSFileEOF
VFSFileGetAttributes
VFSFileGetDate
VFSFileOpen
VFSFileRead
VFSFileReadData
VFSFileRename
VFSFileResize
VFSFileSeek
VFSFileSetAttributes
VFSFileSetDate
VFSFileSize
VFSFileTell
VFSFileWrite

Working with Directories

VFSDirCreate
VFSDirEntryEnumerate
VFSFileClose
VFSFileDelete
VFSFileGetAttributes
VFSFileGetDate
VFSFileOpen
VFSFileRename
VFSFileSetAttributes
VFSFileSetDate
VFSGetDefaultDirectory
VFSRegisterDefaultDirectory
VFSUnregisterDefaultDirectory

Working with Volumes

VFSVolumeEnumerate
VFSVolumeFormat
VFSVolumeGetLabel
VFSVolumeInfo
VFSVolumeMount
VFSVolumeSetLabel
VFSVolumeSize
VFSVolumeUnmount

VFS Manager Functions	
Miscellaneous Functions	
VFSCustomControl	VFSImportDatabaseFromFile
VFSExportDatabaseToFile	VFSImportDatabaseFromFileCustom
VFSExportDatabaseToFileCustom	VFSInstallFSLib
VFSFileDBInfo	VFSRemoveFSLib
VFSFileDBGetRecord	
VFSFileDBGetResource	

9

Attentions and Alarms

In this chapter you learn how to get the user's attention and how to set real-time alarms that can be used to either perform some periodic activity or display a reminder to the user.

This chapter is divided into the following broad topics:

- Getting the User's Attention begins with an introduction to the Attention Manager. This is followed by a detailed description of the Attention Manager from a user's perspective. Finally, it details what developers need to do in order to use the Attention Manager in their applications.
- Alarms covers the Alarm Manager, which can notify your programs when a specified point in time is reached.

Getting the User's Attention

Palm OS® 4.0 introduces a standard mechanism that manages competing demands for the user's attention by both applications and drivers. This mechanism is known as the Attention Manager.

The Role of the Attention Manager

This section provides a brief introduction to the Attention Manager. It covers the relationship between the Attention, Alarm and Notification Managers, and then discusses when it is appropriate to make use of the Attention Manager.

The Attention Manager provides a standard mechanism by which applications can tell the user that something of significance has occurred. It is designed to support communications devices which can receive data without explicit user interaction. The Attention Manager is responsible only for interacting with the user; it is not responsible for generating those events. In particular, the Alarm

Manager can be used in conjunction with the Attention Manager to inform the user that a particular point in time has been reached.

By maintaining a single list of all "alarm-like" things, the Attention Manager also improves the user's experience when returning to the device after being gone for a while: he no longer has to click through a series of old alarm dialogs. Often the user doesn't care about most of the missed appointments—although he might care about a few of them. Without the Attention Manager, the user cannot selectively dismiss or follow up on dialogs.

Applications have complete control over the types of attention they can ask for. They can query the device for the set of special effects available—possibly including sound, vibration, and an LED—and then act on that set. The default option is to beep. All other options are either on or off; different vibrating patterns or multicolored LEDs are currently not supported. Note that the set of special effects is extensible; manufacturers may choose to add other means to get the user's attention beyond the anticipated LED and vibration.

IMPORTANT: The Attention Manager was introduced in Palm OS 4.0. Applications running on earlier versions of the Palm OS need to use the techniques described under "Alarms" on page 261.

In Palm OS 4.0, the Datebook, SMS, and Clock applications use the Attention Manager. Refer to the Datebook application's source code for real-world examples of how you might use the Attention and Alarm Managers.

Attentions, Alarms and Notifications

The Attention, Alarm, and Notification Managers are distinct subsystems that are often used in combination.

- The Attention Manager is designed solely to interact with the user when an event must be brought to the user's attention.
- The Alarm Manager simply sends an event to an application when a particular point in time is reached. The application can then use the Attention Manager or some other mechanism to bring the alarm to the user's attention, if appropriate.

- The Notification Manager informs those applications that have registered their interest whenever certain system-level or application-level events occur. If the user is to be informed of the event, the executable can use the Attention Manager. The Attention Manager itself uses the Notification Manager to broadcast notifications when getting the user's attention or nagging him about an existing attention item.

When the Attention Manager Isn't Appropriate

The Attention Manager is only designed for attempts to get attention that can be effectively suspended. It is not suitable for anything requiring an immediate response, such as a request to connect to another user or the "put away" dialog that is used during beaming. The Attention Manager also doesn't attempt to replace error messages. Applications must use modal dialogs and other existing OS facilities to handle these cases.

The Attention Manager is also not intended to replace the ToDo application, or to act as a universal inbox. Applications must make it clear that an item appearing in the Attention Manager is simply a reminder, and that dismissing it does not delete the item itself. That is, saying "OK" to an alarm does not delete the appointment, and dismissing an SMS reminder does not delete the SMS message from the SMS inbox.

Attention Manager Operation

This section provides a detailed introduction to the Attention Manager from a user's point of view, introducing some of the terminology used throughout the rest of the chapter and pointing out operational subtleties that you should be aware of when developing applications that use the Attention Manager.

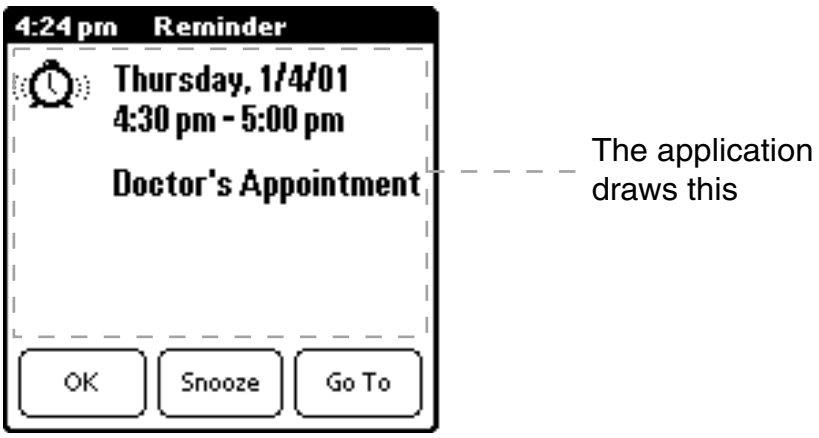
Attention-getting attempts can either be **insistent** or **subtle**. They differ only in the lengths to which each goes to get your attention. Insistent attempts get "in your face" by popping up a dialog and triggering other visible and audible special effects in an effort to bring important events to your attention. A meeting reminder or incoming high-priority email message might warrant interrupting your work in this fashion. Subtle attentions substitute a small on-screen **attention indicator** for the dialog, allowing you to be made aware of less-critical events without interrupting your current work

flow. Although they can also trigger various special effects, subtle attentions don't typically do so. Examples of subtle events might include a reminder of an upcoming birthday or holiday, or an incoming SMS message.

Insistent Attentions

When an application makes an insistent attempt to get the user's attention, the **detail dialog** opens:

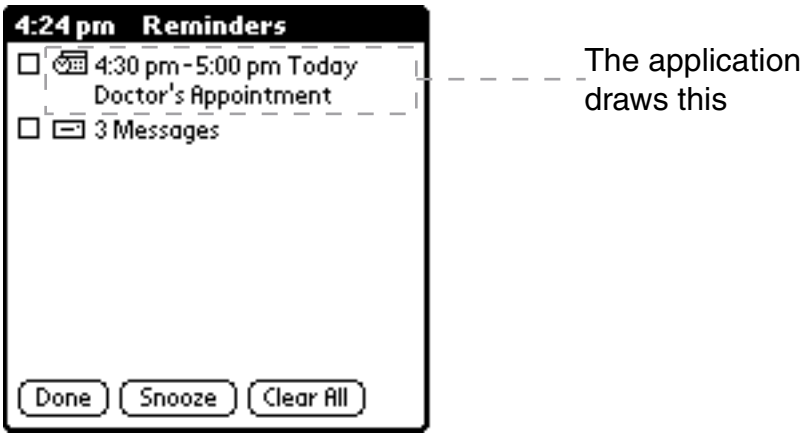
Figure 9.1 Detail Dialog



The Attention Manager draws the title and the buttons. The application is responsible for drawing the rest. Most applications draw text and an appropriate icon, as shown in Figure 9.1.

When a second application attempts to get attention, or when the first application makes a second attempt, and the first has not yet been dismissed or snoozed, the window changes to the **list dialog**, presenting a list of things that require the user's attention:

Figure 9.2 List Dialog



In this dialog, the Attention Manager draws the title and the buttons, and manages the list of items including the checkbox in the left-hand column. Items are listed in order of occurrence, with the newest at the top. The application is responsible for drawing some part of each line, giving it some flexibility over what to display. Applications have space to draw an icon and two lines of text in the standard font on the right-hand side of the list area.

In the detail dialog the OK button dismisses the item. In the list dialog, tapping the checkbox to the left of the item dismisses it. The Clear All button can be used to dismiss all items in the list view. Dismissing an item removes it from the list or closes the detail dialog. Note that although it is gone from the Attention Manager, the item itself remains in the application.

Unique to the list view is a "Done" button which simply closes the list view. It makes no changes to items in the Attention Manager list, nor to any snooze timer.

In either dialog, the "Snooze" button temporarily dismisses the Attention Manager dialog. The attention indicator remains visible and the user can redisplay the dialog at any time. After an interval of five minutes, if any attempts to get attention are still pending the Attention Manager redisplays the dialog. Snooze does not remove attempts to get attention.

There is just one "Snooze" timer, and the snooze operation applies to the Attention Manager as a whole. This can lead to seemingly

odd behavior when new attention items are coming in while there is currently a snooze in progress. This situation should be rare, however.

To "go to" an individual item, tap the text or icon of the item in the list dialog or tap the "Go To" button in the detail dialog. This temporarily dismisses the Attention Manager and launches the appropriate application to display details about the item. For an SMS message, this could take you to the detail dialog showing the message, or, if there are more than one, it could take you to the list of pending SMS messages. For an alarm, this could take you to the Datebook view for the current day, with the current meeting scrolled into view. A successful "go to" also removes the attention item from the list.

Note that while the Attention Manager dialogs are displayed, hard and soft buttons are ignored. This is to prevent you from missing an attention item when you turn on the device by pressing one of the hard keys.

Subtle Attentions

When an application makes a subtle attempt to get the users attention, no dialog appears. Instead, the title bar of all applications that use the standard form title object show a blinking indicator.

Figure 9.3 Attention indicator



When the list contains one or more items, all of which have been seen by the user, the "star" indicator blinks on and off until the list is empty. When the list contains one or more unseen items, the attention indicator performs an "exploding star" animation.

Tapping this indicator opens the Attention Manager in the list mode, even if there is only one item. Tapping to the right of the indicator, or tapping in the indicator's area when there are no pending attention attempts opens the menu bar as expected.

The attention indicator only functions with applications which use a standard form title object. The indicator doesn't appear when:

- there are no items in the Attention Manager's queue.
- the current application uses a custom title.
- the current application draws in the title area.
- the current form uses the Dialog title style.
- the current application's form title is too narrow to include the attention indicator.

Special Effects

When a new attention item is added, the Attention Manager performs some combination of special effects, which can include playing sounds, flashing a LED, and triggering vibration. The exact combination of effects depends on user settings and on the application itself.

The Attention Manager attempts to open the dialog before performing any special effects so you know immediately why it is trying to get your attention. However, it may not be possible to open the Attention Manager dialog. If this is the case, the Attention Manager performs the special effects as soon as possible. It's better for the user to be made aware that something is happening, even if the device cannot say exactly what it is.

System-wide user preferences control the special effects: the volume at which to play alarms, whether or not to flash the LED (if any), whether or not to vibrate (if equipped). Applications can override these system-wide settings in either a positive or a negative way. For instance, an application could always blink the LED, even if the user said not to, or never blink the LED, even if the user desires it in general.

Nagging

As with Datebook alarms in Palm OS 3.5 and earlier, if you don't explicitly dismiss or snooze an attention item it continues to "nag" you at predefined intervals, using the item's specified special effects. Applications control how frequently the user should be reminded, and how many times before the Attention Manager gives up.

When there are multiple attention items competing for nagging, the Attention Manager respects the nag settings for the most recent insistent item, or if there are none then for the most recent subtle item. Each special effect is handled separately; if one reminder wants sound but no vibration, and another wants vibration but no sound, the combination results in the sound from the first one and the vibration from the second one.

Attention Manager and Existing Applications

The Attention Manager makes no attempt to override existing application behavior. If an application written for Palm OS 3.5 or earlier puts up a dialog to get the user's attention, the Attention Manager doesn't get involved. Applications must be specifically written to use the Attention Manager in order to take advantage of its features and seamless integration with the Palm™ user experience.

Some existing third-party applications put up modal alarm-like dialogs. These dialogs can potentially interfere with the Attention Manager. However, issuing of the UI launch code by the Alarm Manager is deferred until after the Attention Manager is closed. This prevents existing applications from putting up their dialogs while the Attention Manager is being displayed. If the reverse happens, and the Attention Manager pops up while an existing application is displaying an alarm-like dialog, only a "go to" becomes problematic: the third-party dialog may consume events required to perform the "go to," preventing it from taking place. This is acceptable, however, since the attention item remains in the Attention Manager's queue. Once the third-party dialog has been dismissed, you can then re-open the Attention Manager and re-initiate the "go to."

Effectively, this means the Attention Manager always shows up on top of any existing application's alarm dialogs that use the Alarm Manager. This ensures that you'll most likely be greeted by the Attention Manager's list after a prolonged period of inactivity.

Getting the User's Attention

This section shows how your applications request the user's attention through the Attention Manager.

Getting the user's attention is simply a matter of calling `AttnGetAttention` with the appropriate parameters and then handling various callbacks made by the Attention Manager. These callbacks allow your application to control what is displayed in the Attention Manager dialogs, to play sounds or perform other special effects, and to do any necessary processing when the user takes action on an existing attention item.

The `AttnGetAttention` prototype looks like this:

```
Err AttnGetAttention (UInt16 cardNo,
LocalID dbID, UInt32 userData,
AttnCallbackProc *callbackFnP,
AttnLevelType level, AttnFlagsType flags,
UInt16 nagRateInSeconds, UInt16 nagRepeatLimit)
```

Specify the application requesting the user's attention in the `cardNo` and `dbID` arguments. You can use the `DmGetNextDatabaseByTypeCreator` function to obtain these values.

`userData` is used to distinguish a given attention attempt from others made by the same application; most applications pass the unique ID or other key for the record which caused the attention request. This value is passed to your code through the callback function, and can be an integer, a pointer, or any other 32-bit value as needed by your application.

The `callbackFnP` argument controls whether the Attention Manager invokes a callback function or issues a launch code to request services from your application. Applications typically supply `NULL` for this parameter, causing launch codes to be sent to the application specified by the `cardNo` and `dbID` arguments. See

"Callback or Launch Code?" on page 249 for a discussion of callback functions and launch codes.

For the `level` argument, supply `kAttnLevelInsistent` or `kAttnLevelSubtle` depending on whether the given attention attempt is to be insistent or subtle.

Regardless of the level of the attention attempt, set the appropriate bits in the `flags` argument to cause sounds to play, LEDs to blink, or other physical effects to be performed. Depending on which flags you specify, the effect can always occur or can be suppressed by the user. For instance, to trigger a sound while honoring the user's preferences, you need only supply `kAttnFlagsSoundBit`. Or, to blink the LED but suppress any sounds, regardless of any preferences the user may have set, supply a value of `kAttnFlagsAlwaysLED | kattnFlagsNoSound`. Finally, to choose only vibrate, do something like:

```
flags = kAttnFlagsNothing ^ kAttnFlagsNoVibrate
   | kAttnFlagsAlwaysVibrate;
```

While the above is somewhat complex, it does ensure that you override all defaults in the negative except vibration, which is overridden in the positive. See the definition of `AttnFlagsType` in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for a complete set of constants that can be used in combination for the `flags` argument.

NOTE: Applications may want to verify that the device is properly equipped to perform the desired effect. See "Detecting Device Capabilities" on page 260 for information on how to do this. If the device isn't properly equipped to handle a given special effect, the effect isn't performed. For example, if you set the `kAttnFlagsLEDBit` flag and the Palm Powered™ device doesn't have an LED, the attention attempt is processed as if the `kAttnFlagsLEDBit` had never been set.

Assuming that the device is capable of getting the user's attention using the requested special effect, the `nagRateInSeconds` and `nagRepeatLimit` arguments control how often and how many times the special effect is triggered in an attempt to get the user's attention. As the name implies, specify the amount of time, in

seconds, the Attention Manager should wait between special effect triggers with `nagRateInSeconds`. Indicate the desired number of times the effect should be triggered using `nagRepeatLimit`. Applications typically supply a value of 300 for `nagRateInSeconds` and a value of 3 for `nagRepeatLimit`, indicating that the special effect should be triggered three times after the initial attempt, at five minute intervals.

The following line of code shows how the SMS application calls the Attention Manager upon receiving a new SMS message. Note that a subtle attention is generated so that the user isn't interrupted every time an SMS message is received. Also note that the application doesn't override the user's settings when getting his attention. Finally, if the user doesn't respond to the first attention-getting attempt, the special effects are repeated three additional times in five-minute intervals.

```
err = AttnGetAttention(cardNo, dbID, NULL,
    NULL, kAttnLevelSubtle,
    kAttnFlagsUseUserSettings, 300, 3);
```

Callback or Launch Code?

For a given attention item, the Attention Manager calls back to the code resource that created that item whenever the Attention Manager needs the resource to draw the attention dialog contents or whenever it needs to inform the code resource of activity relating to the attention item. The Attention Manager calls back using one of two mechanisms:

- If a callback routine has been specified for a given attention item, the Attention Manager invokes it. This callback routine doesn't have application globals available to it, so it is important that anything necessary to draw or otherwise display be available through `commandArgsP`. A callback routine is typically used by libraries and system extensions. See the description of the `AttnCallbackProc` in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for the specifics of the callback routine.
- If a callback routine has not been specified for a given attention item, the Attention Manager instead sends a `sysAppLaunchCmdAttention` launch code to the application that registered the attention item. Accompanying

that launch code is an AttnLaunchCodeArgsType structure containing the three parameters documented above. Applications typically use the launch-code mechanism due to the restrictions that are placed on callback routines.

IMPORTANT: It is your responsibility to ensure that the callback procedure is still in the same place when it gets called, dealing with the possibility that the code resource might be unlocked and moved in memory, and with the possibility that the database containing the code resource might be deleted. For the most part, these problems don't exist when using launch codes.

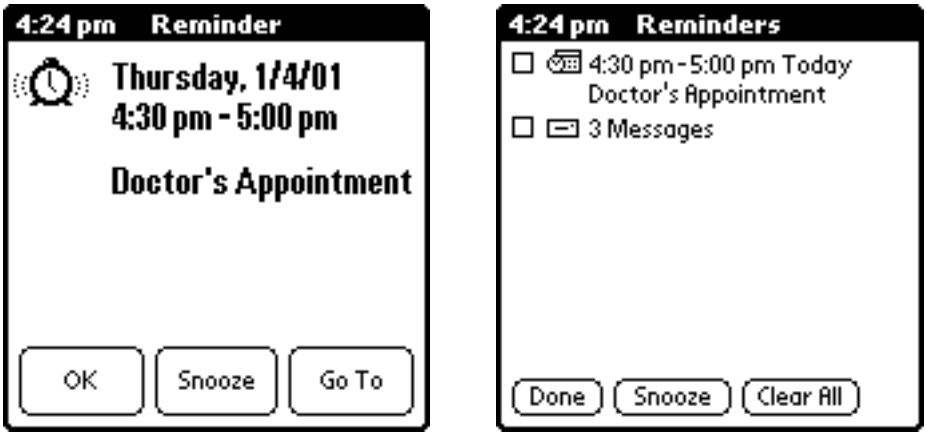
Attention Manager Commands

In addition to calling AttnGetAttention, your code must also respond to commands from the Attention Manager. The Attention Manager issues these commands either by invoking a callback function or issuing a launch code, depending on what you supplied for the `callbackFnP` argument in the `AttnGetAttention` call. Among the possible commands are requests for your application to draw the contents of the detail and list dialogs, play application-specific sounds or perform other special effects, navigate to the item in your application that caused the attention item to be posted, and so forth.

Draw Detail and List Dialogs

The Attention Manager's detail and list dialogs are drawn as a joint effort between the Attention Manager and applications requesting the user's attention. The shell of each dialog, the title, and the buttons and checkboxes are drawn by the Attention Manager, while the remainder—text specific to each attention attempt, and frequently an accompanying icon—is drawn by the application itself. This gives each application full control over what sort of information to display.

Figure 9.4 Attention Manager dialogs



Although your application has full control over the display of its attention items, it may only draw in the designated area; active UI elements, such as scroll bars, custom buttons, or other widgets cannot be included. Users should be encouraged to launch the application with the "Go To" button and use the richer UI provided there. The clipping region is appropriately set so that your application cannot accidentally draw outside the designated area.

The `kAttnCommandDrawDetail` command indicates that your application is to draw the contents of the detail dialog. Along with the command, the Attention Manager passes a structure of type `drawDetail`. This structure contains the window-relative boundaries of the screen rectangle in which your application is to draw, a flag indicating whether this is the first time the user has seen this attention item, and a set of flags indicating which special effects will also be triggered.

NOTE: Unless the `firstTime` bit is set, the portion of the detail dialog in which your application draws is not guaranteed to be blank. If `firstTime` is not set, erase the area indicated by the `bounds` rectangle prior to drawing the contents of the detail dialog.

The following code excerpt shows how a simple application might render the contents of the detail dialog in response to

sysAppLaunchCmdAttention launch code accompanied by a kAttnCommandDrawDetail command:

Listing 9.1 Drawing the contents of the detail dialog

```
// Draw the icon
resH = DmGetResource(bitmapRsc, MyIconBitmap);
WinDrawBitmap(MemHandleLock(resH),
    paramsPtr->drawDetail.bounds.topLeft.x,
    paramsPtr->drawDetail.bounds.topLeft.y + 4);
MemHandleUnlock(resH);
DmReleaseResource(resH);

// Draw the text. The content of the string depends on the
// uniqueID that accompanies the kAttnCommandDrawDetail
// command
curFont = FntSetFont (largeBoldFont);
x = paramsPtr->drawDetail.bounds.topLeft.x + 37;
y = paramsPtr->drawDetail.bounds.topLeft.y + 4;
WinDrawChars(alertString, StrLen(alertString), x, y);
FntSetFont(curFont);
```

For a more complex, real-world example, see the DrawDetailAlarm function in the Datebook application. In particular, note how that application adjusts the displayed text so that it all fits in the allocated space.

Note that because subtle attention items are only shown using the list view, your application doesn't need to respond to kAttnCommandDrawDetail if it doesn't produce insistent attention attempts.

The kAttnCommandDrawList command is similar; it indicates that your application is to draw a portion of the contents of the list dialog. Along with this command, the Attention Manager passes a structure of type drawList, which contains a selected flag in addition to the bounds, firstTime, and flags fields described above. The selected flag indicates whether the item has been selected. Before sending your application the kAttnCommandDrawList command, the Attention Manager sets the background, foreground, and text colors as follows, depending on whether or not the item is selected:

Affected Color	Not Selected	Selected
Background Color	`UIFieldBackground`	`UIObjectSelectedFill`
Foreground Color	`UIObjectForeground`	`UIObjectSelectedForeground`
Text Color	`UIObjectForeground`	`UIObjectSelectedForeground`

Particularly if your attention item icon is in color, you may need to draw the attention item differently when it is selected. The `selected` flag exists to allow you to do this.

The code to draw an attention item in the list dialog is very similar to the code you use to draw the same item in the detail dialog. Here is an excerpt:

Listing 9.2 Drawing the contents of the list dialog

```
// Draw the icon. Ignore the 'selected' flag for this example
resH = DmGetResource(bitmapRsc, MySmallIconBitmap);
iconP = (BitmapPtr)(MemHandleLock(resH));
// center it in the space allotted
iconOffset = (kAttnListMaxIconWidth - iconP->width)/2;
x = paramsPtr->drawList.bounds.topLeft.x;
y = paramsPtr->drawList.bounds.topLeft.y;
WinDrawBitmap(iconP, x + iconOffset, y);
MemHandleUnlock(resH);
DmReleaseResource(resH);

// Draw the text
curFont = FntSetFont(stdFont);
WinDrawChars(alertString, StrLen(alertString),
    x + kAttnListTextOffset, y);
FntSetFont(curFont);
```

The primary differences arise from the fact that the list dialog provides a smaller, more structured area in which to draw. Also, the area in which you draw will always have been erased before you are asked to draw in it, so you don't ever have to erase it beforehand.

The icon should be no wider than `kAttnListMaxIconWidth` pixels, and should be centered within this width if it is smaller than `kAttnListMaxIconWidth`. The text should honor a left-hand

margin of `kAttnListTextOffset` pixels. In the above example, the alert string is assumed to fit within the available space; see the `DrawListAlarm` function in the Datebook application for an example of how that application adjusts the displayed text in the event that it doesn't all fit in the allocated space.

NOTE: Applications may, in certain rare circumstances, receive a `kAttnCommandDrawDetail` or `kAttnCommandDrawList` command for an item which is no longer valid. Respond by either calling `AttnForgetIt`, by drawing nothing, or by drawing an error message.

Play Sound or Perform a Custom Effect

Most applications play a sound when attempting to get the user's attention. If the `kAttnFlagsAlwaysSound` is set when your application calls `AttnGetAttention`, the Attention Manager sends a `kAttnCommandPlaySound` command to your application when attempting to get the user's attention. Your application should simply play the appropriate sound in response to this command. Both the Datebook and SMS applications play sounds based upon the user's preferences when getting the user's attention; see the Datebook application's source code for an example of how to respond to the `kAttnCommandPlaySound` command.

Because the Attention Manager can potentially play a sound, blink an LED, and vibrate in addition to displaying a dialog or blinking the attention indicator, most applications don't request that some other application-specific custom effect be performed. If your application needs to do something different, you can specify `kAttnFlagsAlwaysCustomEffect` when calling `AttnGetAttention`. This causes a `kAttnCommandCustomEffect` command to be sent to your application, at which time it should perform the desired effect. If your application is like most, however, it won't ever receive a `kAttnCommandCustomEffect` command, so you needn't worry about responding to it.

Neither `kAttnCommandPlaySound` nor `kAttnCommandCustomEffect` are accompanied by any kind of data structure indicating the sound or effect to be performed. If your

application doesn't hard-wire this information, you may want to store it in the application's preferences database.

Go There

When the user taps on the "Go To" button in the detail view or on the item text or icon (not the checkbox) in the list view, your application receives a `kAttnCommandGoThere` command. It then needs to switch to your application and display the information relating to the chosen attention item. The `kAttnCommandGoThere` command is similar to the `sysAppLaunchCmdGoto` launch code, but you don't have globals when your application receives the `kAttnCommandGoThere` command and your application is called using `SysAppLaunch`, rather than `SysUIAppSwitch`. Because of this, most applications perform a `SysUIAppSwitch` upon receiving `kAttnCommandGoThere`.

Note that your application should verify that the data that triggered the attention attempt is still relevant. In the Datebook, for instance, the user could:

1. Be alerted to an appointment by the Attention Manager.
2. Tap "Snooze."
3. Press the Datebook button and delete the appointment that was just brought to the user's attention.
4. Tap the blinking attention indicator.
5. Tap the attention item corresponding to the now-deleted appointment.

In this scenario, the Datebook application could theoretically receive a `kAttnCommandGoThere` command along with a unique ID referencing a Datebook record that has been deleted. Whenever the Datebook application receives `kAttnCommandGoThere` along with a unique ID for a deleted Datebook database record, it calls `AttnForgetIt` for the now defunct attention item and then returns.

In reality, the Datebook calls `AttnForgetIt` whenever the user deletes an alarm, and whenever an alarm is determined to be no longer valid. It can do this without even checking to see if the alarm is among those that the Attention Manager is currently tracking; if you pass a combination of card number, database ID, and unique ID

to AttnForgetIt that doesn't correspond to an item in the Attention Manager's queue, AttnForgetIt does nothing and returns a value of false.

Most applications will choose to call AttnForgetIt once the user has viewed the data corresponding to the attention item. This is how the SMS application operates: incoming messages are brought to the user's attention via the Attention Manager, and are removed from the Attention Manager's queue once they've been read.

Got It

When the user dismisses a particular attention item, a kAttnCommandGotIt command is sent to the application. Along with this command is a boolean that indicates if the item was explicitly dismissed by the user, since kAttnCommandGotIt is also issued as the result of a successful AttnForgetIt call. Upon receipt of this command, you may want to clean up memory, delete an alarm, or do other application-specific processing.

Iterate

When something happens that may potentially cause an application's attention items to become invalid, that application should call AttnIterate. AttnIterate generates a series of kAttnCommandIterate commands, one for each of the application's pending attention items. Thus, when your application receives a kAttnCommandIterate command it should validate the indicated attention item and take appropriate action if the item is no longer valid—up to and including calling AttnForgetIt for the item.

The SMS application does not respond to kAttnCommandIterate. The Datebook does; this command is generated whenever the user updates his preferences. Many applications call AttnIterate after receiving a sysAppLaunchCmdSyncNotify launch code so that they can update (with AttnUpdate) or remove (with AttnForgetIt) items which were affected by the HotSync® operation.

Note that you can safely call AttnForgetIt from within the iteration since AttnForgetIt only marks the record for deletion and thus doesn't confuse the iteration.

Snooze

Most applications—including the Datebook and SMS applications—ignore `kAttnCommandSnooze`, which indicates that the user has tapped the Snooze button. Beyond the unique ID that identifies the attention item, nothing accompanies the Snooze command. `kAttnCommandSnooze` is passed to each and every item currently pending, insistent or subtle. This means that applications with more than one attention item pending receive this command more than once.

Triggering Special Effects

The Attention Manager activates any requested special effects for each attention item, but your application might want to activate those special effects without also posting an attention item to the queue. You can do this through a call to `AttnDoSpecialEffects`. Supply the appropriate combination of flags to trigger the desired effects. See `AttnFlagsType` for a complete list of flags.

Attentions and Alarms

The Attention Manager is often used in conjunction with the Alarm Manager to get the user's attention at a particular time. The basic use of the Alarm Manager is covered in "Alarms" on page 261, but because the Attention Manager handles UI synchronization, do the following when using the Alarm Manager with the Attention Manager:

- Call `AttnGetAttention` when your application receives the `sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered` launch code.
- In your `sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered` handling code, set the `purgeAlarm` field in the launch code's parameter block to `true` before returning. This removes the alarm from the queue, so your application won't receive the `sysAppLaunchCmdDisplayAlarm` launch code.

Don't wait until the `sysAppLaunchCmdDisplayAlarm` launch code is received to call `AttnGetAttention`: `sysAppLaunchCmdDisplayAlarm` is not issued while another Alarm Manager dialog is open, so the Attention Manager is prevented from doing anything if a "legacy" application is displaying an Alarm Manager dialog.

NOTE: If you want to use the Alarm Manager to force periodic updates of your application's attention items, don't call `AttnUpdate` after receiving an Alarm Manager launch code since this keeps the handheld from sleeping. Instead, use a procedure alarm a described under "Setting a Procedure Alarm" on page 266 and call `AttnUpdate` from within your procedure alarm callback function.

Detecting and Updating Pending Attentions

Once your application has requested that the Attention Manager get the user's attention, it may later need to update that attention request. For instance, if your application uses a single attention item to indicate that a number of unread messages have been received, it should update that item as additional items are received and read. The Attention Manager provides a handful of functions that allow applications to examine the Attention Manager's queue and update the items within that queue.

The `AttnGetCounts` function allows you to determine how many items are currently competing for the user's attention. It always returns the total number of items, but can return the number of subtle and/or insistent items as well. It can also return the counts for all applications. For instance, the following would set `numItems` to the total number of pending attention items from all sources:

```
numItems = AttnGetCounts(0, 0, NULL, NULL);
```

Or, to get the number of subtle and insistent attention items in addition to the total requested by a single application, use something like:

```
numItems = AttnGetCounts(cardNo, dbID,
    &insistentItems, &subtleItems);
```

To verify each pending attention item for a given application, use the Attention Manager's `AttnIterate` function as described under "Iterate" on page 256.

After a HotSync is a popular time to invoke `AttnIterate`; the HotSync operation may have altered the application's underlying data in such a way as to render pending attention items obsolete or invalid.

Deleting Pending Attention Items

In many cases you'll need to delete an attention item. For instance, a HotSync may alter the underlying application data in such a way so as to invalidate the attention attempt. Or, the user might switch to your application and manually update the data in a similar way, for example by deleting an appointment for which there is a pending alarm. The `AttnForgetIt` function exists for this purpose. Simply invoke this function and supply the card number, database ID, and user data that uniquely identify the attention attempt. You don't even have to verify that the attention attempt is still in the Attention Manager's queue: `AttnForgetIt` doesn't complain if the attention attempt doesn't exist, merely returning a value of `false` to indicate this condition.

Updating Pending Attention Items

To update an existing attention item, use `AttnUpdate`. This function is very similar to `AttnGetAttention`, though instead of actual values you pass pointers to those values you want to update. Supply `NULL` pointers for `flagsP`, `nagRateInSecondsP`, and/or `nagRepeatLimitP` to leave them untouched. For instance, to change the special effects that should be used to get the user's attention, do the following:

Listing 9.3 Updating an existing attention item

```
// This assumes that cardNo, dbID, and myUserData are
// declared and set elsewhere to values that identify the
// attention item we're trying to update
Boolean updated;
AttnFlagsType newFlags;

// set newFlags appropriately
updated = AttnUpdate(cardNo, dbID, myUserData, NULL,
    &newFlags, NULL, NULL);
if (updated){
    // update succeeded
} else {
    // update failed - attention item may no longer exist
}
```

When calling `AttnUpdate`, note that you must not only supply the card number, database ID, and user data that uniquely identifies the attention attempt; you must also supply a pointer to the callback procedure if one is used.

While updating the attention item, if the device is on and the Attention Manager dialog is currently showing then `AttnUpdate` forces the item to be redrawn. This in turn calls back to the client application so that it can update its portion of the dialog. `AttnUpdate` causes the specified item to be redrawn if it is visible, regardless of the `flags`, `nagRateInSeconds`, and `nagRepeatLimit` parameters.Thus, `AttnUpdate` isn't limited to updating one or more aspects of an attention item; it also allows an application to update the text of an attention attempt without having to destroy and then rebuild the Attention Manager dialog.

Note that if the device is off, the update is delayed until the device is next turned on; `AttnUpdate` doesn't itself turn the screen on.

Detecting Device Capabilities

Although you can blindly request that a given special effect, such as vibration, be used to get the user's attention without checking to see if that special effect is supported on the Palm Powered device, you may want your application to behave differently in the absence of a particular device feature. The Attention Manager defines a feature that you use with the `FtrGet` function to determine the device's physical capabilities. You can also use this feature to determine the user's attention-getting preferences. For example:

Listing 9.4 Checking for vibrate capability

```
// See if the device supports vibration
FtrGet(kAttnFtrCreator, kAttnFtrCapabilities, &capabilities);
if (capabilities & kAttnFlagsHasVibrate){
    // Vibrate-specific processing goes here
    ...
}
```

See "Attention Manager Feature Constants" in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for descriptions of all of the relevant flags.

Controlling the Attention Indicator

For the most part, applications can ignore the attention indicator, which consumes a small portion of a form's title bar. If the currently-displayed form doesn't have a title bar, or if the form is modal, the attention indicator isn't drawn. However, if an application takes over the entire screen or does something special with the form's title bar, it should explicitly disable the attention indicator while the form is displayed.

As an example, the Datebook application disables the attention indicator when:

- a note associated with a Datebook entry is displayed.
- an entry's description is being displayed in the week view.
- the time is being displayed in the title bar in place of the date.

To disable the attention indicator, simply call `AttnIndicatorEnable` and supply a value of `false` for the `enableIt` argument. To re-enable it, simply call `AttnIndicatorEnable` again, this time supplying an argument value of `true`.

If your application disables the attention indicator, it may want to provide some means for the user to open the Attention Manager's dialog in list mode. The `AttnListOpen` function can be used to do this.

Alarms

The Palm OS Alarm Manager provides support for setting real-time alarms, for performing some periodic activity, or for displaying a reminder. The Alarm Manager:

- Works closely with the Time Manager to handle real-time alarms.
- Sends launch codes to applications that set a specific time alarm to inform the application the alarm is due.
- Allows only one alarm to be set per application.

- Handles alarms by application in a two cycle operation:
  - First, it notifies each application that the alarm has occurred; the application verifies that the alarm is still valid at this point. Applications that don't use the Attention Manager typically play a sound here.
  - Second, after all pending alarms have received their first notification, it sends another notification to each application, allowing it to display some UI.

The Alarm Manager doesn't have any UI of its own; applications that need to bring an alarm to the user's attention must do this themselves. It doesn't provide reminder dialog boxes, and it doesn't play the alarm sound. Applications running on Palm OS 4.0 should use the Attention Manager to interact with the user; see "Attentions and Alarms" on page 257 for tips on doing this. Applications running on earlier versions of the Palm OS need to provide their own UI, as explained in the following sections.

IMPORTANT: When the handheld is in sleep mode, alarms can occur almost a minute late. This is particularly important to note when utilizing procedure alarms (discussed in "Setting a Procedure Alarm" on page 266); although procedure alarms will continue to fire when the handheld is in sleep mode, they may fire less frequently.

Setting an Alarm

The most common use of the Alarm Manager is to set a real-time alarm within an application. Often, you set this type of alarm because you want to inform the user of an event. For example, the Datebook application sets alarms to inform users of their appointments.

Implementing such an alarm is a two step process. First, use the function `AlmSetAlarm` to set the alarm. Specify when the alarm should trigger and which application should be informed at that time.

Listing 9.5 shows how the Datebook application sets an alarm.

Listing 9.5 Setting an alarm

```
static void SetTimeOfNextAlarm (UInt32 alarmTime, UInt32 ref)
{
    UInt16 cardNo;
    LocalID dbID;
    DmSearchStateType searchInfo;

    DmGetNextDatabaseByTypeCreator (true, &searchInfo,
        sysFileTApplication, sysFileCDatebook, true, &cardNo,
        &dbID);

    AlmSetAlarm (cardNo, dbID, ref, alarmTime, true);
}
```

Second, have your `PilotMain` function respond to the launch codes `sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered` and `sysAppLaunchCmdDisplayAlarm`.

When an alarm is triggered, the Alarm Manager notifies each application that set an alarm for that time via the `sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered` launch code. After each application has processed this launch code, the Alarm Manager sends each application `sysAppLaunchCmdDisplayAlarm` so that the application can display the alarm. The section "Alarm Scenario" gives more information about when these launch codes are received and what actions your application might take. For a specific example of responding to these launch codes, see the Datebook sample code included with Palm OS 3.5.

It's important to note the following:

- An application can have only one alarm pending at a time. If you call `AlmSetAlarm` and then call it again before the first alarm has triggered, the Alarm Manager replaces the first alarm with the second alarm. You can use the `AlmGetAlarm` function to find out if the application has any alarms pending.
- You do not have access to global variables or code outside segment 0 (in a multi-segment application) when you respond to the launch codes. `AlmSetAlarm` takes a `UInt32` parameter that you can use to pass a specific value so that you have access to it when the alarm triggers. (This is the `ref` parameter shown in Listing 9.5.) The parameter blocks for

both launch codes provide access to this reference parameter. If the reference parameter isn't sufficient, you can define an application feature. See the "Features" section in the "Palm System Support" chapter.

- The database ID that you pass to `AlmSetAlarm` is the local ID of the **application** (the `.prc` file), not of the record database that the application accesses. You use record database's local ID more frequently than you do the application's local ID, so this is a common mistake to make.
- In `AlmSetAlarm`, the alarm time is given as the number of seconds since 1/1/1904. If you need to convert a conventional date and time value to the number of seconds since 1/1/1904, use `TimDateTimeToSeconds`.

If you want to clear a pending alarm, call `AlmSetAlarm` with 0 specified for the alarm seconds parameter.

Alarm Scenario

Here's how an application and the Alarm Manager typically interact when processing an alarm:

1. The application sets an alarm using `AlmSetAlarm`.

   The Alarm Manager adds the new alarm to its alarm queue. The alarm queue contains all alarm requests. Triggered alarms are queued up until the Alarm Manager can send the launch code to the application that created the alarm. However, if the alarm queue becomes full, the oldest entry that has been both triggered and notified is deleted to make room for a new alarm.

2. When the alarm time is reached, the Alarm Manager searches the alarm queue for the first application that set an alarm for this alarm time.
3. The Alarm Manager sends this application the `sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered` launch code.
4. The application can now:
   - Set the next alarm.
   - Play a short sound.
   - Perform some quick maintenance activity.

The application should not perform any lengthy tasks in response to `sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered` because doing so delays other applications from receiving alarms that are set to trigger at the same time.

If the application is using the Attention Manager to bring this alarm to the user's attention, call `AttnGetAttention` here and set the `purgeAlarm` field in the launch codes' parameter block to `true` before returning.

If this alarm requires no further processing, the application should set the `purgeAlarm` field in the launch code's parameter block to `true` before returning. Doing so removes the alarm from the queue, which means it won't receive the `sysAppLaunchCmdDisplayAlarm` launch code.

5. The Alarm Manager finds in the alarm queue the next application that set an alarm and repeats steps 2 and 3.
6. This process is repeated until no more applications are found with this alarm time.
7. The Alarm Manager then finds once again the first application in the alarm queue who set an alarm for this alarm time and sends this application the launch code `sysAppLaunchCmdDisplayAlarm`. Note that alarms that had their `purgeAlarm` field set to `true` during the processing of `sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered`—including all alarms that are being brought to the user's attention through the Attention Manager—are no longer in the queue at this point.
8. The application can now:
   - Display a dialog box.
   - Display some other type of reminder.

   Applications typically create a nested event loop at this point to handle the dialog's events. This nested event loop ignores virtually all events that would cause the dialog to go away, causing the dialog to be fixed on the screen; it can't be dismissed until one of the embedded buttons is tapped. Note that the currently active application remains active. You may not be able to see it (if the alarm dialog is full screen) and you cannot interact with it because the dialog's nested event loop

is processing all events. It is effectively suspended, waiting for an event to occur.

9. The Alarm Manager processes the alarm queue for the next application that set an alarm for the alarm being triggered and steps 7 and 8 are repeated.
10. This process is repeated until no more applications are found with this alarm time.

    If a new alarm time is triggered while an older alarm is still being displayed, all applications with alarms scheduled for this second alarm time are sent the `sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered` launch code, but the display cycle for the second set of alarms is postponed until all earlier alarms have finished displaying.

Note that when a second alarm goes off before the first has been dismissed, the alarm manager sends the `sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered` launch code for the second alarm but waits to send the `sysAppLaunchCmdDisplayAlarm` launch code until after the first alarm's dialog has been dismissed. For applications that put up dialogs, this typically means that only one dialog at a time will appear on the screen. The Alarm Manager doesn't return to the event loop between the issuing of launch codes, so when the first alarm's dialog has been dismissed, the second alarm's dialog is immediately displayed. The net result for the user is that each alarm dialog in turn must be dismissed before the device can be used.

Setting a Procedure Alarm

Beginning with Palm OS version 3.2, the system supports setting procedure alarms in addition to the application-based alarms described in the previous sections. The differences between a procedure alarm and an application-based alarm are:

- When you set a procedure alarm, you specify a pointer to a function that should be called when the alarm triggers instead of an application that should be notified.
- When the alarm triggers, the Alarm Manager calls the specified procedure directly instead of using launch codes.

- If the system is in sleep mode, the alarm triggers without causing the LCD display to light up.

You might use procedure alarms if:

- You want to perform a background task that is completely hidden from the user.
- You are writing a shared library and want to implement an alarm within that library.
- You want to use `AttnUpdate` to update an attention item, but you don't want the display to turn on if the device is currently sleeping.

To set a procedure alarm, you call `AlmSetProcAlarm` instead of `AlmSetAlarm`. (Similarly, you use the `AlmGetProcAlarm` function instead of `AlmGetAlarm` to see if any alarms are pending for this procedure.)

`AlmSetProcAlarm` is currently implemented as a macro that calls `AlmSetAlarm` using a special value for the card number parameter to notify the Alarm Manager that this is a procedure alarm. Instead of specifying the application's local ID and card number, you specify a function pointer. The other rules for `AlmSetAlarm` still apply. Notably, a given function can only have one alarm pending at a time, and you can clear any pending alarm by passing 0 for the alarm time.

When the alarm triggers, the Alarm Manager calls the function you specified. The function should have the prototype:

```
void myAlarmFunc (UInt16 almProcCmd,
SysAlarmTriggeredParamType *paramP)
```

IMPORTANT: The function pointer must remain valid from the time `AlmSetProcAlarm` is called to the time the alarm is triggered. If the procedure is in a shared library, you must keep the library open. If the procedure is in a separately-loaded code resource, the resource must remain locked until the alarm fires. When you close a library or unlock a resource, you must remove any pending alarms. If you don't, the system crashes when the alarm is triggered.

The first parameter to your function specifies why the Alarm Manager has called the function. Currently, the Alarm Manager calls the function in two instances:

- The alarm has triggered.
- The user has changed the system time, so the alarm time should be adjusted.

The second parameter is the same structure that is passed with the `sysAppLaunchCmdAlarmTriggered` launch code. It provides access to the reference parameter specified when the alarm was set, the time specified when the alarm was set, and the `purgeAlarm` field, which specifies if the alarm should be removed from the queue. In the case of procedure alarms, the alarm should always be removed from the queue. The system sets the `purgeAlarm` value to `true` after calling your function.

It is important to note that your procedure alarm function should not access global variables if the alarm could be triggered after the application that contains the procedure alarm function has terminated (even if the code remains locked in memory), since the globals no longer exist at this point.

Procedure Alarms and Menus

Procedure alarms are often used to update the handheld's display on a regular basis. Menus aren't automatically informed when an alarm is triggered, so if a menu is open when your procedure alarm code updates the display, your code may overwrite the open menu. To detect this, check for an open menu in your procedure alarm display code, as shown in the following excerpt:

Listing 9.6 Checking for an open menu

```
Boolean menuVisible = false;
MenuBarType *menuBarTypeP = MenuGetActiveMenu();

if (menuBarTypeP)
   menuVisible = menuBarTypeP->attr.visible;

if (!menuVisible){
   // no visible menus, so it's OK to update the display
}
```

Summary of Attentions and Alarms

Attention Manager Functions	
AttnDoSpecialEffects	AttnIndicatorEnabled
AttnForgetIt	AttnIterate
AttnGetAttention	AttnListOpen
AttnGetCounts	AttnUpdate
AttnIndicatorEnable	

Alarm Manager Functions	
AlmSetAlarm	AlmGetAlarm
AlmSetProcAlarm	AlmGetProcAlarm

10

Palm System Support

In this chapter, you learn how to work with the miscellaneous supporting functionality that the Palm OS® system provides, such as sound, time, and floating-point operations. Most parts of the Palm OS are controlled by a manager, which is a group of functions that work together to implement a certain functionality. As a rule, all functions that belong to one manager use the same prefix and work together to implement a certain aspect of functionality.

This chapter discusses these topics:

- Features
- Preferences
- Sound
- System Boot and Reset
- Hardware Interaction
- The Microkernel
- Retrieving the ROM Serial Number
- Time
- Floating-Point
- Summary of System Features

Features

A *feature* is a 32-bit value that has special meaning to both the feature publisher and to users of that feature. Features can be published by the system or by applications.

Each feature is identified by a feature creator and a feature number:

- The feature creator is a unique creator registered with Palm, Inc. You usually use the creator type of the application that publishes the feature.
- The feature number is any 16-bit value used to distinguish between different features of a particular creator.

Once a feature is published, it remains present until it is explicitly unregistered or the device is reset. A feature published by an application sticks around even after the application quits.

This section introduces the feature manager by discussing these topics:

- The System Version Feature
- Application-Defined Features
- Using the Feature Manager
- Feature Memory

The System Version Feature

An example for a feature is the system version. This feature is published by the system and contains a 32-bit representation of the system version. The system version has a feature creator of `sysFtrCreator` and a feature number of `sysFtrNumROMVersion`). Currently, the different versions of the system software have the following numbers:

0x01003001	Palm OS 1.0
0x02003000	Palm OS 2.0
0x03003000	Palm OS 3.0
0x03103000	Palm OS 3.1
0x03203000	Palm OS 3.2
0x03503000	Palm OS 3.5
0x04003000	Palm OS 4.0

Rather than hard wiring an obscure constant like one of the above into your code, however, you can use the `sysMakeROMVersion`

macro (defined in `SystemMgr.h`) to construct a version number for comparison purposes. It takes five parameters:

- Major version number
- Minor version number
- Fix level
- Build stage (either `sysROMStageDevelopment`, `sysROMStageAlpha`, `sysROMStageBeta`, or `sysROMStageRelease`)
- Build number

The fix level and build number parameters are normally set to zero, while build stage is usually set to `sysROMStageRelease`. Simply check to see whether `sysFtrNumROMVersion` is greater than or equal to the version number constructed with `sysMakeROMVersion`, as shown here:

```
// See if we're on ROM version 3.1 or later.
FtrGet(sysFtrCreator, sysFtrNumROMVersion, &romVersion);
if (romVersion >= sysMakeROMVersion(3, 1, 0,
    sysROMStageRelease, 0)) {
   ....
}
```

Other system features are defined in `SystemMgr.h`. System features are stored in a feature table in the ROM. (In Palm OS 3.1 and higher, the contents of this table are copied into the RAM feature table at system startup.) Checking for the presence of system features allows an application to be compatible with multiple versions of the system by refining its behavior depending on which capabilities are present or not. Future hardware platforms may lack some capabilities present in the first platform, so checking the system version feature is important.

IMPORTANT: For best results, we recommend that you check for specific features rather than relying on the system version number to determine if a specific API is available. For more details on checking for features, see the appendix Compatibility Guide in *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

Application-Defined Features

Applications may find the feature manager useful for their own private use. For example, an application may want to publish a feature that contains a pointer to some private data it needs for processing launch codes. Because an application's global data is not generally available while it processes launch codes, using the feature manager is usually the easiest way for an application to get to its data.

The feature manager maintains one feature table in the RAM as well as the feature table in the ROM. Application-defined features are stored in the RAM feature table.

Using the Feature Manager

To check whether a particular feature is present, call `FtrGet` and pass it the feature creator and feature number. If the feature exists, `FtrGet` returns the 32-bit value of the feature. If the feature doesn't exist, an error code is returned.

To publish a new feature or change the value of an existing one, call `FtrSet` and pass the feature creator, number, and the 32-bit value of the feature. A published feature remains available until it is explicitly removed by a call to `FtrUnregister` or until the system resets; simply quitting an application doesn't remove a feature published by that application.

Call `FtrUnregister` to remove features that were created by calling `FtrSet`.

You can get a complete list of all published features by calling `FtrGetByIndex` repeatedly. Passing an index value starting at 0 to `FtrGetByIndex` and incrementing repeatedly by 1 eventually returns all available features. `FtrGetByIndex` accepts a parameter that specifies whether to search the ROM feature table or RAM feature table. Note that in Palm OS version 3.1 and higher, the contents of the ROM table are copied into the RAM table at system startup; thus the RAM table serves the entire system.

Feature Memory

Palm OS 3.1 adds support for **feature memory**. Feature memory provides quick, efficient access to data that persists between invocations of an application. The values stored in feature memory persist until the device is reset or until you explicitly free the memory. Feature memory is memory allocated from the storage heap. Thus, you write to feature memory using `DmWrite`, which means that writing to feature memory is no faster than writing to a database. However, feature memory can provide more efficient access to that data in certain circumstances.

To allocate a chunk of feature memory, call `FtrPtrNew`, specifying a feature creator, a feature number, the number of bytes to allocate, and a location where the feature manager can return a pointer to the newly allocated memory chunk. For example:

```
FtrPtrNew(appCreator,
    myFtrMemFtr, 32, &ftrMem);
```

Elsewhere in your application, you can obtain the pointer to the feature memory chunk using `FtrGet`.

NOTE: Starting with Palm OS 3.5 `FtrPtrNew` allows allocating chunks larger than 64KB. Do keep in mind standard issues with allocating large chunks of memory: there might not be enough contiguous space, and it can impact system performance.

Feature memory is considered a performance optimization. The conditions under which you'd use it are not common, and you probably won't find them in a typical application. You use feature memory in code that:

- Is executed infrequently
- Does not have access to global variables
- Needs access to data whose contents change infrequently and that cannot be stored in a 32-bit feature value

For example, suppose you've written a function that is called in response to a launch code, and you expect to receive this launch code frequently. Suppose that function needs access to the application's preferences database. At the start of the function, you'd

need to open the database and read the data from it. If the function is called frequently, opening the database each time can be a drain on performance. Instead, you can allocate a chunk of feature memory and write the values you need to that chunk. Because the chunk persists until the device is reset, you only need to open the database once. Listing 10.1 illustrates this example.

Listing 10.1 Using feature memory

```
MyAppPreferencesType prefs;

if (FtrGet(appCreator, myPrefFtr, (UInt32*)&prefs) != 0) {

   // Feature memory doesn't exist, so allocate it.
   FtrPtrNew(appCreator, myPrefFtr, 32, &thePref);

   // Load the preferences database.
   PrefGetAppPreferences (appCreator, prefID, &prefs,
      sizeof(prefs), true);

   // Write it to feature memory.
   DmWrite(thePref, 0, &prefs, sizeof(prefs));
}
// Now prefs is guaranteed to be defined.
```

Another potential use of feature memory is to "publish" data from your application or library to other applications when that data doesn't fit in a normal 32-bit feature value. For example, suppose you are writing a communications library and you want to publish an icon that client applications can use to draw the current connection state. The library can use `FtrPtrNew` to allocate a feature memory chunk and store an icon representing the current state in that location. Applications can then use `FtrGet` to access the icon and pass the result to `WinDrawBitmap` to display the connection state on the screen.

Preferences

The Preferences Manager handles both system-wide preferences and application-specific preferences. The Preferences Manager maintains preferences in two separate databases:

- The "saved" preferences database contains preferences that are backed up during a HotSync operation. There is one "saved" preferences database that all applications use. This database contains all system-wide preferences as well as application-specific preferences.
- The "unsaved" preferences database contains application-specific preferences that are not to be backed up during a HotSync operation. There is one "unsaved" preferences database that all application use.

This section describes how to obtain and set values for each of these preferences databases. It covers:

- Accessing System Preferences
- Setting System Preferences
- Setting Application-Specific Preferences

Accessing System Preferences

The system preferences specify how users want their Palm Powered handhelds to behave. For example, system preferences specify how dates and times are displayed and whether the system plays a sound when an alarm fires. These values are typically set using the built-in Preferences or Security application. Applications should, as a rule, respect the values stored in the system preferences.

To obtain the value of a system preference, use the `PrefGetPreference` function and pass one of the `SystemPreferencesChoice` enum constants. For example, if an application's user interface displays the current date and time, it could do the following to find out how the user wants the date and time displayed:

```
TimeFormatType timeFormat = (TimeFormatType)
   PrefGetPreference(prefTimeFormat);
DateFormatType dateFormat = (DateFormatType)
   PrefGetPreference(prefDateFormat);
```

WARNING! Do not confuse `PrefGetPreference` with `PrefGetPreferences`. The latter function is obsolete and retrieves the 1.0 version of the system preferences structure.

Note that the `PrefGetPreference` function by default returns a `UInt32` value. This return value must be cast to the appropriate type for the preference being returned.

Also note that the system preferences structure has been updated many times and maintains its own version information. Each Palm OS release that modifies the system preferences structure adds its new values to the end and increments the structure's version number. See Table 10.1.

Table 10.1 System preference version numbers

Palm OS Version	System Preference Version
2.0	2
3.0	3
3.0	4
3.1	5
3.2	6
3.3	7
3.5	8
4.0	9

To learn which preferences were added in which version, as well as the return type expected for each preference, see Table 44.1 on page 738 in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

To maintain backward compatibility, check the preference version number before checking the value of any preference added after Palm OS 2.0. For example, Palm OS 4.0 added a preference that allows you to access the device's locale information (the country and language) as an `LmLocaleType` structure. Before you try to access that preference, you should check the preference version, as shown in Listing 10.2.

Listing 10.2 Checking the system preference version

```
LmLocaleType currentLocale;
CountryType currentCountry;
if (PrefGetPreference(prefVersion) >= preferenceDataVer9) {
   currentLocale = (LmLocaleType)
     PrefGetPreference(prefLocale);
} else { /* make do with the country */
   currentCountry = (CountryType)
     PrefGetPreference(prefCountry);
}
```

In some cases, a newer preference is intended to replace an existing preference. For example, the `prefAutoOffDuration` preference is replaced by `prefAutoOffDurationSecs` in version 8 of the preference structure. The older preference stored the auto-off time in minutes, and the newer one stores the time in seconds. If you use `prefAutoOffDuration` in Palm OS 4.0, the system still returns the current auto-off time in minutes; however, to obtain this value, the system converts the value in seconds to minutes and rounds the result if necessary. You'll receive a more precise value if you use `prefAutoOffDurationSecs`.

Setting System Preferences

Occasionally, an application may need to set the value of a system-wide preference. It is strongly recommended that you not override the system preferences without user input.

For example, suppose you are writing a replacement for the built-in Address Book application. The Preferences application contains a panel where the user can remap the Address Book hard key to open any application they choose. However, you want to make it more convenient for your users to remap the Address Book button, so you might display an alert that asks first-time users if they want the button remapped. If they tap Yes, then you should call `PrefSetPreference` with the new value. The code might look like the following:

Listing 10.3 Setting a system preference

```
if (PrefGetPreference(prefHard2CharAppCreator !=
      myAppCreatorId)) {
   if (FrmAlert(MakeMeTheDefaultAlert) == 0) {
      /* user pressed Yes */
      PrefSetPreference(prefHard2CharAppCreator ,
         myAppCreatorId);
   }
}
```

WARNING! Do not confuse `PrefSetPreference` with `PrefSetPreferences`. The latter function is obsolete and sets the entire system preferences structure for version 1.0.

Setting Application-Specific Preferences

You can use the Preferences Manager to set and retrieve preferences specific to your application. You do this by storing the preferences in one of two databases: the "saved" preferences database or the "unsaved" preferences database.

To write application preferences, you use `PrefSetAppPreferences`. To read them back in, you use `PrefGetAppPreferences`. Typically, you write the preferences in response to the `appStopEvent` when control is about to pass to another application. You read the preferences in response to a normal launch.

`PrefSetAppPreferences` and `PrefGetAppPreferences` take roughly the same parameters: the application creator ID, a preference ID that uniquely identifies this preference resource, a pointer to a structure that holds the preference values, the size of the preferences structure, and a Boolean that indicates whether the "saved" or the "unsaved" preferences database is to be used. `PrefSetAppPreferences` also takes a version number for the preference structure. This value is the return value for `PrefGetAppPreferences`.

The following sections discuss the issues involved in using application-specific preferences:

- When to Use Application Preferences
- How to Store Preferences
- Which Preferences Database to Use
- Updating Preferences Upon a New Release

When to Use Application Preferences

You use application preferences to store state specific to your application that should persist across invocations of your application. For example, the built-in applications store information about the last form and the last record or records displayed before control switched to another application. This way, the user can be returned to the same view when he or she goes back to that application.

You can also use preferences for other values. You might allow the user to customize the way the application behaves and store such information in the preferences database. You might also use the preferences database as a way to share information with other applications.

Make sure that the preference values you choose are as concise as possible. In games, for example, it is often tempting to store a bitmap for the current state of the screen. Such a bitmap is over 25KB on a color device, and it is therefore best avoided. Instead, it is better to store items that let you recreate the current state, such as the player's position in pixels and the current level.

There are other ways to store values pertinent to your application. For example, you can store a single value as a feature using the Feature Manager. The differences between storing application value as preferences and storing application values as features are:

- Preferences (including those stored in the "unsaved" database) survive a soft reset because they reside in the storage heap. Features are deleted upon a soft reset. For this reason, preferences are more appropriate for storing application state than feature are.
- An application preference is a database record, so it has a size limit of 64KB. Multiple application preferences are allowed.

The features that are supported by all releases of Palm OS have a maximum size of 4KB.

In Palm OS 3.1 and higher, you can create features greater than 4KB by using feature memory. Feature memory has a maximum size of 64KB before Palm OS 3.5. Palm OS 3.5 and higher allows allocating a chunk of feature memory that is larger than 64KB. However, feature memory is intended to be used in different situations than an application preference is. See the section "Feature Memory" on page 275 for more information.

Instead of storing application state values as preferences or features, you could also use a database that your application creates and maintains itself. If you choose this method of storing application preference values, you must write your own functions to read the preferences from the database and write the preferences to the database. If you want the preferences backed up, you need to set the backup bit. However, there may be cases where using your own database has advantages. See "Which Preferences Database to Use" on page 283.

How to Store Preferences

Most applications store a single preference structure under a single preference resource ID. When the application receives an `appStopEvent`, it writes the entire structure to the resource using `PrefSetAppPreferences`. When it receives a `sysAppLaunchCmdNormalLaunch`, it reads the structure back in using `PrefGetAppPreferences`.

Storing a single preference structure in the database is a convention that most applications follow because it is convenient to access the all preferences at once. The Preferences Manager does allow an application to store more than one preference resource. This requires more calls to `PrefSetAppPreferences` and `PrefGetAppPreferences`, but you may find it more convenient to use several preference resources if you have several variable-length preferences.

Which Preferences Database to Use

Both `PrefGetAppPreferences` and `PrefSetAppPreferences` take a Boolean value that indicates whether the value is to be read from and written to the "saved" or the "unsaved" preferences database. To write the preference to the "saved" preferences database, use `true`. To write to the "unsaved" preferences database, use `false`.

The only difference between the two databases is that the "saved" preferences database is backed up when a user performs the HotSync operation, and the "unsaved" preferences database is not backed up by default. (The user can use a third-party tool to set the backup bit in the "unsaved" preferences database, which would cause it to be backed up.) Both the "saved" and the "unsaved" preferences reside in the storage heap and thus persist across soft resets. The only way that preferences are lost is if a hard reset is performed.

Use the "saved" preferences only for items that must be restored after a hard reset, and use the "unsaved" preferences for the current state of the application. For example, if your application has a registration code, you might write that to the "saved" preferences database so that the user does not have to look up the registration code and re-enter it after a hard reset. However, such items as the current form being displayed and the current database record being displayed can be lost, so they are written to the "unsaved" preferences database. For games, you might write the high score to the "saved" preferences database and any information about the current game to the "unsaved" preferences database.

It is important to use the "saved" preferences database sparingly. Any time that any application stores or changes a preference in the "saved" preferences database, the **entire** database is backed up during the next HotSync operation. For users with a large number of applications, this practice can seriously impact the time that it takes to perform a HotSync operation.

Listing 10.4 shows the preferences structures and the `StopApplication` function from the HardBall application. The `HardBallPreferenceType`, which is written to the "saved" preferences database, only stores the high score information and accumulated time. All other preferences are stored in `GameStatusType`, which is written to the "unsaved" preferences database.

Listing 10.4 Saving application-specific preferences

```
typedef struct {
   SavedScore highScore[highScoreMax];
   UInt8 lastHighScore;
   UInt8 startLevel;
   UInt32  accumulatedTime;
} HardBallPreferenceType;

typedef struct {
   enum gameProgress  status;
   UInt8  periodLength;
   UInt32 nextPeriodTime;
   UInt32 periodsToWait;
   Boolean  paused;
   UInt32  pausedTime;
   BrickType  brick[rowsOfBricks][columnsOfBricks];
   UInt8  bricksRemaining;
   UInt8 level;
   WorldState last;
   WorldState next;
   RemovedBrick brokenBricks[brokenBricksMax];
   Int16  brokenBricksCount;
   UInt8 ballsRemaining;
   Boolean movePaddleLeft;
   Boolean movePaddleRight;
   SoundType  soundToMake;
   Int8  soundPeriodsRemaining;
   Int32  scoreToAwardBonusBall;
   Boolean lowestHighScorePassed;
   Boolean highestHighScorePassed;
   Boolean gameSpedUp;
   Boolean  cheatMode;
   UInt32 startTime;
} GameStatusType;

HardBallPreferenceType Prefs;
static GameStatusType GameStatus;

static void StopApplication (void)
{
   ...
   // Update the time accounting.
   Prefs.accumulatedTime += (TimGetTicks() -
      GameStatus.startTime);

   // If we are saving a game resuming (it hasn't started
   // playing yet) then preserve the game status.
```

```
   if (GameStatus.status == gameResuming) {
      GameStatus.status = SavedGameStatus;
   }

   // Save state/prefs.
   PrefSetAppPreferences (appFileCreator, appPrefID,
      appPrefVersion, &Prefs, sizeof (Prefs), true);

   PrefSetAppPreferences (appFileCreator, appSavedGameID,
      appSavedGameVersion, &GameStatus, sizeof (GameStatus),
      false);

   // Close all the open forms.
   FrmCloseAllForms ();
}
```

If you have a large amount of preference data that must be backed up during a HotSync operation and is frequently changed, you could, as a performance optimization, store the preferences in a database that your own application creates and maintains rather than in the "saved" preferences database. This saves the user from having to have the entire "saved" preferences database backed up on every HotSync operation. The disadvantage of this method of saving application preferences is that you must write all code to maintain the database and to retrieve information from it.

Updating Preferences Upon a New Release

When you update your application, you may have new items that you want to store in the preferences database. You may choose to write a separate preference record to the database. However, it is better to update the current preference structure, size permitting.

The `PrefSetAppPreferences` and `PrefGetAppPreferences` functions use a versioning system that allows you to update an existing preference structure. To use it, keep track of the version number that you pass to `PrefSetAppPreferences`. Add any new preferences to the end of the preferences structure, and then increment the version number. You might use a macro for this purpose:

```
#define CurrentPrefsVersion 2
```

When a user launches the new version of the application, `PrefGetAppPreferences` is called before

`PrefSetAppPreferences`. The `PrefGetAppPreferences` function returns the version number of the preference structure that it retrieved from the database. For example, if the new version is version 2, `PrefGetAppPreferences` returns 1 the first time that version 2 is run. If the returned version does not match the current version, you know that the user does not have values for the new preferences introduced in version 2. You can then decide to provide default values for those new preferences.

The first time any version of your application is run, `PrefGetAppPreferences` returns `noPreferenceFound`. This indicates that the user does not have any preferences for the current application and the application must supply default values for the entire preferences structure. Listing 10.5 shows how the Datebook handles retrieving the version number from `PrefGetAppPreferences`.

Listing 10.5 Checking the preference version number

```
#define datebookPrefsVersionNum 4

Int16 DatebookLoadPrefs (DatebookPreferenceType* prefsP)
{
   UInt16 prefsSize;
   Int16 prefsVersion = noPreferenceFound;
   Boolean haveDefaultFont = false;
   UInt32 defaultFont;

   ErrNonFatalDisplayIf(!prefsP, "null prefP arg");


   // Read the preferences / saved-state information.  Fix-up if no prefs or
   // older/newer version
   prefsSize = sizeof (DatebookPreferenceType);
   prefsVersion = PrefGetAppPreferences (sysFileCDatebook, datebookPrefID,
      prefsP, &prefsSize, true);

   // If the preferences version is from a future release (as can happen when
   // going back and syncing to an older version of the device), treat it the
   // same as "not found" because it could be significantly different
   if ( prefsVersion > datebookPrefsVersionNum )
      prefsVersion = noPreferenceFound;

   if ( prefsVersion == noPreferenceFound ) {
      // Version 1 and 2 preferences
```

```
      prefsP->dayStartHour = defaultDayStartHour;
      prefsP->dayEndHour = defaultDayEndHour;
      prefsP->alarmPreset.advance = defaultAlarmPresetAdvance;
      prefsP->alarmPreset.advanceUnit = defaultAlarmPresetUnit;
      prefsP->saveBackup = defaultSaveBackup;
      prefsP->showTimeBars = defaultShowTimeBars;
      prefsP->compressDayView = defaultCompressDayView;
      prefsP->showTimedAppts = defaultShowTimedAppts;
      prefsP->showUntimedAppts = defaultShowUntimedAppts;
      prefsP->showDailyRepeatingAppts =
         defaultShowDailyRepeatingAppts;

      // We need to set up the note font with a default value for the system.
      FtrGet(sysFtrCreator, sysFtrDefaultFont, &defaultFont);
      haveDefaultFont = true;

      prefsP->v20NoteFont = (FontID)defaultFont;
   }

   if ((prefsVersion == noPreferenceFound) || (prefsVersion <
         datebookPrefsVersionNum)) {
      // Version 3 preferences
      prefsP->alarmSoundRepeatCount = defaultAlarmSoundRepeatCount;
      prefsP->alarmSoundRepeatInterval = defaultAlarmSoundRepeatInterval;
      prefsP->alarmSoundUniqueRecID = defaultAlarmSoundUniqueRecID;
      prefsP->noteFont = prefsP->v20NoteFont;

      // Fix up the note font if we copied from older preferences.
      if ((prefsVersion != noPreferenceFound) && (prefsP->noteFont ==
            largeFont))
         prefsP->noteFont = largeBoldFont;

      if (!haveDefaultFont)
         FtrGet(sysFtrCreator, sysFtrDefaultFont, &defaultFont);

      prefsP->apptDescFont = (FontID)defaultFont;
   }

   if ((prefsVersion == noPreferenceFound) || (prefsVersion <
         datebookPrefsVersionNum)) {
      // Version 4 preferences
      prefsP->alarmSnooze = defaultAlarmSnooze;
   }

   return prefsVersion;
}
```

Sound

The Palm OS platform device has rudimentary sound generation. A square wave is generated directly from the 68328's PWM circuitry. There is frequency, duration, and volume control. Additionally, Palm OS 3.0 and higher support creating and playing standard MIDI sounds.

The Palm OS sound manager provides an extendable API for playing custom sounds and system sounds, and for controlling default sound settings. Although the sound API accommodates multichannel design, the system provides only a single sound channel at present.

The sound hardware can play only one simple tone at a time through an onboard piezoelectric speaker. Note that for a particular amplitude level, the Palm III™ device is slightly louder than its predecessors.

Single tones can be played by the `SndDoCmd` function and system sounds are played by the `SndPlaySystemSound` function. The end-user can control the amplitude of alarm sounds, game sounds, and system sounds by means of the Preferences application. System-supplied sounds include the Information, Warning, Error, Startup, Alarm, Confirmation, and Click sounds.

Palm OS 3.0 introduces support for Standard MIDI Files (SMFs), format 0. An SMF is a note-by-note description of a tune—Palm OS doesn't support sampled sound, multiple voices, or complex "instruments." You can download the SMF format specification from the `http://www.midi.org` Web site.

The alarm sounds used in the built-in Date Book application are SMFs stored in the System MIDI Sounds database and can be played by the `SndPlaySmf` function.

All SMF records in the System MIDI Sounds database are available to the user. Developers can add their own alarm SMFs to this database as a way to add variety and personalization to their devices. You can use the `sysFileTMidi` file type and `sysFileCSystem` creator to open this database.

Each record in the database is a single SMF, with a header structure containing the user-visible name. The record includes a song header,

then a track header, followed by any number of events. The system only recognizes the `keyDown`, `keyUp` and `tempo` events in a single track; other commands which might be in the SMF are ignored. For more information, see the following:

- Adding a Standard MIDI File to a Database in this chapter.
- SndCallbackInfoType in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.
- SndMidiRecHdrType in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

You can use standard MIDI tools to create SMF blocks on desktop computers, or you can write code to create them on the Palm OS device. The sample code project "RockMusic," particularly the routines in the `MakeSMF.c` file, can be helpful to see how to create an SMF programmatically.

Previous versions of Palm OS don't support SMFs or asynchronous notes; don't use the new routines or commands when the `FtrGet` function returns a system version of less than `0x03000000`. Doing so will crash your application. See the section "The System Version Feature" for more information.

Synchronous and Asynchronous Sound

The `SndDoCmd` function executes synchronously or asynchronously according to the operation it is to perform. The `sndCmdNoteOn` and `sndCmdFrqOn` operations execute asynchronously; that is, they are non-blocking and can be interrupted by another sound command. In contrast, the `sndCmdFreqDurationAmp` operation is synchronous and blocking (it cannot be interrupted).

The `SndPlaySmf` function is also synchronous and blocking; however, the Sound Manager polls the key queue periodically during playback and halts playback in progress if it finds events generated by user interaction with the screen, digitizer, or hardware-based buttons. Optionally, the caller can override this default behavior to specify that the `SndPlaySmf` function play the SMF to completion without being interrupted by user events. In Palm OS 4.0, three functions were added that allow you to interrupt a `SndPlaySmf` call that normally blocks: `SndInterruptSmfIrregardless` simply interrputs the

currently-playing sound, while SndPlaySmfIrregardless and SndPlaySmfResourceIrregardless interrupt the current sound and also start a new one playing.

Using the Sound Manager

Before playing custom sounds that require a volume (amplitude) setting, your code needs to discover the user's current volume settings. To do so in Palm OS 3.X, pass one of the prefSysSoundVolume, prefGameSoundVolume, or prefAlarmSoundVolume selectors to the PrefGetPreference function.

NOTE: See "Sound Preferences Compatibility Information" for important information regarding the correct use of sound preferences in various versions of Palm OS.

You can pass the returned amplitude information to the SndPlaySmf function as one element of a SndSmfOptionsType parameter block. Alternatively, you can pass amplitude information to the SndDoCmd function as an element of a SndCommandType parameter block.

To execute a sound manager command, pass to the SndDoCmd function a sound channel pointer (presently, only NULL is supported and maps to the shared channel), a pointer to a structure of SndCommandType, and a flag indicating whether the command should be performed asynchronously.

To play SMFs, call the SndPlaySMF function. This function, which is new in Palm OS 3.0, is used by the built in Date Book application to play alarm sounds.

To play single notes, you can use either of the SndPlaySMF or SndDoCmd functions. Of course, you can use the SndPlaySMF function to play a single MIDI note from an SMF. You can also use the SndDoCmd function to play a single MIDI note by passing the sndCmdNoteOn command selector to this function. To specify by frequency the note to be played, pass the sndCmdFrqOn command selector to the SndDoCmd function.You can pass the sndCmdQuiet selector to this function to stop playback of the current note.

The system provides no specialized API for playing game sounds. Game sounds are implemented by the game developer using any appropriate element of the Sound Manager API. Games should observe the `prefGameSoundVolume` setting, as described in the section "Sound Preferences Compatibility Information."

To play a default system sound, such as a click or an error beep, pass the appropriate system sound ID to the `SndPlaySystemSound` function, which will play that sound at the volume level specified by the user's system sound preference. For the complete list of system sound IDs, see the `SoundMgr.h` file provided by the Palm OS SDK.

Adding a Standard MIDI File to a Database

To add a format 0 standard MIDI file to the system MIDI database, you can use code similar to the `AddSmfToDatabase` example function shown in the following code listing. This function returns 0 if successful, and returns a non-zero value otherwise. To use a different database, pass different creator and type values to the `DmOpenDatabaseByTypeCreator` function.

Listing 10.6 AddSmfToDatabase

```
// Useful structure field offset macro
#define prvFieldOffset(type, field) ((UInt32)(&((type*)0)-
>field))

// returns 0 for success, nonzero for error
Int16 AddSmfToDatabase(MemHandle smfH, Char* trackName)
{
   Err            err = 0;
   DmOpenRef      dbP;
   UInt16*        recIndex;
   MemHandle      recH;
   UInt8*         recP;
   UInt8*         smfP;
   UInt32         bMidiOffset;
   UInt32         dwSmfSize;
   SndMidiRecHdrType       recHdr;

   bMidiOffset = sizeof(SndMidiRecHdrType) +
                       StrLen(trackName) + 1;
   dwSmfSize = MemHandleSize(smfH);
```

```
   recHdr.signature = sndMidiRecSignature;
   recHdr.reserved = 0;
   recHdr.bDataOffset = bMidiOffset;

   dbP = DmOpenDatabaseByTypeCreator(sysFileTMidi,
sysFileCSystem,
                                          dmModeReadWrite |
dmModeExclusive);
   if (!dbP)
      return 1;

   // Allocate a new record for the midi resource
   recIndex = dmMaxRecordIndex;
   recH = DmNewRecord(dbP, &recIndex, dwSmfSize +
bMidiOffset);
   if ( !recH )
      return 2;

   // Lock down the source SMF and target record and copy the
data
   smfP = MemHandleLock(smfH);
   recP = MemHandleLock(recH);

   err = DmWrite(recP, 0, &recHdr, sizeof(recHdr));
   if (!err) err = DmStrCopy(recP,
prvFieldOffset(SndMidiRecType,
        name), trackName);
   if (!err) err = DmWrite(recP, bMidiOffset, smfP,
dwSmfSize);

   // Unlock the pointers
   MemHandleUnlock(smfH);
   MemHandleUnlock(recH);

   //Because DmNewRecord marks the new record as busy,
   // we must call DmReleaseRecord before closing the
database
   DmReleaseRecord(dbP, recIndex, 1);

   DmCloseDatabase(dbP);

   return err;
}
```

Saving References to Standard MIDI Files

To save a reference to a SMF stored in a particular database, save its record ID and the name of the database in which it is stored. Do not store the database ID between invocations of your application, because various events, such as a HotSync®, can invalidate database IDs. Using an invalid database ID can crash your application.

Retrieving a Standard MIDI File From a Database

Standard MIDI Files (SMFs) are stored as individual records in a MIDI record database—one SMF per record. Palm OS defines the database type `sysFileTMidi` for MIDI record databases. The system MIDI database, with type `sysFileTMidi` and creator `sysFileCSystem`, holds multiple system alarm sounds. In addition, your applications can create their own private MIDI databases of type `sysFileTMidi` and your own creator.

To obtain a particular SMF, you need to identify the database in which it resides and the specific database record which holds the SMF data. The database record itself is always identified by record ID. The MIDI database in which it resides may be identified by name or by database ID. If you know the creator of the SMF, you can use the `SndCreateMidiList` utility function to retrieve this information. Alternatively, you can use the Data Manager record API functions to iterate through MIDI database records manually in search of this information.

The `SndCreateMidiList` utility function retrieves information about Standard Midi Files from one or more MIDI databases. This information is returned as a table of entries. Each entry contains the name of an SMF; its unique record ID; and the database ID and card number of the record database in which it resides.

Once you have the appropriate identifiers for the record and the database in which it resides, you need to open the MIDI database. If you have identified the database by type and creator, pass the `sysFileTMidi` type and an appropriate creator value to the `DmOpenDatabaseByTypeCreator` function. For example, to retrieve a SMF from the system MIDI database, pass type `sysFileTMidi` and creator `sysFileCSystem`. The `DmOpenDatabaseByTypeCreator` function returns a reference to the open database.

If you have identified the database by name, rather than by creator, you'll need to discover its database ID in order to open it. The DmFindDatabase function returns the database ID for a database specified by name and card number. You can pass the returned ID to the DmOpenDatabase function to open the database and obtain a reference to it.

Once you have opened the MIDI database, call DmFindRecordByID to get the index of the SMF record. To retrieve the record itself, pass this index value to either of the functions DmQueryRecord or DmGetRecord. When you intend to modify the record, use the DmGetRecord function—it marks the record as busy. When you intend to use the record in read-only fashion, use the DmQueryRecord function —it does not mark the record as busy. You must lock the handle returned by either of these functions before making further use of it.

To lock the database record's handle, pass it to the MemHandleLock function, which returns a pointer to the locked record holding the SMF data. You can pass this pointer to the SndPlaySmf function in the smfP parameter to play the MIDI file.

When you've finished using the record, unlock the pointer to it by calling the MemPtrUnlock function. If you've used DmGetRecord to open the record for editing, you must call DmReleaseRecord to make the record available once again to other callers. If you used DmQueryRecord to open the record for read-only use, you need not call DmReleaseRecord.

Finally, close the database by calling the DmCloseDatabase function.

Sound Preferences Compatibility Information

The sound preferences implementation and API varies slightly among versions 1.0, 2.0, and 3.X of Palm OS. This section describes how to use sound preferences correctly for various versions of Palm OS.

Because versions 2.0 and 3.X of Palm OS provide backward compatibility with previous sound preference mechanisms, applications written for an earlier version of the sound preferences API will get correct sound preference information from newer

versions of Palm OS. However, it is strongly recommended that new applications use the latest API.

Using Sound Preferences on All Palm OS Devices

Because the user chooses sound preference settings, your application should respect them and adhere to their values. Further, you should always treat sound preferences as read-only values.

At reset time, the sound manager reads stored preference values and caches them for use at run time. The user interface controls update both the stored preference values and the sound manager's cached values.

The `PrefSetPreference` function writes to stored preference values without affecting cached values. New values are read at the next system reset. The system-use-only `SndSetDefaultVolume` function updates cached values but not stored preferences. Applications should avoid modifying stored preferences or cached values in favor of respecting the user's choices for preferences.

Using Palm OS 1.0 Sound Preferences

To read sound preference values in version 1.0 of Palm OS, call the `PrefGetPreferences` function to obtain the data structure shown in Listing 10.7. This `SystemPreferencesTypeV10` structure holds the current values of all system-wide preferences. You must extract from this structure the values of the `sysSoundLevel` and `alarmSoundLevel` fields. These values are the only sound preference information that Palm OS version 1.0 provides.

Each of these fields holds a value of either `slOn` (on) or `slOff` (off). Your code must interpret the values read from these fields as an indication of whether those volumes should be on or off, then map them to appropriate amplitude values to pass to Sound Manager functions: map the `slOn` selector to the `sndMaxAmp` constant (defined in `SoundMgr.h`) and map the `slOff` selector to the value `0` (zero).

Listing 10.7 `SystemPreferencesTypeV10` data structure

```
typedef struct {
   UInt16 version;      // Version of preference info

   // International preferences
```

```
   CountryType country;  // Country the device is in
   DateFormatType dateFormat;  // Format to display date in
   DateFormatType longDateFormat;  // Format to display date
in
   UInt8 weekStartDay;  // Sunday or Monday
   TimeFormatType timeFormat;  // Format to display time in
   NumberFormatType numberFormat;  // Format to display
numbers in

   // system preferences
   UInt8 autoOffDuration;  // Time period before shutting off
   SoundLevelTypeV20 sysSoundLevel;  //error beeps
   SoundLevelTypeV20 alarmSoundLevel;   //alarm only
   Boolean hideSecretRecords;  // True to not display records
with
                                  // their secret bit
attribute set
   Boolean deviceLocked;          // Device locked until the
system
                                  // password is entered
   UInt16  sysPrefFlags;   // Miscellaneous system pref flags
copied into
                           // the global GSysPrefFlags at boot
time.
   SysBatteryKind sysBatteryKind;
                                       // The type of
batteries installed.
                                      // This is copied into
the globals
                                      // GSysbatteryKind at
boot time.

   } SystemPreferencesTypeV10;
```

Using Palm OS 2.0 Sound Preferences

Version 2.0 of Palm OS introduces a new API for retrieving individual preference values from the system. You can pass any of the selectors `prefSysSoundLevelV20`, `prefGameSoundLevelV20`, or `prefAlarmSoundLevelV20` to the `PrefGetPreference` function to retrieve individual amplitude preference values for alarm sounds, game sounds, or for overall (system) sound amplitude. As in Palm OS 1.0, each of these settings holds values of either `slOn` (on) or `slOff` (off), as defined in the Preferences.h file. Your code must interpret the values read

from these fields as an indication of whether those volumes should be on or off, then map them to appropriate amplitude values to pass to Sound Manager functions: map the `slOn` selector to the `sndMaxAmp` constant (defined in `SoundMgr.h` file) and map the `slOff` selector to the value `0` (zero).

For a complete listing of selectors you can pass to the `PrefGetPreference` function, see the `Preferences.h` file.

Using Palm OS 3.X Sound Preferences

Palm OS version 3.X enhances the resolution of sound preference settings by providing discrete amplitude levels for games, alarms, and the system overall. As usual, do not set preferences yourself, but treat them as read-only values indicating the proper volume level for your application to use.

Palm OS 3.X defines the new sound amplitude selectors `prefSysSoundVolume`, `prefGameSoundVolume`, and `prefAlarmSoundVolume` for use with the `PrefGetPreference` function. The values this function returns for these selectors are actual amplitude settings that may be passed directly to Sound Manager functions.

NOTE: The amplitude selectors used in previous versions of Palm OS (all ending with the `Level` suffix, such as `prefGameSoundLevel`) are obsoleted in version 3.0 of Palm OS and replaced by new selectors. The old selectors remain available in Palm OS 3.X to ensure backward compatibility and are suffixed `V20` (for example, `prefGameSoundLevelV20`).

Ensuring Sound Preferences Compatibility

For greatest compatibility with multiple versions of the sound preferences mechanism, your application should condition its sound preference code according to the version of Palm OS on which it is running. See "The System Version Feature" for more information.

When your application is launched, it should retrieve the system version number and save the results in its global variables (or equivalent structure) for use elsewhere. If the major version number

is 3 (three) or greater, then use the 3.0 mechanism for obtaining sound amplitude preferences, since this reflects the user's selection most accurately. If the major version number is 2 (two), then use the 2.0 mechanism described in "Using Palm OS 2.0 Sound Preferences." If it is 1 (one), then use the 1.0 mechanism described in "Using Palm OS 1.0 Sound Preferences."

Avoid calling new APIs (including new selectors) when running on older versions of Palm OS that do not implement them. In particular, note that violating any of the following conditions will cause your application to crash:

- Do not call either of the `SndPlaySmf` or `SndCreateMidiList` functions on versions of Palm OS prior to 3.0.
- Do not pass any selector other than `sndCmdFreqDurationAmp` to the `SndDoCmd` function on versions of Palm OS prior to 3.0.

System Boot and Reset

Any reset is normally performed by sticking a bent-open paper clip into the small hole in the back of the device. This hole, known as the "reset switch" is above and to the right of the serial number sticker (on Palm III devices). Depending on additional keys held down, the reset behavior varies, as follows:

Soft Reset

A soft reset clears all of the dynamic heap (Heap 0, Card 0). The storage heaps remain untouched. The operating system restarts from scratch with a new stack, new global variables, restarted drivers, and a reset communication port. All applications on the device receive a `sysAppLaunchCmdSystemReset` launch code.

Soft Reset + Up Arrow

Holding the up-arrow down while pressing the reset switch with a paper clip causes the same soft reset logic with the following two exceptions:

- The `sysAppLaunchCmdSystemReset` launch code is not sent to applications. This is useful if there is an application on the device that crashes upon receiving this launch code (not uncommon) and therefore prevents the system from booting.
- The OS won't load any system patches during startup. This is useful if you have to delete or replace a system patch database. If the system patches are loaded and therefore open, they cannot be replaced or deleted from the system.

Hard Reset

A hard reset is performed by pressing the reset switch with a paper clip while holding down the power key. This has all the effects of the soft reset. In addition, the storage heaps are erased. As a result, all programs, data, patches, user information, etc. are lost. A confirmation message is displayed asking the user to confirm the deletion of all data.

The `sysAppLaunchCmdSystemReset` launch code is sent to the applications at this time. If the user selected the "Delete all data" option, the digitizer calibration screen comes up first. The default databases for the four main applications is copied out of the ROM.

If you hold down the up arrow key when the "Delete all data" message is displayed, and then press the other four application buttons while still holding the up arrow key, the system is booted without reading the default databases for the four main applications out of ROM.

System Reset Calls

The system manager provides support for booting the Palm OS device. It calls `SysReset` to reset the device. This call does a soft reset and has the same effect as pressing the reset switch on the unit. *Normally applications should not use this call.*

`SysReset` is used, for example, by the Sync application. When the user copies an extension onto the Palm OS device, the Sync application automatically resets the device after the sync is completed to allow the extension to install itself.

Hardware Interaction

Palm OS differs from a traditional desktop system in that it's never really turned off. Power is constantly supplied to essential subsystems and the on/off key is merely a way of bringing the device in or out of low-power mode. The obvious effect of pressing the on/off key is that the LCD turns on or off. When the user presses the power key to turn the device off, the LCD is disabled, which makes it appear as if power to the entire unit is turned off. In fact, the memory system, real-time clock, and the interrupt generation circuitry are still running, though they are consuming little current.

This section looks at Palm OS power management, discussing the following topics:

- Palm OS Power Modes
- Guidelines for Application Developers
- Power Management Calls

Palm OS Power Modes

To minimize power consumption, the operating system dynamically switches between three different modes of operation: sleep mode, doze mode, and running mode. The system manager controls transitions between different power modes and provides an API for controlling some aspects of the power management.

- In **sleep mode**, the device looks like it's turned off: the display is blank, the digitizer is inactive, and the main clock is stopped. The only circuits still active are the real-time clock and interrupt generation circuitry.

  The device enters this mode when there is no user activity for a number of minutes or when the user presses the off button. The device comes out of sleep mode only when there is an interrupt, for example, when the user presses a button.

  To enter sleep mode, the system puts as many peripherals as possible into low-power mode and sets up the hardware so that an interrupt from any hard key or the real-time clock wakes up the system. When the system gets one of these interrupts while in sleep mode, it quickly checks that the battery is strong enough to complete the wake-up and then

takes each of the peripherals, for example, the LCD, serial port, and timers, out of low-power mode.

- In **doze mode**, the main clock is running, the device appears to be turned on, the LCD is on, and the processor's clock is running but it's not executing instructions (that is, it's halted). When the processor receives an interrupt, it comes out of halt and starts processing the interrupt.

  The device enters this mode whenever it's on but has no user input to process.

  The system can come out of doze mode much faster than it can come out of sleep mode since none of the peripherals need to be woken up. In fact, it takes no longer to come out of doze mode than to process an interrupt. Usually, when the system appears on, it is actually in doze mode and goes into running mode only for short periods of time to process an interrupt or respond to user input like a pen tap or key press.

- In **running mode**, the processor is actually executing instructions.

  The device enters this mode when it detects user input (like a tap on the screen) while in doze mode or when it detects an interrupt while in doze or sleep mode. The device stays in running mode only as long as it takes to process the user input (most likely less than a second), then it immediately reenters doze mode. A typical application puts the system into running mode only about 5% of the time.

To maximize battery life, the processor on the Palm OS platform device is kept out of running mode as much as possible. Any interrupt generated on the device must therefore be capable of "waking" up the processor. The processor can receive interrupts from the serial port, the hard buttons on the case, the button on the cradle, the programmable timer, the memory module slot, the real-time clock (for alarms), the low-battery detector, and any built-in peripherals such as a pager or modem.

Guidelines for Application Developers

Normally, applications don't need to be aware of power management except for a few simple guidelines. When an

application calls EvtGetEvent to ask the system for the next event to process, the system automatically puts itself into doze mode until there is an event to process. As long as an application uses EvtGetEvent, power management occurs automatically. If there has been no user input for the amount of time determined by the current setting of the auto-off preference, the system automatically enters sleep mode without intervention from the application.

Applications should avoid providing their own delay loops. Instead, they should use SysTaskDelay, which puts the system into doze mode during the delay to conserve as much power as possible. If an application needs to perform periodic work, it can pass a time out to EvtGetEvent; this forces the unit to wake up out of doze mode and to return to the application when the time out expires, even if there is no event to process. Using these mechanisms provides the longest possible battery life.

Power Management Calls

The system calls SysSleep to put itself immediately into low-power sleep mode. Normally, the system puts itself to sleep when there has been no user activity for the minimum auto-off time or when the user presses the power key.

The SysSetAutoOffTime routine changes the auto-off time value. This routine is normally used by the system only during boot, and by the Preferences application. The Preferences application saves the user preference for the auto-off time in a preferences database, and the system initializes the auto-off time to the value saved in the preferences database during boot. While the auto-off feature can be disabled entirely by calling SysSetAutoOffTime with a time-out of 0, doing this depletes the battery.

The current battery level and other information can be obtained through the SysBatteryInfo routine. This call returns information about the battery, including the current battery voltage in hundredths of a volt, the warning thresholds for the low-battery alerts, the battery type, and whether external power is applied to the unit. This call can also change the battery warning thresholds and battery type.

The Microkernel

Palm OS has a preemptive multitasking kernel that provides basic task management.

Most applications don't need the microkernel services because they are handled automatically by the system. This functionality is provided mainly for internal use by the system software or for certain special purpose applications.

In this version of the Palm OS, there is only one user interface application running at a time. The User Interface Application Shell (UIAS) is responsible for managing the current user-interface application. The UIAS launches the current user-interface application as a subroutine and doesn't get control back until that application quits. When control returns to the UIAS, the UIAS immediately launches the next application as another subroutine. See "Power Management Calls" for more information.

Usually, the UIAS is the only task running. Occasionally though, an application launches another task as a part of its normal operation. One example of this is the Sync application, which launches a second task to handle the serial communication with the desktop. The Sync application creates a second task dedicated to the serial communication and gives this task a lower priority than the main user-interface task. The result is optimal performance over the serial port without a delay in response to the user-interface controls.

Normally, there is no user interaction during a sync, so that the serial communication task gets all of the processor's time. However, if the user does tap on the screen, for example, to cancel the sync, the user-interface task immediately processes the tap, since it has a higher priority. Alternatively, the Sync application could have been written to use just one task, but then it would have to periodically poll for user input during the serial communication, which would hamper performance and user-interface response time.

NOTE: Only system software can launch a separate task. The multi-tasking API is not available to developer applications.

Retrieving the ROM Serial Number

Some Palm™ devices, beginning with the Palm III product, hold a 12-digit serial number that identifies the device uniquely. (Earlier devices do not have this identifier.) The serial number is held in a displayable text buffer with no null terminator. The user can view the serial number in the Application Launcher application. (The pop-up version of the Launcher does not display the serial number.) The Application Launcher also displays to the user a checksum digit that you can use to validate user entry of the serial number.

To retrieve the ROM serial number programmatically, pass the `sysROMTokenSnum` selector to the `SysGetROMToken` function. If the `SysGetROMToken` function returns an error, or if the returned pointer to the buffer is `NULL`, or if the first byte of the text buffer is `0xFF`, then no serial number is available.

The `DrawSerialNumOrMessage` function shown in Listing 10.8 retrieves the ROM serial number, calculates the checksum, and draws both on the screen at a specified location. If the device has no serial number, this function draws a message you specify. This function accepts as its input a pair of coordinates at which it draws output, and a pointer to the message it draws when a serial number is not available.

Listing 10.8 DrawSerialNumOrMessage

```
static void DrawSerialNumOrMessage(Int16 x, Int16 y, Char*
noNumberMessage)
{
   Char* bufP;
   UInt16* bufLen;
   Err retval;
   Int16    count;
   UInt8    checkSum;
   Char    checksumStr[2];
      // holds the dash and the checksum digit

   retval = SysGetROMToken (0, sysROMTokenSnum,
                                        (UInt8**) &bufP,
&bufLen);
   if ((!retval) && (bufP) && ((UInt8) *bufP != 0xFF)) {
      // there's a valid serial number!
```

```
      // Calculate the checksum:  Start with zero, add each
digit,
      // then rotate the result one bit to the left and
repeat.
         checkSum = 0;
         for (count=0; count<bufLen; count++) {
            checkSum += bufP[count];
            checkSum = (checkSum<<1) | ((checkSum & 0x80) >>
7);
            }
      // Add the two hex digits (nibbles) together, +2
      // (range: 2 - 31 ==> 2-9, A-W)
      // By adding 2 to the result before converting to
ascii,
      // we eliminate the numbers 0 and 1, which can be
      // difficult to distinguish from the letters O and I.
      checkSum = ((checkSum>>4) & 0x0F) + (checkSum & 0x0F) +
2;

      // draw the serial number and find out how wide it was
      WinDrawChars(bufP, bufLen, x, y);
      x += FntCharsWidth(bufP, bufLen);

      // draw the dash and the checksum digit right after it
      checksumStr[0] = '-';
      checksumStr[1] =
         ((checkSum < 10) ? (checkSum +'0'):(checkSum -10
+'A'));
      WinDrawChars (checksumStr, 2, x, y);
      }
      else // there's no serial number
      // draw a status message if the caller provided one
      if (noNumberMessage)
         WinDrawChars(noNumberMessage,
StrLen(noNumberMessage),x, y);
}
```

Time

The Palm OS platform device has a real-time clock and programmable timer as part of the 68328 processor. The real-time clock maintains the current time even when the system is in sleep mode (turned off). It's capable of generating an interrupt to wake the device when an alarm is set by the user. The programmable timer is used to generate the system tick count interrupts (100

times/second) while the processor is in doze or running mode. The system tick interrupts are required for periodic activity such as polling the digitizer for user input, key debouncing, etc.

The date and time manager (called time manager in this chapter) provides access to both the 1-second and 0.01-second timing resources on the Palm OS device.

- The 1-second timer keeps track of the real-time clock (date and time), even when the unit is in sleep mode.
- The 0.01-second timer, also referred to as the **system ticks**, can be used for finer timing tasks. This timer is not updated when the unit is in sleep mode and is reset to 0 each time the unit resets.

The basic time-manager API provides support for setting and getting the real-time clock in seconds and for getting the current system ticks value (but not for setting it). The system manager provides more advanced functionality for setting up a timer task that executes periodically or in a given number of system ticks.

This section discusses the following topics:

- Using Real-Time Clock Functions
- Using System Ticks Functions

Using Real-Time Clock Functions

The real-time clock functions of the time manager include `TimSetSeconds` and `TimGetSeconds`. Real time on the Palm OS device is measured in seconds from midnight, Jan. 1, 1904. Call `TimSecondsToDateTime` and `TimDateTimeToSeconds` to convert between seconds and a structure specifying year, month, day, hour, minute, and second.

Using System Ticks Functions

The Palm OS device maintains a tick count that starts at 0 when the device is reset. This tick increments

- 100 times per second when running on the Palm OS device
- 60 times per second when running on the Macintosh under the Simulator

For tick-based timing purposes, applications should use the macro SysTicksPerSecond, which is conditionally compiled for different platforms. Use the function TimGetTicks to read the current tick count.

Although the TimGetTicks function could be used in a loop to implement a delay, it is recommended that applications use the SysTaskDelay function instead. The SysTaskDelay function automatically puts the unit into low-power mode during the delay. Using TimGetTicks in a loop consumes much more current.

Floating-Point

The Palm OS supports IEEE-754 single and double precision floating-point numbers declared with the C types float and double. Numbers of type float occupy four bytes and have an effective range of 1.17549e-38 to 3.40282e+38. Numbers of type double occupy eight bytes and have an effective range of 2.22507e-308 to 1.79769e+308.

You can use basic arithmetic operations to add, subtract, multiply, and divide numbers of type float and double. Higher-level functions such as those in the standard C header file math.h are not part of the core OS; you must either write them yourself, or you must employ a third-party math library.

The standard IEEE-754 special "non-number" values of NaN (not a number), +INF (positive infinity), and -INF (negative infinity) are generated as appropriate if you perform an operation that produces a result outside the range of numbers that can be represented. For instance, dividing a positive number by 0 returns +INF.

The Float Manager contains functions that convert double-precision floating-point numbers to and from a string using scientific notation. It also contains FlpBufferCorrectedAdd and FlpBufferCorrectedSub, which perform the indicated operation and correct the result in those situations where the result should be zero but isn't due to the way that floating-point numbers are represented. All of the Float Manager functions that either accept or return a floating-point number require it to be declared as an FlpDouble. The Float Manager defines a union, FlpCompDouble, that you use to declare values that can be

interpreted either as a `double` or as an `FlpDouble`. You use this union as shown here:

```
double dblFlpCorrectedAdd (double d1, double d2, Int16 acc) {
    FlpCompDouble fcd1, fcd2, fcdResult;

    fcd1.d = d1;
    fcd2.d = d2;
    FlpBufferCorrectedAdd(&fcdResult.fd, fcd1.fd, fcd2.fd,
        acc);
    return fcdResult.d;
}
```

NOTE: If you are using CodeWarrior, you have the option of using `FlpAToF`, `FlpCorrectedAdd`, and `FlpCorrectedSub` instead of `FlpBufferAToF`, `FlpBufferCorrectedAdd`, and `FlpBufferCorrectedSub`. These "non-buffer" functions all return their results directly, rather than updating a value pointed to by the first parameter. Because they return an `FlpDouble`—which is a struct—and because the GCC compiler's convention for returning structures from functions is incompatible with Palm OS, GCC users can only use the `FlpBuffer...` versions.

In the rare event that you need to work with the binary representation of a `double`, the Float Manager also contains a number of functions and macros that allow you to obtain and in some cases alter the sign, mantissa, and exponent of a 64-bit floating-point number. See Chapter 33, "Float Manager," on page 629 of the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for the functions and macros that make up the Float Manager.

The Float Manager, which was introduced in Palm OS 2.0, is sometimes referred to as the New Float Manager to distinguish it from the Float Manager that was part of Palm OS 1.0. The 1.0 Float Manager, which is less accurate and less convenient to use (simple operations such as addition require a call to a Float Manager function), remains in the ROM solely for backward compatibility; its functions are no longer publicly declared in the Palm OS SDK and should no longer be used. The functions in the old Float Manager all begin with "Fpl" rather than the current "Flp"; see Appendix C, "1.0

Float Manager." on page 1803 of the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for the functions that make up the original Float Manager.

Summary of System Features

Feature Manager Functions	
FtrGet	FtrGetByIndex
FtrSet	FtrUnregister
FtrPtrNew	FtrPtrFree
FtrPtrResize	

Preferences Functions	
PrefGetAppPreferences	PrefGetAppPreferencesV10
PrefSetAppPreferences	PrefSetAppPreferencesV10
PrefGetPreference	PrefSetPreference
PrefOpenPreferenceDB	PrefOpenPreferenceDBV10
PrefGetPreferences	PrefSetPreferences

Sound Manager Functions	
SndCreateMidiList	SndDoCmd
SndGetDefaultVolume	SndInterruptSmfIrregardless
SndPlaySmf	SndPlaySmfIrregardless
SndPlaySmfResource	SndPlaySmfResourceIrregardless
SndPlaySystemSound	

System Manager Functions	
System Dialogs	
SysGraffitiReferenceDialog	SysKeyboardDialog
SysKeyboardDialogV10	

System Manager Functions	
Power Management	
SysBatteryInfo	SysBatteryInfoV20
SysSetAutoOffTime	SysTaskDelay
System Management	
SysLibFind	SysLibLoad
SysRandom	SysReset
SysGremlins	
Working With Strings and Resources	
SysBinarySearch	SysInsertionSort
SysQSort	SysCopyStringResource
SysCreatePanelList	SysStringByIndex
SysFormPointerArrayToStrings	
Database Support	
SysCreateDataBaseList	SysCurAppDatabase
Error Handling	
SysErrString	
Event Handling	
SysHandleEvent	
System Information	
SysGetOSVersionString	SysGetStackInfo
SysGetROMToken	SysTicksPerSecond

Time Manager Functions	
Allowing User to Change Date and Time	
DayDrawDays	SelectDay
DayDrawDaySelector	SelectTimeV33
DayHandleEvent	SelectDayV10

Time Manager Functions	
Changing the Date	
DateAdjust	TimAdjust
TimSetSeconds	
Converting to Date Format	
DateDaysToDate	DateSecondsToDate
TimSecondsToDateTime	
Converting Dates to Other Formats	
DateToAscii	TimeToAscii
DateToDays	DateToDOWDMFormat
TimGetSeconds	TimDateTimeToSeconds
TimGetTicks	
Date Information	
DayOfMonth	DayOfWeek
DaysInMonth	

Float Manager Functions	
FlpAToF	FlpBufferAToF
FlpBufferCorrectedAdd	FlpBufferCorrectedSub
FlpCorrectedAdd	FlpCorrectedSub
FlpFToA	FlpNegate
FlpSetNegative	FlpSetPositive

11

Localized Applications

When you write an application, or any other type of software, you need to take special care when working with characters, strings, numbers, and dates, as different countries represent these items in different ways. This chapter describes how to write code that works properly for any language that is supported by Palm OS®. It focuses on the text manager and international manager, which were introduced in Palm OS version 3.1, and the overlay manager, which is introduced in Palm OS version 3.5. The chapter covers:

- Localization Guidelines
- Maintaining Backward Compatibility
- Using Overlays to Localize Resources
- Text Manager and International Manager
- Characters
- Strings
- Dates
- Numbers
- Obtaining Locale Information
- Notes on the Japanese Implementation
- Summary of Localization

This chapter does not cover how to actually perform localization of resources. For more information on this subject, see the *Palm OS Programming Development Tools Guide*.

Localization Guidelines

If there is a possibility that your application is going to be localized, you should follow these guidelines when you start planning the application. It's a good idea to follow these guidelines even if you don't think your application is going to be localized.

- If you use the English language version of the software as a guide when designing the layout of the screen, try to allow:
  - extra space for strings
  - larger dialogs than the English version requires
- Don't put language-dependent strings in code. If you have to display text directly on the screen, remember that a one-line warning or message in one language may need more than one line in another language. See the section "Strings" in this chapter for further discussion.
- Don't depend on the physical characteristics of a string, such as the number of characters, the fact that it contains a particular substring, or any other attribute that might disappear in translation.
- Database names must use only 7-bit ASCII characters (0x20 through 0x7E). If an actual PDB name is displayed to the user, the application should have a way of associating a localizable name (resource based, if possible) with each database.
- Use the functions described in this chapter when working with characters, strings, numbers, and dates.
- Consider using string templates as described in the section "Dynamically Creating String Content" in this chapter. Use as many parameters as possible to give localizers greater flexibility. Avoid building sentences by concatenating substrings together, as this often causes translation problems.
- Abbreviations may be the best way to accommodate the particularly scarce screen real estate on the Palm OS device.
- Remember that user interface elements such as lists, fields, and tips scroll if you need more space.

The chapter "Good Design Practices" provides further user interface guidelines.

Maintaining Backward Compatibility

The managers described in this chapter are supported starting in Palm OS version 3.1. If you want to maintain backward compatibility with earlier releases but you still want to use the international support described in this chapter, you can link your application with the library PalmOSGlue (`PalmOSGlue.lib` or `libPalmOSGlue.a`). This library provides the latest localization features and can be used in any application that runs on Palm OS 2.0 and later.

When you use PalmOSGlue, you use the functions in the same way as described in this chapter, but their names are different. For example, `TxtFindString` is named `TxtGlueFindString` in PalmOSGlue. When you make a call to a glue function (for example, `TxtGlue`*Func*, `FntGlue`*Func*, or `WinGlue`*Func*), the code in PalmOSGlue either uses the text manager or international manager found in the ROM or, if the managers don't exist, executes a simple Latin equivalent of the function.

In this chapter when a function that has a PalmOSGlue counterpart is described, the name of the PalmOSGlue function appears in parentheses. To see a complete list of functions in PalmOSGlue, see the chapter "PalmOSGlue Library" on page 1671 of the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference*.

PalmOSGlue is a linkable library that is bound to your project at link time. It is not a shared library. PalmOSGlue will increase your application's code size. The exact amount by which your code size increases depends on the number of library functions you call; the linker strips any unused routines and data.

IMPORTANT: Palm OS version 3.1 introduced some changes to the Latin character encoding and to some of the string manager functions. If you are updating a legacy application written before the release of Palm OS 3.1, these changes may affect your application. See "3.1 New Feature Set" on page 1775 of the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for details about these changes.

Using Overlays to Localize Resources

Palm OS version 3.5 adds support for localizing resource databases through **overlays**. Localization overlays provide a method for localizing a software module without requiring a recompile or modification of the software. Each overlay database is a separate resource database that provides an appropriately localized set of resources for a single software module (the PRC file, or **base database**) and a single target **locale** (language and country).

No requirements are placed on the base database, so for example, third parties can construct localization overlays for existing applications without forcing any modifications by the original application developer. In rare cases, you might want to disable the use of overlays to prevent third parties from creating overlays for your application. To do so, you should include an `'xprf'=0` resource (symbolically named `sysResTExtPrefs`) in the database and set its `disableOverlays` flag. This resource is defined in `UIResources.r`.

An overlay database has the same creator as the base database, but its type is `'ovly'`, and a suffix identifying the target locale is appended to its name. For example, `Datebook.prc` might be overlaid with a database named `Datebook_jpJP`, which indicates that this overlay is for Japan. Each overlay database has an `'ovly'`=1000 resource specifying the base database's type, the target locale, and information necessary to identify the correct version of the base database for which it was designed.

The Palm OS SDK provides tools that you can use to create overlays. See the *PRC to Overlay Tool* chapter in the *Palm OS Programming Development Tools Guide* for more information on creating overlays.

When a PRC file is opened on a system that supports overlays, the overlay manager determines what the current locale is for this device, and it looks for an overlay matching the base database and the locale. The overlay database's name must match the base database's name, its suffix must match the locale's suffix, and it must have an `'ovly'`=1000 resource that matches the base database. If the name, suffix, and overlay resource are all correct, the overlay is opened in addition to the PRC file. When the PRC file is closed, its overlay is closed as well.

The overlay is opened in read-only mode and is hidden from the programmer. When you open a database, you'll receive a reference to the base database, not the overlay. You can simply make resource manager calls like you normally would, and the resource manager accesses the overlay where appropriate.

When accessing a localizable resource, do not use functions that search for a resource only in the database you specify. For example:

```
// WRONG! searches only one database.
DmOpenRef dbP = DmNextOpenResDatabase(NULL);
UInt16 resIndex = DmFindResource(dpP, strRsc,
  strRscID);
MemHandle resH = DmGetResourceIndex(dbP,
  resIndex);
```

In the example above, `dbP` is a reference to the most recently opened database, which is typically the overlay version of the database. Passing this reference to `DmFindDatabase` means that you are searching only the overlay database for the resource. If you're searching for a non-localized resource, `DmFindResource` won't be able to locate it. Instead, you should use `DmGet1Resource`, which searches the most recently opened database and its overlay for a resource, or `DmGetResource`, which searches all open databases and their overlays.

```
// Right. DmGet1Resource searches both
// databases.
MemHandle resH = DmGet1Resource(strRsc,
  strRscID);

// Or use DmGetResource to search all open
// databases.
MemHandle resH = DmGetResource(strRsc,
  strRscID);
```

The data manager only opens an overlay if the resource database is opened in read-only mode. If you open a resource database in read-write mode, the associated overlay is not opened. What's more, if you modify the an overlaid resource in the base database, the checksum in the overlay's `'ovly'` resource becomes invalid, which prevents the overlay from being used at all. Thus if you change the resource database, you must also change the overlay database.

You typically don't work with the overlay manager directly although it does provide a few public functions. One potentially useful function is `OmGetCurrentLocale` (or `OmGlueGetCurrentLocale`), which returns a structure identifying the locale on this device.

Text Manager and International Manager

The Palm OS provides two managers that help you work with localized strings and characters. These managers are called the text manager and the international manager.

Computers represent the characters in an alphabet with a numeric code. The set of numeric codes for a given alphabet is called a **character encoding**. Of course, a character encoding contains more than codes for the letters of an alphabet. It also encodes punctuation, numbers, control characters, and any other characters deemed necessary. The set of characters that a character encoding represents is called, appropriately enough, a **character set**.

As you know, different languages use different alphabets. Most European languages use the Latin alphabet. The Latin alphabet is relatively small, so its characters can be represented using a single-byte encoding ranging from 32 to 255. On the other hand, Asian languages such as Chinese, Korean, and Japanese require their own alphabets, which are much larger. These larger character sets are represented by a combination of single-byte and double-byte numeric codes ranging from 32 to 65,535.

A given Palm OS device supports one character encoding. Although the Palm OS supports multiple character encodings, a given device uses only one of those encodings. For example, a French device uses the Palm™ Latin encoding, which is identical to the Microsoft® Windows® code page 1252 character encoding (an extension of ISO Latin 1) but includes Palm-specific characters in the control range. A Japanese device, on the other hand would use the Palm Shift JIS character encoding, which is identical to Microsoft Windows code page 932 (an extension of Shift JIS) but includes Palm-specific characters in the control range. Code page 932 is not supported on the French device, and code page 1252 is not supported on the Japanese device even though they both use the same version of

Palm OS. No matter what the encoding is on a device, Palm guarantees that the low ASCII characters (0 to 0x7F) are the same. The exception to this rule is 0x5C, which is a yen symbol on Japanese devices and a backslash on all others.

The text manager allows you to work with text, strings, and characters independent of the character encoding. If you use text manager routines and don't work directly with string data, your code should work on any system, regardless of which language and character encoding the device supports (as long as it supports the text manager).

The international manager's job is to detect which character encoding a device uses and initialize the corresponding version of the text manager. The international manager also sets system features that identify which encoding and fonts are used. For the most part, you don't work with the international manager directly.

Characters

Depending on the device's supported languages, the Palm OS may encode characters using either a single-byte encoding or a multi-byte encoding. Because you do not know which character encoding is used until runtime, **you should never make an assumption about the size of a character**.

For the most part, your application does not need to know which character encoding is used, and in fact, it should make no assumptions about the encoding or about the size of characters. Instead, your code should use text manager functions to manipulate characters. This section describes how to work with characters correctly. It covers:

- Declaring Character Variables
- Using Character Constants
- Missing and Invalid Characters
- Retrieving a Character's Attributes
- Virtual Characters
- Retrieving the Character Encoding

Declaring Character Variables

Declare all character variables to be of type `WChar`. `WChar` is a 16-bit unsigned type that can accommodate characters of any encoding. Don't use `Char`. `Char` is an 8-bit variable that cannot accommodate larger character encodings. The only time you should ever use `Char` is to pass a parameter to an older Palm OS function.

```
WChar ch; // Right. 16-bit character.
Char ch; // Wrong. 8-bit character.
```

When you receive input characters through the `keyDownEvent`, you'll receive a `WChar` value. (That is, the `data.keyDown.chr` field is a `WChar`.)

Even though character variables are now declared as `WChar`, string variables are still declared as `Char *`, even though they may contain multi-byte characters. See the section "Strings" for more information on strings.

Using Character Constants

Character constants are defined in several header files. The header file `Chars.h` contains characters that are guaranteed to be supported on all systems regardless of the encoding. Other header files exist for each supported character encoding and contain characters specific to that encoding. The character encoding-specific header files are not included in the `PalmOS.h` header by default because they define characters that are not available on every system.

To make it easier for the compiler to find character encoding problems with your project, make a practice of using the character constants defined in these header files rather than directly assigning a character variable to a value. For example, suppose your code contained this statement:

```
WChar ch = 'å'; // WRONG! Don't use.
```

This statement may work on a Latin system, but it would cause problems on an Asian-language system because the å character does not exist. If you instead assign the value this way:

```
WChar ch = chrSmall_A_RingAbove;
```

you'll find the problem at compile time because the `chrSmall_A_RingAbove` constant is defined in `CharLatin.h`, which is not included by default.

Missing and Invalid Characters

If during application testing, you see an open rectangle, a shaded rectangle, or a gray square displayed on the screen, you have a missing character.

A **missing character** is one that is valid within the character encoding but the current font is not able to display it. In this case, nothing is wrong with your code other than you have chosen the wrong font. The system displays an open rectangle in place of a missing single-byte rectangle (see Figure 11.1).

Figure 11.1 Missing characters



Missing single-byte character

In multi-byte character encodings, a character may be missing as described above, or it may be invalid. In single-byte character encodings, there's a one-to-one correspondence between numeric values and characters to represent. This is not the case with multi-byte character encodings. In multi-byte character encodings, there are more possible values than there are characters to represent. Thus, a character variable could end up containing an **invalid character**—a value that doesn't actually represent a character.

If the system is asked to display an invalid character, it prints an open rectangle for the first invalid byte. Then it starts over at the next byte. Thus, the next character displayed and possibly even the remaining text displayed is probably not what you want. Check your code for the following:

- Truncating strings. You might have truncated a string in the middle of a multi-byte character.
- Appending characters from one encoding set to a string in a different encoding.
- Arithmetic on character variables that could result in an invalid character value.

- Arithmetic on a string pointer that could result in pointing to an intra-character boundary. See "Performing String Pointer Manipulation" for more information.
- Assumptions that a character is always a single byte long.

Use the text manager function `TxtCharIsValid` (`TxtGlueCharIsValid`) to determine whether a character is valid or not.

Retrieving a Character's Attributes

The text manager defines certain functions that retrieve a character's attributes, such whether the character is alphanumeric, etc. You can use these functions on any character, regardless of its size and encoding.

A character also has attributes unique to its encoding. Functions to retrieve those attributes are defined in the header files specific to the encoding.

WARNING! In previous versions of the Palm OS, the header file `CharAttr.h` defined character attribute macros such as `IsAscii`. Using these macros on double-byte characters produces incorrect results. Use the text manager macros instead of the `CharAttr.h` macros.

Virtual Characters

Virtual characters are nondisplayable characters that trigger special events in the operating system, such as displaying low battery warnings or displaying the keyboard dialog. Virtual characters should never occur in any data and should never appear on the screen.

The Palm OS uses character codes 256 decimal and greater for virtual characters. The range for these characters may actually overlap the range for "real" characters (characters that should appear on the screen). The `keyDownEvent` distinguishes a virtual character from a displayable character by setting the command bit in the event record.

The best way to check for virtual characters, including virtual characters that represent the hard keys, is to use the TxtGlueCharIsVirtual function defined in the PalmOSGlue library.

Therefore, when you check for a virtual character, first check the command bit in the event record. If the command bit is set, then the character is virtual. See Listing 11.1.

Listing 11.1 Checking for virtual characters

```
if (TxtGlueCharIsVirtual
   (eventP->data.keyDown.modifiers,
   eventP->data.keyDown.chr)) {
   if (TxtCharIsHardKey
      (event->data.keyDown.modifiers,
      event->data.keyDown.chr)) {
      // Handle hard key virtual character.
   } else {
      // Handle standard virtual character.
   }
} else {
   // Handle regular character.
}
```

Retrieving the Character Encoding

Occasionally, you may need to determine which character encoding is being used. For example, your application may need to do some unique text manipulation if it is being run on a European device. You can retrieve the character encoding from the system feature set using the `FtrGet` function as shown in Listing 11.2.

Listing 11.2 Retrieving the character encoding

```
UInt32 encoding;
Char* encodingName;
if (FtrGet(sysFtrCreator, sysFtrNumEncoding,
   &encoding) != 0)
   encoding = charEncodingPalmLatin;
      //default encoding
if (encoding == charEncodingPalmSJIS) {
   // encoding for Palm Shift-JIS
} else if (encoding == charEncodingPalmLatin) {
```

```
   // extension of ISO Latin 1
}

// The following text manager function returns the
// official name of the encoding as required by
// Internet applications.
encodingName = TxtGlueEncodingName(encoding);
```

Strings

On systems that support the international manager and the text manager, strings are made up of characters that are either a single-byte long or multiple bytes long, up to four bytes. As stated previously, character variables are always two bytes long. However, when you add a character to a string, the operating system may shrink it down to a single byte if it's a low ASCII character. Thus, any string that you work with may contain a mix of single-byte and multi-byte characters.

Using characters of different sizes in a string has implications for manipulating strings, searching strings, and implementing the global find facility in your application. This section describes how to perform all of these tasks using text manager functions. It also describes how to create and display dynamically computed strings and how to display error messages.

- Manipulating Strings
- Performing String Pointer Manipulation
- Truncating Displayed Text
- Comparing Strings
- Global Find
- Dynamically Creating String Content

TIP: Many of the existing Palm OS functions have been modified to work with strings containing multi-byte characters. All Palm OS functions that return the length of a string, such as `FldGetTextLength` and `StrLen`, always return the size of the string in bytes, not the number of characters in the string.

Manipulating Strings

Any time that you want to work with character pointers, you need to be careful not to point to an intra-character boundary (a middle or end byte of a multi-byte character). For example, any time that you want to set the insertion point position in a text field or set the text field's selection, you must make sure that you use byte offsets that point to inter-character boundaries. (The **inter-character boundary** is both the start of one character and the end of the previous character, except when the offset points to the very beginning or very end of a string.)

Suppose you want to iterate through a string character by character. Traditionally, C code uses a character pointer or byte counter to iterate through a string a character at a time. Such code will not work properly on systems with multi-byte characters. Instead, if you want to iterate through a string a character at a time, use text manager functions:

- `TxtGetNextChar` (`TxtGlueGetNextChar`) retrieves the next character in a string.
- `TxtGetPreviousChar` (`TxtGlueGetPreviousChar`) retrieves the previous character in a string.
- `TxtSetNextChar` (`TxtGlueSetNextChar`) changes the next character in a string and can be used to fill a string buffer.

Each of these three functions returns the size of the character in question, so you can use it to determine the offset to use for the next character. For example, Listing 11.3 shows how to iterate through a string character by character until a particular character is found.

Listing 11.3 Iterating through a string or text

```
Char* buffer; // assume this exists
UInt16 bufLen = StrLen(buffer);
// Length of the input text.
WChar ch = 0;
UInt16 i = 0;
while ((i < bufLen) && (ch != chrAsterisk))
   i+= TxtGlueGetNextChar(buffer, i, &ch));
```

The text manager also contains functions that let you determine the size of a character without iterating through the string:

- TxtCharSize (TxtGlueCharSize) returns how much space a given character will take up inside of a string.
- TxtCharBounds (TxtGlueCharBounds) determines the boundaries of a given character within a given string.

Listing 11.4 Working with arbitrary limits

```
UInt32* charStart, charEnd;
Char* fldTextP = FldGetTextPtr(fld);
TxtGlueCharBounds(fldTextP,
   min(kMaxBytesToProcess, FldGetTextLength(fld)),
   &charStart, &charEnd);
// process only the first charStart bytes of text.
```

Performing String Pointer Manipulation

Never perform any pointer manipulation on strings you pass to the text manager unless you use text manager calls to do the manipulation. For text manager functions to work properly, the string pointer must point to the first byte of a character. If you use text manager functions when manipulating a string pointer, you can be certain that your pointer always points to the beginning of a character. Otherwise, you run the risk of pointing to an inter-character boundary.

```
// WRONG! buffer + kMaxStrLength is not
// guaranteed to point to start of character.
buffer[kMaxStrLength] = '\0';


// Right. Truncate at a character boundary.
UInt32 charStart, charEnd;
TxtCharBounds(buffer, kMaxStrLength,
  &charStart, &charEnd);
TxtGlueSetNextChar(buffer, charStart, chrNull);
```

Truncating Displayed Text

If you're performing drawing operations, you often have to determine where to truncate a string if it's too long to fit in the available space. Two functions help you perform this task on strings with multi-byte characters:

- `WinDrawTruncChars` (`WinGlueDrawTruncChars`) - This function draws a string within a specified width, determining automatically where to truncate the string. If it can, it draws the entire string. If the string doesn't fit in the space, it draws one less than the number of characters that fit and then ends the string with an ellipsis (...).
- `FntWidthToOffset` (`FntGlueWidthToOffset`) - This function returns the byte offset of the character displayed at a given pixel position. It can also return the width of the text up to that offset.

Comparing Strings

Use the text manager functions `TxtCompare` (`TxtGlueCompare`) and `TxtCaselessCompare` (`TxtGlueCaselessCompare`) to perform comparisons of strings.

In character encodings that use multi-byte characters, some characters are accurately represented as either single-byte characters or multi-byte characters. That is, a character might have both a single-byte representation and a double-byte representation. One string might use the single-byte representation and another might use the multi-byte representation. Users expect the characters to match regardless of how many bytes a string uses to store that character. `TxtCompare` and `TxtCaselessCompare` can accurately match single-byte characters with their multi-byte equivalents.

Because a single-byte character might be matched with a multi-byte character, two strings might be considered equal even though they have different lengths. For this reason, `TxtCompare` and `TxtCaselessCompare` take two parameters in which they pass back the length of matching text in each of the two strings. See the function descriptions in the *Palm OS Programmer's API Reference* for more information.

Note that `StrCompare` and `StrCaselessCompare` are equivalent, but they do not pass back the length of the matching text.

Global Find

A special case of performing string comparison is implementing the global system find facility. To implement this facility, you should call `TxtFindString` (`TxtGlueFindString`). As with `TxtCompare` and `TxtCaselessCompare`, `TxtFindString` accurately matches single-byte characters with their corresponding multi-byte characters. Plus, it passes back the length of the matched text. You'll need this value to highlight the matching text when the system requests that you display the matching record.

Older versions of Palm OS use the function `FindStrInStr`. `FindStrInStr` is not able to return the length of the matching text. Instead, it assumes that characters within the string are always one byte long.

Listing 11.5 and Listing 11.6 show how to implement a global find facility on all systems (whether the text manager exists or not), and how to implement a response to `sysAppLaunchCmdGoto`, which is the system's request that the matching record be displayed. These two listings are only code excerpts. For the complete implementation of these two functions, see the example code in your development environment.

Note that if you want to use `TxtFindString` to implement a search within your application (as opposed to the global find facility), you need to call `TxtGluePrepFindString` before you call `TxtFindString` to ensure that the string is in the proper format. (In the global find facility, the system has already prepared the string before your code is executed.)

Listing 11.5 Implementing global find

```
static void Search (FindParamsPtr findParams)
{
   UInt16 recordIndex = 0;
   DmOpenRef dbP;
   UInt16 cardNo = 0;
   LocalID dbID;
```

```
   MemoDBRecordPtr memoPadRecP;


   // Open the database to be searched.
   dbP = DmOpenDatabaseByTypeCreator(memoDBType,
      sysFileCMemo, findParams->dbAccesMode);
   DmOpenDatabaseInfo(dbP, &dbID, 0, 0, &cardNo,
      0);

   // Get first record to search.
   memoRecP = GetRecordPtr(dbP, recordIndex);
   while (memoRecP != NULL) {
      Boolean done;
      Boolean match;
      UInt32 matchPos, matchLength;

      // TxtGlueFindString calls TxtFindString if it
      // exists, or else it implements the Latin
      // equivalent of it.
      match = TxtGlueFindString (&(memoRecP->note),
         findParams->strToFind, &matchPos,
         &matchLength);

      if (match) {
         done = FindSaveMatch (findParams,
            recordIndex, matchPos, 0, matchLength,
            cardNo, dbIDP);
      }
      MemPtrUnlock (memoRecP);

      if (done) break;
      recordIndex += 1;
   }
   DmCloseDatabase (dbP);
}
```

Listing 11.6 Displaying the matching record

```
static void GoToRecord (GoToParamsPtr goToParams, Boolean
launchingApp)
{
   UInt16 recordNum;
   EventType event;
```

```
    recordNum = goToParams->recordNum;
    ...

    // Send an event to goto a form and select the
    // matching text.
    MemSet (&event, sizeof(EventType), 0);

    event.eType = frmLoadEvent;
    event.data.frmLoad.formID = EditView;
    EvtAddEventToQueue (&event);

    MemSet (&event, sizeof(EventType), 0);
    event.eType = frmGotoEvent;
    event.data.frmGoto.recordNum = recordNum;
    event.data.frmGoto.matchPos =
       goToParams->matchPos;
    event.data.formGoto.matchLen =
       goToParams->matchCustom;
    event.data.frmGoto.matchFieldNum =
       goToParams->matchFieldNum;
    event.data.frmGoto.formID = EditView;
    EvtAddEventToQueue (&event);
    ...
}
```

Dynamically Creating String Content

When working with strings in a localized application, you never hard code them. Instead, you store strings in a resource and use the resource to display the text. If you need to create the contents of the string at runtime, store a template for the string as a resource and then substitute values as needed.

For example, consider the Edit view of the Memo application. Its title bar contains a string such as "Memo 3 of 10." The number of the memo being displayed and the total number of memos cannot be determined until runtime.

To create such a string, use a template resource and the text manager function `TxtParamString` (`TxtGlueParamString`). `TxtParamString` allows you to search for the sequence ^0, ^1, up to ^3 and replace each of these with a different string. If you need more parameters, you can use `TxtReplaceStr` (`TxtGlueReplaceStr`), which allows you to replace up to ^9; however, `TxtReplaceStr` only allows you to replace one of these sequences at a time.

In the Memo title bar example, you'd create a string resource that looks like this:

```
Memo ^0 of ^1
```

And your code might look like this:

Listing 11.7 Using string templates

```
static void EditViewSetTitle (void)
{
   Char* titleTemplateP;
   FormPtr frm;
   Char posStr [maxStrIToALen];
   Char totalStr [maxStrIToALen];
   UInt16 pos;
   UInt16 length;

   // Format as strings, the memo's postion within
   // its category, and the total number of memos
   // in the category.
   pos = DmPositionInCategory (MemoPadDB,
      CurrentRecord, RecordCategory);
   StrIToA (posStr, pos+1);

   if (MemosInCategory == memosInCategoryUnknown)
      MemosInCategory = DmNumRecordsInCategory
         (MemoPadDB, RecordCategory);
   StrIToA (totalStr, MemosInCategory);

   // Get the title template string.  It contains
   // '^0' and '^1' chars which we replace with the
   // position of CurrentRecord within
   // CurrentCategory and with the total count of
   // records in CurrentCategory ().
   titleTemplateP = MemHandleLock (DmGetResource
      (strRsc, EditViewTitleTemplateStringString));

   EditViewTitlePtr =
      TxtGlueParamString(titleTemplateP, posStr,
      totalStr, NULL, NULL);

   // Now set the title to use the new title
   // string.
   frm = FrmGetFormPtr (MemoPadEditForm);
   FrmSetTitle (frm, EditViewTitlePtr);
   MemPtrUnlock(titleTemplateP);
}
```

Dates

If your application deals with dates and times, it should abide by the values the user has set in the system preference for date and time display. The default preferences at startup are vary among locales, and the default values can be overridden by the user.

To check the system preferences call `PrefGetPreference` with one of the values listed in the second column of Table 11.1. The third column lists an enumerated type that helps you interpret the value.

Table 11.1 Date and time preferences

Preference	Name	Returns a value of type
Date formats (i.e., month first or day first)	`prefDateFormat`, `prefLongDateFormat`	`DateFormatType`
Time formats (i.e., use a 12-hour clock or use a 24-hour clock)	`prefTimeFormat`	`TimeFormatType`
Start day of week (i.e., Sunday or Monday)	`prefWeekStartDay`	0 (Sunday) or 1 (Monday)
Local time zone	`prefMinutesWestOfGMT` (before Palm OS 4.0), `prefTimeZone` (Palm OS 4.0 and higher)	Minutes east of Greenwich Mean Time (GMT), also known as Universal Coordinated Time (UTC).
Daylight savings time adjustment	`prefDaylightSavings` (before Palm OS 4.0), `prefDaylightSavingAdjustment` (Palm OS 4.0 and higher)	Before 4.0, the `DaylightSavingsTypes` described the daylight savings adjustment. In Palm OS 4.0 and higher, the preference is stored as the number of minutes by which to adjust the current time.

IMPORTANT: The `prefMinutesWestOfGMT` preference mentioned above is not the same as the `prefTimeZone` preference. The `prefMinutesWestOfGMT` returns an unsigned value ranging from 0 to 1440. The `prefTimeZone` preference ranges from -720 to 720.

To work with dates in your code, use the Date and Time Manager API. It contains functions such as `DateToAscii`, `DayOfMonth`, `DayOfWeek`, `DaysInMonth`, and `DateTemplateToAscii`, which allow you to work with dates independent of the user's preference settings.

Numbers

If your application displays large numbers or floating-point numbers, you must check and make sure you are using the appropriate thousands separator and decimal separator for the device's country by doing the following (see Listing 11.8):

1. Store numbers using US conventions, which means using a "," as the thousands separator and a decimal point (.) as the decimal separator.
2. Use `PrefGetPreference` and `LocGetNumberSeparators` to retrieve information about how the number should be displayed.
3. Use `StrLocalizeNumber` to perform the localization.
4. If a user enters a number that you need to manipulate in some way, convert it to the US conventions using `StrDelocalizeNumber`.

Listing 11.8 Working with numbers

```
// store numbers using US conventions.
Char *jackpot = "20,000,000.00";
Char thou; // thousand separator
Char dp; // decimal separator

// Retrieve user's preferred number format.
LocGetNumberSeparators((NumberFormatType)
```

```
   PrefGetPreference(prefNumberFormat), &thou,
      &dp);
// Localize jackpot number. Converts "," to thou
// and "." to dp.
StrLocalizeNumber(jackpot, thou, dp);
// Display string.
// Assume inputString is a number user entered,
// convert it to US conventions this way. Converts
// thou to "," and dp to "."
StrDelocalizeNumber(inputNumber, thou, dp);
```

Obtaining Locale Information

Some applications may require information about the current locale. For example, many applications need to know the format for displaying dates or numbers, which is determined in part by the current locale (and described in more detail in the section "Dates" and "Numbers" in this chapter.) Other applications may need other information, such as the country name.

The information that most applications require is stored in the system preferences structure and can be obtained using `PrefGetPreference`. This is the recommended way of obtaining locale-specific settings because the user can override many of these settings. Applications should always honor the user's preferences rather than the locale defaults.

Other locale-specific settings can not be set by the user and are not stored in the system preferences. Instead, these settings are stored in a private resource that contains information about several possible locales, including the locale currently used by the system. For example, the user cannot change the symbol used for the local currency. If your application needs this information, it must use the locale manager function `LmGetLocaleSetting` to retrieve it. The locale manager is new in Palm OS 4.0, but for backwards compatibility you can use the corresponding PalmOSGlue function `LmGlueGetLocaleSetting`. Listing 11.9 shows how to use `LmGlueGetLocaleSetting`.

Listing 11.9 Retrieving a locale setting using locale manager

```
LmLocaleType locale;
Char currencySymbol[kMaxCurrencySymbolLen+1];
UInt16 index;

// Find out what the current locale is.
OmGlueGetCurrentLocale(&locale);

// Find out which index in the locale resource
// contains info about that locale.
LmGlueLocaleToIndex(&locale, &index);

// Get the currency symbol stored in the locale at
// that index.
LmGlueGetLocaleSetting(index,
   lmChoiceCurrencySymbol, currencySymbol,
   sizeof(currencySymbol));
```

Table 11.2 shows which types of information about the current locale should be retrieved from the system preferences and which types should be retrieved from the locale resource. Of course, if you want to retrieve information about a different locale or if you want to look up the default used for the current locale, you would always use the locale manager instead of the preferences manager.

Table 11.2 Obtaining locale information

Value	Function used to retrieve value
Language code	`PrefGetPreference(prefLanguage)`
Locale description	`PrefGetPreference(prefLocale)`
Country code	`PrefGetPreference(prefCountry)`
Country name	`LmGlueGetLocaleSetting(..., lmChoiceCountryName, ...)`
Currency name	`LmGlueGetLocaleSetting(..., lmChoiceCurrencyName, ...)`
Currency symbol	`LmGlueGetLocaleSetting(..., lmChoiceCurrencySymbol, ...)`

Table 11.2 Obtaining locale information *(continued)*

Value	Function used to retrieve value
Unique currency symbol	`LmGlueGetLocaleSetting(..., lmChoiceUniqueCurrencySymbol, ...)`
Measurement system (metric or English)	`PrefGetPreference(prefMeasurementSystem)`
Number formats	`PrefGetPreference(prefNumberFormat)`
Number of decimal places for monetary values	`LmGlueGetLocaleSetting(..., lmChoiceCurrencyDecimalPlaces, ...)`
Starting day of the week	`PrefGetPreference(prefWeekStartDay)`
Date formats	`PrefGetPreference(prefDateFormat)` `PrefGetPreference(prefLongDateFormat)`
Time format	`PrefGetPreference(prefTimeFormat)`
Time zone	`PrefGetPreference(prefMinutesWestOfGMT)` (pre 4.0) `PrefGetPreference(prefTimeZone)` (4.0 and higher)
Daylight savings time	`PrefGetPreference(prefDaylightSavings)` (pre 4.0) `PrefGetPreference(prefDaylightSavingAdjustment)` (4.0 and higher)

Notes on the Japanese Implementation

This section describes programming practices for applications that are to be localized for Japanese use. It covers:

- Japanese Character Encoding
- Japanese Character Input
- The Calculator Button
- Displaying Japanese Strings on UI Objects
- Displaying Error Messages

Japanese Character Encoding

The character encoding used on Japanese systems is based on Microsoft code page 932. The complete 932 character set (JIS level 1 and 2) is supported in both the standard and large font sizes. The bold versions of these two fonts contain bolded versions of the glyphs found in the 7-bit ASCII range, but on some devices, the single-byte Katakana characters and the multi-byte characters are not bolded.

Japanese Character Input

On current Japanese devices, users enter Japanese text using Latin (ASCII) characters, and special software called a front-end processor (FEP) transliterates this text into Hiragana or Katakana characters. The user can then ask the FEP to phonetically convert Hiragana characters into a mixture of Hiragana and Kanji (Kana-Kanji conversion).

Four silkscreen buttons added to the Japanese device control the FEP transliteration and conversion process. These four FEP buttons are arranged vertically between the current left-most silkscreen buttons and the Graffiti® area. The top-most FEP button tells the FEP to attempt Kana-Kanji conversion on the inline text. The next button confirms the inline text and terminates the inline conversion session. The third button toggles the transliteration mode between Hiragana and Katakana. The last button toggles the FEP on and off.

Japanese text entry is always inline, which means that transliteration and conversion happen directly inside of a field. The field code passes events to the FEP, which then returns information about the appropriate text to display.

During inline conversion, the Graffiti space stroke acts as a shortcut for the conversion FEP button and the Graffiti return stroke acts as a shortcut for the confirm FEP button.

The Calculator Button

On current Japanese devices, the Calculator silkscreen button doesn't generate a `calcChr`. Instead, it generates a `keyDown` event with the event's `data.keyDown.chr` field set to `keyboardChr` and it's `data.keyDown.modifiers` field set to `commandKeyMask`.

Displaying Japanese Strings on UI Objects

To conserve screen space, you should use half-width Katakana characters on user interface elements (such as buttons, menu items, labels, and pop-up lists) whenever the string contains only Katakana characters. If the string contains a mix of Katakana and either Hiragana, Kanji, or Romaji, then use the full-width Katakana characters instead.

Displaying Error Messages

You may have code that uses the macros `ErrFatalDisplayIf` and `ErrNonFatalDisplayIf` to determine error conditions. If the error condition occurs, the system displays the file name and line number at which the error occurred along with the message that you passed to the macro. Often these messages are hard-coded strings. On Japanese systems, the Palm OS traps the messages passed to these two macros and displays a generic message explaining that an error has occurred.

You should only use `ErrFatalDisplayIf` and `ErrNonFatalDisplayIf` for totally unexpected errors. Do not use them for errors that you believe your end users will see. If you wish to inform your users of an error, use a localizable resource to display the error message instead of `ErrFatalDisplayIf` or `ErrNonFatalDisplayIf`.

Summary of Localization

Text Manager

Working With Multi-Byte Characters

TxtCharBounds
TxtCharSize
TxtPreviousCharSize
TxtNextCharSize
TxtByteAttr

Changing Text

TxtReplaceStr
TxtSetNextChar
TxtGetTruncationOffset
TxtTransliterate

Text Manager	
Accessing Text	
TxtGetNextChar	TxtGetPreviousChar
TxtGetChar	TxtWordBounds
TxtGetWordWrapOffset	
Searching/Comparing Text	
TxtCaselessCompare	TxtCompare
TxtFindString	
Obtaining a Character's Attributes	
TxtCharIsAlNum	TxtCharIsAlpha
TxtCharIsDigit	TxtCharIsGraph
TxtCharIsLower	TxtCharIsPrint
TxtCharIsSpace	TxtCharIsUpper
TxtCharIsValid	TxtCharXAttr
TxtCharIsCntrl	TxtCharIsHex
TxtCharIsPunct	TxtCharAttr
Obtaining Character Encoding information	
TxtStrEncoding	TxtEncodingName
TxtMaxEncoding	TxtCharEncoding
TxtConvertEncoding	TxtNameToEncoding

Localizing Numbers	
StrLocalizeNumber	StrDelocalizeNumber
LocGetNumberSeparators	

Locale Manager	
LmGetLocaleSetting	LmGetNumLocales
LmLocaleToIndex	

International Manager	
IntlGetRoutineAddress	IntlSetRoutineAddress

Overlay Manager	
OmGetCurrentLocale	OmGetSystemLocale
OmGetIndexedLocale	OmLocaleToOverlayDBName
OmGetRoutineAddress	OmOverlayDBNameToLocale
OmSetSystemLocale	OmGetNextSystemLocale

12

Debugging Strategies

You can use a Palm OS® system manager called the error manager to display unexpected runtime errors such as those that typically show up during program development. Final versions of applications or system software won't use the error manager.

The error manager API consists of a set of functions for displaying an alert with an error message, file name, and the line number where the error occurred. If a debugger is connected, it is entered when the error occurs.

The error manager also provides a "try and catch" mechanism that applications can use for handling such runtime errors as out of memory conditions, user input errors, etc.

This section helps you understand and use the error manager, discussing the following topics:

- Displaying Development Errors
- Using the Error Manager Macros
- The Try-and-Catch Mechanism
- Summary of Debugging API

This chapter only describes programmatic debugging strategies; to learn how to use the available tools to debug your application, see the book *Palm OS Programming Development Tools Guide*.

Displaying Development Errors

The error manager provides some compiler macros that can be used in source code. These macros display a fatal alert dialog on the screen and provide buttons to reset the device or enter the debugger after the error is displayed. There are three macros: `ErrDisplay`, `ErrFatalDisplayIf`, and `ErrNonFatalDisplayIf`.

- `ErrDisplay` always displays the error message on the screen.
- `ErrFatalDisplayIf` and `ErrNonFatalDisplayIf` display the error message only if their first argument is `TRUE`.

The error manager uses the compiler define `ERROR_CHECK_LEVEL` to control the level of error messages displayed. You can set the value of the compiler define to control which level of error checking and display is compiled into the application. Three levels of error checking are supported: none, partial, and full.

If you set `ERR_CHECK_LEVEL` to...	The compiler...
`ERROR_CHECK_NONE (0)`	Doesn't compile in any error calls.
`ERROR_CHECK_PARTIAL (1)`	Compiles in only `ErrDisplay` and `ErrFatalDisplayIf` calls.
`ERROR_CHECK_FULL (2)`	Compiles in all three calls.

During development, it makes sense to set full error checking for early development, partial error checking during alpha and beta test periods, and no error checking for the final product. At partial error checking, only fatal errors are displayed; error conditions that are only possible are ignored under the assumption that the application developer is already aware of the condition and designed the software to operate that way.

Using the Error Manager Macros

Calls to the error manager to display errors are actually compiler macros that are conditionally compiled into your program. Most of the calls take a boolean parameter, which should be set to `true` to display the error, and a pointer to a text message to display if the condition is true.

Typically, the boolean parameter is an in-line expression that evaluates to `true` if there is an error condition. As a result, both the expression that evaluates the error condition and the message text are left out of the compiled code when error checking is turned off.

You can call ErrFatalDisplayIf, or ErrDisplay, but using ErrFatalDisplayIf makes your source code look neater.

For example, assume your source code looks like this:

```
result = DoSomething();
ErrFatalDisplayIf (result < 0,
  "unexpected result from DoSomething");
```

With error checking turned on, this code displays an error alert dialog if the result from DoSomething() is less than 0. Besides the error message itself, this alert also shows the file name and line number of the source code that called the error manager. With error checking turned off, both the expression evaluation err < 0 and the error message text are left out of the compiled code.

The same net result can be achieved by the following code:

```
result = DoSomething();
#if ERROR_CHECK_LEVEL != ERROR_CHECK_NONE
if (result < 0)
  ErrDisplay ("unexpected result from
DoSomething");
#endif
```

However, this solution is longer and requires more work than simply calling ErrFatalDisplayIf. It also makes the source code harder to follow.

The Try-and-Catch Mechanism

The error manager is aware of the machine state of the Palm OS device and can therefore correctly save and restore this state. The built-in try and catch of the compiler can't be used because it's machine dependent.

Try and catch is basically a neater way of implementing a goto if an error occurs. A typical way of handling errors in the middle of a routine is to go to the end of the routine as soon as an error occurs and have some general-purpose cleanup code at the end of every routine. Errors in nested routines are even trickier because the result code from every subroutine call must be checked before continuing.

When you set up a try/catch, you are providing the compiler with a place to jump to when an error occurs. You can go to that error handling routine at any time by calling ErrThrow. When the compiler sees the ErrThrow call, it performs a goto to your error handling code. The greatest advantage to calling ErrThrow, however, is for handling errors in nested subroutine calls.

Even if ErrThrow is called from a nested subroutine, execution immediately goes to the same error handling code in the higher-level call. The compiler and runtime environment automatically strip off the stack frames that were pushed onto the stack during the nesting process and go to the error handling section of the higher-level call. You no longer have to check for result codes after calling every subroutine; this greatly simplifies your source code and reduces its size.

Using the Try and Catch Mechanism

The following example illustrates the possible layout for a typical routine using the error manager's try and catch mechanism.

Listing 12.1 Try and Catch Mechanism Example

```
ErrTry {
  p = MemPtrNew(1000);
  if (!p) ErrThrow(errNoMemory);
  MemSet(p, 1000, 0);
  CreateTable(p);
  PrintTable(p);
  }

ErrCatch(err) {
  // Recover or clean up after a failure in the
  // above Try block."err" is an int
  // identifying the reason for the failure.

  // You may call ErrThrow() if you want to
  // jump out to the next Catch block.

  // The code in this Catch block doesn't
  // execute if the above Try block completes
  // without a Throw.

  if (err == errNoMemory)
```

```
   ErrDisplay("Out of Memory");
else
   ErrDisplay("Some other error");
} ErrEndCatch
// You must structure your code exactly as
// above. You can't have an ErrTry without an
//ErrCatch { } ErrEndCatch, or vice versa.
```

Any call to `ErrThrow` within the `ErrTry` block results in control passing immediately to the `ErrCatch` block. Even if the subroutine `CreateTable` called `ErrThrow`, control would pass directly to the `ErrCatch` block. If the `ErrTry` block completes without calling `ErrThrow`, the `ErrCatch` block is not executed.

You can nest multiple `ErrTry` blocks. For example, if you wanted to perform some cleanup at the end of `CreateTable` in case of error,

- Put `ErrTry/ErrCatch` blocks in `CreateTable`
- Clean up in the `ErrCatch` block first
- Call `ErrThrow` to jump to the top-level `ErrCatch`

Summary of Debugging API

Error Manager Functions

Displaying Errors

ErrAlert
ErrDisplay
ErrDisplayFileLineMsg
ErrFatalDisplayIf
ErrNonFatalDisplayIf

Catching Exceptions

ErrCatch
ErrEndCatch
ErrExceptionList
ErrThrow
ErrTry

13

Standard IO Applications

The Palm OS® supports command line (UNIX style) applications for debugging and special purposes such as communications utilities. This capability is not intended for general users, but for developers. This feature is not implemented in the Palm OS, but rather by additional C modules that you must link with your application.

NOTE: Don't confuse this standard IO functionality with the file streaming API. They are unrelated.

There are two parts necessary for a standard IO application:

- The standard IO application itself.

  A standard IO application is not like a normal Palm™ application. It is executed by a command line and has minimal user interface. It can take character input from the stdin device (the keyboard) and write character output to the stdout window.

- The standard IO provider application.

  A standard IO provider application is necessary to execute and see output from a standard IO application. The standard IO provider application is a normal Palm application that provides a field in which you can enter commands to execute standard IO applications. The field also serves as a stdout window where output from the executing application is written.

The details of creating these two different applications are described in the following sections.

Creating a Standard IO Application

To create a standard IO application, you must include the header file `StdIOPalm.h`. In addition to including this header, you must link the application with the module `StdIOPalm.c`. This module provides a `PilotMain` routine that extracts the command line arguments from the `cmd` and `cmdPBP` parameters and the glue code necessary for executing the appropriate callbacks supplied by the standard IO provider application.

You build the application normally, but give it a database type of `sioDBType` ('sdio') instead of 'appl'. In addition, it must be named "Cmd-*cmdname*" where *cmdname* is the name of the command used to execute the application. For example, the ping command would be placed in a database named "Cmd-ping".

In the Palm VII™ device, the Network panel, whose log window is a standard IO provider application, has two standard IO commands built-in: info and finger. The ROM has two additional ones: ping and nettrace.

When compiling for the Palm device, the entry point must be named `SioMain` and must accept two parameters: `argc` and `argv`. Here's the simplest possible example of a standard IO application.

```
#include <StdIOPalm.h>
Int16 SioMain(UInt16 argc, Char* argv[ ])
{
    printf("Hello World\n");
}
```

Standard IO applications can use several input and output functions that mimic their similarly named UNIX counterparts. These are listed in the summary table at the end of this chapter.

Your standard IO application can accept input from stdin and write output to stdout. The stdin device corresponds to the text field in the standard IO provider application that is used for input and output. The stdout device corresponds to that same text field.

Creating a Standard IO Provider Application

In order for a standard IO application to be invoked and able to provide results, you need a standard IO provider application. This application provides the user interface support; that is, the stdin device support and the stdout window that the standard IO application reads from and writes to.

The standard IO provider launches the standard IO application when the user types in a command line and Return (using Graffiti®). The provider application passes a structure pointer that contains the callbacks necessary for performing IO to the standard IO application through the `cmdPBP` parameter of `PilotMain`.

To create a standard IO provider application, you must link the application with the module `StdIOProvider.c`.

To handle input and output, the standard IO provider application must provide a form with a text field and a scroll bar. The standard IO provider application must do the following:

1. Call `SioInit` during application initialization. `SioInit` saves the object ID of the form that contains the input/output field, the field itself, and the scroll bar.
2. Call `SioHandleEvent` from the form's event handler before doing application specific processing of the event. In other words, the form event handler that the application installs with `FrmSetEventHandler` should call `SioHandleEvent` before it does anything else with the event.
3. Call `SioFree` during application shutdown.

The application is free to call any of the standard IO macros and functions between the `SioInit` and `SioFree` calls. If the current form is not the standard IO form when these calls are made, they will record changes to the active text and display it the next time the form becomes active.

A typical standard IO provider application will have a routine called `ApplicationHandleEvent`, which gets called from its main event loop after `SysHandleEvent` and `MenuHandleEvent`. An example is shown in Listing 13.1.

Listing 13.1 Standard IO Provider ApplicationHandleEvent Routine

```
static Boolean ApplicationHandleEvent (EventPtr event)
{
   FormType* frm;
   UInt16 formId;

   if (event->eType == frmLoadEvent) {
     formId = event->data.frmLoad.formID;
     frm = FrmInitForm (formId);
     FrmSetActiveForm (frm);

     switch (formId) {
        .....
        case myViewWithStdIO:
           FrmSetEventHandler (frm, MyViewHandleEvent);
           break;
        }
     return (true);
     }

   return (false);
   }
```

A typical application form event handler is shown in Listing 13.2.

Listing 13.2 Standard IO Provider Form Event Handler

```
static Boolean MyViewHandleEvent (EventPtr event)
{
   FormType* frm;
   Boolean handled = false;

   // Let StdIO handler do its thing first.
   if (SioHandleEvent(event)) return true;

   // If StdIO did not completely handle the event...
   if (event->eType == ctlSelectEvent) {
      switch (event->data.ctlSelect.controlID) {
         case myViewDoneButtonID:
           FrmGotoForm (networkFormID);
           handled = true;
           break;
        }
      }
```

```
    else if (event->eType == menuEvent)
      return MyMenuDoCommand( event->data.menu.itemID );

    else if (event->eType == frmUpdateEvent) {
      MyViewDraw( FrmGetActiveForm() );
      handled = true;
      }

    else if (event->eType == frmOpenEvent) {
      frm = FrmGetActiveForm();
      MyViewInit( frm );
      MyViewDraw( frm );
      handled = true;
      }

    else if (event->eType == frmCloseEvent) {
      frm = FrmGetActiveForm();
      MyViewClose(frm);
      }

    return (handled);
  }
```

Summary of Standard IO

Standard IO Macros and Functions	
fgetc	Siofgets
fgets	Siofprintf
fprintf	Siofputc
fputc	Siofputs
fputs	Siogets
getchar	Sioprintf
gets	Sioputs
printf	Siosystem
putc	Siovfprintf
putchar	sprintf
puts	system
SioAddCommand	vfprintf
Siofgetc	vsprintf

Application-Defined Functions
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Standard IO Provider Functions	
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SioExecCommand	SioInit
SioFree	

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